

The 5
Essential Smart Skills
for Work and Life Success

THINKING AND PROBLEM SOLVING

By Bob Wiele



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Fearless Diamond Press

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PROFICIENCIES IN THINKING SKILLS AND PROBLEM-SOLVING SKILLS

The goal of this module is to equip you with the knowledge, skills and confidence in thinking and problem solving to succeed in our changing 21st century world. The thinking and problem solving skills give you the foundations for success in this program and more importantly in life. This module will help you build your versatility and your adaptability to deal better with change.

The SmartSkills @ Work curriculum is based on the OneSmartWorld system of how to build your total intelligence and confidence. The 4D-i® / 4 Dimensions Inventory will give you practical knowledge, skills and tools to help you develop more self-awareness and increase your self understanding. The 4D-i® will help you decide how to make the most of what you have. It will help you decide how best to improve your performance. This module will give you the tools to generate more ideas, get better organized and make better decisions working on your own and with others.

In this module, you have the opportunity to develop proficiency in these skills:

CRITICAL THINKING

1. Identify the root cause or crux of a problem, challenge or opportunity
2. Interpret information and come to conclusions
3. Evaluate and validate alternatives prior to making a decision
4. Reflect critically on experience and processes to improve decision-making

ANALYTICAL THINKING

1. Scan situations, observe people's actions and feelings, gather and record information
2. Plan, structure and organize information and tasks
3. Clarify all information and reduce confusions to ensure deep understanding before acting

CREATIVE THINKING

1. Brainstorm ideas and options
2. Challenge assumptions to open up new ways
3. Reframe problems into opportunities
4. Envision possibilities

PROBLEM SOLVING – use the strategies as tools to plan, problem solve and achieve goals

1. Assess situations and identify the crux of problems or issues
2. Set outcome based objectives
3. Use and develop sequential planning and problem solving processes
4. Develop time based steps to carry out the processes
5. Follow the process plans to achieve results
6. Reflect and assess effectiveness of results, process and transfer to other situations

THE LEAP FRAMEWORK FOR LEARNING

The LEAP framework for learning is a simple framework for learning, developed by Bob Wiele, to accelerate skill development and improve your success .

LEAP consists of the following core components.

L – LeARN. This has two elements – one that outlines the what and the why of the knowledge and the second that provides procedures and tips on how to use the information



- **Need to Know** – short information capsules on the current research and theories on the topic



- **Smart How To's** - a list of key pointers on how to implement the knowledge into life and work



- **e-exPeRieNCe** – opportunities to reflect on one's experiences and what the learner already knows



A- Apply@ WorK ANd ASSeSS

- **Apply @ Work** – poses a challenge on how best to transfer what you learned to the workplace

- **Assess** – this component is not included in the books but is for the instructor to use with you to help you know how you are doing. It assists you grow your skills.



- **p – prAcTice SKills** – a focus on repeated practice of the concepts, the language and the behaviors to build your skills, your confidence and improve your results.

Lesson 1: Thinking Styles and Thinking at Work

INTRODUCTION

In the 21st century, people need to be able to think better and work smarter to find and keep good jobs. Thinking Skills is a new core competency. Leading business, education and government organizations around the world have all identified thinking skills – critical thinking, analytical thinking and creative thinking – as essential for people looking for work and being successful in their jobs. Smart employers want people who can think well, communicate effectively, work well with others and take initiative to solve problems and get work done.

Here is how Mona Mourshed, director of education at McKinsey, describes the challenge for learners today:

“Students need more than subjects and content in their curriculum. They need to acquire a new set of 21st century ‘smart skills’ to help them become more nimble, more adaptive and versatile. Beyond subject mastery, students need to be more effective thinkers, communicators, creative problem solvers and collaborative teammates.”

This program is designed to equip you with the smart skills you need in thinking, problem-solving, communicating and working collaboratively with others.

This lesson covers some basic information about thinking styles and the higher order thinking skills that employers are looking for. It introduces some of the new understanding of how our brain works and the six executive functions of your brain.

A UNIVERSAL COMMON LANGUAGE



STOP AND DECIDE

SLOW AND UNDERSTAND

GO AND CREATE



Experience Exercise: Thinking about Thinking

Here are three questions about thinking:

1. What are some words and phrases that describe different types of thinking? Make a list of as many different types as you can come up with.

2. What type of thinking do you enjoy doing? What type of thinking motivates you the most?

3. What type of thinking work do you find difficult to do? What type of thinking doesn't motivate you?



Need to Know: Thinking Styles

A thinking style is a way of thinking. It is not a skill or ability. A thinking style is the way you like to use the abilities you have. It is the way you see the world. People have different thinking styles. Your thinking style is the way you prefer to use the abilities you have. Thinking styles aim where you put your focus and attention.

Here are some things to know about thinking styles, thanks to the lifelong research work of Robert Sternberg:

- **Thinking styles are your preferences, not your abilities.** You can like to do something, but not necessarily be good at it. You can be good at something and not like it. The best combination for success at work is to know your own thinking style preferences – like analytical or creative or practical - and to make sure you build up your abilities in that type of thinking so that you are good and skilled at what you like to do.
- **you have more than just one thinking style.** You have your own mix of how you like to think and act. The 4D-i gives you a way to understand your own unique approach and thinking style preferences. You can use it to help you find the type of work you like and can succeed in.
- **your thinking styles can change over a lifetime.** As you learn more and gain different experiences, your thinking preferences can change.
- **Thinking styles are measureable.** Your 4D-i gives you a powerful set of tools to know yourself and to measure how your preferences compare to other people's thinking styles. It also gives you some information to help decide how to develop the additional skills you need to succeed.
- **your success at work comes from fi the right fi** - a job and a set of tasks that match your personal thinking styles. Finding the right job fit is important. This way you can do what you enjoy and develop the abilities you need to be successful.
- **one type of thinking style may be valued in one place or one job, but not in another.** Someone who is very analytical is best suited for work that requires accuracy and precision. That same skill set may not be effective in creative marketing or in front line customer service job in a fast food restaurant.
- **one type of thinking style can be valued at one time, but not at another.** In the changing workplace, one type of thinking can help get certain types of work done. But if conditions change, that type of thinking may no longer be as important.
- **Thinking styles are not good or bad – it's all about the fi .** Most jobs require people to use more than one thinking style. The best performers have more versatility. They can shift and adapt their thinking to match the specific job that needs to be done.
- **Thinking styles can be learned.** While you may prefer one type of thinking style over another, the good news is that you can learn to acquire different thinking styles.

This program will help you to understand your own unique thinking styles. Just as importantly, it will help you to develop and expand your thinking skills in order to be more effective in many different situations.



Experience Exercise: Dumb and Dumber. Smart and Smarter.

REFLECT ON AND DISCUSS THESE QUESTIONS

DUMB AND DUMBER

1. If someone at work was acting in a dumb way, how would you know?
2. What would you notice them doing?
3. What would they not be doing, that they should be doing?
4. What might be the impact of this type of behaviour?

NOTES:

SMART AND SMARTER

1. If someone at work was acting in a smart or intelligent way, how would you know?
2. What would you notice them doing?
3. What would be the impact of this type of behaviour?

NOTES:



Apply @ Work: Hiring People Who Know How to Think and Work Smarter

Reflect on your discussions from the Dumb and Dumber. Smart and Smarter exercise.

1.If you were an employer, what would you look for in your employees if you wanted to hire people who knew how to think, work and act smarter? What would they do well? Develop a checklist of the top seven 'think, work and act smarter behaviours?

2.What questions would you ask to help you judge if people had one or more of these top seven behaviours?



Experience Exercise: Thinking is Hard Work

Henry Ford said,

“Thinking is the hardest work there is, which is probably the reason so few engage in it.”

1. What types of thinking work do you find the most difficult to do?

2. Why are they difficult for you?

3. Imagine yourself in a workplace: what type of thinking work would be the most enjoyable for you to do?

4. Why is that type of thinking work most enjoyable for you?

5. What type of thinking skills would you like to develop?



Need to Know: Your Brain and the Six Executive Functions

Today's jobs require more brain work than muscle work. All of your thinking happens in your brain. You do all of your planning, idea generation, evaluating, problem-solving and decision-making in what is called the executive part of your brain. That makes sense since you are the executive in charge of your own life. The executive part of your brain is located at the front of your skull, behind your forehead.



Learning is brain work. All learning happens in your brain. Your brain is your most valuable asset in today's workplace. It is where you store what you know and where you go when you need to figure things out. And the good news is that you can also make your brain work better and help you work smarter.

SIX EXECUTIVE FUNCTIONS OF YOUR BRAIN

The way you learn the Essential Skills in this program will help you get more mentally fit by building up the six executive functions of your brain. This program gives you an opportunity to:

1. Overcome rigid one way black and white thinking and increase your skills in how to switch from one type of thinking to another in order to better meet the demands of the work or person you are dealing with.

2. Learn how to use different types of thinking and master the processes to find better solutions to the problems you have to cope with and sort out.

3. Learn how to take charge of your own attention and direct your attention. Learn how to keep your focus on the task at hand and avoid distractions to help you complete the important things you need to do.

4. Learn how to control your impulses better under pressure. Learn how to make smarter choices and increase your control over your quick reaction emotional reactions.

5. Learn how to set goals. Learn how organize your thinking, speaking and writing skills to get more done and improve your results.

6. Learn how to learn better. Learn how to retain and remember what you have learned.



Apply @ Work: Build Your Executive Skills

Review the six executive functions. Identify the one that you feel would be the most useful and important for you to develop.

1. Which one did you choose. Why?

2. If you develop it, what impact or difference will it make for you at work?

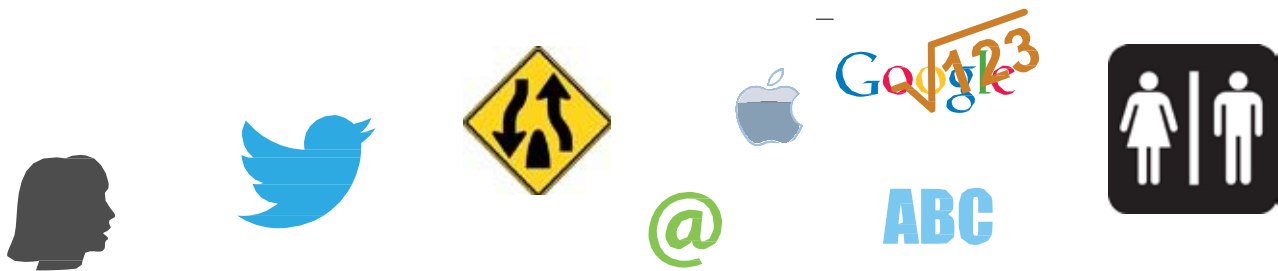
3. What tasks will it help you to become better at?

4. What evidence will convince an employer and convince you that you have improved your skills in this particular executive function?

Lesson 2: A New Common Language for Thinking, Problem-solving and Working with Others

INTRODUCTION

Common languages help us in every aspect of our lives. These languages are made up of symbols and pictures to help save time, make the right decisions and get work done. They do everything from help us decide which washroom to use, where to turn on the highway, what products to buy, how to read, write, do math. They are embedded into our lives and in our smart phones.



In today's fast moving and hectic life, we all use simple phrases and symbols as a common language for communicating and working together. We do this at work, with our friends, in our families, and in the groups we belong to. A common language helps us get on the same page quickly and easily. A common language helps us decide what to do. Like the symbols on washrooms, arrow signs on the highway and red stop signs, a common language tells us where to go and what to do to get what we need.

A common language gives us the keys to access all kinds of knowledge and skills:

- S -53)# – learn the notes in music, and you can use the notes as the basic tools to do everything from play “Mary Had a Little Lamb” to compose a rock opera.
- S .5-"%23 – learn the numbers in math and you can use the numbers to help you add up your grocery bill or do the math to design an aerodynamic airplane part.
- S ,%44%23 – learn the letters of the alphabet and you can use the letters to make a list, compose a poem, send an e-mail or write a technical manual.

In the 21st century, we have the most diverse workforce ever. People from all over the world come to Canada and are working together. Organizations have people with different cultures, backgrounds, education, ages and experiences. More and more of that work involves people working in groups and teams. Much of that work involves communicating and collaborating.

This module will teach you a simple new color-coded language, developed in Canada, to help you think better and work smarter with others. It will help you get on the same page with people who have different thinking styles and come from different places.



Experience Exercise: Common Languages

1. Can you list some examples of common languages you use in your life?

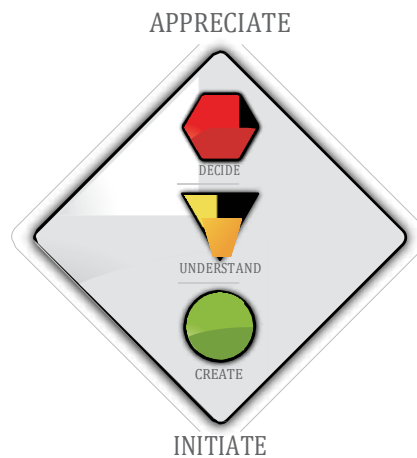
2. What does knowing a common language do for a member of a group or team?

3. What does not having a common language do to a newcomer in a group?



Need to Know: The Common Language of Thinking

Our lives are full of common languages. Some of them are universal, such as music, math, the US dollar and smiles. Other common languages are more local – ethnic-based or community-based languages that members of that community all share and use, but people outside of that community don't know or understand.



In this program, you will learn a new SmartSkills® common language that will help you to think better and work smarter with others. Knowing how to use this common language will be a big part of improving your employability, your thinking skills and your versatility.

THE 4 DIMENSIONS OF HIGH PERFORMANCE THINKING

This simple universal common language is based on four dimensions of high performance thinking. It's modeled on a traffic light to make it easy to learn, simple to understand and effortless to use.



DO RED. STOP AND DECIDE – get to the bottom of things, make decisions, demand proof, see how it fits with your values and beliefs. Just do it



BE YELLOW. SLOW DOWN AND UNDERSTAND – be careful, look around and gather information, and get the facts. Know the details. Get organized. Have a clear plan. Seek to understand other people to make sure you know what's important to them



GO GREEN. GO AND CREATE – go and develop as many ideas, options, dreams, new solutions and breakthrough ideas as possible



BE WHITE. APPRECIATE AND INITIATE – appreciate yourself, other people and the opportunity or opportunities that you have. Take the initiative

THE 7 MINDSETS

Each of the first three dimensions has a cool or thinking mindset and a warm or emotional mindset.

THE GREEN CREATIVITY DIMENSION WORKS IN TWO VERY DIFFERENT WAYS



Creative thinking – Cool Green – focuses your attention on pro-active ways to generate new ideas or options by using strategies of brainstorming, challenging assumptions, reframing problems into opportunities and envisioning future possibilities.

Creative intuition – Warm Green – produces ‘Aha!’ breakthrough ideas, by using strategies of get into the flow and flash of insight

THE YELLOW UNDERSTANDING DIMENSION WORKS IN TWO VERY DIFFERENT WAYS



Analytical thinking – Cool Yellow – focuses your attention on deepening your understanding of the situation, task, problem or relationship by using strategies of scanning for information, structuring information and continually clarifying.

compassion – Warm Yellow – focuses your attention on the feelings and emotions, to give you a more in-depth understanding of how people feel, by using the strategies of tuning-in to feelings, empathizing with others and expressing your own feelings.

THE RED DECISION-MAKING DIMENSION WORKS IN TWO VERY DIFFERENT WAYS



Critical thinking – Cool Red – focuses your attention on making decisions based on practical logic, using the strategies of getting to the crux of an issue, coming to a conclusion, validating the conclusion and relying on experience.

emotion-based decision-making – Warm Red – focuses your attention on making decisions, based on your emotions and your heart, by using two very different types of strategies – your values and beliefs about what is right or wrong and trusting your heart or gut intuition to decide. Each of these strategies is a separate mindset and a different way of making decisions.



Practice Skill: Putting Words to Signs

Using the traffic light and the diamond, prepare a list of words and activities that would apply in the work place for each of the four dimensions.

	WORDSTOUSE	ACTIVITIESTODO
 CREATE		
 UNDERSTAND		
 DECIDE		
APPRECIATE  INITIATE		



Smart How To's: Use the Seven Mindsets at Work

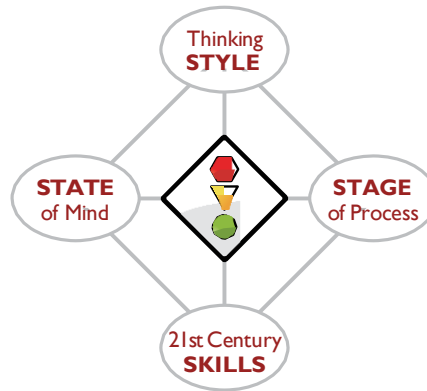
Here is a way to harness your thinking and to shift your thinking into any one of the 3 thinking mindsets and the 4 emotional mindsets. Use this as your power shifting guide, when you need to shift from one type of thinking to another, to reach your goals and be successful with someone else.





Need to Know: The Four S Framework

The Smart Skills model has four core applications for improving skills and getting work done, all off the same platform.



KNOW AND GROW YOURSELF

The first two S's describe how you can first know yourself and then grow your skills.

1. THINKING STYLE. The 4D-i gives you a deep understanding of your own Thinking Style; your own preferred way of thinking and operating. Your own operating style makes you unique. It highlights the strategies you like to use. It's very useful for both knowing yourself better, and for giving you ideas on how to grow.

2. SKILLS PORTFOLIO. The 4D-i is based on 21 core thinking skills. Your 4D-i results show which of the 21 skills you like the most. You can learn all of these skills the same way you learn anything else – with commitment, effort, deliberate practise and perseverance. There are six skills to develop your creativity, six skills to develop your understanding, six skills to improve your decision-making abilities, and three skills to build your personal spirit. The good news is that the more of these strategies and skills you can learn, the better prepared you will be for the workplace.

IMPROVE PRODUCTIVITY AND GET WORK DONE

The next two S's are about improving your productivity. They use the same common language to help you focus where to put your attention and shift your thinking to get work done.

3. STATES OF MIND. Each of the colours represents a different state of mind. The red traffic light tells you to shift your thinking to get to the point and make a decision. The Yellow state of mind, like the yellow traffic light, tells you to shift your thinking and slow down, to look around and make sure that you have all of the information you need. The Green state of mind tells you to take your foot off the brake and shift your thinking to open up and create new ideas, options and alternatives.

4. STAGES OF A PROCESS. Each of the four colors can be used as building blocks for a step-by-step process for figuring things out. The Smart Tracks are a set of colour-coded problem-solving processes. Each Smart Track uses the same 4 building blocks to help you plan and organize your thinking to get work done. Smart Tracks will help you get organized so that you can plan how and where to start and finish a task, get ready for difficult conversations, plan, run and participate in team meetings etc..



Apply @ Work: Thinking at Work

1. What work have you done – paid or unpaid – where you were expected to figure things out?

2. What work did not encourage you to think, just to do what was expected?

3. What type of work can you imagine being the most meaningful for you?

4. Do you prefer having some freedom to think things through and make decisions, or do you prefer to do work that is controlled?

Lesson 3: The 4D-i® and How to Make the Most of Your Results

INTRODUCTION

The 4D-i is not a test. It is an assessment to help you learn more about yourself and to learn a simple common language and skill set for workplace success. Other self assessments are designed as mirrors, to simply help you know who you are. The 4D-i is designed as a portal or doorway to help you know yourself better and also to give you the tools and guidance to grow yourself – to show you how to acquire new skills to become a 4 dimensional thinker.

This lesson covers some of the basics in understanding your 4D-I and how to make the most of your results. It gives you detailed descriptions of all of the colours and the strategies and exercises to build your skills.



Experience Exercise: Tools for Knowing Yourself and Tools for Learning

Reflect on any other types of assessments you have done. What did you learn about yourself?

1. How helpful were 'tests' in school?

2. What did this type of test teach you?

3. Where did you learn the most about yourself?

4. What would you really like to know more about yourself?



Need to Know: The 4D-i and a Simple Common Language

In 2000, the 4D-i was invented in Canada, by Bob Wiele and his team at OneSmartWorld. The goal was to develop a simple common language and toolkit to help people and teams everywhere succeed, by learning how to think better and work smarter together.

The purpose of the 4D-i in this program, is to give you the basic tools to know yourself better and as a way to expand your thinking skills.

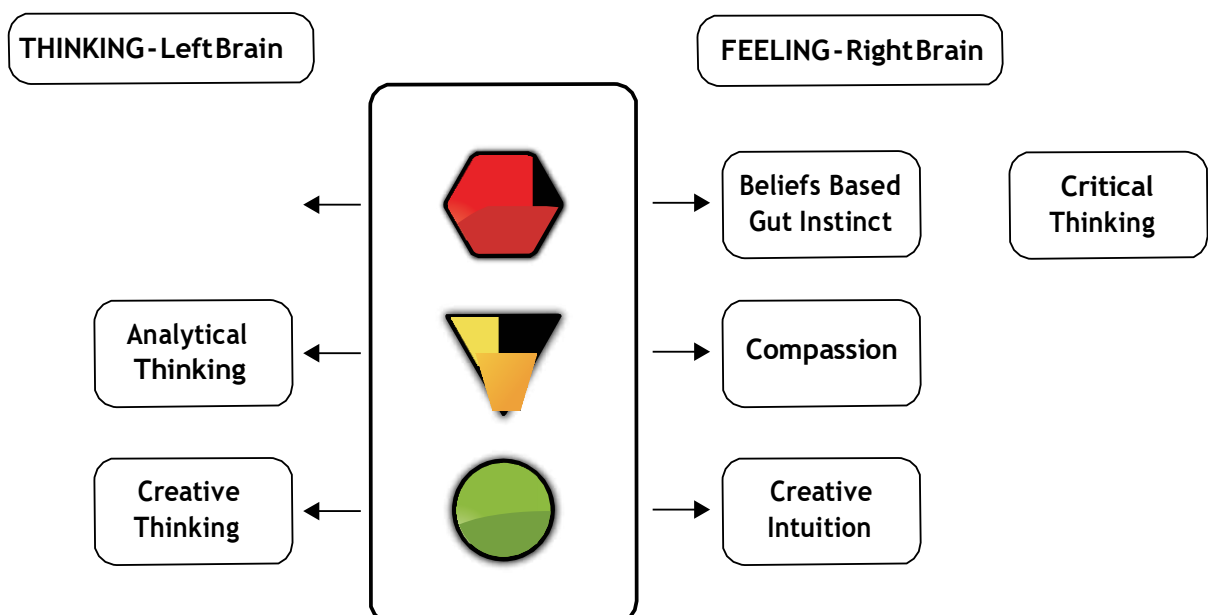
The 4D-i is based on 15 years of research. The 4D-i has been selected by leading businesses, governments and not-for-profit organizations to develop leaders, build high performance teams and increase innovation.

The OneSmartWorld Smarter Meetings program, using the 4D-i and the Smart Track processes in this module, produced a 558% ROI or return on investment, the highest ever achieved and measured in Canada, from a corporate training program, by saving time and money by reducing the length of waste in meetings.

In schools, colleges and universities in Canada and the US, the 4D-i is used in courses and programs to help learners understand themselves better and give them the core thinking, problem solving, communications and collaborative teamwork skills to succeed in school and at work.

The common language and thinking strategies in the 4D-i are the foundations for this program. The 4D-i is the first instrument that was designed to help people think better and work smarter by using the results to increase self-awareness, build 21st century skills, improve relationships and get work done faster.

Cool Head and Warm Heart





Need to Know: The 4D-i Basics

The 4D-i is based on 3 separate research studies to set the norms for the instrument – 1000 people in 2000, 8,000 people in 2004 and 25,000 people in 2008. This compares what you prefer and like to do with thousands of other people who took the same assessment. Here are some things to know about the 4D-i:

1. **NO RIGHT OR WRONG.** There is no right or wrong profile. This is all about your preferences
2. **PERCENTILES COMPARE PREFERENCES NOT ABILITIES.** The results are in percentiles. They compare your preferences with other people's preferences, not your skills.
3. **HIGH RESULT= HIGH PREFERENCE.** A high result means you have a high preference for a colour or strategy
4. **LOW RESULT = LOW PREFERENCE.** A low result means you have a low preference, not a low ability
5. **ZERO = NO SELECTION, NO PREFERENCE.** A 0/zero result simply means that you never selected it as one of the ones you prefer, in any of the five times it was offered as a choice.
6. **COOL HEAD.** The term cool means you prefer to lead with your head and your thinking
7. **WARM HEART.** The term Warm means you prefer to lead with your heart and your emotions
8. **BALANCED.** The term balanced means you have a similar preference for using both your head and your heart
9. **LEARNABLE NOT FIXED.** You can learn how to build any one or more of the skills in any of these strategies by using the tools in the 4D-i and the exercises in this program
10. **ACCESSIBLE 24/7.** You will have access to your online results 24/7

NOTES



Smart How To's: Seven Ways to be Great

Tools are only as good as how you use them. Here are seven tips from the experts on how to succeed.

1. **DELIBERATE PRACTISE** – this is a life-long key to success in anything. Deliberate means that you focus on the specific and often difficult things that you need to master in order to be good. The tighter you focus on what you need to improve, the better. Take small steps. Practise means that you try a skill over and over again. You learn from how you did it and you learn while you work on correcting and improving your how-to steps.
2. **DELIBERATE THINKING** – smart people don't act impulsively and make rash decisions. They think twice and act once. They learn how to slow things down and think things through. The skills and tools from your 4D-i and this program will help you to become a more deliberate thinker.
3. **DAILY EFFORT AND HARD WORK** – there are no short cuts or instant ways to become great at something. You have to commit to continuous learning, and put in the time and effort to work on your game.
4. **PASSION** – it is so important to find work and things to do that are meaningful for you, and that you really love. Find what you love to do. Work carefully and deliberately to build your abilities.
5. **PERSEVERANCE** – obstacles and setbacks are part of life. The winners keep going when the going gets tough. Your own personal spirit will help you stay on track and work through the challenges. Keep on keeping on.
6. **SELF-DISCIPLINE** – know what you want to accomplish and continue to pick the one thing you need to do, right now, that will move you towards your desired future. Plan your work. Work your plan. No excuses. You and your life are too important.
7. **POSITIVE OUTLOOK** – find the silver lining. Bad things happen to everyone. Approach everything with a positive, constructive mindset – “How can I make the most of this/learn from this?” Positivity beats negativity at work and in life.



Practice Skill: Plan Your Work, Learning and Life Profile

Think about your work habits and approach to learning and life. Plot your own profile along these seven lines. On each line, put an X where you feel you put your efforts and commitment.

1. DELIBERATE PRACTICE	LOW	HIGH
2. DELIBERATE THINKING	LOW	HIGH
3. DAILY EFFORT	LOW	HIGH
4. PASSION	LOW	HIGH
5. PERSEVERANCE	LOW	HIGH
6. SELF-DISCIPLINE	LOW	HIGH
7. POSITIVE OUTLOOK	LOW	HIGH

NOTES



Apply @ Work: Getting Better

What task or skill would you like to build the most? Select one of the Seven Ways to be Great that would be the most important for you to get better at. What specific steps could you take that would help you develop that skill? How could you apply the Seven Ways to be Great to building that skill?

☐ DELIBERATE PRACTICE

☐ DELIBERATE THINKING

☐ DAILY EFFORTS

☐ PASSION

☐ PERSEVERANCE

☐ SELF-DISCIPLINE

☐ POSITIVE OUTLOOK

1. Select one.

2. What steps could you take to build up this skill?

3. How could you apply all 7 to get better?



Experience Exercise: Thinking About Your Thinking

What types of things do you like to think about the most? What types of thinking do you like to do? How do you suppose your thinking style impacts your results in life and in your relationships?

NOTES:



Need to Know: The 21 Strategies

You need to be good enough in each of the four dimensions of thinking, not just in the ones you like to use. The more you can strive to be a 4D or four-dimensional person through hard work, the more likely you will succeed at work. The 21 strategies in your 4D-i are like the 10 digits in numeracy or the 26 letters of the alphabet in literacy. They are the building blocks for effective thinking, problem-solving, communicating, writing and working with others. As you get better at each one, your performance will improve. The 21 thinking strategies are the core building blocks in the 4D-i, the SmartSkills system and in the entire Success @Work program.

THE 11 THINKING STRATEGIES



CRITICAL THINKING – use these strategies to make a sound, logical and practical decision

- **Get to the crux** – determine the essence or most critical aspect of a problem, issue or situation in order to take action
- **conclude** – reach a logical conclusion or resolution about what is the best way to proceed
- **Validate the conclusion** – pose tough questions to eliminate inferior options and poor quality information in order to critically assess and ensure the best decision
- **rely on experience** – rely upon and use one's past experience to guide decision-making and problem solving



ANALYTICAL THINKING – use these strategies to develop a comprehensive, well-organized and clear understanding of issues, topics, relationships and situations

- **Scan the Situation** – survey the environment, person or situation to gather as much information as possible
- **Structure information** – organize information, data, people, resources and processes in meaningful and systematic ways
- **clarify Understanding** – sharpen the understanding of a situation by gathering more information and asking questions



CREATIVE THINKING

- **Brainstorm ideas** – generate many ideas and a wide variety of options prior to analysis or decision-making
- **challenge Assumptions** – questions assumptions, the status quo and accepted wisdom in order to create new ideas, options and fresh ways of dealing with the task at hand
- **reframe problems into opportunities** – create new ways of looking at a problem or situation by shifting the approach, angle or way of thinking about it
- **envision possibilities** – create mental pictures or imagine 'what if' scenarios of future possibilities or solutions

THE 7 EMOTIONAL STRATEGIES



EMOTION BASED DECISIONS – use these strategies when you need to base your decisions on feelings

BELIEFS- BASED

- **Values- driven** – make decisions based on your personal core beliefs about what is good or bad, right or wrong

GUT INTUITION

- **Trust your Heart** – Listen to your heart and your feelings as a guide for making decisions about what to do



COMPASSION – use these strategies to deeply understand the emotions and feelings in yourself and others

- **Tune-in to Feelings** – sense and connect with the emotional dimensions in a situation, other person or group
- **empathize with others** – show kindness, caring, compassion, tolerance and deep understanding for and a connection to others
- **express Feelings** – select and use the appropriate emotional and verbal language or communication method to get the true message across



CREATIVE INTUITION

- **Get into the Flow** – tolerate ambiguity, conflicting information and feelings while refraining from decision-making, waiting for a better idea or option to appear
- **Flash of insight** – know intuitively without conscious reasoning and/or produce insights and hunches



PERSONAL SPIRIT

- **your outlook** – is a personal disposition and an active process of experiencing the world, based on your belief that an optimistic, constructive approach to life and its challenges helps one to find and harness the positive hidden potential and meaning in any situation, task or person.
- **your Sense of control** – is a personal disposition and an active process, founded on the belief that, despite difficult circumstances, one can exert personal control over one's own emotions and efforts to impact an outcome or achieve an objective. It does not mean controlling others.
- **your initiative** – is a personal disposition and an active process, based on the belief that one should attempt to go beyond conventional boundaries, if necessary, to do what it takes to complete important tasks, achieve goals and to assist others to solve their problems.



Practice Skill: Work Your Green Skills

Focus on what to think, feel, say and do.



CREATIVE THINKING

- **Brainstorm ideas**

- **challenge Assumptions**

- **reframe problems into opportunities**

- **envision possibilities**



CREATIVE INTUITION

- **Get into the Flow**

- **Flash of insight**



Practice Skill: Work Your Yellow Skills

Focus on what to think, feel, say and do.



ANALYTICAL THINKING

- **Scan the Situation**

- **Structure information**

- **clarify Understanding**



COMPASSION

- **Tune in to Feelings**

- **empathize with others**

- **express Feelings**



Practice Skill: Work Your Red Skills

Focus on what to think, feel, say and do.



CRITICAL THINKING

- **Get to the crux**

- **come to conclusions**

- **Validate conclusions**

- **rely on experience**



EMOTION-BASED DECISION MAKING

- **Values driven**

- **Gut intuition**



Apply @ Work: Strengthening Your Skills

Reflect and plan for where and how you can use and expand each of the skills in and outside of the workplace.



CRITICAL THINKING



EMOTION BASED DECISION-MAKING



ANALYTICAL THINKING



COMPASSION



CREATIVE THINKING



CREATIVE INTUITION



PERSONAL SPIRIT



Apply @ Work: Refl

and Projections

Reflect on what you have learned so far.

1. What are the implications for you? What types of work would let you use your highest preferences? What one colour skill could you develop that would have the most impact on your abilities, relationship skills and future job success?

2. What are some of the obstacles you have to overcome to improve your thinking skills?

3. Set two personal development goals that will help you to be a 4D-i learner, person and employee.

4. What steps will get you moving forward?



Practice Skill: Believe It to Achieve It

Use this performance planner to help you prepare for an interview, presentation or important event.

High performers in all walks of life think better and work smarter. They know how to mentally prepare for their performance, long before they have to perform. *The Believe It to Achieve It Planner* is a powerful tool to help you mentally and emotionally prepare for an important event like giving a speech, handling an interview, managing a conflict or dealing with a challenging person or task.

Use this simple template, whenever you have to perform at your best. Get your mind, heart and spirit ready, by carefully aligning your inner world of beliefs, feelings and thoughts, with the results you want to achieve.

BELIEVE IT TO ACHIEVE IT: YOUR PERSONAL SUCCESS PLANNER

Start by completing Step 1: *Set Your Intention* and Step 7: *Achieve It*. Next, complete Steps 2 through to 6.

STEP 1. *Set Your Intention*: Everything starts with intention. Describe in detail what your overall desire is. Get in touch and write down why you are doing what you want to do.

STEP 2. *Believe It*: List your own “I believe...” statements - the key, positive, empowering beliefs about yourself and your commitment to your intention, that you will need to support the achievement of your desired results

STEP 3. *Feel It*: Write down your own powerful and positive “I feel...” (terrific, confident, passionate, courageous, deeply committed) statements. These are the feelings that you need to choose to be in the right emotional state.

STEP 4. *Think It:* Describe clearly and specifically the positive, constructive self-talk phrases you will say to yourself, particularly under pressure, to reinforce your beliefs and support your intentions. Identify any negative self-talk you tended to use in the past and commit to replace it with the positive self-talk.

STEP 5. *Say It:* Identify the actual words and phrases you will use with other people, to reinforce your commitment to the achievement of your goals.

STEP 6. *Do It:* Make a list of the specific action steps you commit to. List the small steps and the big steps. Be specific. Make a plan to get started. Set a timeline – what you will do today, tomorrow, in the next 3 days, week...

STEP 7. *Achieve It:* Write a detailed description of what successful achievement looks like. Describe success as clearly as you can. Use the present tense and positive language, as if success is already in place for you..

Lesson 4: Problem-Solving Skills

INTRODUCTION

Each day we work to solve problems and challenges that we face, sometimes successfully and sometimes not so much. Problem solving is a key skill for success at work and home in the 21st century because so many things are changing.

Problem solving skills are like muscles – the more you use them, the stronger they get. This lesson focuses on using the color-coded language of green, yellow, red and white as the building blocks for thinking through any problem. You will learn how to set outcomes, plan problem solving processes and the how to work your way through challenges to come up with better solutions and decisions.

The skills in this lesson can be used 2 distinct ways

1. Problem solving and decision-making – working through problems, issues and challenges
2. Opportunity and dream development – using the Smart Track processes to pursue a new vision, project or opportunity where you are creating something new and innovative

Many simple problems can be solved by finding the right answer. Get the right information and there is your solution. Not too much thinking is involved. Complex problems are tougher. There is no one right answer and no easy way to finding a solution. This is where you need to use some good quality thinking.

This lesson introduces the process side of the color-coded language and some practical tools called Smart Tracks you can use to figure things out.



Experience Exercise: Problems, Problems Everywhere

Reflect on how you go about solving problems. Think about a recent decision you had to make. What steps, if any, did you go through to arrive at your decision? What's your own personal way of achieving a solution on a small issue/item? What's your approach for making a decision on a big issue, problem or challenge?

NOTES:



Apply @ Work: Two Signifi

Problems

Think of two significant problems you have seen someone deal with in their jobs that were poorly solved, or where the way in which the problems were 'solved' actually made them worse.

1. What was the problem?

2. What key factors contributed to what happened?

3. What was a big takeaway for you from those experiences?

NOTES:



Need to Know: Three Typical Problem-Solving Mistakes

Sometimes the problems we have to deal with are made worse by the way we go about solving them. The real problem is not the problem itself, but the way we go about solving it.

1. LACK OF A PROCESS. This is where you leave things to chance, make decisions much too quickly or slowly, and never use a simple step-by-step process to get you where you want to go. Without a process, you might not gather the essential facts and information that would help you to solve the problem. You fail to explore enough options, and you can jump to conclusions too quickly.

TIP: Before you do anything, make sure you pick a process for every important problem you face. Select a Smart Track process that will help you think through what you have to do. Use it as your path and GPS to get to where you want to go.

2. OVERCONFIDENCE IN OUR OWN JUDGEMENT. This is where fools rush in. Experts and novices can make the mistake of rushing in and deciding what the problem is before they really stop to think things through. This is the result of an arrogant, know it all or closed mindset.

TIP: Slow down. See every problem as fresh and unique, and don't simply lump it in with other problems you have dealt with in the past. Get into Yellow to learn as much as you can before you take any other steps. Tune in. Listen. Scan the situation. Ask lots of clarifying-type questions.

3. MISTAKING TALKING FOR PROGRESS. A lot of talking goes on in meetings, but not always a lot of progress. Problem-solving is mainly about getting to Red. Too much talk and no action wastes everyone's time and energy.

TIP: Keep the outcome and end in mind. Know where you want to end up, and make sure that everything you do helps to get you there. Listen to what you are thinking about, and make sure that you focus on continuing to move things forward.



Practice Skill: : Hindsight is 20/20

Reflect on three situations where you tried to solve a problem and used one of the three mistakes listed below:

1. LACK OF A PROCESS – review what happened. Develop a list of three of your own tips, based on what you have learned, to teach others how to learn from your experience.

2. OVERCONFIDENCE – review what happened. Develop a list of three of your own tips, based on what you have learned, to teach others how to learn from your experience.

3. MISTAKING TALKING FOR PROGRESS – review what happened. Develop a list of three of your own tips, based on what you have learned, to teach others how to learn from your experience.



Need to Know: 3 Key Guidelines

Smart problem-solving starts with you. It is an inside job. It all starts with your point of view. Some people only see problems, while others see opportunities buried in those problems. The smart problem-solving process is based on three simple guidelines:

GUIDELINE #1: DECIDE WHAT TYPE OF OUTCOME YOU WANT. This resembles your mind's GPS. It helps you decide your destination – where you want to end up. The colour-coded system provides you with three distinct types of outcomes. While most outcomes are Red, sometimes the outcome is a plan or a relationship that's working well again, or simply a set of options to consider for a later time.

 ADVICE OR DECISION-MAKING	 CLARITY OR UNDERSTANDING	 CREATIVE IDEAS AND OPTIONS
☐ Advice and experience - on what to do ☐ Critical assessment - of my proposal ☐ Recommendation - on what to do ☐ Decision - solution	☐ Clarification and understanding ☐ Analysis ☐ A plan or process to follow ☐ Empathy and rapport	☐ Ideas and option ☐ New ways of looking at a situation ☐ What if's ☐ Imaginative solutions and insights

GUIDELINE #2: SELECT THE SMART TRACK PROCESS TO GET YOU THERE. The next step is to plan your route and decide how you want to get to your destination. Simple problems only need a direct route; complex problems need more thought so that you can make the most of your time and resources. To be a smart problem solver, you need to slow down and think through how to get to the best solution.

The following Smart Tracks offer you five key benefits:

- **repeatable** – you can use the same processes over and over again
- **consistent** – they use the same steps and procedures
- **Step-by-Step** – they give you a sequence or order to follow so that you don't miss any important steps
- **colour-coded** – they show you the different types of thinking to use for each step
- **results** – they will help you get the best results you need

GUIDELINE #3: SHIFT YOUR THINKING AT EACH PHASE OF THE PROCESS. Once you have the Smart Track process in place, the next thing to do is stretch your mind so that you can get the most out of Green idea generating, Yellow information gathering and good critical thinking in Red. This means changing your thinking to match the task or person you are working with.



Practice Skill: How to Select Outcomes

Think of three upcoming issues you have to figure out, such as making a purchase, planning something, or resolving a problem with a friend or family member. Think about each situation and select the colour of the outcome you want for each one – a decision, a solution, a plan, a relationship back on track, new options and ideas to consider, etc.

1.

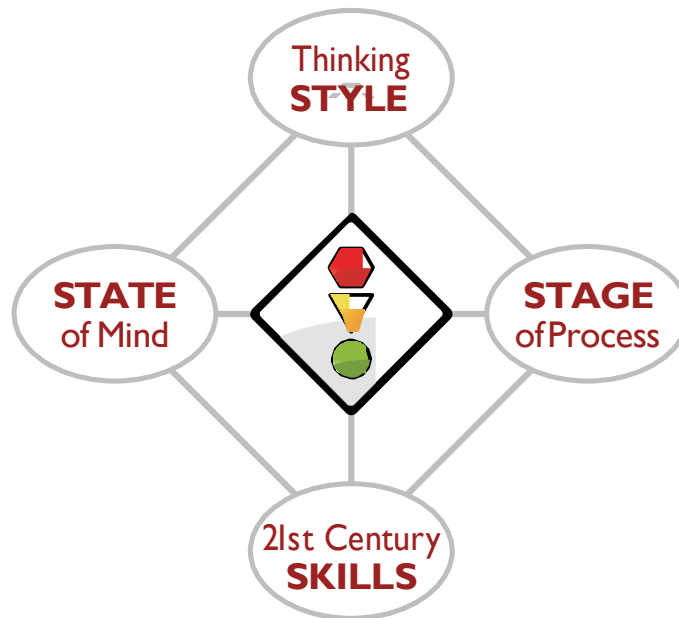
2.

3.



Need to Know: The Colours of Smart Problem Solving

Simple problems usually require less thinking, more complex problems require more. Your thinking tools for smart problem solving are found in the 4 dimensions of high performance thinking. The specific strategies are your precision tools for figuring things out.



Smart problem solving means you need to tap into all the skills in the 4 dimensions. It means you adjust your state of mind at each stage of the process – see the Smart Tracks in this lesson – and use just the right amount of each type of thinking to get to where you need to be.



GO GREEN

The more difficult a problem is, the more you will need to use creative thinking to ensure you explore a wide variety of approaches and ideas before you decide on what to do.

S 5. - when you settle too quickly on one solution or limited set of options, without doing some hard work to challenge assumptions or reframe the problem to come at it from a different and potentially more effective angle. Impatience or overconfidence can kill high quality thinking and decision-making by short circuiting green time.

S /6 – when you keep generating different ideas and solutions, possibly avoiding a commitment, when it is time to cut to the chase, make a decision and select a solution

S 2) - when you have generated a wide variety of possible options and solutions that will address the crux of the problem you are dealing with



Need to Know: The Colours of Smart Problem Solving



BE YELLOW

The more complex a problem is, the more you will need to develop a deeper understanding of the forces, factors and facts to ensure you have enough information and analysis before you decide to take action.

S 5.5% - when you settle too quickly on one solution or limited set of options, without doing some hard work to gather information, study the facts, analyze the data and attend to how people are feeling about it. Impatience and overconfidence can kill high quality thinking and decision-making by underusing yellow time.

S 16.5% – when you keep going over and over data, seeking more and more information, studying the details without turning the corner and coming to a decision. This is often described as paralysis by analysis.

S 21.45% – when you have examined the ‘right’ amount of information and spent time really clarifying the information and organizing it into ways that are useful to build a plan, launch an innovation or make a decision.



DO RED

To solve any problem well, it is vital to determine what the crux of the issue is before generating ideas and rushing to judgement. The more difficult a problem is, the more vital it is to use your critical thinking effectively.

S 5.5% - when you delay and postpone coming to a conclusion or rush to make a reactive decision, based on strong feelings and values instead of hard facts and evidence, and your critical thinking time and effort.

S 16.5% – when you continually dive in and make hasty decisions, instead of stepping back and developing a real understanding of the situation, the people involved and implications of the decision.

S 21.45% – when you have spent enough time really thinking through the root cause or crux of the problem, gathered the right amount of information, generated a variety of workable options and then debated the best way to proceed, based on evidence and agreement.



IGNITE WHITE

The more challenging the problem, the more you will need to harness your Personal Spirit to ignite your commitment and resilience to persevere through tough times. Your personal spirit keeps you going forward, learning and finding ways to achieve the goal.

S 5.5% - when you worry too much, choose a poor outlook, feel like a victim and quit too early

S 16.5% – when you are so motivated that you overwhelm others around you and smother their desire to exert their own personal spirit.

S 21.45% – when you fully appreciate the opportunities and the challenges and the people around you, when you continually seek where and how to move things forward and you have the courage to step up and lead when needed.



Practice Skill: Allocating the Right Amount of Time to Think

POOR RESULTS

Reflect back to situations where decisions and plans did not work out too well. Using the 4 colours:

1. What one colour was over-used and what one colour was under-used?

2. How would you re-design the time spent in each colour in order to produce a better result?

GOOD RESULTS

Reflect back to situations where decisions and plans did work out well. Using the 4 colours:

1. What one colour was used most effectively and what did that produce?

2. How would you re-design the time spent in each colour in order to produce a better result?



Smart How To's: Tips on Using the Colour Coded Thinking and Shifting

Most problem solving processes end in Red with a decision, followed by a plan or initiative. Here are some practical tips on when to use the different colours and strategies as your precision tools in problem solving.



RED – the role of Red is different depending on where it is in the Smart Track process.

- **crux** – usually used at the outset after there is a review of the information
- **conclude** – usually used after Yellow information is understood and/or Green options are generated
- **Validate the conclusion** – best used right after a crux or conclusion as the quality assurance tool to make sure the solution or decision makes sense
- **rely on experience** – sometimes help at the beginning and always at the end to help validate the conclusions
- **Values driven** – sometimes needs to be parked at the outset, most helpful to energize the thinking work and to use to make sure a decision aligns with what you or the group values
- **Trust your heart** – this gut intuition is helpful at the crux stage too and at the conclusion phase to balance head with heart



YELLOW -

- **Beginning** - most often used at the beginning of a process to provide a solid foundation of research, facts and information by scanning
- **Middle**
 - clarify, clarify, clarify – very useful to deepen understanding and avoid getting into Red too soon, so everyone really understands what each other is saying
 - tune-in and empathize – to ensure everyone is engaged and to make sure everyone contributes
 - structure – after the Green phase as a disciplined way of organizing the ideas into categories and buckets
- **end** – to build a detailed implementation plan of what, when, how and who



GREEN

- **Beginning** - most often used at the beginning of a process to shift away from complaining and jump start finding solutions by envisioning possibilities and brainstorming ideas
- **Middle** – used after the crux is decided upon and it is time to explore options, ideas and alternatives
- **end** – seldom used, unless someone has a flash of insight or a way to reframe that helps move to a resolution



WHITE

- **Beginning** – great to set the right positive can-do tone and positive outlook
- **Middle** – when people lose heart, ignite the Personal Spirit to persevere and keep moving forward
- **end** – great to ask for people to take initiative to step up and take the lead to make things happen

JUST DO IT! The bottom line is to just start using a Smart Track. Any process is better than no process. You will get better the more you use them. So – pick your outcome, select your Smart Track process, locate some times for each phase and adjust as needed.

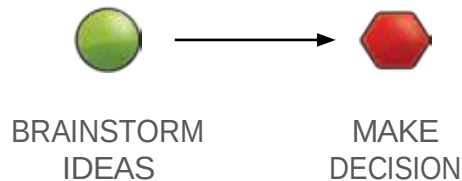


Smart How To's: Two-Step Smart Tracks

THE FIVE TWO-STEP SMART TRACKS

When problems, challenges or situations are not very complex, you only need to use one of the five simple two-step Smart Track processes. When there is little time available, you can go to Smart Tracks #1, #2 and #7. When time is not really an issue, but in-depth understanding is important, go to Smart Track #6. When generating a variety of options and ideas is essential, go to Smart Track #8.

SMART TRACK #1: IDEAS TO ACTION



USE IT WHEN

- Time is tight and you want a few ideas before deciding

HOW TO USE THIS PROCESS

- Select type of outcome - advice, recommendations, decisions etc...
- Share information on the problem/challenge for one minute
- Brainstorm a variety of ideas
- Eliminate ideas or recombine to ensure best option is selected

SMART TRACK #2: FACTS TO ACTION



USE IT WHEN

- You've presented information (e.g. a report) and you want a critique, advice, recommendations or decision

HOW TO USE THIS PROCESS

- Select type of outcome - advice, recommendations, decisions etc...
- Share information on the situation and the options available
- Focus on deciding the best course of action



Smart How To's: The Smart Track Worksheets

SMART TRACK #6: FACTS TO UNDERSTANDING



SHARE
INFORMATION

CLARIFY
UNDERSTANDING

USE IT WHEN

- You or others need to understand the situation better

HOW TO USE THIS PROCESS

- Select type of outcome - understanding, analysis, rapport etc...
- Share the necessary information
- Ensure clarity and understanding

SMART TRACK #7: DECISIONS TO PLAN



MAKE
DECISION

PLAN AND
ORGANIZE

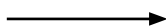
USE IT WHEN

- You need to make a decision and work on how to implement it

HOW TO USE THIS PROCESS

- Select type of outcome - plan or process...
- Two options - announce a decision or decide on a course of action, then work out how to implement
- In Yellow - establish the proper level of detail needed to carry out the plan
- Expect Green ideas to surface to help the implementation planning

SMART TRACK #8: INFORMATION TO OPTIONS



DESCRIBE
SITUATION

REFRAME AND
BRAINSTORM
IDEAS

USE IT WHEN

- You need fresh input and a broader number of options, alternatives or ideas on how to solve a problem before you choose which one is the right one

HOW TO USE THIS PROCESS

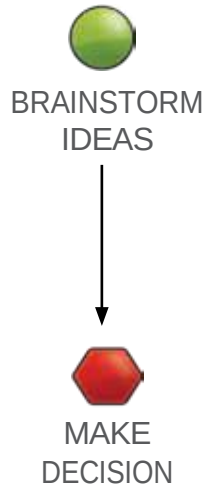
- Select type of outcome - ideas, options, solutions etc...
- Briefly describe the situation, challenge, issue or problem
- Generate as many ideas and options as possible - what if...and write down every idea



Smart How To's: The Smart Track Worksheets: Two-Step Smart Tracks

SMART TRACK #1: IDEAS TO ACTION

Use this track when you have an issue or problem and you want a quick decision, but first you need some ideas and options before you decide what to do.

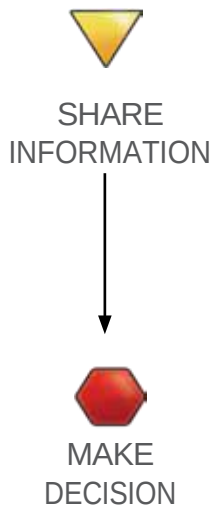


STEP 1. Reframe the problem - list the positive aspects, generate many ideas and options

STEP 2. Select the best option and commit to act on it.

SMART TRACK #2: FACTS TO ACTION

Use this track when you have an issue or problem and you want to get a recommendation or a decision, base on clear information and understanding prior to taking action.



STEP 1. Describe the situation or problem; just the facts.

STEP 2. Come to a conclusion and determine the right course of action.



Smart How To's: The Smart Track Worksheets: Two-Step Smart Tracks

SMART TRACK #6: FACTS TO UNDERSTANDING

Use this track when you want the other person to develop clarity and understanding about a situation or issue.



SHARE
INFORMATION



CLARIFY
UNDERSTANDING

STEP 1. Share information on the current situation/status.

STEP 2. Ensure clarity and understanding through dialogue.

SMART TRACK #7: DECISIONS TO PLAN

Use this track when you need to start first with a decision, then shift into developing an implementation plan - what, who, when, how...



MAKE
DECISION



PLAN AND
ORGANIZE

STEP 1. Begin with deciding what you are going to do.

STEP 2. Outline the steps you will take to implement your solution.

SMART TRACK #8: INFORMATION TO OPTIONS

Use this track when you need ideas, options and alternatives before you make a decision at a later date. First, you outline and explain the current situation, then look for new ideas by reframing problems into opportunities and brainstorming.



DESCRIBE
SITUATION



REFRAME AND
BRAINSTORM IDEAS

STEP 1. Describe the situation with enough information.

STEP 2. Generate many ideas and options, reframe problems into opportunities.



Smart How To's: Smart Track Facts to Decisions

SMART TRACK #3: FACTS TO DECISIONS



USE IT WHEN

- You need to start with the facts
- There are strong feelings or confusion

HOW TO USE THIS PROCESS

Step 1. yellow – Describe the Situation

- What specifically is known about this?
- What's the whole picture?

Step 2. Green – Generate Ideas

- What different ideas, options or solutions can be generated?
- What are some other ways to address this?

Step 3. red – Decide the 'Best Bet'

- What option will work best?
- What decision makes the most sense?

TIPS FOR SUCCESS

1. limit the time in yellow. Beware of the trap of using too much time in Yellow. There is a point where too much information confuses or overwhelms people and sidetracks the need to move forward. Know when to say, "That's enough information, let's move to the next phase."

2. Use all of the time budgeted in Green. Beware of shutting down the Green phase too quickly. Research shows that ideas often come in waves, and that the best ideas may come in the last wave. Use all of the time you have budgeted in Green.

3. Use red Stepping Stone 1: yellow to Green. Sometimes when the Yellow phase is completed, you may need to spend a few minutes taking a mini-Red step – "What is the crux of the issue?" – before going to the Green zone. Think of this as a helpful stepping stone that will assist you in zeroing in on the key issue before moving on to generate great Green ideas.

4. Use yellow Stepping Stone 2: Green to red. Sometimes it helps to review all of the options and alternatives generated before moving on to the decision-making phase. Think of this as a helpful stepping stone to get you from ideas to the action phase.



Practice Skill: Facts to Decisions

SMART TRACK #3: FACTS TO DECISIONS



DESCRIBE
SITUATION

Step 1. What's the problem? What's the situation?



BRAINSTORM
IDEAS

Step 2. What could we do?



MAKE
DECISION

Step 3. What will we do?



Smart How To's: Smart Track Ideas and Decisions

SMART TRACK #4: IDEAS TO DECISIONS



This track is the best one to use when you are ready to stop spinning your wheels and move forward. It often starts with a brief recap, in Yellow, of the current situation; or in Red with a brief statement of the crux of the issue to be addressed.

USE IT WHEN

- There is little or no disagreement on the problem
- You need to be creative to move on

HOW TO USE THIS PROCESS

Step 1. Green – Generate Ideas

What ideas can I/we generate?

What new possibilities can be created?

Step 2. yellow – Organize Ideas into Categories

How should these ideas be organized?

Where exactly do each of these ideas fit?

Step 3. red – Make Decisions

What is the best option?

Which proposal is the right one?

TIPS FOR SUCCESS

- 1. Go Green with idea cards.** You will get more and better ideas if people initially work on their own and write their ideas on post-it notes, file cards or flipcharts. (The same is true when working by yourself.)
- 2. in yellow, develop categories to Bundle and Structure the ideas.** A key to success is the ability to structure the information from idea generating into definable categories or 'buckets.' The first step is to scan the information from the Green phase, and then to find common ways of grouping and organizing the ideas.
- 3. Use a Green Stepping Stone Between yellow and red.** Sometimes it is worthwhile to combine or recombine ideas from the list into possible solutions.
- 4. Use a Stepping Stone from yellow to red.** Sometimes it is helpful to step back and develop criteria for deciding which idea to choose.



Practice Skill: Ideas to Decisions

SMART TRACK #4: IDEAS TO DECISIONS



GENERATE
IDEAS



Step 1. What could we do?



ORGANIZE
IDEAS



Step 2. How can we organize these ideas into clusters?



MAKE
DECISION

Step 3. What should we do?



Smart How To's: Smart Track Crux to Decisions

SMART TRACK #5: CRUX TO DECISIONS



USE IT WHEN

- The real issue is unclear
- There is a need to establish common ground

HOW TO USE THIS PROCESS

Step 1. red – Determine the Crux

What is the crux of the situation?
What's the real issue here?

Step 2. Green – Generate Alternatives

What options can be developed?
How many different ways can we approach this?

Step 3. yellow – Make Decisions

How should these ideas be organized?
Where exactly do each of these ideas fit?

Step 4. red – Make Decisions

What is the best option to select?
Which proposal is the right one to act upon?

TIPS FOR SUCCESS

- 1. First of all, get the right crux.** This first step is vital to success. Get clear on what the real problem is that you want to solve. Sometimes it helps to reframe the problem a number of times to ensure that you select the right problem. (The same is true when working by yourself.)
- 2. Accelerate Green with idea cards.** You will get more and better ideas if people initially work on their own and write out their ideas on post-it notes, file cards or flipcharts.
- 3. in yellow, develop categories to Bundle and Structure ideas.** A key to success is the ability to structure the information from idea generating into definable categories or 'buckets.' The first step is to scan the information from the Green phase, and then to find common ways of grouping and organizing the ideas.
- 4. Use a Green Stepping Stone Between yellow and red.** Sometimes it is worthwhile combining or recombining ideas from the list into possible solutions.
- 5. Use a Stepping Stone from yellow to red.** Sometimes it is helpful to step back and develop criteria for deciding which idea to choose.



Practice Skill: Crux to Decisions

SMART TRACK #5: CRUX TO DECISIONS



DETERMINE
THE CRUX

Step 1. What is the crux of the problem?



GENERATE
ALTERNATIVES

Step 2. What are the ideas or alternatives?



ORGANIZE
IDEAS

Step 3. How can we cluster these ideas?



MAKE
DECISION

Step 4. What should we do?



Practice Skill: Making Smart Tracks

The purpose of this exercise is to learn how to build your skills for using different Smart Tracks. What are some of the human challenges, as well as the technical, workplace and cultural factors that have an impact on your current situation? What future changes and opportunities for employment exist in the near future?

TASK

Think of work challenges, community-based challenges, personal issues or employment issues, such as:

- how to apply for a job
- an incident that happened on your last job
- how to deal with a conflict
- making a plan for next weekend
- what to do about...
- making a plan for...

APPLICATION

Build your skills by completing two of the two-step Smart Tracks and three of the three- to five-step Smart Tracks. Include an estimate of the amount of time you think each step will take.

STEP 1.

STEP 2.

STEP 3.

STEP 4.



Experience Exercise: Track Your Decision-Making Style

1. When you decide to make an important purchase, what steps do you go through before you buy it?
2. If you had to make a decision on purchasing an important item, and you decided to use the Yellow to Red track, what would you do in the Yellow phase before you went out and bought it?
3. What would you do in the Green phase before you went out and bought it?



SMART HOW-TO'S: THE RIGHT QUESTIONS AT THE RIGHT TIME

In smart problem solving, you need to be able to shift from one type of thinking to another as you work through a Smart Track process, on your own or with a group.

Here are some of the questions you can use to shift your own thinking or the thinking of your friend, workmate or team into a different colour zone.



GREEN ZONE QUESTIONS

- What are all the ideas we can generate to ...?
- What if... yes and...?
- What is the hidden opportunity here?
- If this was solved, what does success look like?
- What's your hunch?



YELLOW ZONE QUESTIONS

- What do we need to know before we...?
- How can we organize this?
- Can you clarify what you mean?
- How do you feel?
- What is this telling us?



RED ZONE QUESTIONS

- What is the crux of the issue?
- What is the evidence and proof?
- What makes the most sense?
- What is the benefit of...?
- What should we decide to do?



WHITE ZONE QUESTIONS

- What can we appreciate about this?
- How can we get through the hard parts?
- Where can we start to make an impact?
- Who do we need to get on board to support this?
- What can we do to make a real difference?



Practice Skill: Build Your Own Smart Tracks

Think of an upcoming challenge or a problem you face right now. Develop your own problem solving process using the building blocks. Check off the colour coded symbols for each step. Add your key points beside each step.

OUTCOME YOU WANT

STEP 1.



STEP 2.



STEP 3.



STEP 4.



STEP 5.





Practice Skill: Build Your Own Smart Tracks

Think of an upcoming challenge or a problem you face right now. Develop your own problem solving process using the building blocks. Check off the colour coded symbols for each step. Add your key points beside each step.

OUTCOME YOU WANT

STEP 1.



STEP 2.



STEP 3.



STEP 4.



STEP 5.





Practice Skill: Build Your Own Smart Tracks

Think of an upcoming challenge or a problem you face right now. Develop your own problem solving process using the building blocks. Check off the colour coded symbols for each step. Add your key points beside each step.

OUTCOME YOU WANT

STEP 1.



STEP 2.



STEP 3.



STEP 4.



STEP 5.





Practice Skill: Quick Tracks

Work in 3 or 4 person teams to complete these exercises.

Step 1. pick a topic

- order food for your class group
- plan a group trip to a cool place within one hour of driving
- organize an event to teach others how to think smarter
- problem-solve on how to make these classes more useful for all
- plan a work team meeting to solve a real problem

Step 2. Pick a Smart Track or design a problem solving process.

Step 3. Allocate up to 20 minutes to complete the task and allocate times for each step.

Step 4. Work through the Smart Track to come to a conclusion.

Step 5. De-brief how the process worked and the lessons learned.



Apply @ Work: Do's and Don'ts

All the colours and types of thinking are essential for smart problem-solving. Complete the following sheet to determine three don'ts for each of the four colours when you use them in problem-solving.

DO'S	DON'TS
RED - STIMULATE DECISION-MAKING	
• Get to the crux of the issue • Ask tough, practical questions • Use your experience • Decide with the three-way check: common sense, heart and values	e.g. keep asking for more information
YELLOW - STIMULATE UNDERSTANDING	
• Gather information from many sources • Clarify to understand • Listen carefully to others • Be kind, show empathy • Organize everything systematically	e.g. judge
GREEN - STIMULATE CREATIVITY	
• Generate as many ideas as possible • Reframe all problems into opportunities • Challenge all assumptions • Envision future possibilities • Wait for a flash of insight	e.g. criticize
WHITE - STIMULATE PERSONAL SPIRIT	
• Notice what is going on inside and around you • Be positive and constructive in what you say and do • Be courageous, don't hold back • Take the initiative, make commitments	e.g. give up



Apply @ Work: Use on the Job

TASKS

1. Identify a list of five appropriate and five inappropriate problem-solving behaviours.

2. Work with a partner and coach him/her to develop a customized track to deal with a real issue he or she is currently facing.

3. Develop a presentation or drawing on the positive benefits of using colour-coded problem-solving processes at work.



Apply @ Work: On the Job

TASKS

1. Good and ineffective behaviours - identify 3 effective problem solving behaviors and 3 ineffective behaviors that undermine good problem solving

GOOD ONES

INEFFECTIVE ONES

2. coach and develop a customized Smart Track – work with a partner and coach each other on selecting or designing a customized Smart Track to work through a typical on-the-job type of problem.

3. develop a 3-minute presentation on the benefits of using Smart Tracks for teams to solve problems.

ALL ABOUT YOU

As you complete this program, you will have a unique passport to success in the 21st century. Anywhere you go, you will know how to think better. You will know how to solve problems faster. You will be able to communicate and collaborate with others. You will have a stronger personal spirit. You will have the skills to work smarter. These smart skills will be your inside edge to face difficulties, overcome challenges and make the most of your opportunities.

You are already smart. Your 4D-i helps you know more about how you are smart, in your own unique way. Appreciate this. Celebrate what you learn about yourself. The good news is that we can all get smarter. Brains can change and grow. Grow yourself. Be more adaptable. Work on your game. Choose to practice, practice, practice. Put in the effort. Over and over. This is your opportunity. You are in charge.

We are all wired to keep growing and get better. Continue to build your skills in all 4 dimensions.

- Go green – to expand your skills in how to generate more creative ideas
- Slow in yellow – to deepen your skills in how to analyze and organize information and connect better with others
- Get to red – to sharpen your critical thinking skills and make smarter decisions
- Ignite your white – to tap into the power of your personal spirit to appreciate, persevere and initiate.

Support, encourage and help others to get ahead. Reach out. Teach others how to use the traffic light model to shift their thinking. Help them get better results too. Make your mark. Help us all build a smarter, better world.

ABOUT SMARTSKILLS®

Thinking is the core competency for the 21st century. SmartSkills was developed by Bob Wiele and his team at OneSmartWorld. The SmartSkills advantage is its one integrated platform to deliver five essential 21st century skills. It is like having a 4 wheel all terrain vehicle for your mind. SmartSkills is a system of thinking skills, strategies and thinking processes to help people think better, work smarter and get better results. The five skills are thinking, problem solving, communications in speaking and writing, collaborative teamwork and resilience in personal spirit. SmartSkills was designed as an educational innovation to implement the work of the Partnership for 21st Century Skills, the government of Canada's essential skills and the insights of many educational thought leaders. The SmartSkills system has been adopted by many progressive businesses, government workforce development programs and educational institutions.

ABOUT BOB WIELE

Bob Wiele, founder and President of OneSmartWorld, is a relentless innovator committed to help make the world a smarter, better place. His focus is on developing practical tools for individuals, organizations and nations to harness their brainpower, as their key to success in the 21st century. Bob and his team have built powerful thinking skills tools like the 4D-i and the SmartSkills system. He has a BA from McGill, a Master's degree in adult education from the University of Toronto and over 40 years of learning from his mistakes, ventures and efforts. Bob the author of a number of programs, books and papers. He has a great family and lives happily with Mandy in Collingwood, Ontario, Canada. Bob is still working hard to find new ways to get a little bit smarter every day.

NOTES

Thinking and
Problem Solving

Igniting
Personal
Spirit

Communicating



Writing

Working with
Others

THE 21ST CENTURY SKILLS CHALLENGE

"To succeed in our fast changing world, we all need to become more versatile, agile and adaptable. We need to acquire a new set of 21st century 'smart skills'. These skills empower us to improve how we think, problem solve and become great collaborative teammates."
– Bob Wiele, Founder, OneSmartWorld

THE 5 SMART SKILLS PROGRAM

1. Thinking and Problem Solving
2. Igniting Personal Spirit
3. Speaking, Presenting and Communicating
4. Writing to Record, Report and Persuade
5. Working Collaboratively with Others

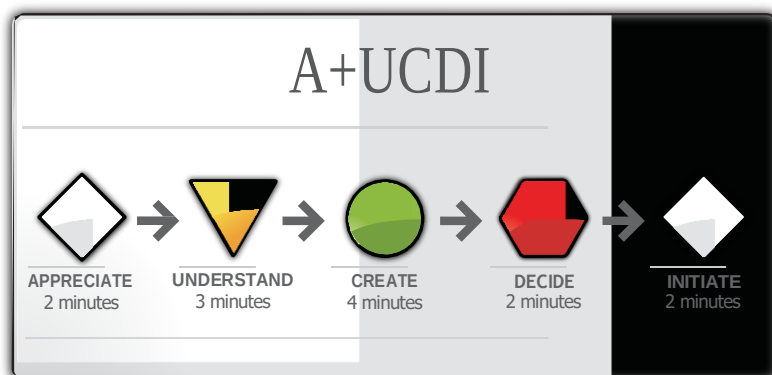
THE 5 STEP PEER COACHING CONVERSATION

WHY WE ARE DOING THIS

1. Deepen your appreciation and understanding of how to use your 4D-i® results
2. Help you select one or two skills and behaviors to improve your performance
3. Practice performance coaching with a partner

THE WAY IT WORKS.

- People work in pairs.
- Each person has the opportunity to both coach and be coached.
- There are 2 rounds. Each round is 7 minutes. Switch roles after the first round.
- Follow the 5-step A+UCDI process to guide the conversation.
- Shift your thinking at each step
- Use the time lines to ensure each person can achieve good quality results
- Coach can make notes on the worksheet and give it to your partner.



THE 5 STEPS

STEP 1. APPRECIATE – “Looking across your 4D-i® profile, what did you learn and appreciate the most about your results?” - 1 minute

STEP 2. UNDERSTAND THE RESULTS – “What patterns do you see? What stands out? What do you think it tells you about yourself?” - 2 minutes

STEP 3. CREATE POSSIBILITIES – “What are some ideas and options to expand your skills and work on your game, that could lead to better results?” - 2 minutes

STEP 4. DECIDE – “Given the ideas and options, what do you want to do that will make the most impact?” - 1 minute

STEP 5. INITIATE – “What one specific initiative and new behavior will you commit to over the next 4 weeks? What’s a first step in the next 24 hours?” - 1 minute

DEBRIEF – Thank each other and reflect on the value of the conversation and what you each appreciated for how you worked together. – 1 minute

THE 4D-I[®] PEER COACHING WORKSHEET

STEP 1. **APPRECIATE** – *“Looking across your 4D-i[®] profile, what did you learn and appreciate the most about your results?”* - 1 minute

STEP 2. **UNDERSTAND THE RESULTS** – *“What patterns do you see? What stands out? What do you think it tells you about yourself?”*- 2 minutes

STEP 3. **CREATE POSSIBILITIES** – *“What are some ideas and options to expand your skills and work on your game, that could lead to better results?”* - 2 minutes

STEP 4. **DECIDE** – *“Given the ideas and options, what do you want to do that will make the most impact?”* - 1 minute

STEP 5. **INITIATE** – *“What one specific initiative and new behavior will you commit to over the next 4 weeks? What’s a first step in the next 24 hours?”* - 1 minute

Work Smarter with Others

How to Detect and Connect Successfully with Different Styles



Detecting The Red Styles: Decision-Making

When a person is operating in Cool Red, they:

- Are very task, goal and deadline oriented
- Are focused, straightforward and direct
- Ask tough questions to pinpoint weaknesses
- Want to get to the bottom line quickly

When a person is operating in Warm Red, they:

- Make decisions based on personal values and beliefs
- Are passionate, committed, willing to take a stand
- Counter logic with gut instincts and hunches
- Trust their heart in making the right decision

Tactics for Connecting to Red

Direction of the Dialogue	Direct, moving to a conclusion
Focus On	Critical issues or values Evidence/benefits, results and action
Attitude	No-nonsense, business-like, emphatic
Pacing	Fast, moving to closure
Duration	Shorter – less time
Body Language	Authoritative, strong Passionate, committed



Detecting The Yellow Styles: Understanding

When a person is operating in Cool Yellow, they:

- Are organized, accurate, precise
- Collect details or facts from a variety of sources
- Ask many questions to clarify understanding
- Take their time coming to a decision

When a person is operating in Warm Yellow, they:

- Are sensitive, empathetic and compassionate
- Use all senses to tune-in to a situation
- Focus on building relationships
- Are able to put themselves in another's shoes

Tactics for Connecting to Yellow

Direction of the Dialogue	Step-by-step Comprehensive
Focus On	Information, sensitivity Clarity and honesty
Attitude	Serious, analytical Accepting and tolerant
Pacing	Methodical, systematic
Duration	Longer – more time
Body Language	Organized, caring, expressive



Detecting The Green Styles:

Creativity

When someone is operating in Cool Green, they:

- Offer many new ideas and options
- Ask “why?” and “why not?” to find new approaches
- Look for the positive side of everything
- Imagine or speculate about what could be

When someone is operating in Warm Green, they:

- Don't appear concerned with time or deadlines
- Have ‘AHA!’ intuitive flashes of insight
- Enjoy change and ambiguity

Tactics for Connecting to Green

Direction of the Dialogue	May jump around, open to change
Focus On	Ideas, options, opportunities
Attitude	Exploratory, see what emerges, free wheeling
Pacing	Fast, non-linear
Duration	Open-ended

Work Smarter with Others

Do's & Don'ts for Successful Communication



WORK SMARTER WITH THE RED STYLES

CRITICAL THINKING	IN COOL RED DO... • Be clear, concise and practical • Stay focused and relevant • Give logical explanations • Rely on experience • Provide sound reasons with proof	IN WARM RED DO... • Be passionate and committed • Speak in the first person • Let your values and beliefs guide you • Decide what really matters most • Go with your gut feelings	VALUES DRIVEN & TRUST YOUR HEART DECISION-MAKING
	IN COOL RED DON'T... • Give too much information • Suggest ideas and options • Stray off track or waste time • Avoid tough questions • Be indirect, vague or defensive	IN WARM RED DON'T... • Second-guess actions or decisions • Be vague or non-committal • Stifle feelings with logic • Be compromised • Stall or avoid tough decisions	



WORK SMARTER WITH THE YELLOW STYLES

ANALYTICAL THINKING	IN COOL YELLOW DO... • Give lots of details and information • Be accurate and precise • Be organized and systematic • Answer questions carefully, completely • Allow time for analysis, clarification	IN WARM YELLOW DO... • Build the relationship • Take time to really listen, observe • Express your feelings honestly • Build rapport and offer support • Listen to all sides of an issue	COMPASSION
	IN COOL YELLOW DON'T... • Expect quick decisions • Rush or skip the details • Stray off track or change the subject • Present too little information • Disrespect their need for clarity	IN WARM YELLOW DON'T... • Take sides or be judgmental • Be inattentive or insensitive • Hold back or reserve true feelings • Assume everyone understands • Ignore feelings and emotions	



WORK SMARTER WITH THE GREEN STYLES

CREATIVE THINKING	IN COOL GREEN DO... • Present what's new and different • Exchange ideas, explore options • Be flexible and adaptable • Move quickly, with an open mind • Lighten up, enjoy their humor	IN WARM GREEN DO... • Relax and exercise patience • Wait for a flash of insight • Believe that a better solution will emerge if you go with the flow • Trust your intuition and theirs	CREATIVE INTUITION
	IN COOL GREEN DON'T... • Push for a quick decision • Judge or criticize their ideas • Be too rigid or structured • Raise obstacles, barriers or problems • Slow down the process	IN WARM GREEN DON'T... • Jump at the first solution or answer • Set deadlines or time tables • Overpower their insights with logic • Ignore their unusual ideas • Evaluate or raise "yes but..." issues	

The 5
Essential Smart Skills
for Work and Life Success

SPEAKING, PRESENTING AND COMMUNICATING

By Bob Wiele



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SPEAKING, PRESENTING AND COMMUNICATING

Speaking, Presenting and Communicating and the LEAP System for Learning 1

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PROFICIENCIES IN SPEAKING, PRESENTING AND COMMUNICATING

The goal of this module is to equip you with the knowledge, skills and confidence in speaking, presenting and communicating so you can listen well and get your message across to others.

In this module, you have the opportunity to develop proficiency in these skills:

1. Communicate clear and complete messages to inform others, appropriate to the task and situation
2. Use positive and professional language in speaking and presenting to others
3. Organize your thinking logically to present problems and suggestions for solutions in a way that can be understood by others
4. Speak to influence, reassure and persuade others
5. Speak to instruct and coach others
6. Speak to provide information and to contribute ideas, suggestions and solutions
7. Listen and ask questions to clarify understanding and appreciate other viewpoints
8. Use questioning, paraphrasing, clarifying and summarizing to confirm others' understanding
9. Display appropriate body language and read the body language of others

THE LEAP FRAMEWORK FOR LEARNING

The LEAP framework for learning is a simple framework for learning, developed by Bob Wiele, to accelerate skill development and improve your success .

LEAP consists of the following core components.

L – LeARn. This has two elements – one that outlines the what and the why of the knowledge and the second that provides procedures and tips on how to use the information



- **Need to Know** – short information capsules on the current research and theories on the topic



- **Smart How To's** - a list of key pointers on how to implement the knowledge into life and work



- **e – expeRienCe** – opportunities to reflect on one's experiences and what the learner already knows



A- Apply@ WorK ANd ASSeSS

- **Apply @ Work** – poses a challenge on how best to transfer what you learned to the workplace

- **Assess** – this component is not included in the books but is for the instructor to use with you to help you know how you are doing. It assists you grow your skills.



- **p – prAcTice SKills** – a focus on repeated practice of the concepts, the language and the behaviors to build your skills, your confidence and improve your results.

Lesson 1: Smart Communications

The communication basics are covered in this lesson. You will learn about the importance of how to send and receive a message when you communicate. Sometimes the way we send a message is the real problem, not the message itself. If the receiver doesn't 'get' the message, the communication breaks down.

You will learn and practice

- 5 core skills in how to communicate
- how the Judger and Learner Mindsets impact your communications
- the Platinum Rule and how successful communication focuses more on what the receiver needs
- what to say and ask in each of the colour-coded mindsets

Communication is an essential workplace skill. It always requires our best thinking to be effective.



Experience Exercise: Poor and Good Communicators We Know

Think about the four points listed here and jot down some point form notes for each of the four items. Pair up with another person and share and talk about what you have come up with.

THE POOR

1. Pick two or three really poor communicators you know personally, or have seen and heard.
2. Think about what makes them so ineffective. List some of the specific types of things they say and do. Jot down the impact their poor communication skills have on their results.

THE GOOD

1. Pick two or three of your favorite communicators – people that you know and admire in your life.
2. Think about what makes them so effective. List some of the specific types of things they say and do. Jot down the impact their good communication skills have on their results.

Pair Share Notes – List some of the points you and your learning partner identified:

POOR COMMUNICATING

GOOD COMMUNICATING



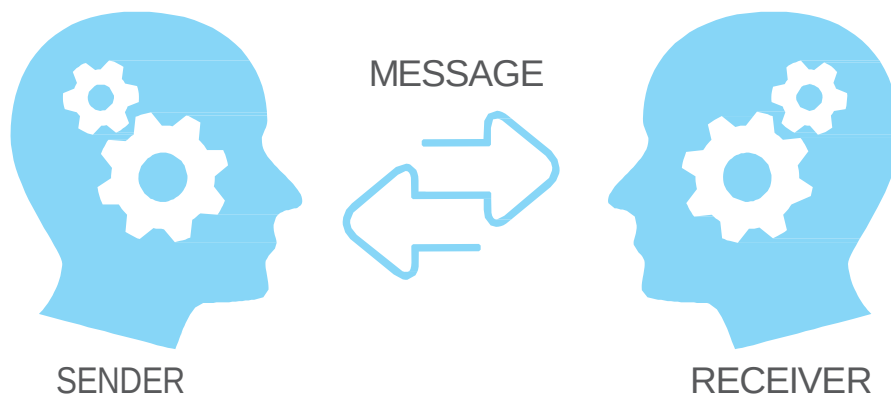
Need to Know: Communicating and Learning Points

People communicate every day. We communicate on the phone, face-to-face, online, in stores, with our friends and family, and with the people we meet and work with every single day. Conversations are the lifeblood of our lives. They fuel our relationships and our success.

Successful people in all walks of life have learned some basic secrets and skills on how to get their message across, as well as how to get along with others. The more skilful you are at having open, engaging conversations, the more successful you will be. Learning how to listen and ask smart questions are two of the keys to success you will learn in this module.

At the core of effective communication is the color Yellow. While all of the colours are used in communicating, the heart of communicating is in Yellow understanding. The three key elements of communicating are:

- **THE SENDER.** How skilful we are at getting that message across to the person we are communicating with.
- **THE RECEIVER.** How well we understand the other person and the message.
- **THE MESSAGE.** How clear the message is that we want to communicate.



Real communication is a two-way street. When you communicate, you are the sender. When someone else communicates, they are the sender and you are the receiver. There is always a sender, the person doing the communicating. There is always a receiver, the person or persons the communication is aimed at. And, of course, there are always one or more messages.

Relationships and communication go together. The better you can build a relationship with someone, even in a few seconds over a counter in a store or while chatting on the phone, the more likely you will be to connect with them, communicate better and achieve a worthwhile solution.



Practice Skill: Effective Communication

Here are a few practice exercises for you to build your knowledge and skills in what it takes to be an effective communicator. First, observe others who are speaking and communicating and see what you can learn.

PROCEDURE

1. Watch clips on YouTube© from your favorite shows or films. Watch TV interviews with celebrities and also watch some serious interviews. Pick two or three people and observe what they do. Note their facial expressions, their body language and their tone of voice. Pay attention to what they say when they are sending a message. Watch what they do – body language, facial expressions – and what they say when the other person is talking. What do you notice? What do the most effective ‘senders’ do? What do the most effective ‘receivers’ do?

COLLECT BEST PRACTICES

	SENDER	RECEIVER
THINK		
FEEL		
SAY		
FACE		
TONE		
BODY LANGUAGE		



Apply @ Work: Drama in the Workplace – What Works and What Doesn't

REAL LIFE

1. In a group of three, each person will share one story about his/her personal experience with good or poor communication in a workplace, as either as a participant or a watcher.. List the results of both poor and good communication.

SUMMARIZE

2. Build a summary of the five most important Communicating Do's and Don'ts for the workplace.

1. _

2. _

3. _

4. _

5. _

PRESENT

3. Prepare a short skit presentation from your results.

4. Debrief together to discuss what people in a workplace need to do in order to make the shift from being poor communicators to becoming effective communicators.

POOR COMMUNICATION



EFFECTIVE COMMUNICATION

_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____



Smart How To's: Five Big Skills in Communicating

Here are five key skills:

1. **CONNECT** – **tune in** to what the other person is doing, as well as possibly thinking and feeling. Start with putting the other person's needs ahead of your own. Scan their face. Tune in to their facial expressions, body language and tone of voice.
2. **LISTEN** – **stop talking**. Make sure that you listen and hear what the other person is saying. Shift your full attention outside of yourself. Put your full energy into listening, hearing and learning as much as you can.
3. **ASK** – **ask smart questions** to engage the other person, e.g., Green questions to have them come up with new ideas and options; Yellow questions to deepen their understanding of the task, situation or issues; Red questions to get to the bottom of things and make decisions; and White questions to build appreciation and get things moving forward.
4. **SPEAK** – **express what you want to say**. Say it in ways that the other person will understand. Say it in ways that can work for them, not just for you. Learn to shift deliberately from one type of thinking and speaking to another type in order to match the needs of the situation, the job at hand, and the other person.
5. **RESPOND AND CO-CREATE** – **engage in good back and forth conversation**. Work together to create a picture of success and a plan to get there.



SKILL PRACTICE: HOW TO'S FOR EACH OF THE FIVE SKILLS

Make a simple breakdown of the specific how to's for each of the five skills. Do a demonstration of what not to do and what to do for each of these five skills.

1. CONNECT:

2. LISTEN:

3. ASK:

4. SPEAK:

5. RESPOND & CO-CREATE:



Need to Know: Learning or Judging:

ARE YOU JUDGING OR LEARNING?

Marilee Adams identified two primary mindsets when people communicate. She calls them the Judger and the Learner mindsets. These mindsets are like glasses we put on to see and experience the world. Choose your glasses and you choose your world. The mindset you choose will determine the result you get.

JUDGER MINDSET

The Judger mindset is like the Fixed mindset. In the Judger mindset, you are closed, not open. You argue, criticize and defend your point of view. As a Judger, you usually think you know it all. You protect yourself and defend what you believe and value. You are not open to possibilities and other points of view.

JUDGER MINDSET

- Judgmental of self, of others
- reactive and automatic
- Knows it already
- rigid and inflexible
- either/or thinking
- Self-righteous
- Afraid of differences
- Self-centred
- defends assumptions
- Sees limited possibilities
- protective

LEARNER MINDSET

- Accepting – Non-judgmental
- responsive and mindful
- is oK with not knowing right away
- Flexible and adaptive
- Both/and thinking
- inquisitive and curious
- Values differences
- Takes in others' points of view
- Questions assumptions
- Sees many possibilities
- curious

LEARNER MINDSET

The Learner mindset is like the Growth mindset. It starts in a different place with a desire to learn and understand. In the Learner mindset, you use a blend of White, Green, Yellow and Red.



WHITE – start by genuinely appreciating the other person and the situation



GREEN – be open to possibilities and new ideas



YELLOW – tune in and gather information and clarify



RED – seek practical, constructive solutions that work for both parties



Practice Skill: The Judger and Learner Mindsets

PROCEDURE

The purpose of this exercise is to experience both of these mindsets. You will work with a partner on the two mindsets. Explore the two approaches using the list above. Your goal is to go through the points in the two lists in Judger and Learner mindsets. Discuss the approach you would take in each one.

1. When are the Judger and Learner mindsets most visible in life and in the workplace?

2. What is the value of each mindset? What does it bring to the person who is in it?

3. When do you find yourself using the Judger mindset? What results do you get?

4. Demonstrate what you and other people think, say and do in the Learner mindset? What results do you get?

5. Demonstrate a simple mental technique to shift from the Judger to the Learner mindset?



Apply @ Work: Judger and Learner

PROCEDURE

Pair up with a partner. Each person will practice being in the Judger mindset and the Learner mindset. This exercise has four rounds of two minutes each – two rounds in the Judger mindset and two rounds in the Learner mindset.

- **JUDGER ROUND 1:**

The first person tells a story about something important to them that happened this week. The second person practices being in the Judger mindset. When the time expires, debrief on what happened and on the impact of the Judger mindset.

- **JUDGER ROUND 2:**

Reverse roles and repeat the same instructions.

- **LEARNER ROUND 1:**

The first person tells an important story about something important to them that happened this week. The second person practices being in the Learner mindset. When the time expires, debrief on what happened and on the impact of the Learner mindset.

- **LEARNER ROUND 2:**

Reverse roles and repeat the same instructions.



Need to Know: The Platinum Rule in Communicating

Most people are familiar with the Golden Rule, *“Do unto others as you would have them do unto you.”*

This has guided people’s behaviour for years. Now we know more about the real heart of good communications, and it’s a lot like good marketing. Find out what people want, and give it to them in the ways that work best for them.

THE PLATINUM RULE

1. We are all different.
2. How others like to be treated is not necessarily the same as how you would like to be treated.
3. Treat others how they would like to be treated.

The Platinum Rule can be a game changer for you in work and in life.

The Platinum Rule helps you decide where to put your attention and focus. It gives you an extra edge and a method for how to shift away from focusing on yourself and your needs to what the other person needs.

To make this work, you have to get out of your own mind and into the mind of the person you are communicating with. Listen, watch, learn and develop an understanding of what they need and how they like to receive information. If you can, start with them first and find out what they need. You are then on your way to success! It’s the same message, but delivered differently to make sure it lands and sticks.

The Smart Skills colours system provide you with a powerful toolkit to access the Platinum Rule. A key to successful communication in life and in relationships is the adaptability to shift from your own strengths and preferences and comfort zone into the mindset and preferences of the person you are dealing with.



Practice Skill: Platinum Rule Show And Tell

PROCEDURE

Answer these questions about your own preferences in communicating:

1. How do you like to be treated when someone is communicating with you?

2. What communication styles or tactics work best for you? What doesn't work?

3. When things are hard to understand, what works best for you to get what you need?

PROCEDURE

1. Think of someone you care about. Think of the Platinum Rule. What do you think works best for them? What doesn't? Demonstrate and describe how you think they like to be treated when someone communicates with them?

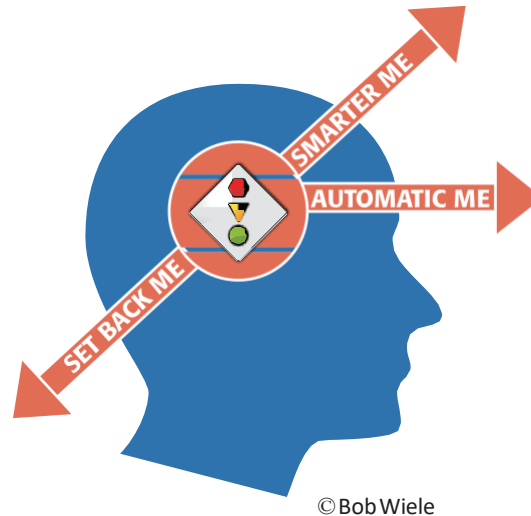
2. Develop a simple way to explain the Platinum Rule to others and share why it is important?



Need to Know: Smarter Choices for Good Communicating

We all know how to speak, but few of us know how to communicate skillfully. When the language we use is automatic and thoughtless, it shapes what we do and the results we get. There is a better and smarter way to communicate.

CHOICEPOINT - THE 3 ME'S



NOT SO SMART

When we don't choose our words thoughtfully, and instead shoot from the hip or the heart, we:

1. Talk more than we need to
2. Fail to listen and learn when working with others
3. Misjudge the impact we have on the emotions of other people
4. Damage relationships
5. Sink our chances for success

Sometimes we resist learning new skills because they require effort. EVERYTHING worth doing and achieving requires effort. There are no shortcuts to success. Trying and failing, continuing to try again and again, and learning from experience are the only ways to move forward.



Need to Know: Smarter Choices for Good Communicating

STALL OR SHIFT AND GROW

There are many ways to communicate. Many people stall in their careers and their relationships because they get stuck into one way of operating, and can't shift out of their own favourite way of communicating.

Some people just don't know:

- that there are different ways of communicating and that they, too, can use them
- how to shift from one thinking style to another
- how to feel comfortable trying something new and different
- how to leave their comfort zone

SMART COMMUNICATING

Change your words, change your thinking, change results. A key starting point for smart communication is to believe that two people are smarter together than each is on his/her own. One person may know more about a particular subject, but when working together, each person brings valuable experience, information and insights that can produce a superior solution.

When you plan how to speak or write, begin with the task or the person in mind.

What type of thinking is best suited to describe and accomplish the task?

- ☐ To persuade and convince others – SHIFT to RED.
- ☐ To clarify, describe and explain a situation, procedure or plan – SHIFT to YELLOW.
- ☐ To generate innovative ideas – SHIFT to GREEN.
- ☐ To inspire others to action – SHIFT to WHITE.



Smart How To's: Convince and Persuade

Here are some sample ways to shift into the Red mindsets to communicate, to convince and persuade others.



Cool Red: Get to the Point

Communicate to get to the point, unite the thinking and decide to do something.

KEY COOL RED STATEMENTS:

“The heart of the problem is...”

“Based on the information available and the options we have, we should...”

“It’s time to push to a conclusion and decide.”

“This evidence clearly shows that we need to...”

KEY COOL RED QUESTIONS:

“What is the crux of the problem?”

“What would you recommend?”

“How will you prove that?”



Warm Red: Use Values and Beliefs

The focus of getting to warm Red is to communicate strong personal feelings about a point or decision.

KEY WARM RED STATEMENTS:

“What we must do is...”

“I feel strongly that we should...”

“My gut tells me that we...”

“I want...”

KEY WARM RED QUESTIONS:

“What do you really want to do?”

“What do you believe is the most important...?”

“Will you commit totally to...?”



Practice Skill: Convince and Persuade

PROCEDURE

Select a topic you feel strongly about and you want to convince others to take action. Read over the information on the previous page. Use the tips and techniques to produce a simple Think, Feel, Say, Do plan to speaking in ways that will demonstrate how you will convince and persuade others.

THINK

FEEL

SAY

DO



Smart How To's: Connect, Clarify, Describe and Explain

Here are some simple ways to shift into the Yellow mindsets to get a clear message across that clarifies, describes or explains your message.



Cool Yellow: Clarify and Explain with Data

Use analytical words to communicate, to develop understanding, to gather and organize information, and to ensure accuracy and clarity.

KEY COOL YELLOW STATEMENTS:

- “Let’s review the information in order to understand...”
- “Based on the information we have, we need further study or discussion to...”
- “To make sense of it all, we need a plan or diagram.”
- “Here is a clear and simple way to describe exactly what...”

KEY COOL YELLOW QUESTIONS:

- “What do we know?”
- “How would we organize and structure the information?”
- “Can you please clarify that?”
- “What else do you need to know to understand this?”



Warm Yellow: Connect at the Emotional Level

Focus with compassion on the other person’s feelings in order to communicate, develop understanding, tune in to the other person’s feelings/emotions, demonstrate genuine empathy, and express your own feelings constructively.

KEY WARM YELLOW STATEMENTS:

- “I hear you and sense that you are...”
- “This information makes me feel that...”
- “I feel...”

KEY WARM YELLOW QUESTIONS:

- “How do you feel?”
- “How could you express your feelings about...?”
- “How can I help?”
- “How else can I explain this?”



Practice Skill: Connect, Clarify, Describe and Explain

PROCEDURE

Select a topic you need to share information or feelings about and you want to ensure others clearly understand what they need to know. Read over the information on the previous page. Use the tips and techniques to produce a simple Think, Feel, Say, Do plan to speaking in ways that will demonstrate how you will connect with others and clarify, describe and explain the information.

THINK

FEEL

SAY

DO



Smart How To's: Generate Ideas

Here are some simple ways to shift into a Green mindset to spark fresh ideas and options with others.



Green: Open Up Possibilities

Stop being judgmental, and explore all of the possibilities and options. Brainstorm ideas, challenge assumptions, reframe problems into opportunities and envision future possibilities.

KEY GREEN STATEMENTS:

“Looking to the future, we could...”

“There are many possibilities to explore.”

“It’s time to generate ideas, options and alternatives.”

KEY GREEN QUESTIONS:

“What if...?”

“What’s the hidden potential here?”

“What would a solution look like?”

“What other ideas or possibilities do you see?”



Smart How To's: Inspire Others to Action

Here are some simple ways to shift into a Green mindset to spark fresh ideas and options with others.



White: Focus On Positive Can Do's

Find ways to move forward and take the initiative.

KEY WHITE STATEMENTS:

“I appreciate...”

“I can do it.”

“I will.”

“You can do it.”

KEY QUESTIONS:

“Where is the positive opportunity?”

“What else can we do to keep moving forward?”

“What will take us above and beyond?”

“What initiatives can we take to move things forward?”



Practice Skill: Inspire Others to Action

PROCEDURE

Select a topic you want to generate enthusiasm and inspire others to action. Read over the information on the previous page. Use the tips and techniques to produce a simple Think, Feel, Say, Do plan that will demonstrate how you will inspire others to action.

THINK

FEEL

SAY

DO



Smart How To's: 6 Tips on Making Good Conversation

Here are 6 simple tips to try to make all your conversations a bit smarter, more meaningful and productive.

1. Approach every conversation as if you were meeting a friend.
2. Think before you speak.
3. Match what you say with your message and with how the other person likes to receive information.
4. Be brief.
5. Listen intently to what the other person says, and watch what she/he does.
6. Choose a positive learning mindset to persevere, and avoid negativity and judgment.



Apply @ Work

PROCEDURE

Think if someone you love had a difficult time communicating with you. Make notes on how you could shift your approach using the 6 tips.

1. Approach as friend

2. Think

3. How they like to receive

4. Be brief

5. Listen

6. positive learner mindset



Quick Quiz

True-FAISe Quiz	True	FAISe
1. The four dimensions in 4D-I are creativity, understanding, decision-making and personal spirit.		
2. When people are operating in Green, they enjoy data, facts and analysis.		
3. When people are operating in Red, they like to make decisions and push for closure.		
4. A person who is pessimistic and doesn't believe that he or she can have an impact has a strong Personal Spirit.		
5. Someone who listens with careful attention and empathy is operating in warm Yellow.		
6. A person with strong opinions is operating in cool Green.		
7. Outlook is one of three key success factors in personal spirit.		
8. A person who interrupts a conversation with a variety of new ideas is operating in Green.		
9. To reach agreement and make a decision between two people, both of them have to shift into Yellow.		
10. Smart Tracks are colour-coded processes designed to improve problem-solving and communications.		
11. All effective communicators play it by ear and don't need processes to get agreement from others.		
12. The greater the range of skills, and the more of the Seven Mindsets a person feels comfortable using, the better the communicator he or she is likely to be.		

Lesson 2: Smart Listening Skills

“Most of the successful people I know are the ones who do more listening than talking.”

—Bernard Baruch

Listening skills are critical. At work, you need to listen carefully to instructions, to directions, to customer problems and to each other. You need to remember what you heard so that you can apply it. Good listening skills can also help you to feel confident enough to ask for clarification when you aren't sure that you understand things.

Most of the time we live in our own heads. Some of us are more tuned in and sensitive to others. Some of us are not. Great listening involves shifting – from me to you, and from what is most important to me to what is important to you as well.

Listening is about being a great receiver. You are smart and know how to communicate. We want to help you get better at how to listen to others so you can succeed at work and life

“It's not that hard to understand a person. It's only hard to listen without bias.”

—Criss Jam

LISTEN = SILENT = LISTEN

The word ‘listen’ contains the same letters as the word ‘silent.’

There is a big lesson here. To listen fully and completely is to be truly silent. To listen is to hear. The key is to silence your own judgement and need to respond. The challenge is to focus 100% on the other person's words, facial expressions and tone of voice. To truly listen is to hear what the other person is really saying, feeling and experiencing.



Experience Exercise #1: Why Is It So Hard To Listen Well?

1. In your experience, when is it important that someone else really listens carefully?
 - In day-to-day life?
 - In relationships?
 - On the job?

2. How do you know when someone has really listened to you?

3. Why can't other people really hear what you want to tell them?

4. What are some of the reasons it seems so hard for you to listen to someone else?

5. What do people do that kills good listening?



Experience Exercise #2: Demonstrations of Poor and Good Listening

GROUP TASK: POOR LISTENING

In groups, develop a short skit to demonstrate five poor listening behaviours and five good listening behaviours.

1. Each group will first present the poor listening skit while the other groups identify the poor listening behaviours that they can see in the skit.
2. Debrief the 'poor listening' round by having the full group list the top seven poor listening behaviours. Have a conversation about how poor listening behaviours could negatively impact you in a job interview or when interacting with your boss or a co-worker.
3. After the presentations and discussions, make a list of the points that were most important for you. Pick one listening behaviour to work on that will improve your own performance.

GROUP TASK: GOOD LISTENING

1. Ask each group to present the good listening skit, and have other groups identify the good listening behaviours.
2. Have a conversation about how good listening behaviours could positively impact you in a job interview or when interacting with your boss or a co-worker.
3. Summarize the discussions by deciding on some core do's and don'ts involved in listening. Pick one listening behaviour to use to improve your own performance.

REFLECTION: LIST

DO'S	DON'TS



Practice Skill: Listening and the Three-Minute Story Presentation

SKILL PRACTICE: WORKING IN 2'S OR 3'S

ROUND 1

For three minutes, tell a simple story about something that happened recently,, or share information about something you know about.

REFLECTION

Discuss these points at the end of the story:

1. STORYTELLER

- What behaviours demonstrated that you were listened to?
- What behaviours distracted you or did not demonstrate good listening?
- What did you take away from this experience?

2. LISTENERS

- What were you working on to become a better listener? How did that feel?
- What did the sender storyteller do that was effective? What tips could help the storyteller be better in the future?
- What did you take away from this experience?

SKILL PRACTICE: WORKING IN 2'S OR 3'S

ROUND 2 AND 3

Rotate roles and have a new storyteller. Repeat the storyteller's and listeners' discussion points. At the end of the group work, re-convene and have a discussion about the exercise.



Smart How To's: 9 Tips On How To Listen Well

A micro skill is a small precise adjustment in what you do and how you do it to achieve best results. Here are nine 'Micro Skills' that make up how to listen effectively.:

9 MICRO SKILLS ON SMART LISTENING

1. Approach each important conversation with 100% attention.
2. Start with the commitment that you want to collaborate and work things out.
3. Ask a question, make a point and then listen 100% to what the other person has to say.
4. Don't interrupt. Listen fully and patiently. Wait until he/she has said what they want to say.
5. Keep eye contact and nod while the person speaks.
6. Listen and then ask clarification questions to make sure that you understand.
7. Draw them out by asking for examples and to tell you more.
8. Show respect for the other person, regardless of whether you agree or not.
9. Listen and ask yourself, regardless of the topic, "What can I learn from this so that I can be better next time?"

Adapted from Michael Marquardt's *Leading with Questions: How Leaders Find the Right Solutions by Knowing What to Ask*.

A small shift, like moving your steering wheel or boat rudder an inch, can bring about a significant change in where you end up.



Practice Skill: Pick and Build a Micro-Skill

PROCEDURE

Work in pairs. Pick one of the nine micro-skills to work on. Build a detailed **Think. Feel. Say. do.** plan for the micro-skill you selected. Decide on how you will know that this skill worked. What evidence would convince you? Prepare a coaching session to demonstrate this skill and be ready to teach others how to do it.

SKILL

What do I have to think, feel, say and do to demonstrate this micro skill?

• THINK

• FEEL

• SAY

• DO

SKILL PRACTICE

Reflect on the nine micro-skills. Pick the one that is most important for you to improve or develop. Complete a written point-form plan and develop a short, 90-second presentation on that micro-skill.

DIALOGUE AND FEEDBACK

Discuss the following:

1. The most important micro-skills for me to be a better listener...
2. Why these micro-skills are important to me...
3. What I will do to practise them...



Practice Skill: Listening in Different Colours

PROCEDURE

Read an article from a newspaper. Listen to a story from a co-learner. Watch a TV clip. Practice listening in one colour for each story:

- GREEN - Listen for opportunities, ideas and flashes of insight
- YELLOW - Listen to reason and understand
- RED - Listen to judge, agree or disagree
- WHITE - Listen to appreciate all sides



1. What did you hear listening in Green?



2. What did you hear listening in Yellow?



3. What did you hear listening in Red?



4. What did you hear listening in White?



Practice Skill: The Three-Minute Story

PROCEDURE: WORK IN 3'S OR 4'S

One person tells a story for 3 minutes. The Listener listens without taking notes. The second person must summarize the story in 90 seconds. The third must summarize the 90 second summary into 30 seconds of speaking. Rotate process and repeat. Note your observations after each round.

ROUND 1 NOTES:

ROUND 2 NOTES:

ROUND 3 NOTES:

REFLECTION

What are some personal insights from this exercise?



Practice Skill: Deep Listening

PROCEDURE

Make sure you have a pen and paper for this exercise.

TUNE-IN PRACTICES

Step 1. PAIR UP and sit across from each other.

Step 2. TUNE IN. Spend 30 seconds tuning in and not speaking. Look into your learning partner's eyes.

Step 3. ROTATE. Do this with two or more people.

Step 4. TALK AND LISTEN. In the 3rd round, after the tuning in activity, one person becomes the listener and recorder. The other person is the sender communicator.

ROUND 1 LISTENING PRACTICE

1. The listener selects a topic and asks, "What are all your hopes and best ideas about? Your life? Getting a good job? Your family? Your success on this course?"
2. Speaker speaks for three minutes. The listener listens appreciatively. Do not interrupt the other person. Nod and affirm whatever the person says. Take notes.
3. Ask short clarifying questions only to help deepen your understanding.
4. Record all of the ideas on the notepad.
5. Give your list of notes to your partner when the time expires.
6. Discuss procedure.

ROUND 2 LISTENING PRACTICE

1. Reverse roles once the round is completed.
2. Repeat the steps.

REFLECTIONS

What are some personal insights from this exercise?

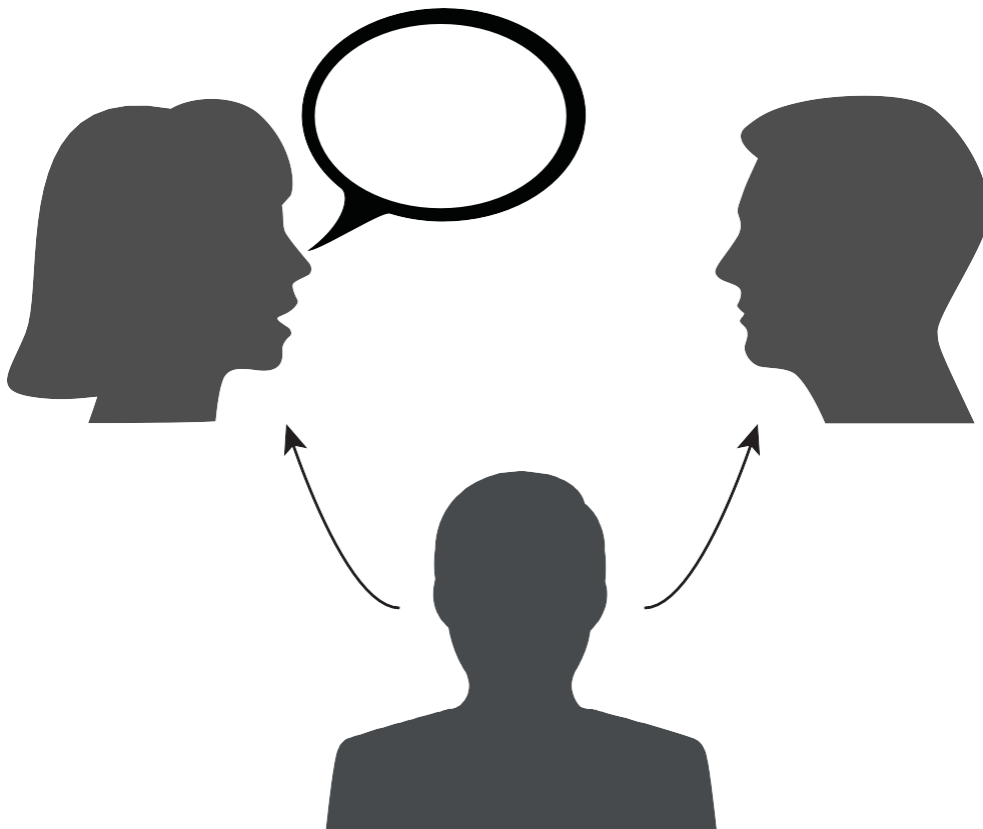


Practice Skill: Coaching Listening Skills

PROCEDURE

Work in groups of three to practice listening skills and how to coach listening skills in others. This exercise works in three rounds of three minutes each. In each round there is a speaker/sender, a listener/receiver and a coach.

1. Discuss when it is really hard to listen to someone else. Discuss what is going on and why it is difficult to do.
2. In each round, the speaker tells a story or shares information. The listener pays deep attention, asks questions for clarification, and practices attentive listening.
3. At the end of the three minutes, first the coach and then the speaker provide coaching advice for the listener.
4. In the second round, rotate roles and repeat the process.
5. In the third round, rotate roles and repeat the process.
6. At the end of the three rounds:
 1. Prepare a five-point coaching guide to help others learn how to listen better
 2. Perform a short demonstration that shows what good and poor listening skills at work look like, and what to say and do to help others listen better





Apply @ Work and Real Life

To conclude the module, focus on some practical applications of listening skills at work and life.



1. YELLOW. What are three or more things that you experienced, noticed or felt?



2. RED. What are the two most important take-away lessons for improving your listening skills?



3. GREEN. List three ways you can use what you learned at work.



4. WHITE. Name one initiative you will take to improve your listening skills.

Lesson 3: How to Ask and Use Smart Questions

INTRODUCTION

Questions are like precision power tools for your mind. They help you open up things. They help you measure things. They help you map and make things. They help you close things, fix things and connect things.

Smart questions shape your behaviour and direct how other people respond to you. Change your questions and you can change your results.

Questions help you achieve a wide variety of objectives. They can be used to:

- Persuade others
- Develop understanding
- Build relationships
- Generate new ideas and approaches to problems
- Reduce errors and mistakes
- Appreciate different points of view
- Reduce confusion and anxiety
- Inspire others
- Make better decisions

This lesson is designed to help you build deliberate skills in using questions to achieve your goals.



Experience Exercise: Killer Phrases and Killer Questions

“It’ll never work.” “You aren’t smart enough to...” “Are you kidding me?” “Where did you come up with that ridiculous idea?”

KILLER PHRASES and **KILLER QUESTIONS** kill ideas, stop change from happening, extinguish hope, halt new efforts and kill the human spirit.

KILLER PHRASES

Make a list of the ‘killer phrases’ you hear in your life.

KILLER QUESTIONS

Make a list of the ‘killer questions’ you hear in your life.

KILLER IMPACT

What is the impact of these killer phrases and killer questions on you, on the people you know, on trying new things?



Need to Know: Asking Smart Questions – Open And Closed

The art and science of asking smart questions is a vital life skill. Too often people ask only closed – right or wrong – questions. These questions can shut down thought and force a decision that may or may not be right. For example: when you are operating under a tight time frame, when you need to decide quickly, and when a simple ‘yes’ or ‘no’ response is required. Use closed questions when a yes/no or answer is needed.

Here is how the **JUDGER** and the **LEARNER** mindsets use questions to get the answers they want.

CLOSED

JUDGER QUESTIONS

- What’s wrong?
- Who is to blame?
- How can i prove i am right?
- How can i protect myself?
- How can i be in control?
- Why is that person so stupid?
- Why bother?

OPEN

LEARNER QUESTIONS

- What works?
- What am i responsible for?
- What are the facts?
- What’s the big picture?
- What are my choices?
- What does the other person need?
- What are the possibilities?

CLOSED QUESTIONS:

Closed questions look for only one answer: a fact or a decision or a belief. They are useful in some situations when you need a clear factual answer. For example, “What time is it right now?” “How many kilometres to the arena from here?” “Are you with me or against me?”

Closed questions, though, can quickly lead to a dead-end in a conversation. The factual answer ends the conversation. A values-based decision ends opportunities for discussion and shared decision making.

CLOSED QUESTIONS–CONTINUED

COOL YELLOW questions seek correct and accurate information. How many people were at the meeting? What is the capital of Prince Edward Island? How many times did the phone ring while I was out? What time is it? How much does the gas cost today?

JUDGE RED questions are critical to make good quality discussions. **JUDGE RED** questions aim to close the door to discussion and communication.

JUDGE RED QUESTIONS

BAD JUDGE RED QUESTIONS:

- **Criticize:** “What’s wrong with you?”
- **Blame:** “Why is it always your fault?”
- **defend:** “What’s your problem?”
- **dismiss and put down:** “Why are you always so dumb?”

GOOD JUDGE RED QUESTIONS:

- **Get to the crux:** “What is the real problem here?” “Why did you do it that way?”
- **Validate:** “Where is the proof?”
- **confirm a conclusion:** “Have we agreed on the final answer?” “Where is the proof?”

OPEN QUESTIONS:

Open questions act like can openers: they provide people with an opportunity to open up and talk.

Open questions always engage people’s higher order thinking. Here are some examples of open questions:

- What are you thinking?
- How are you feeling?
- What would you like to see happen?
- What are some ways we could deal with this?
- What’s the message you want to get across?
- What could go wrong?
- What do think our priorities could be?
- What can I do to help you?
- How can we make it better?
- What would a good solution look like?



Apply @ Work: Closed and Open Questions

1. What are the closed questions that annoy or upset you the most?

2. What are appropriate situations when you can use closed questions at work?

3. Which open-ended questions bring out the best in you?

4. What are appropriate situations when you can use open questions at work?



Smart How To's: The Colour of Smarter Questions

Questions are power tools for your mind. They drive behaviour in yourself and in others. Questions shape action. The Smart Skills colours give you a powerful set of tools that will help you work more effectively with other people.



GO GREEN

When You Want to Get New Ideas and Options:

- How many ideas can we come up with?
- What assumptions can we challenge to open up new solutions?
- What are different ways to approach this so we can find opportunities?
- What does success look like?



BE COOL YELLOW

When You Need to Understand More:

- What information do we have and what else do we need?
- How can we organize the information?
- What do we need to clarify the information?



BE WARM YELLOW

When You Need to Understand Another Person:

- How are you feeling?
- What does it feel like to be in their shoes?
- How can we express effectively what we are feeling?



DO RED

When You Need to Get to the Point and Decide:

- What's the crux/root of the problem?
- What should we do?
- How can we prove that this is the best solution?
- What can we learn from past experience?
- How does this fit in with what I value most?



BE WHITE

When You Need to Get Moving Forward:

- What is the hidden opportunity and positive potential?
- What can we do to get going?
- What can we do that will make a real difference?

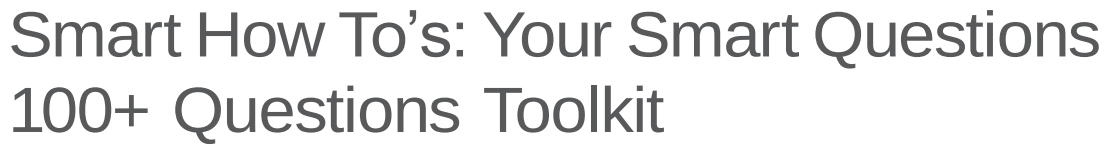


Smart How To's: Your Smart Questions

100+ Questions Toolkit

The purpose of these questions is to give you the tools you need to become skilled in using the right questions with others at work and in everyday life. Use these questions to plan your thinking and think through your planning.

QUESTIONS				
1. What do you think?				
2. What would you like to know?				
3. What is the opportunity here?				
4. What is another way of looking at this?				
5. Where is the silver lining?				
6. How can I turn this into a positive learning experience?				
7. What's the hidden potential here?				
8. If this were solved or figured out, what would a great solution look like?				
9. What's my/your vision of success?				
10. What are the best possible outcomes?				
11. Why am I/are we doing it this way?				
12. Could there be a better way?				
13. What does my/your desired future look like?				
14. If this were successful, what is in place and what is different?				
15. If a successful solution is found/developed, what will be the impact?				
16. What if...?				
17. What exactly do you mean?				
18. Can you be more specific?				
19. Can you please clarify what you mean?				
20. What other information would be helpful to have?				
21. What am I/are you missing?				
22. Can you tell me more about..., and give me more details about...?				
23. Can you give me an example of that?				
24. As you think about your potential future, what are you most excited about?				
25. As you think about your potential future, what are you most worried about?				

[illegible]



Smart How To's: Your Smart Questions

100+ Questions Toolkit

QUESTIONS					
51.	How am I feeling about this?				
52.	What do I/you notice when I/you watch and listen?				
53.	What one incredible change would make your life better?				
54.	How can this be the best possible win-win?				
55.	Why are you doing this?				
56.	Can you explain more about...?				
57.	What is important about this?				
58.	What results do you want?				
59.	What is the real problem?				
60.	What is the heart of the problem?				
61.	What possibilities come to mind?				
62.	What do you want to do next?				
63.	What might happen if...?				
64.	Who else could help?				
65.	Could you say more about...?				
66.	What is the crux of the issue?				
67.	Why do you do what you do?				
68.	Is this the best you can do?				
69.	Is it a yes or a no?				
70.	Can you help me get a better understanding of this?				
71.	Can you help me understand how you feel?				
72.	What is the underlying cause of...?				
73.	What is the root cause of...?				
74.	How do you think the problem could be solved?				
75.	What has contributed to the problem?				



Smart How To's: Your Smart Questions

100+ Questions Toolkit

QUESTIONS				
76. What have I/you done to contribute to this situation – good and bad/right or wrong?				
77. What is the driving force behind this?				
78. What are you going to do?				
79. What conclusions have you come to?				
80. What is the best solution?				
81. What is the most sensible thing to do?				
82. What is the best way to proceed?				
83. What did you learn?				
84. What are you trying to accomplish?				
85. What is stopping me/you/us?				
86. What would happen if I/you/we did nothing at all?				
87. What positive lessons can I/you/we take from this?				
88. What do I really appreciate about you/this situation/this opportunity/this challenge?				
89. What is a positive way of looking at this?				
90. What are the best things that could happen?				
91. What are the worst things that could happen?				
92. How will this help you achieve your goals?				
93. What is getting in the way of my/your success? Our success?				
94. If you had the resources – time, money, support – what would you be doing that you are not?				
95. Can you tell me about your plans?				
96. What is the most difficult challenge you have faced?				
97. Is this the best that you can do?				
98. What do you feel is the right decision for you?				
99. What in your life has given you the greatest sense of fulfilment or meaning?				
100. What would you like to be remembered for?				



Smart How To's: Your Smart Questions

100+ Questions Toolkit

QUESTIONS



101. Is this consistent with your values and beliefs?
102. What evidence will convince you that this has been successful?
103. Based on your experience, what do think will happen?
104. What are your assumptions about...? What assumptions could be wrong?
105. What are your priorities right now? Over the next month? Year?
106. What have you tried so far? What's worked? What's not worked? And why?
107. What do you feel is the right thing for you?
108. Do you feel this is the right thing for you?
109. What is the most important thing I/you/we need to do today?
110. INSERT YOUR OWN QUESTIONS HERE
- 111.
- 112.
- 113.
- 114.
- 115.
- 116.
- 117.
- 118.
- 119.
- 120.



Practice Skill: Smart Questions @ Work

Smart people use a process to follow when they need to figure things out. Imagine your team has to purchase a new piece of equipment. Develop a list of questions for each step of this process.



STEP 1. UNDERSTAND



STEP 2. DECIDE - CRUX



STEP 3. CREATE - OPTIONS



STEP 4. DECIDE - CONCLUSIONS



STEP 5. INITIATE - ACTION

REFLECTIONS

What are some personal insights from this exercise?



Smart How To's: Tips on How to Make Your Questions Smarter

Here is a simple format to help you plan ahead when you have an important meeting, interview or a situation where you need to ask questions.

1. PLAN AHEAD Think twice before you ask an important question. Think about the following:



- The Red 'why'. Why is this question important?



- The Yellow 'who'. Who do I want the answer from and how does that affect what I

do?



- The Yellow 'what'. What are their needs?



- The Red 'win-win'. How can I ask it in the right way?

2. SELECT THE RIGHT QUESTION



- Red: open or closed



- Yellow: open or

closed



- Green: open



- White: open

3. LISTEN TO THE ANSWER – STAY IN YELLOW



- Clarify that you understood



- Ask for more information if necessary



- Ensure you understand before you respond



Smart How To's: Tips on How to Make

4. RESPOND AND CONNECT



- Acknowledge the question and think of your options.



- Respond in Red if that is what they want



- Reframe to Green to open up possibilities before rushing to judgment



- Respond in Yellow by providing the information



Apply @ Work

PROCEDURE

First work on your own, and then in teams of three, to produce a 'three best questions' list for each of the four workplace communication applications.

CLARIFY. Write out three questions that you could use to help you clarify and ask for further explanation.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

INFLUENCE. Write out three questions that could help you influence, persuade, reassure and convince someone to do something.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

ENGAGE. Write out three questions that could help you engage and inspire someone to do something.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

INSTRUCT. Write out three questions that could help you instruct, teach or coach someone in a skill or workplace procedure.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____



Apply @ Work

PREPARING FOR MEETINGS AND CONVERSATIONS

Select an upcoming meeting or conversation that might be difficult for you. List three questions you would like to ask or get answers to.

PREPARING FOR A JOB INTERVIEW

Think of a job interview: Plan ahead.

- What key questions would you like to ask in the interview?
- What questions do you think they could ask you?

Lesson 4: Smart Speaking, Responding and Communicating with Others

INTRODUCTION

Adaptability is a key to success in the constantly changing world we live in today. The more adaptable you are, the better prepared you will be to deal with life challenges. In communicating, if you only know how to communicate one way, you will be restricted in how effective you are with others. This could limit your job prospects and your ability to be successful in a job when changes happen.

Adaptability is a core skill of effective communication. This simply means being able to speak in different ways, to respond and shift into all 4 dimensions to communicate and get the job done well.

The key to adaptability is knowing how and when to shift your thinking and communicating to meet the demands of the other person or situation. The more skillful and versatile you are at shifting, even though it is outside your comfort zone or annoying or difficult to do, the more effective you will become.

The purpose of this lesson is to give you the knowledge, skills and tools to increase your own adaptability as a communicator.



Experience Exercise: Picture and Practice

WORDS AND DEEDS

Choose a situation. Identify what you would say and how you would communicate.

ASK QUESTIONS TO CLARIFY

SPEAK TO INFLUENCE, PERSUADE, REASSURE OR CONVINCE

SPEAK TO ENGAGE AND INSPIRE OTHERS

SPEAK TO INSTRUCT, TEACH AND COACH

REFLECTION

What are some personal insights I can take from this exercise?



Need to Know: The Judger and Learner Mindsets @ Work

Many people stall in their careers and relationships because they can't shift out of their own preferred way of operating into another state of mind in order to meet and match the state of mind the other person is operating in.

This is how the **JUDGER** and the **LEARNER** mindsets play out in relationships at work and in life.

JUDGER RELATIONSHIPS

- **Win-lose**
- **Feel separate**
- **Fear differences**
- **debate**
- **listen for:**
 - **right/Wrong**
 - **Agree/disagree**
 - **differences**
- **Seek to defend or attack**
- **Feedback as rejection**

LEARNER RELATIONSHIPS

- **Win-Win**
- **Feel connected**
- **Value differences**
- **dialogue**
- **listen for:**
 - **Facts**
 - **Understanding**
 - **Commonalities**
- **Seek to resolve and create**
- **Feedback as helpful**

Smart people learn how to shift from a constant focus on what they like, to also focusing on giving the other person what he/she needs.

This is where the **PLATINUM RULE** can help:

“Treat others how they would like to be treated, and how they would like you to treat them.”



Experience Exercise: Connecting With the Judger and the Learner

THE JUDGER

Share and compare your own experience in communicating with someone who is in the Judger state of mind.
What are the challenges? What works and what doesn't work?

THE LEARNER

Share and compare your own experience in communicating with someone who is in the Learner state of mind.
What are the challenges? What works and what doesn't work?



Need to Know: In Smart Communicating Three Big Ideas

Here are the three big ideas that will help you get better results with everyone you meet and work with. It won't change the other person, but it will change how you connect and communicate with them. It should also improve the results that you get with them.

BIG IDEA NO. 1

ANYONE CAN BE IN
ANY MINDSET AT
ANY GIVEN TIME

BIG IDEA NO. 2

GET OUT OF YOUR
OWN MIND TO
FIND SUCCESS WITH
OTHERS

BIG IDEA NO. 3

THE MORE MINDSETS
YOU CAN OPERATE
IN, THE GREATER THE
SUCCESS YOU WILL
HAVE

Your own personal operating style is how you like to operate. It pinpoints what you want to achieve. However, depending upon the situation, most people can be in mindsets and colours that are not their most preferred. As situations change, people change. In smart communicating, you have to be able to detect where they are and know how to connect with them.



Smart How To's: 5 Simple Guidelines

Here are some basic guidelines for connecting and communicating with others:

1. **BEGIN WITH A WIN-WIN END IN MIND.** Start with good intentions on seeking a solution or understanding that will be as acceptable to you as it is to the other person. Expect success.
2. **STAY OPEN** and attentive to the other person's needs as long as you can. Start with a commitment to gaining a deeper understanding of what mindset the other person is in.
3. **GIVE THE OTHER PERSON THE BENEFIT OF THE DOUBT**, since he/she wants to be happy and successful too. Remember that each of us experiences the world very differently.
4. **AVOID REACTING JUDGMENTALLY** to what others say and do. Stay in Yellow, seeking to understand the other person's reality. Develop empathy, whether or not you agree with them or like what they are saying. Control your impulse to react negatively or defensively.
5. **CREATE SMART ZONES** to allow different types of conversation. Use the colours to create common ground to converse and communicate more effectively.



Practice Skill: How to Clarify, Persuade, Inspire and Teach

In teams, develop a series of 30-second commercials on the benefits of the *Skills @ Work* program.. Develop a story board and script for one or more commercials.

CLARIFY.

Communicate to clarify and provide the facts about this program.

PERSUADE.

Communicate to influence, persuade, reassure or convince others to take this program.

INSPIRE.

Communicate to engage and inspire others to choose to take this program.

TEACH.

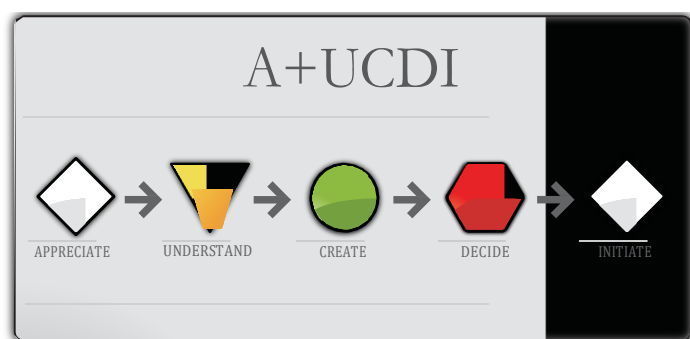
Communicate to instruct, teach and coach others on what they will learn in this program.



Practice Skill: Coaching

SKILL PRACTICE

Work in pairs. Use the A+UCDI 15-minute coaching conversation process format to build personal skills in coaching for performance.



1. A - APPRECIATE what you know already
2. U - UNDERSTAND what you want to work on and develop
3. C - CREATE OPTIONS and ideas for building your skills
4. D - DECIDE what path to take
5. I - INITIATE what you will commit to do, starting right now

THE 5 STEPS

STEP 1 - APPRECIATE - “Looking across your 4D-i profile, what did you learn and appreciate the most about your results?” - 2 minutes

STEP 2 - UNDERSTAND THE RESULTS - “What patterns do you see? What stands out? What do you think it tells you about yourself?” - 3 minutes

STEP 3 - CREATE POSSIBILITIES - “What are some ideas and options to expand your skills and work on your game, that could lead to better results?” - 4 minutes

STEP 4 - CONCLUDE - “Given the ideas and options, what do you want to do that will make the most impact?” - 2 minutes

STEP 5 - INITIATE - “What one specific initiative and new behaviour will you commit to over the next 4 weeks? What’s a first step in the next 24 hours?” - 2 minutes

DEBRIEF - Thank each other and reflect on the value of the conversation and what you each appreciated for how you worked together. - 2 minutes



Practice Skill: Working Smarter with Others

PROCEDURE

This skill builder uses the colours of thinking to help you understand how to communicate with people who think differently than you do. Use the **Think. Feel. Say. do.** approach.

SENDER	RECEIVER
 COOL RED	 COOL RED
 WARM RED	 WARM RED
 COOL YELLOW	 COOL YELLOW
 COOL GREEN	 COOL GREEN
 WARM GREEN	 WARM GREEN
 WARM YELLOW	 WARM YELLOW



Practice Skill: Working Smarter with Others

PROCEDURE

This skill builder uses the colours of thinking to help you understand how to communicate with people who think differently than you do. Use the **Think. Feel. Say. do.** approach.

 COOL RED	 WARM YELLOW
 WARM RED	 COOL YELLOW
 COOL YELLOW	 WARM GREEN
 WARM YELLOW	 COOL RED
 COOL GREEN	 COOL RED
 WARM YELLOW	 WARM RED



Practice Skill: Working Smarter with Others

PROCEDURE

This skill builder uses the colours of thinking to help you understand how to communicate with people who think differently than you do. Use the **Think. Feel. Say. do.** approach.

 COOL RED	 WARM RED
 COOL YELLOW	 WARM YELLOW
 COOL GREEN	 WARM GREEN
 COOL YELLOW	 WARM RED
 WARM RED	 COOL GREEN
 WARM GREEN	 WARM YELLOW



Apply @ Work: Labels vs Contributions

PROCEDURE

How you see it is what you get. Identify the types of negative labels we give to people. Identify the positive contribution each state of mind brings. Develop a simple point form chart.

	NEGATIVE LABELS	POSITIVE CONTRIBUTIONS
Cool Red: Critical Thinkers		
WarmRed: Values-Driven Gut Intuition		
Cool Yellow: Analytical Thinkers		
Warm Yellow: Compassionates		
Cool Green: Creative Thinkers		
WarmGreen: Creative Intuitives		



Practice Skill: Pitch and Catch

PROCEDURE

Make a 30-second presentation about a product or program you think is great. Choose someone who thinks differently to present to – someone high in a different colour. Practice preparing your presentation by selecting and using words and points that will connect with how they like to think.

PITCH 1: PRODUCT/PROGRAM

REFLECTIONS

PITCH 2: PRODUCT/PROGRAM

REFLECTIONS

PITCH 3: PRODUCT/PROGRAM

REFLECTIONS

What are some of the personal insights I can take from this exercise?



Skill Builder: Working Smarter with Others

SKILL PRACTICE

This game helps you practice skills ‘in the moment’.

COOL		WARM
		
		
		



COOL		WARM
		
		
		

COOL		WARM
		
		
		



COOL		WARM
		
		
		

COOL		WARM
		
		
		



COOL		WARM
		
		
		

COOL		WARM
		
		
		



COOL		WARM
		
		
		

COOL		WARM
		
		
		



COOL		WARM
		
		
		



Smart How To's: Tips for 1 to 1 Meetings

- ☐ 1. Explain the specific outcome you want to make sure the other person is supportive.
- ☐ 2. Describe the process you would like to follow in order to achieve your result.
- ☐ 3. Agree on time - how long you expect the two of you will need to be together.
- ☐ 4. Appeal to their style - Green, Yellow or Red.
- ☐ 5. Listen carefully to what they say. Avoid debating, getting defensive or aggressive.
- ☐ 6. Remember the outcome you want. Keep it front and centre. Adapt as needed along the way.
- ☐ 7. Watch the time in each step of the process. Adjust where necessary.
- ☐ 8. Use smart questions to engage their best thinking.
- ☐ 9. Keep moving the conversation forward - don't get sidetracked.
- ☐ 10. Shift into Yellow - when in doubt or when feelings arise.
- ☐ 11. Keep your Personal Spirit high - positive outlook, feel in control, take initiative.



Skill Builder: Perfect Pitch on “Project You”

PROCEDURE: LEARN AND SELECT

1. **Select** a product category that you know and like, e.g., smart phones, laptops, clothing, cars, bikes, shoes, sporting equipment, food, electronics, etc.
2. **Watch a Steve Jobs** product launch, as well as different commercials that pitch various products.
3. **develop your own list of the 5 Keys to Successful product pitches.** Assess what you think are the most effective strategies.

PROCEDURE: DEVELOP YOUR PERFECT PITCH-ON YOU!

1. **Write a perfect pitch on you.** Use the tips you wrote up and learned. Write up the key advantages and skills you bring to an employer. Work on how to persuade and convince them on why they should hire you.

2. **present and discuss**

REFLECTIONS

What are some personal insights I can take from this exercise?



Smart How To's: Tips and Techniques for Connecting Deeply with Others

– adapted from Newberg and Waldman's *Words Can Change Your Brain*

Here is an excellent process for learning how to prepare for an important meeting or conversation by tuning into yourself and to the other person to communicate effectively.

PHASE 1: PREPARE MENTALLY AND EMOTIONALLY

- 1) Relax and take three deep breaths
- 2) Stay present. Be here. Just This. Now. Hear. This.
- 3) Cultivate silence. Quiet the internal mind chatter
- 4) Increase your positivity to open up
- 5) Reflect on your deepest values, e.g., what is most important to you
- 6) Access a pleasant memory. Feel good

PHASE 2: SHIFT AND CONNECT

- 1) Observe non-verbal cues
- 2) Express appreciation
- 3) Speak warmly
- 4) Speak slowly
- 5) Speak briefly and for no longer than 30 seconds
- 6) Listen deeply

To change results, you often have to change your approach. The more thoughtful and mindful you are when you approach an important conversation, the more likely you will get better results.



Skill Builder: 30-Second Drills of Great Listening Back-to-Back

SKILL DRILL

1. Work in pairs and sit back-to-back.
2. One person talks for 30 seconds.
3. The other person listens, and then explains what was heard. No notes are taken.
4. Reverse roles and repeat the process.
5. Continue repeating the process with other partners. Increase the time for speaking and listening to build skills.

ROUND 1: REFLECTIONS

ROUND 2: REFLECTIONS

ROUND 3: REFLECTIONS

ROUND 4: REFLECTIONS



Practice Skill: Job Interview

SKILL DRILL

Work – in pairs or teams – and practice asking and answering the following questions:

- ☐ 1. Why did you apply for this job?
- ☐ 2. How are you qualified for this job? What evidence will convince me?
- ☐ 3. How has your past experience prepared you for this position?
- ☐ 4. What have you learned from the *Success @ Work* program that makes you more suitable for work here?
- ☐ 5. What did you like the most about your last job? What did you like the least?
- ☐ 6. What types of skills do you bring?
- ☐ 7. What do you want to accomplish in your career or job here?
- ☐ 8. What are some of your pet peeves about a job or about a boss?
- ☐ 9. What makes you want to come to work every day?
- ☐ 10. What are you proudest of?
- ☐ 11. What do you look for in the people you work with?
- ☐ 12. How do you handle criticism and feedback?
- ☐ 13. What are you good at?
- ☐ 14. How do you handle problems such as equipment problems, people problems, safety problems, etc.?
- ☐ 15. Why should we hire you?

REFLECTIONS

What are some personal insights I can take away from this exercise?



Smart How To's: 11 Wrap-Up Communication Tips

This module has many tips, guidelines and how-to's to help you communicate more effectively. This list of 11 brings them all together for your reflection.

- ☐ 1. **Know What you Want.** Pick the outcome colour you want: understanding, ideas, decisions, better spirit.
- ☐ 2. **Open it Up.** Use open-ended questions to get the conversation moving.
- ☐ 3. **liSTeN 100%.** Ask your question. Stop and listen to the full response before speaking.
- ☐ 4. **eyes open.** Look the other person in the eyes as you listen.
- ☐ 5. **Nod, Affirm, and don't interrupt.** Listen carefully by nodding and affirming.
- ☐ 6. **clarify.** Ask clarifying questions to ensure a complete understanding.
- ☐ 7. **paraphrase.** Reword to show that you listened, whether you agree or not.
- ☐ 8. **deal With.** Make your points, and ask your difficult questions by framing them with curiosity and a need for deeper understanding.
- ☐ 9. **Respond.** Respond and build on what the other person said.
- ☐ 10. **engage.** Communicate what you want. Have a back-and-forth dialogue.
- ☐ 11. **Conclude.** Close the conversation with an affirmation, an action or next steps.



Practice Skill: Plan a Presentation to a Boss, Team or Workplace Committee

PICK YOUR TOPIC

PICK YOUR OUTCOME

Pick the Outcome. Decide what type of result you want. This could be a decision, a plan, a commitment to act, more information, etc.

PLAN YOUR PROCESS

Use this 5 step process to plan your presentation. Complete the points in each stage



1. Yellow. The current situation – a description of what is known.



2. Red. The crux of the issue, problem, situation – what needs to be addressed.



3. Green. What would be considered a success and the options available – what success looks like and the three best options.



4. Red. Conclusions and recommendations – what you recommend.



5. Yellow. Issues to address when planning an implementation of the recommendation.



6. White. Your commitment to contribute to the solution going forward.

REFLECTIONS

What are some personal insights I can take away from this exercise?



Apply @ Work: Refl and Communicating

on Speaking

PRACTICAL APPLICATIONS AND REFLECTIONS



YELLOW

List three things that you experienced, noticed or felt in practicing communication skills.



RED

Select the two most important take-away lessons to improve your communication skills at work.



GREEN

Come up with three ways you can use what you have learned in a workplace.



WHITE

Select one initiative you will take to improve your skills.

ALL ABOUT YOU

As you complete this program, you will have a unique passport to success in the 21st century. Anywhere you go, you will know how to think better. You will know how to solve problems faster. You will be able to communicate and collaborate with others. You will have a stronger personal spirit. You will have the skills to work smarter. These smart skills will be your inside edge to face difficulties, overcome challenges and make the most of your opportunities.

You are already smart. Your 4D-i helps you know more about how you are smart, in your own unique way. Appreciate this. Celebrate what you learn about yourself. The good news is that we can all get smarter. Brains can change and grow. Grow yourself. Be more adaptable. Work on your game. Choose to practice, practice, practice. Put in the effort. Over and over. This is your opportunity. You are in charge.

We are all wired to keep growing and get better. Continue to build your skills in all 4 dimensions.

- Go green – to expand your skills in how to generate more creative ideas
- Slow in yellow – to deepen your skills in how to analyze and organize information and connect better with others
- Get to red – to sharpen your critical thinking skills and make smarter decisions
- Ignite your white – to tap into the power of your personal spirit to appreciate, persevere and initiate.

Support, encourage and help others to get ahead. Reach out. Teach others how to use the traffic light model to shift their thinking. Help them get better results too. Make your mark. Help us all build a smarter, better world.

ABOUT SMARTSKILLS®

Thinking is the core competency for the 21st century. SmartSkills was developed by Bob Wiele and his team at OneSmartWorld. The SmartSkills advantage is its one integrated platform to deliver five essential 21st century skills. It is like having a 4 wheel all terrain vehicle for your mind. SmartSkills is a system of thinking skills, strategies and thinking processes to help people think better, work smarter and get better results. The five skills are thinking, problem solving, communications in speaking and writing, collaborative teamwork and resilience in personal spirit. SmartSkills was designed as an educational innovation to implement the work of the Partnership for 21st Century Skills, the government of Canada's essential skills and the insights of many educational thought leaders. The SmartSkills system has been adopted by many progressive businesses, government workforce development programs and educational institutions.

ABOUT BOB WIELE

Bob Wiele, founder and President of OneSmartWorld, is a relentless innovator committed to help make the world a smarter, better place. His focus is on developing practical tools for individuals, organizations and nations to harness their brainpower, as their key to success in the 21st century. Bob and his team have built powerful thinking skills tools like the 4D-i and the SmartSkills system. He has a BA from McGill, a Master's degree in adult education from the University of Toronto and over 40 years of learning from his mistakes, ventures and efforts. Bob the author of a number of programs, books and papers. He has a great family and lives happily with Mandy in Collingwood, Ontario, Canada. Bob is still working hard to find new ways to get a little bit smarter every day.

NOTES

Thinking and
Problem Solving

Igniting
Personal
Spirit

Communicating



Writing

Working with
Others

THE 21ST CENTURY SKILLS CHALLENGE

"To succeed in our fast changing world, we all need to become more versatile, agile and adaptable. We need to acquire a new set of 21st century 'smart skills'. These skills empower us to improve how we think, problem solve and become great collaborative teammates."
– Bob Wiele, Founder, OneSmartWorld

THE 5 SMART SKILLS PROGRAM

1. Thinking and Problem Solving
2. Igniting Personal Spirit
3. Speaking, Presenting and Communicating
4. Writing to Record, Report and Persuade
5. Working Collaboratively with Others

SmartSkills®: 21st Century Skills for Success

WORKING COLLABORATIVELY WITH OTHERS

& of;iele



Powered by



Think Better. Work Smarter.

SMARTSKILLS®
21ST CENTURY SKILLS FOR SUCCESS

Working Collaboratively with Others
by
Bob Wiele

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WORKING COLLABORATIVELY WITH OTHERS

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PROFICIENCIES IN WORKING COLLABORATIVELY WITH OTHERS

The goal of this module is to equip you with the knowledge, skills and confidence to work better with others and to participate and contribute effectively in group discussions.

In this module, you have the opportunity to develop proficiency in the these skills:

1. Appreciate how others differ in their thinking styles and how to connect with them
2. Participate and interact collaboratively in all phases of a group's work to produce useful solutions
3. Apply simple strategies to keep conversations moving forward in a positive, constructive and results-oriented way
4. Adapt your responses in the moment, to deal appropriately with diverse situations, emotions and demands
5. Give feedback to appreciate others, to coach and to evaluate performance
6. Receive feedback from others constructively to improve your performance
7. Interact with others in a way that is respectful of the roles of others and contributes to positive and productive outcomes
8. Act in ways that demonstrate openness to other people's ideas, opinions and contributions
9. Address inter-personal conflict positively and appropriately

THE LEAP FRAMEWORK FOR LEARNING

The LEAP framework for learning is a simple framework for learning, developed by Bob Wiele, to accelerate skill development and improve your success .

LEAP consists of the following core components.

L – LeARn. This has two elements – one that outlines the what and the why of the knowledge and the second that provides procedures and tips on how to use the information



• **Need to Know** – short information capsules on the current research and theories on the topic



• **Smart How To's** - a list of key pointers on how to implement the knowledge into life and work



e – experieNce – opportunities to reflect on one's experiences and what the learner already knows



A- AppLy@ WorK ANd ASSeSS

• **Apply @ Work** – poses a challenge on how best to transfer what you learned to the workplace

• **Assess** – this component is not included in the books but is for the instructor to use with you to help you know how you are doing. It assists you grow your skills.



p – prACTiCe SKiLLS – a focus on repeated practice of the concepts, the language and the behaviors to build your skills, your confidence and improve your results.

Lesson 1: How to Use the 5:1 Ratio in Conversations at Work

INTRODUCTION

When you change how often you say and do positive, affirmative and supportive things, your chances for success in working with others go up. Like ice changes to water when things warm up, warming up has the same potential in our relationships with others.

Scientists have discovered that people who do well in their relationships with others think, speak and act differently. They work to focus more on the good instead of the bad. They focus more on the positive instead of the negative. They focus more on what's working instead of what isn't working. It is the same for teams.

The ratio of 5:1 or 5 positive statements and actions for every 1 negative, seems to be the tipping point in great teams and great relationships. Smart teams members build momentum by speaking and working positively together. They respond constructively and with genuine curiosity to each other. They ask more questions to clarify and understand than simply defend their existing positions. They put other people's success ahead of, or on a par with, their own success.

Positivity opens us up. It keeps us engaged and learning. Positivity stops us from reacting, criticizing or retaliating. It helps us develop and strengthen high quality relationships that are so important in the workplace and in life.

In this lesson, you will learn some of the keys to working well with others. You will learn how to adapt to different situations in the moment and how to respond appropriately to different emotions and demands. You will expand your skills by learning how to demonstrate greater openness to others' ideas, opinions and contributions, even in conflict.



Experience Exercise: Killer Phrases

Think about all of the times people have used words, phrases or comments that stop you in your tracks. These 'killer phrases' often happen suddenly. We usually react negatively in the moment, or feel hurt and don't know how to deal with it. For example: you suggest a new idea to solve an ongoing problem. Others respond with Killer Phrases such as; "We don't need new ideas we need solutions", "We tried that and it just caused us more work." "They won't listen to our ideas anyway so there's no point in making suggestions". "We don't have the money for that"

List some of the killer lines or killer phrases people have used with you.

While you are thinking of your examples, pay attention to the thoughts and emotions you are experiencing? How do these comments make you feel?

Take some time to think of constructive/positive responses and actions you could use for each of those Killer lines and phrases.



Need to Know: The 5:1 Ratio - 5 Positives for every 1 Negative

Researchers have discovered that high-performing teams and people have a secret to their success. They use a ratio of five positive comments or responses for every negative one. This sets a constructive tone for working well with others. Negativity has a very powerful and of course, negative, impact on relationships. Researchers have found that it takes five positive responses to undo the damage of one negative comment. Smart people work hard to remain positive and not to respond negatively to other people's negativity. They have learned approaches and skills to help continue moving things forward.

Groups are the way work gets done. How to work well with others in groups is essential for success at work. High quality relationships with other people are the bedrock of good teamwork and respectful workplaces. Great relationships mean people know and trust each other. They support each other and work together to get things done.

+ 5 : 1 -

Relationships are the key to success at work and in life. Good relationships are hard work. They require you to expand your ability to respond well in different ways to make sure that the relationship continues to thrive. In the workplace, physical safety is vital. Emotional safety is equally important.

Here are three core underlying thinking skills to deal with the ongoing demands of inter-personal relationships in the workplace:

1. Keep a high degree of openness to new ideas and influences
2. Maintain a high degree of resilience and versatility. That means being capable of dealing with and bouncing back from stress, change and adversity
3. Use a 'bigger mind' and show emotional maturity. Be capable of dealing constructively with a full range of emotions

As the Boy Scouts say – *Be Prepared*. A real key to workplace and life success is to always be prepared in advance for difficult conversations. Have your mind and heart ready to deal with adversity and differences. Prepare your own “positive personal response programs” on what you will think, feel, say, and do whenever adversity or negative reactions occur.



Smart How To's: Three Ways to Get to the 5:1 Ratio

The heart of the 5:1 ratio is to operate from a Strong Yellow position of understanding. There are three main behaviours to use:

1. **Ask First to Clarify** – instead of pushing your point of view. Ask questions to understand instead of promoting what you want. Respond rather than react.
2. **respond Constructively** – make sure you respond positively, not negatively to each other. Show real interest, use positive words and apply friendly collaborative actions instead of confrontation or passive behaviours. Take responsibility and repeat what the other person says, and shift the focus to ways all of you can move forward together. Express your ideas and approaches. Shift from “Yes, but...” to “Yes, and...”.
3. **Seek 50:50 You and Me** – be as interested in the other person's needs as you are in your own needs. Go for an equal balance: focus on what the other person needs as much as you focus on your own needs.

It is all about the relationship. Invest your time in building great relationships with the three behaviours, and you are well on your way to working well with others.

NOTES:



Practice Skill: What to Say and Do in the 5:1

Identify what you would say and do when you use these three behaviours. What do you have to pay attention to in order to make it work?

1. Ask first to clarify

2. respond constructively

3. Seek 50:50 you and me

NOTES:



Practice Skill: Go Small to Go Big

In this activity you will begin to practice using the behaviours from the previous page. Small improvements in these skills will lead to big improvements in your inter-personal relationships.

PICK A REAL ISSUE THAT NEEDS TO BE FIGURED OUT. PRACTICE WORKING IT THROUGH.

1. Stay in the positive zone and act as if this can all be worked out. Write down and practice the specific what's and how's of a think, feel, say and do plan in order to perform this behaviour successfully.

Almost every situation you will encounter in life has a positive and a negative aspect to it.

THINK - Brainstorm a list of 5 positive outcomes of your loss.

FEEL – I feel awful about losing the money but hopeful that it will benefit someone who really needs it.

SAY – “Next time I’m going to ensure that my money is safely put away.”

DO – Develop a deliberate practice of putting your money in my wallet.

Debrief and discuss what works best to shift into the positive zone.

2. Listen carefully. park and hold your Warm red. Write down and practice the specific what's and how's of a think, feel, say and do plan in order to perform this behaviour successfully. For example – Think - when I want to shift into the positive zone, I imagine what I would say to a close friend who was feeling down, and then I use my own advice for my own situation.

Debrief and discuss what works best to shift into the listening zone.

3. Be genuinely interested in the other person's concerns and worries. Tune in to their feelings. Write down and practice the specific what's and how's of a think, feel, say and do plan in order to perform this behaviour successfully. For example – Think when I realize I need to listen carefully I clear my surroundings of distractions and I look at the person as they are speaking. In my mind I am trying not to judge or come to conclusions. I simply remain neutral tuning in to the other person's thoughts and feelings. Say I try not to use any judging words such as – “oh no”, or “that's great” only saying “mmmm” to let them know I'm paying attention and am encouraging them to say more.

Debrief and discuss what works best to help you tune in to the other person's concerns.

- 4. inquire and ask questions of clarification vs. advocating only for your point.** Write down and practice the specific what's and how's of a think, feel, say and do plan in order to perform this behaviour successfully. For example; Think – I truly want and need to understand where the other person is coming from. Say, “I’m not sure that I understand your idea, please tell me more about how you see it solving this tricky situation”

Debrief and discuss what works best to get clarification.

- 5. Shift to using active constructive responses.** Take responsibility and repeat what the other person said, and shift the focus to ways you can move forward together. Express your ideas and approaches. Shift from “Yes but...” to “Yes and...”. Write down and practice the specific what's and how's of a think, feel, say and do plan in order to perform this behaviour successfully. For example – Say _ “I like the part of your idea about creating world peace, I think if we put my ideas together with your ideas we would have a winning solution!”

Debrief and discuss how to work constructively in seeking solutions.

NOTES:



Experience Exercise: Finding the Keys to Working Well in Groups and Teams

Think of examples of groups and teams from your community, e.g., sports, hobby, volunteer, community groups, etc. Discuss what makes teams work well together. From your experience, what do group members do that frustrates you and undermines success? What advice would you give to new teams and new members of a team in order to help them get started down the right path?

NOTES:



Apply @ Work: Promoting Yourself

If you were applying for a job or a promotion, what would you write in a letter or say in an interview about your working with others skills.

- Explain how you can contribute to a group or work team's success.

- Write down key sentences you could use to describe how you would apply and use what you have learned about skills for working with others.

- Develop a list of examples that show you being a positive contributor to a group, team or workplace.

- Include several examples of the inter-personal skills you have developed in your volunteer or community group work.

For example – “As a Girl Guide leader I am developing young girls and women for leadership roles. I coach and mentor girls from a diversity of backgrounds to work together well and to value each other's contributions. It seems like it rains at every outdoor event we have, but I model solid inter-personal skills by always speaking well and kindly to them and engaging every member of the group in finding the positives in any situation.”

OPTIONAL

[illegible]

Lesson 2: How to Shift Your Thinking to Work

INTRODUCTION

Charles Darwin once said “It is not the strongest of the species that survives, nor the most intelligent that survives. It is the one that is most adaptable to change.”

This lesson is designed to give you some practical tools to increase your adaptability when you work with others. It gives you a set of power tools for shifting your mind to help you adapt to meet the demands of different tasks or people that you have to work with. It will give you some things to say and do to shift from one mindset to another. The more adaptable you are, the better you will cope and deal with change.





Experience Exercise: Shifting Mindsets

Start with a review of the seven different mindsets – creative thinking, creative intuition, analytical thinking, compassion, critical thinking, and values-driven and gut instinct decision making. Which ones are you most comfortable with? Which ones are the most difficult to get into? Think of people you know or who you have worked with, and recall the mindsets they would get stuck in. Which ones are the hardest for you to shift out of and into?

NOTES:



Need to Know: Smart Power Shifting – From One Mindset to Another

Successful people achieve extraordinary results by knowing how to use all four of the thinking dimensions. You can learn to use these states of mind to improve your own results with others.

“Adaptability is the ability to perceive when a new kind of behavior is called for and to respond appropriately (with action or non-action) while remaining true to oneself.”

–Richard Wedemeyer and Ronald Jue, *! eInnerEdge*

The more versatility and adaptability you develop, the more able you are to deal with different people and circumstances. Smart power shifting gives you the tools and skills to increase your adaptability in a deliberate and disciplined way. It helps you to achieve specific outcomes for yourself and with other people. Power shifting is a tool to increase your possibilities for success. It will help you precisely match your thinking skills with the demands of the situation, task or person.

Here are some work related examples of opportunities to shift mindsets in the moment:

RED TO GREEN Your project or work team has decided on a certain approach to a problem. While you are planning the implementation of your solution, a new problem arises that you have never encountered before. You need to shift to Green to find innovative solutions to this new and significant obstacle.

RED TO YELLOW You are a salesperson and today is the last day of the month and you are one sale away from making sales person of the month. You want to make a sale to a person who is asking a lot of questions about a specific product. You want to move the person to decision making and therefore achieve your quota. The customer is still asking a lot of questions and needs a lot more information. You need to shift out of your Red decision making mode to where the customer is, in Yellow – hoping the additional information will help shift them into Red.

YELLOW TO RED You have been waiting patiently for many months for a possible job promotion. Your boss has offered you a new position in an office just being opened in another location. You need to let your boss know of your decision within 24 hours or risk losing the promotion. You need to shift from Yellow to Red.

YELLOW TO GREEN You have been presenting the results of your 6 month research project to your colleagues. As you finalize your one-hour presentation your boss thanks you for all your hard work and then asks you for innovative ideas of how to approach the situation that you have been researching. You need to shift from thinking about the Yellow details to Green envisioning of the possibilities.

RED TO YELLOW You are a bank teller serving a customer and your transaction is completed and you are ready to move onto the next client in the line-up. As the client is leaving your station she bursts into tears. You could easily say goodbye to the client and serve others but you want to ensure that your client has received your care and that you have given them accurate and professional service. You call the client back (by name) and move into Yellow to understand her concerns fully.

MATCH MINDSET TO TASK

Make the shift, match your mind to the task and get the smarter results you want – better and faster. The shifts refer to four core types of thinking work:



GREEN – broaden the focus of attention to open up, use alternative thinking, and expand thinking to generate new ideas, options, alternatives and insights



YELLOW – focus attention on what is known, what is not known, and what needs to be understood before further action



RED – narrow the focus of attention to zero in, make connections, pinpoint issues, come to conclusions, make decisions and get closure



WHITE – raise the energy and motivation from negative to positive, from victim to victor, from ‘no can do’ to ‘can do’, from ‘I can’t’ to ‘I will’

To get results, it is important to think things through using the universal common language of the colours to get from issues, information or ideas to action.



Practice Skill: Meeting Skills

Use a three-stage 30-minute colour coded meeting to arrive at a decision on a motto for the program you are involved in. Spend 10 minutes each in Green, then in Yellow, and then in Red to make a decision. Practice the skill of staying in the zone for each of the three stages. Then debrief.



GENERATE IDEAS



ORGANIZE INTO CATEGORIES



DECIDE ON BEST ONE

NOTES:



Apply @ Work

What could get in the way of using this skill set with others?

Develop a simple way to explain the Smart Skills traffic light system.

Describe the benefits of having a common language that helps people work smarter together.



Smart How To's: Power Shifting in Three Steps

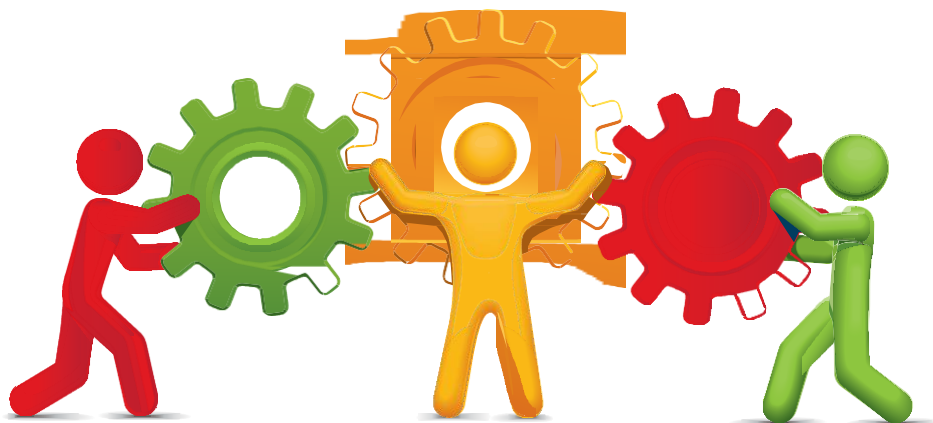
There are three steps to work through to take control and power shift your thinking:

STEP 1. SPOT AND STOP – spot the mindset you are in right now. Stop and get ready to shift out of it. “OK, I am in Yellow, studying and gathering information. Time to shift.”

STEP 2. SHIFT OUT AND TRANSITION – talk to yourself and give yourself instructions to consciously, mindfully and deliberately turn away from the one state of mind you are in, and instead focus on where you need to go next. “OK, drop the Yellow and it’s Red time. Got to get into the Red zone and decide what I am going to do now. Deep breath – power down to Red and decide what to do next.”

STEP 3. SHIFT IN AND ENGAGE – engage in the next state of mind to do the work needed in the process. “Red time – I need to zero in on the three key options to consider and decide which one option is the best.”

It is a big challenge for individuals to change their mind and shift their thinking, especially while under pressure. We all love our comfort zone, but adaptability is a core life skill for the workplace. Your ability to be flexible, overcome rigid thinking and adapt to new things will be critical to your success.





Need to Know: Step 1 - Spot and Stop

Here are ways to stop one type of thinking before you shift to another.

STOP YOUR GREEN CREATIVE THINKING

- Take a deep breath and turn off your idea engine
- Say – “Stop being Green. Time to park it”
- Do – step back and shift your attention to dealing with the task at hand or to the other person
- Ask – “What is the most important thing I need to do right now to move forward?”

STOP YOUR COOL YELLOW ANALYTICAL THINKING

- Take a deep breath and turn off your need for more data
- Say – “Stop analysing and gathering more information”
- Do – step back and shift your attention to using the information to take action
- Ask – “What is the most important thing I need to do right now to use this info?”

STOP YOUR WARM YELLOW COMPASSION

- Take a deep breath and try to focus on facts rather than feelings.
- Say – “Stop worrying about my feelings and everyone else’s for now”
- Do – step back and shift your attention to a more logical approach and think about what you should do next
- Ask – “What do I need to do next in order to move things forward?”

STOP YOUR COOL RED CRITICAL THINKING

- Take a deep breath and turn off your impatience and need to get to closure
- Say – “Step back, chill, relax and open up”
- Do – step back and shift your attention to how others are feeling or to different options
- Ask – “What do you think and how do you feel about this?”

STOP YOUR WARM RED VALUES-DRIVEN THINKING

- Take a deep breath and turn off your need to be always right, to act immediately and to defend
- Say – “Step back, relax and open up to what others are feeling and saying”
- Do – step back and shift your attention to how others are feeling or why their side is important to them
- Ask – “what do you think and how do you feel about this?”

STOP YOUR WARM RED GUT INTUITION

- Take a deep breath and turn off your need to go with your gut
- Say – “Step back and focus on what others are saying and thinking is important to them”
- Do – step back and shift your attention to the facts and the rationale
- Ask – “Show me the logic and evidence behind what you propose?”



Practice Skill #1: Shifting Out of Green and Yellow

Think of real-life situations and tasks where you are in the Green or Yellow mindset and you need to shift out of it to move into another one.

Try working through these steps with a partner:

1) What do you enjoy about being in this particular mindset?

2) What are you typically doing?

3) Why is it difficult for you to shift out and change?

4) What could you do to spot it sooner and get ready to shift out?



Practice Skill #2: : Shifting Out of Red

Think of real life situations where you are in Red mindsets:

1. What do you enjoy about being in this particular mindset?

2. What are you typically doing?

3. Why is it difficult for you to shift out and change

4. What could you do to spot it sooner and get ready to shift out?



Smart How To's: Step 2 – Shift Out and Transition

SHIFT OUT

1. Acknowledge and affirm the good effort and contributions
2. Summarize what was covered.

As you shift into the next mindset, here are some simple techniques and phrases you can use with yourself, in one-to-one conversation, and in work groups:



LEAVING GREEN - SAY AND DO

- “We have a number of ideas, possibilities and options... Now we need to...”
- “That was excellent. We have many options and alternatives to work with and now we have to shift our attention to how to group and organize the ideas into...”
- “Great work on future thinking. Now we need to shift our attention to ...”



LEAVING YELLOW - SAY AND DO

- “We now have a deeper understanding of... and that will help us as we shift into Red and decide...”
- “We now have an appreciation for how you feel about... I think we can move into exploring options and solutions for ...”
- “We have organized the information/ options...”



LEAVING RED - SAY AND DO

- “We have a solid definition of the root or the crux of the issue. Now we need to...”
- “We now have an appreciation of what people's values are. Given that we...”
- “We have made a decision. Our next step is...”



LEAVING WHITE - SAY AND DO

- “We appreciate what this offers, and now we can move forward to...”
- “We have a good sense of what we can do, so next we will...”
- “We are ready to take initiative, and so our next step is to...”



Practice Skill: Read and Succeed

These simple and practical statements on the previous page are for guiding conversations and keeping them moving forward in a constructive way. Practice reading these statements out loud to yourself and to others. Practice using your own speaking style to fit what you are saying. Discuss what it accomplishes for you and the person or group you are working with.

NOTES:



Apply @ Work: How to Make a Shift in Conversation

Identify situations that you have experienced, or think that you might have to deal with in the future, with your co-workers, customers, supervisor or others where this conversation and group work transition skill would be most helpful.

NOTES:



Smart How To's: Step 3 – Shift In and Engage

The next step is to shift into a new mindset. To recap the use of colours for getting work done, here is a look at what you need to say to make the shift into the next mindset.

“Now it's time to go from the good work we just did, and shift our attention to...”

“Now we need to park that work ... and turn our full attention to...”

“It's time to make a big turn and put our full focus on...”



GO GREEN

“Green light time: Green broadens our thinking and opens up our minds to generate as many ideas, options, possibilities and insights as possible, without worry or judgement. Green is the time to look up to the sky, do some Green thinking, and cast our eyes, hearts and minds to the future. Shift into “What if...?”, “How might we...?” and “What does success look like?” Telescope – crystal ball – green light all ideas.”



BE YELLOW

“Yellow light time: Slow down. Pay full attention in order to understand the situation clearly. Study the information. Tune in to how people are feeling. It's time to look at what we have and what we know, examine the information, learn what we need to know more about, get a real sense of how people are feeling, and get as clear as we can..”



DO RED

“Red light time: Narrow the focus of attention to determine the crux of the issue. Make a decision and ensure that you have the evidence or commitment to act. Zero in on it. Get to the point. Get to the bottom line. Decide what needs to be done.”



INSPIRE WHITE

“Personal spirit time: Power up the positivity, empower your motivation and ignite the initiative. It's diamond time – time to sparkle and tap into your spirit and resilience to take action and make a positive difference.”



Apply @ Work

Discuss how you would contribute to helping a co-worker or supervisor shift the conversation to another mindset in order to keep focused on getting the best results.

NOTES:



Smart How To's: Shift from Green

Shifting comes easily to some people, and not so easily to others. Some states of mind are easier to shift into. Others are more difficult to shift out of and leave behind. The greater the pressure, the more likely people get trapped into a mindset that does not match the demands of the other person, task or situation.

The big idea is to meet people where they are. Respect where they are coming from. Recognize that to arrive at high quality results, it is often necessary to move from your current thinking to where you need to be. Here are some guidelines, detailed tips and techniques to help an individual shift from one state of mind to another. Also included are guidelines, tips and techniques to help a conversation between two people or a group shift from one state of mind to another.

ONE ON ONE. Here are several techniques to help someone in a high Green creative state of mind.



STEP 1: CONNECT WITH GREEN

- Invite them to share all of their ideas.
- Take notes, preferably on a surface others can see.
- Simply agree with the process of producing all their ideas. Don't interrupt or argue.
- Clarify if necessary. Make sure you write down every idea and suggestion. Continually ask, "What else?"
- After a few minutes, ask for a pause to look over the list of ideas and options. Ask if there are any other possibilities or combinations.



STEP 2: SHIFT TO RED

- Shift the focus of the conversation to stop any further idea generation. Request a shift of attention to select the best idea(s).
- Close by confirming, "So, do I have this correct? The best idea you want to act on is...? Great. Thanks."

TWO PEOPLE OR A TEAM – GREEN TO RED

Here are some sample scripts on what to say and do in order to shift a conversation or group meeting from talking about ideas to decision making:

- "We have come up with some exciting situations/ideas. Our task now is to shift from coming up with ideas to evaluating which are the best ones to act on."
- "Great work on getting all these ideas out. Let's go around the group. Can each person select the two ideas that you think will most likely solve the problem? We can add them up at the end."
- "We have brainstormed a lot of ideas. Next step, we have to shift our attention to organizing them into bundles or categories of similar ideas. Once we do that, we can then decide which ones are the most important and choose the best. "
- "To get in the right state of mind to make a decision, let's all play five fast rounds of rock, paper, scissors."



Practice Skill: Green to Red

Working in pairs, practice reading and completing each of the Green to Red statements on the previous page. Use a real discussion on a subject of shared interest in the starting colour mindset. One person will practice speaking up and making the shift as described. Debrief, switch roles and try again right away, and then debrief and discuss how best to do it.

NOTES:



Apply @ Work: Ideas to Decisions

Imagine some possible work situations where a conversation or meeting is in the same mindset for too long and there is a need to shift to doing something else. How would you know when to make the shift, and what would you say and do?

NOTES:



Smart How To's: Shift from Yellow to Red

Here are several techniques to help someone high in the Yellow understanding state of mind shift from data gathering and feelings to making a decision. Remind the person at the beginning, that by the end of the conversation, it will be necessary to come to some conclusions and to make a decision.



STEP 1: CONNECT WITH YELLOW

- Invite them to share all of the information they have.
- Take your time and give them the time they need so that they don't feel rushed.
- Take notes, preferably on a surface both of you can see. Listen carefully and ask if they need any further clarification.
- Simply agree, and don't argue. Clarify and structure the information. Ask if anything needs more clarification.



STEP 2: SHIFT TO RED

- Give the highlights of the discussions and the key information points.
- Shift the conversation to stop any further discussions, and say that it is time to make a decision.
- Close by confirming, "So, do I have this correct? The best idea you want to act on is...? Great. Thanks."

TWO PEOPLE OR A TEAM – GREEN TO RED

Here are some sample scripts on what to say and do in order to shift a conversation or group meeting from data gathering and feelings to decision making:

- "We have gone over the situation in great detail. Now it's time to shift our focus from what we know to what we should do."
- "There is a lot of information. We seem to have a good understanding of what it tells us. Now we need to turn our attention to how we can use it to get to the right conclusions and recommendations."
- "I think we can agree we have a better understanding. Now we need to move on and make a decision."
- "Thanks to everyone for so openly expressing your feelings and emotions. This has helped us to both clear the air and deepen our understanding of the issues and their impact. Let's move on now to deciding what we need to do next to solve this problem."



Skill Practice: Yellow to Red

Working in pairs, practice reading and completing each of the Yellow to Red statements on the previous page. Use a real discussion on a subject of shared interest in the starting colour mindset. One person will practice speaking up and making the shift as described. Debrief, switch roles and try again right away, and then debrief and discuss how best to do it.

NOTES:



Apply @ Work: Information to Action

Imagine some possible work situations where a conversation or meeting is in the same mindset for too long and there is a need to shift to doing something else. How would you know when to make the shift, and what would you say and do?

NOTES:



Smart How To's: Shift from Green Options to Yellow

Here are several techniques to help someone in a high Green creative state of mind shift away from pushing for more options to slow down, step back, look at the existing ideas and options, and then to organize them the best way. Remind others at the beginning of the conversation, the goal is to build a solid foundation of grouped and organized ideas so that they can be used and acted upon.



STEP 1: CONNECT WITH GREEN

- Invite them to share all of their ideas.
- Take notes, preferably on a surface others can see.
- Simply agree with the process of producing all their ideas. Don't interrupt or argue.
- Clarify if necessary. Continually ask, "What else?", or if they have any more ideas.
- After a few minutes, ask for a pause to look over the list of ideas and options. Ask if there are any other possibilities or combinations.
- There is always time to add more options



STEP 2: SHIFT TO YELLOW

- Now ask them what patterns or critical elements they see in the data.
- Ask if there is anything missed that could come back and hurt or negatively impact a decision.
- If the issue is Warm Yellow and feelings-related, it is important to request time to sit back and listen carefully to the feelings that need to be expressed. Seek to understand the underlying issues, fears, anxieties, frustrations and hurt feelings, and how any decision will impact how the other person feels.
- Ensure clarity and agreement on the amount and level of information needed before going any further.
- Close by confirming, "So, do I have this correct? We need more information before we proceed..." or "... we now have enough clarity and data to move to action."

TWO PEOPLE OR A TEAM – GREEN TO YELLOW

Here are some sample scripts on what to say and do in order to shift a conversation or group meeting from the generating phase to the analysis and organizing phase:

- "We have identified some good ideas and options. That's great work. Now it's time to shift our attention to see how we can organize them into categories before deciding which ones are best."
- "We have come up with some good ideas/situations. Our task now is to shift from coming up with ideas to making each one as clear as possible, then putting them into categories before deciding which are the best ones to act on."
- "Great work on getting all these ideas out. Let's go around the group. Can each person select one category or theme to organize these ideas under?"
- "We have brainstormed a lot of ideas. Next step, we have to shift our attention to organizing them into bundles or categories of similar ideas.. Once we do that, we can then decide which ones are the most important and select the best."



Skill Practice: Green to Yellow

Working in pairs, practice reading and completing each of the Green to Yellow statements on the previous page. Use a real discussion on a subject of shared interest in the starting colour mindset. One person will practice speaking up and making the shift as described. Debrief, switch roles and try again right away, and then debrief and discuss how best to do it.

NOTES:



Apply @ Work: Ideas to Categories

Imagine some possible work situations where a conversation or meeting is in the same mindset for too long and there is a need to shift to doing something else. How would you know when to make the shift, and what would you say and do?

NOTES:



Smart How To's: Shift from Red to Green

Here are several techniques to help someone in a high Red decisive state of mind to shift away from pushing for closure and making a decision toward slowing down, stepping back, and exploring options before rushing to a decision. Remind others at the beginning of the conversation that the goal is to make the best decision possible by developing other valuable (perhaps even better) solutions.



STEP 1: CONNECT WITH RED

- Request a pause. Buy time: five minutes, 10 minutes, or whatever it takes to ensure the best quality decision.
- Say that you agree there is a need for action, AND that there's a need to make sure it will be smart action.
- Provide the reasoning that there are many factors at play/things to consider and that no one wants to make a mistake. "It's best to take our time and think twice and then act once with confidence."
- Go over the highlights of the information – not the details – unless they are critical. Ask the other person what they believe is the crux of the issue.



STEP 2: SHIFT TO GREEN

- Now switch the tone of the conversation. Ask to put the data and conversation aside for a few minutes.
- Say that it's time to step back, open up our minds and explore what ideas and options are possible.
- Use any one of the four creative thinking strategies – brainstorm ideas, challenge assumptions, reframe problems into opportunities and envision possibilities – to stimulate thinking.
- Ask the "What if..." question to drive idea generation.
- Write down all of the ideas to ensure that they are recorded and can be used in the next phase.
- Close by confirming, "So, there are a number of alternatives. Next step is to bring some structure and order to them so that these options can be used constructively."

TWO PEOPLE OR A TEAM

Here are some sample scripts on what to say and do in order to shift a conversation or group meeting from the decision-making phase to the generating phase:

- "We have identified a number of good issues. That's great work. Now it's time to shift our attention to come up with ideas."
- "These issues are an excellent start. Our next task is to turn our focus to generating options and possible solutions."
- "We have come up with some good ideas. Our task now is to shift from generating ideas to clarifying each one, then putting them into categories before deciding which are the best ones to act upon."
- "Great work on getting all these concerns out. Let's go around the group. Can each person select one idea or solution?"



Practice Skill: Red to Green

Working in pairs, practice reading and completing each of the Red to Green statements on the previous page. Use a real discussion on a subject of shared interest in the starting colour mindset. One person will practice speaking up and making the shift as described. Debrief, switch roles and try again right away, and then debrief and discuss how best to do it.

NOTES:



Apply @ Work: Issues to Options

Imagine some possible work situations where a conversation or meeting is in the same mindset for too long and there is a need to shift to doing something else. How would you know when to make the shift, and what would you say and do?

NOTES:



Smart How To's: Shift from Yellow to Green

Here are several techniques to help someone high in a Yellow state of mind shift away from pushing for more discussion, analysis and sharing to step back and look at what ideas and options could be generated from the information. Remind the person at the beginning of the conversation that the goal is to move things forward by having options to work on.



STEP 1: CONNECT WITH YELLOW

- Invite them to share all of the information they have.
- Take your time and give them the time they need so that they don't feel rushed.
- Take notes, preferably on a surface both of you can see. Listen carefully and ask if they need any further clarification.
- Simply agree, and don't argue. Clarify and structure the information. Make sure that you write down every idea and proposal. Ask if anything needs more clarification.



STEP 2: SHIFT TO GREEN

- Now switch the tone of the conversation. Ask to put the data and conversation aside for a few minutes.
- Say that it's time to step back, open up our minds and explore what ideas and options are possible.
- Use any one of the four creative thinking strategies – brainstorm ideas, challenge assumptions, reframe problems into opportunities and envision possibilities – to stimulate thinking.
- Ask the “What if...” question to drive idea generation.
- Write down all of the ideas to ensure that they are recorded and can be used in the next phase.
- Close by confirming, “So, there are a number of alternatives. Next step is to bring some structure and order to them so that these options can be used constructively.”

TWO PEOPLE OR A TEAM

Here are some sample scripts on what to say and do to in order shift a conversation or group meeting from the analysis and clarification phase to the generating ideas, options and solutions phase:

- “We have done a solid job in getting clear on the facts at hand. That's great work. Now it's time to shift our attention to generating a variety of ideas and creative options to guide our decision making.”
- “This analysis and discussion is excellent. Our next task is to turn our focus from looking at what we have to sketching out future possibilities and options.”
- “Our task now is to shift our attention and efforts from understanding and clarifying issues to generating ideas and solutions on what to do next. Let's start by using “What if...” questions to generate some positive constructive ideas. “What if...?”
- “Great work on the data and discussion. Now it's time to shift our focus. Let's go around the group. Can each person generate one idea on what we could do to solve the problem?”



Practice Skill: Yellow to Green

Working in pairs, practice reading and completing each of the Yellow to Green statements on the previous page. Use a real discussion on a subject of shared interest in the starting colour mindset. One person will practice speaking up and making the shift as described. Debrief, switch roles and try again right away, and then debrief and discuss how best to do it.

NOTES:



Apply @ Work: Information to Options

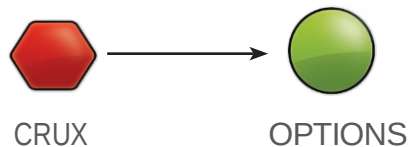
Imagine some work situations where a conversation or meeting has been in the same mindset for too long and there is a need to shift to doing something else. How would you know when to make the shift, and what would you say and do?

NOTES:



Practice Skill: Mastering the Shifts

TASK: Identify situations at work or in everyday situations where shifting would help move things forward. Write out a script for using this technique in a one-on-one conversation on each of the 6 tasks.



Lesson 3: How to Give and Receive Feedback

INTRODUCTION

Feedback brings us back to the sender and receiver. Feedback is what the sender gets back when they communicate or do something. This feedback is information that can be listened to, clarified, used or not. We get feedback all the time – a smile, a frown, a look, a pat on the back, a harsh comment or stony silence – all feedback all the time. The key mindset for this lesson is Yellow – to stay neutral and in an understanding frame of mind – to notice, listen carefully and to clarify before leaping to conclusions too quickly.

This lesson will give you some simple tools on how to use three different types of feedback and some practical ways to give and receive feedback.





Experience Exercise: Feedback on Feedback

1. From your experience, what do you say to someone who is not performing properly on a team or in a group?

2. What techniques do you use that would work well?

3. What techniques would make it worse?

4. When someone has to give you feedback on your performance, what works best for you and what doesn't work?



Need to Know: Coaching, Communicating and Learning Points

Feedback is any information you get about yourself. No learning or growth happens without feedback. Feedback tells us how we are doing, and gives us the opportunity to self-correct, adjust and adapt so that what we do works better.

One big problem is that most of us are not very good at giving feedback. Another big problem is that most of us are not very good at receiving feedback either. There is often a huge resistance to giving it and to hearing what others say since learning about ourselves can be difficult and painful to hear and accept.

THE THREE TYPES OF FEEDBACK ARE:

S !002%#)!4)/. – a shout out, a thank you and recognition of the positive impact and difference you make through your efforts and behaviour. It motivates you.

S #/!#().' – to help someone expand their skills and capabilities by providing information and guidance. The focus is on someone learning something, getting better, improving and changing. Coaching usually focuses on what you need to know – the information, knowledge and 'How-To' skills. Coaching also helps improve how you interact in a relationship.

S %6!,5!4)/. – an assessment of your performance to help in decision-making regarding yourself. In evaluative feedback, you are often compared to standards of performance or to others. Therefore, judgement is involved.

We need all three of the types of feedback. The core of all great feedback is Yellow understanding. It is not about whether we feel it is right or wrong. Instead, it's about whether we first understand fully what is being said before we respond.

The key is to know the real purpose of giving feedback, and then making sure that the other person is prepared for it. The big challenge is to separate coaching as learning feedback from evaluation as judging feedback. Coaching is for helping performance improve, not for saying that you are or are not good enough.



Need to Know: The Johari Window

A simple model for understanding each other better and giving feedback is the Johari window. The Johari window depicts four aspects of ourselves:

	WHAT YOU SEE IN ME	WHAT YOU DO NOT SEE IN ME
WHAT I SEE IN ME	The Public Self	The Private Self (or Hidden) Self
WHAT I DO NOT SEE IN ME	The Blind Self	The Undiscovered Self

- **PUBLIC SELF** – what I and others know about me
- **PRIVATE SELF** – what I know about myself, but others don't know
- **BLIND SPOT** – what others know about me that I don't know about me
- **UNDISCOVERED SELF** – the undiscovered and untapped me

The Johari window is one way of understanding feedback. It sometimes focuses on giving feedback on what you already understand about yourself. It is particularly useful in helping you uncover your blind spot – good things you need to know about yourself, and things about yourself that have a negative or poor impact on others.

NOTES:



Practice Skill: Feedback on Johari Window

Practice these skills in small groups:

- 1) Share three things everyone knows about each other.
- 2) Share two things from your hidden self – things that others do not know about you - “You wouldn’t know this about me but I am a great ballroom dancer. Also, I have a twin.”
- 3) Share one appreciative thing about each other’s blind spot – “You don’t know this, but one thing I appreciate about you is...”
- 4) Share one coaching piece of feedback. Invite each person to request feedback from the others on a particular behaviour or performance they witnessed and how they could improve next time

NOTES:



Apply @ Work: Feedback

Discuss situations in the workplace where it might be important to give feedback to a co-worker or supervisor.

1. What are the situations?

2. Why is it important to offer feedback?

3. What will probably make it difficult?

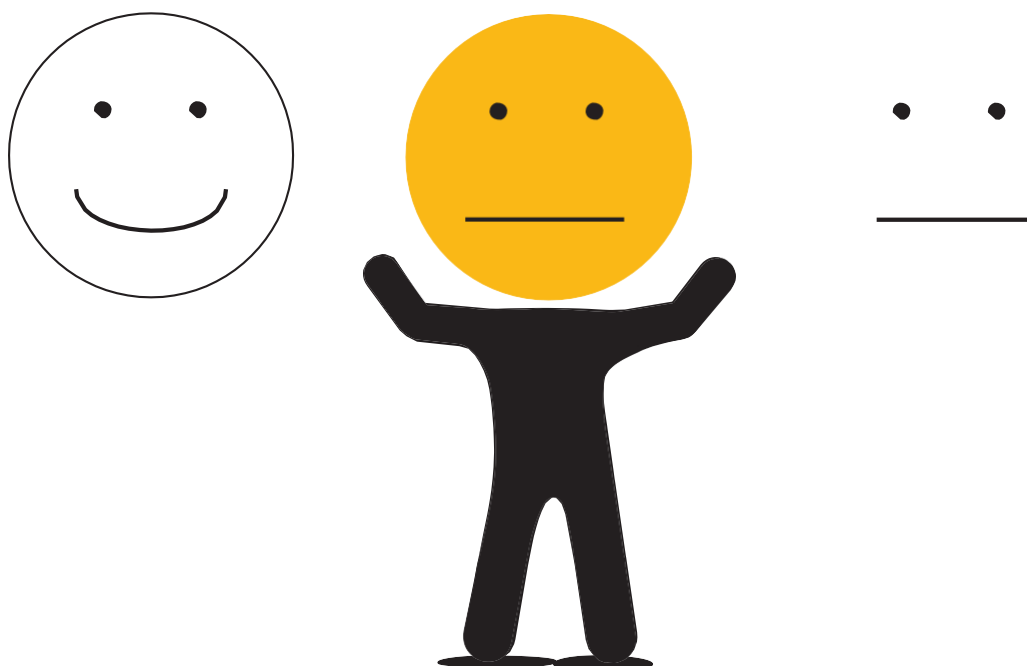
4. What could make it better?



Practice Skill: Try the Three Types of Feedback

Working in a group, discuss how each person needs to pay attention while receiving feedback. Always conclude each feedback round with a short reminder of what was said to ensure understanding, as well as a thank you, before moving on:

1. APPRECIATE FEEDBACK
2. COACHING FEEDBACK
3. EVALUATIVE FEEDBACK



PROCEDURE

Go around your group of 3-4 people in three rounds.

1. First, deliver one piece of appreciative feedback to each member.
2. Second, each member will ask for coaching feedback on a skill they want to improve. Seek to clarify.
3. Third, each member will ask for one piece of evaluative feedback on one of their behaviours. Seek to clarify.
4. Debrief as a group.



Apply @ Work: Feedback

Think about the workplace and the percentage of feedback you may receive that is appreciative, coaching or evaluative. How do you deal with:

- “That’s not true about me!”
- “Who are you to tell me?”
- “It’s not me. You are the problem.”
- “I always screw things up.”

Focus on how you feel and what it takes to respond and deal with feedback effectively at work. Write down your plan for a positive response to feedback.

MORE STRATEGIES TO DEAL WITH FEEDBACK

1. APPRECIATIVE FEEDBACK

- **Feel**
- **Think**
- **Say**
- ° **do**

2. COACHING FEEDBACK

- **Feel**
- **Think**
- **Say**
- ° **do**

3. EVALUATIVE FEEDBACK

- **Feel**
- **Think**
- **Say**
- ° **do**

NOTES:



Smart How To's: Tips on Receiving Feedback

The main point in receiving feedback is to take full responsibility for the fact that you are the only person who can learn for you. You make the calls. So stay in Yellow and seek to understand for as long as possible. Do your best to stay out of Red until you are totally clear on what is being communicated to you. And avoid getting into the angry, defensive, protective, threatened side of Red.

LISTEN FOR THESE POINTS

1. **What information do you have that i am missing?**
2. **What negative impact am i having that i don't know about?**
3. **What am i doing to make this worse or not work well?**
4. **What can i do or say right now to be effective?**

NOTES:



Practice Skill: Give and Receive Feedback

Work in pairs to practice giving and receiving feedback by using the questions listed here.
Take turns in each role.

LISTEN FOR THESE POINTS

- What information do you have that I am missing?
- What negative impact am I having that I don't know about?
- What am I doing to make this worse or not work well?
- What can I do or say right now to be effective?

NOTES:



Apply @ Work: User Feedback

Discuss how to use these skills in the workplace with different types of supervisors and co-workers. Work on an approach to test out, based on:

1. How do you like to receive feedback?

2. Whose feedback do you value most/least?

3. When is the ideal time for you to receive feedback (eg; while learning a new skill)?

4. What usually works best for you?



Smart How To's: Tips on Giving Feedback

A GUIDE FOR SELECTING WHAT YOU SAY AND DO

Here is a simple 4 quadrant model for thinking about how to improve the feedback you give so it has the impact you want. The more mindful and smarter you are in choosing your words, the more likely you will be successful. This model is based on the work of George Lock Land. Whether you are appreciating someone's efforts or results, coaching or evaluating, a key to success is to combine positive affirmative statements with useful, 'nutritious' statements that give specifics the receiver can use to continue or improve. Non-nutritious = no worthwhile food for thought and action.

	NUTRITIOUS	NON-NUTRITIOUS
POSITIVE	• Great effort. • you spoke with Confidence • Next time, try speaking a bit more slowly.	That was great!
NEGATIVE	You were rushed and too loud.	i didn't like it.



Smart How To's: Tips on Giving Feedback

1. **Know the purpose for the feedback** – appreciative, coaching or evaluative.
2. **Keep in mind three key things:**
 - How will this help achieve the long-term outcome or success you want?
 - How will this strengthen this relationship?
 - How best to deliver the message – think of the person, place, time
3. **Accept, appreciate and respect** the person you are coaching or evaluating.
4. **Combine positive affirmative feedback with quality information** - select the nutritious information
5. **Fit the feedback to the person:**
 - Red – prefers directness and getting to the point; may react strongly
 - Cool Yellow – needs lots of information, detailed clarity and time
 - Warm Yellow – picks up on very subtle feedback
 - Green – can shift the topic and may feel attacked by a direct approach
 - Low White – may receive the feedback as confirming their low control
6. **Give feedback that is clear** and based on facts, not assumptions.
7. **Be accountable** and ask for accountability.
8. **Separate the person from the performance** – I like you, and the performance needs some work.
9. **Focus on the outcome** that is needed.
10. **Be ready to coach** and support when asked to do so.

NOTES:



Practice Skill: Give Feedback

Work in pairs to practice feedback, using different approaches - positive and negative, nutritious and non-nutritious words.

1. APPRECIATIVE FEEDBACK POSITIVE POSITIVE	NUTRITIOUS NON-NUTRITIOUS
2. COACHING FEEDBACK POSITIVE NEGATIVE	NUTRITIOUS NON-NUTRITIOUS
3. EVALUATIVE FEEDBACK POSITIVE NEGATIVE	NUTRITIOUS NON-NUTRITIOUS



Apply @ Work

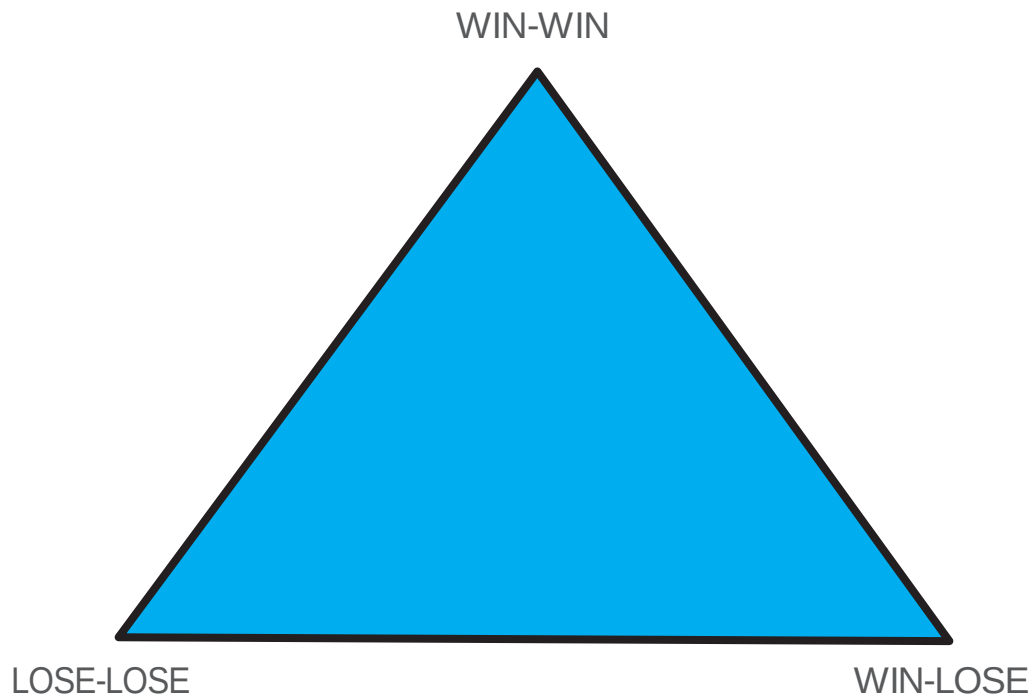
Discuss how to use these skills in the workplace. Think about different types of supervisors and co-workers. Work on an approach to test out, based on:

- Your commitment to learn and grow
- When you might have to give evaluative feedback to a co-worker
- What will likely work best for you

NOTES:

Lesson 4: How to Manage Conflict

Few of us like conflict, but conflict often happens. Under the right conditions, conflict can be part of arriving at the best decision, by debating the merits of different options and finding the better way.





Need to Know: Confl

A conflict is when people or groups differ and are at odds with each other over who is right or wrong, or how a solution is to be arrived at. Here are three potential scenarios:

WIN-WIN – when both sides give and take and achieve benefits

WIN-LOSE – when one side wins at the expense of the other side

LOSE-LOSE – when the way the conflict is handled ends with both sides losing

GETTING TO YES

Roger Fisher, William Ury and Bruce Patton are Harvard University experts in conflict who wrote a famous book about negotiating called *Getting to Yes*. They focus on negotiating skills and processes to achieve results that feel fair enough to both parties and are win-win. Over time, collaboration consistently wins out over a win-lose approach in most organizations. The five key points from the experts are:

- 1. Separate the person/people from the problem.** Focus on the issues that need to be dealt with, and not on the personalities. Stay in Yellow to understand, and then work on defining the crux in Red.
- 2. Focus on the interests of each person/group, and don't take positions.** Avoid coming in with non-negotiable cool or warm Reds, such as a 'my way or the highway' position.
- 3. invent options for mutual gain** vs. win-lose options. Take the time needed to go Green. Challenge assumptions, reframe problems into possibilities and think about possible solutions.
- 4. invest in setting and using objective criteria** vs. personalized ones. Use the cool Red criteria such as time, money, effort and value, instead of the 'my way' position, to validate all possible conclusions.
- 5. Know your BATNA** – Best Alternative Negotiated Agreement – and be ready to reframe back-up positions. This means to know in advance what your bottom line is in coming to an agreement.



Need to Know: The Colours of Confl

The Red mindset is at the heart and the colour of conflict. This mindset does not consist of people who are high in Red, but people who choose to be in Red because that is when they make decisions. In the Red zone, you have to decide what you want, what is right, and what is fair or not fair. The resolution of all conflict is also in Red – the ability to make practical, sensible decisions and commitments that align with your values, as well as the values of others.



USE COOL RED/CRITICAL THINKING – use the logic, objectivity, practicality and real differences expressed by each party to help them achieve their aims. It's easier to work through conflict by staying objective and following the expert's guidelines from the previous page.



USE WARM RED/VALUES DRIVEN – personal values and beliefs are at the core of many differences. These include issues of fairness and personal points of view, and the feeling that one side's beliefs are superior to the other side's beliefs. Very difficult to work through because both sides deeply believe they are right and refuse to 'give in' to the other side. Unless a shift can be made away from values-driven me/my tribe vs. you/your tribe it can be difficult to shift to cool Red logic, apply cool Yellow analysis and cool Green options to work through the conflict.



USE COOL YELLOW/ANALYTICAL – this is less about conflict, and more about differences in data or a feeling that the research and analysis has not been done thoroughly, properly or completely. This may be resolved by further exploration of relevant information and clarification.



USE WARM YELLOW – In high in warm yellow find it important to truly listen to and understand others and to openly express thoughts and feelings. These are critical elements in interpersonal relationships. When these skills are not used by others in interactions with warm yellow thinkers they may feel undervalued and not listened to, resulting in misunderstanding and eventually conflict.



USE GREEN – this is less about conflict, and more about generating additional ideas when it's time to zero in on problems.

To Get to Yes: Use warm Yellow to focus on building the relationships between people.

To Get to Yes: Use cool-thinking approaches to stay as objective as possible and avoid emotional issues, unless they are needed to clear the air and contribute to 'yes'.

To Get to Yes: Use cool red to stay objective, focussing on the issues, not the individuals.

To Get to Yes: Use green humour to break the tension and open up new ways.



Experience Exercise: Worst and Best

What are some of the worst conflicts you have seen or been a part of when on a team or in a group? What went wrong? What was your takeaway? What are some of the most effective ways to resolve conflicts you have witnessed or been a part of? Why did they turn out successfully? What happened that made the difference? What was your takeaway?

NOTES:



Practice Skill: The Colours of Confl

Work in pairs. Pick random objects and issues. Practice discussing from Warm Red and Cool Red points of view. Attempt to find common ground, and reflect on what works and what doesn't work.

ROUND1:

ROUND2:

ROUND3

LESSONS LEARNED:



Experience Exercise: Red or Dead

In some situations it is impossible to find a way through conflict because one party is aggressive , has more power and little respect for the other party, or there is a lack of fairness in the way things are going. Have you been in this situation? How did you deal with it?

NOTES:



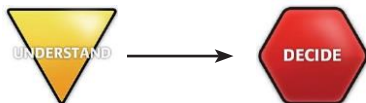
Smart How To's: The Colours of Conflict Resolution

Given the goodwill of both parties, one of the keys to any conflict resolution is to have an agreed-upon process or path to follow in order to find a resolution together. The simplest way to work is to use these guidelines:

1. **determine the outcome of the conflict** – the type of result you are seeking – not who wins or loses, but the colour of the outcome. This is a decision, a solution, a plan, etc.
2. **Select the right process** by selecting the best Smart Track.
3. **Allocate times** for each step of the process to ensure that you get to your outcome on time.
4. **Agree to some ground rules** to follow. These are simple ways to give feedback to get back on track together.

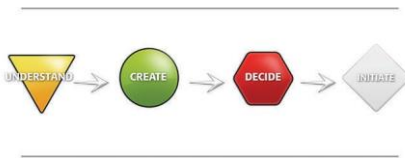
THREE TRACKS TO SUCCESS

Here are three Smart Tracks that use the Smart Skills system, and which will help you to work and negotiate your way through conflict:



1. **Y to R** – a deep Yellow conversation to clear up misunderstanding. Then shift to Red to decide how best to proceed.

UCDI



2. **A+UCdi** – a five-step process that goes from an Appreciation of both sides, to Understanding and confirming understanding of the issues, feelings and facts, to the Creation of options, followed by the Decision to act and, finally, Initiatives to implement.

3. **Crux to Conclusion** – a five-step process that goes from determining the real crux of the problem right through option generation to analysis and decision-making.



Practice Skill: Working Through Confl

Pick a situation where there is some minor conflict that first needs clarification and then a decision. Use the worksheet for the Smart Track to practice both planning the process and then what you will say and do to work your way through the issue. Write down your plan and practice your Think, Feel, Say, Do approach.







Practice Skill: Working Through Confl

Pick a situation where there is some conflict that can be resolved using the UCDI Smart Track approach to conflict resolution. Use the worksheet to plan the points to raise and the questions to ask at each of the four phases. Write down your plan and practice your Think, Feel, Say, Do approach at each phase.

UCDI











Apply @ Work: Practical Applications

Now you know the Smart Skills language to better understand yourself and other people, and you know how to use the Smart Track processes to get to 'yes'. Discuss possible situations at work where you could use this knowledge and skills.

ALL ABOUT YOU

As you complete this program, you will have a unique passport to success in the 21st century. Anywhere you go, you will know how to think better. You will know how to solve problems faster. You will be able to communicate and collaborate with others. You will have a stronger personal spirit. You will have the skills to work smarter. These smart skills will be your inside edge to face difficulties, overcome challenges and make the most of your opportunities.

You are already smart. Your 4D-i helps you know more about how you are smart, in your own unique way. Appreciate this. Celebrate what you learn about yourself. The good news is that we can all get smarter. Brains can change and grow. Grow yourself. Be more adaptable. Work on your game. Choose to practice, practice, practice. Put in the effort. Over and over. This is your opportunity. You are in charge.

We are all wired to keep growing and get better. Continue to build your skills in all 4 dimensions.

- Go green – to expand your skills in how to generate more creative ideas
- Slow in yellow – to deepen your skills in how to analyze and organize information and connect better with others
- Get to red – to sharpen your critical thinking skills and make smarter decisions
- Ignite your white – to tap into the power of your personal spirit to appreciate, persevere and initiate.

Support, encourage and help others to get ahead. Reach out. Teach others how to use the traffic light model to shift their thinking. Help them get better results too. Make your mark. Help us all build a smarter, better world.

ABOUT SMARTSKILLS®

Thinking is the core competency for the 21st century. SmartSkills was developed by Bob Wiele and his team at OneSmartWorld. The SmartSkills advantage is its one integrated platform to deliver five essential 21st century skills. It is like having a 4 wheel all terrain vehicle for your mind. SmartSkills is a system of thinking skills, strategies and thinking processes to help people think better, work smarter and get better results. The five skills are thinking, problem solving, communications in speaking and writing, collaborative teamwork and resilience in personal spirit. SmartSkills was designed as an educational innovation to implement the work of the Partnership for 21st Century Skills, the government of Canada's essential skills and the insights of many educational thought leaders. The SmartSkills system has been adopted by many progressive businesses, government workforce development programs and educational institutions.

ABOUT BOB WIELE

Bob Wiele, founder and President of OneSmartWorld, is a relentless innovator committed to help make the world a smarter, better place. His focus is on developing practical tools for individuals, organizations and nations to harness their brainpower, as their key to success in the 21st century. Bob and his team have built powerful thinking skills tools like the 4D-i and the SmartSkills system. He has a BA from McGill, a Master's degree in adult education from the University of Toronto and over 40 years of learning from his mistakes, ventures and efforts. Bob the author of a number of programs, books and papers. He has a great family and lives happily with Mandy in Collingwood, Ontario, Canada. Bob is still working hard to find new ways to get a little bit smarter every day.

NOTES:

Thinking and Problem Solving

Igniting Personal Spirit

Communicating



Writing

Working with Others

THE 21ST CENTURY SKILLS CHALLENGE

±To WYGGeeH in oYrJaWtGhanKinK [orPH [e aPPneeH to FeGome more
ZerWatiPe aKiPe anHaHaTtaFPe. WeneeH to aGUYire ane[Wet oJ^{Wt}
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THE SMARTSKILLS® PROGRAM

- 1) 8LinkinK anH 4roFlem SolZinK
- 2) -KnitinK 4ersonal STirit
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Think Better. Work Smarter.

SmartSkills®: 21st Century Skills for Success

created by &oF ;iele

Fearless Diamond Press 2015

SmartSkills®: 21st Century Skills for Success

WRITING TO RECORD, REPORT AND PERSUADE

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Powered by



Think Better. Work Smarter.

SMARTSKILLS®
21ST CENTURY SKILLS FOR SUCCESS

Writing to Record, Report and Persuade
by
Bob Wiele

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WRITING TO RECORD, REPORT AND PERSUADE

Writing to Record, Report and Persuade and the LEAP System for Learning 1

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PROFICIENCIES IN WRITING TO RECORD, INFORM AND PERSUADE

The goal of this module is to equip you with the knowledge, skills and confidence in writing to inform, persuade and get your message across to others.

In this module, you have the opportunity to develop proficiency in these skills:

1. Write to communicate a clear and complete message, appropriate to the task
2. Use language, style and structure appropriate to the purpose and audience
3. Write to request information or justify a request
4. Write to record relevant information, accurately and completely
5. Organize information logically, sequentially and in a way that can be easily understood
6. Write to persuade, convince and recommend

THE LEAP FRAMEWORK FOR LEARNING

The LEAP framework for learning is a simple framework for learning, developed by Bob Wiele, to accelerate skill development and improve your success .

LEAP consists of the following core components.

L – LEARn. This has two elements – one that outlines the what and the why of the knowledge and the second that provides procedures and tips on how to use the information



- **Need to Know** – short information capsules on the current research and theories on the topic



- **Smart How To's** - a list of key pointers on how to implement the knowledge into life and work



E – ExPERiEncE – opportunities to reflect on one's experiences and what the learner already knows



A- Apply@ WorK AND ASSeSS

- **Apply @ Work** – poses a challenge on how best to transfer what you learned to the workplace

- **Assess** – this component is not included in the books but is for the instructor to use with you to help you know how you are doing. It assists you grow your skills.



p – prAcTice SKills – a focus on repeated practice of the concepts, the language and the behaviors to build your skills, your confidence and improve your results.

Introduction: The Smarts Skills Writing Style Guide

Every person doing any kind of job needs the right tools to get the job done. The better the tools, the easier it is to get the job done. It is the same with writing. There are some basic tools that you can learn to use that will help you write better and achieve better results.

The Smart Skills system gives you the core essential language tools to plan and write effectively. Like any tool kit, the more you practice, the better you perform. In this lesson, you will receive an inventory of good writing tools that you can choose from when you have to write to inform, make a request, record notes or persuade others.

In this lesson and the lessons that follow, you will have the opportunity to test drive the different words and phrases, get familiar with using as many of them as possible, gain confidence and sharpen your writing skills.



Need to Know: The Smart Writing and Communication Guide

Two main components to effective writing are the words you choose to use and plan the structure, or steps you need to organize your writing.

The purpose of this Smart Writing and Communicating Guide is to provide you with the right language to use in order to organize your thinking and get the results you want when you need to write or speak more clearly.

This guide is based on the framework of the Smart Skills® 4 dimensions of high performance thinking – creativity, understanding, decision making and personal spirit, the 7 mindsets and the 21 strategies. Use this guide as your kit of precision tools to build skills in speaking and writing.

When you plan how to speak or write, start first with the task and the person in mind. What type of thinking is best suited to describe and accomplish the task?

- **To persuade and convince others** – go to Red
- **To describe and explain a situation**, procedure or plan – go to Yellow
- **To generate innovative ideas** – go to Green
- **To inspire others to action** – go to White

EASY AS 1, 2, 3

Use this simple 1,2,3 formula to plan out your approach.

- 1. Pick a colour** to match the nature of the task or person.
- 2. Select a mindset** to match the task or person – cool thinking for objective and factual writing, or warm emotions for developing empathy and commitments.
- 3. pick a strategy** to increase your success – select the most precise communication tool.



USE YELLOW WORDS TO DEVELOP UNDERSTANDING

COOL YELLOW: THINK ANALYTICALLY in Cool Yellow and use analytical thinking to develop understanding – gather information, organize it and ensure accuracy and clarity.

KEY COOL YELLOW ACTION WORDS: To shift focus to use Cool Yellow analytical thinking, use these verbs: *know, learn, gather, scan, describe, recall, show, learn, study, plan, slow down, explain, say, review, understand, map, research, examine, clarify, specify, outline, organize, structure, give examples, analyse.*

KEY COOL YELLOW STATEMENTS:

“Let’s review the information to understand...”

“Based on the information we have, we need further study to...”

“To make sense of it all, we need to organize a plan.”

KEY COOL YELLOW QUESTIONS:

“What do we know?”

“How would you organize and structure that?”

“Can you please clarify?”

WARM YELLOW: SHOW COMPASSION in Warm Yellow and use a focus on compassion for the other person’s feelings to develop understanding. Tune in to other people’s feelings and emotions, demonstrate genuine empathy and express feelings constructively.

KEY WARM YELLOW ACTION WORDS: To shift focus to use Warm Yellow compassion, use these verbs: *feel, tune in, share, slow down, sense, know, trust, hear, sympathize, love, nourish, encourage, support, help, experience, let go, release, dialogue, relax, facilitate, enable, laugh, connect, communicate, reach out, embrace, empathize, listen, learn, express, say.*

KEY WARM YELLOW STATEMENTS:

“I hear and support you.”

“I can’t imagine how you feel...”

“I feel...”

KEY WARM YELLOW QUESTIONS:

“How do you feel?”

“How would you express your feelings about it?”

“How can I help?”



USE RED WORDS TO MAKE SMARTER DECISIONS

The focus of getting to Red is converging thinking in order to decide to do something.

KEY RED ACTION WORDS: To move to Cool Red decision making, use these verbs: *should, must, compare, assess, differentiate, need, want, decide, act, criticize, evaluate, value, validate, determine, zero in, focus on, push to, conclude, demonstrate, prove, prioritize, judge.*

KEY RED STATEMENTS:

“The heart of the problem is...”

“Based on the information and the options available, we should...”

“It is time to push to a conclusion and decide.”

KEY RED QUESTIONS:

“What is the crux of the issue?”

“What would you recommend?”

“How would you prove that?”



USE WHITE WORDS TO INSPIRE PERSONAL SPIRIT

In White, focus on the positive and find ways to move forward and take initiative.

KEY WHITE ACTION WORDS: To shift focus on building Personal Spirit, use these verbs: *appreciate, inspire, enhance, engage, control, find a way, adapt, adjust, move forward, persevere, persist, bounce back, carry on, commit, recover, flex, continue, bounce back, rebound, initiate.*

KEY WHITE STATEMENTS:

“I appreciate...”

“I can do it.”

“I will...”

KEY QUESTIONS:

“Where is the positive opportunity?”

“What else can I do to keep moving forward?”

“What will take me above and beyond?”



USE GREEN WORDS TO GENERATE IDEAS, OPTIONS, SOLUTIONS AND INSIGHTS

In Green, focus on opening up, broadening your thinking and letting go of judging to explore possibilities and options – brainstorm ideas, challenge assumptions, reframe problems into opportunities and envision future possibilities.

KEY GREEN ACTION WORDS: To shift focus to apply Green creativity, use these verbs: *could, brainstorm, generate, innovate, reframe, challenge, expand, create, invent, suppose, add, combine, synthesize, make, produce, solve, add to, draw, construct, explore, ponder, wait, intuit, envision, contribute, inspire, pioneer.*

KEY GREEN STATEMENTS:

“Looking to the future, we could...”

“There are many possibilities.”

“It’s time to generate ideas, options and alternatives.”

KEY GREEN QUESTIONS:

“What if...?”

“What’s the hidden potential?”

“What could a solution look like?”



Need to Know: The 21 Strategies Your Precision Thinking Tools for Speaking and Writing

The 7 mindsets and Personal Spirit are each built on from one to four of 21 strategies in the system. These strategies give you a set of sharp, precise verbal tools for thinking, speaking and writing more effectively. This 21 strategies writing and speaking section highlights the precise action words to use to produce the results you want. It offers you a mini-library of the very specific words and phrases to use to ensure your communication is clear, concise and effective.

SPEAK AND WRITE TO DECIDE



COOL RED: CRITICAL THINKING TO PINPOINT ISSUES AND MAKE PRACTICAL DECISIONS

1. GET TO THE CRUX

- Action words – *focus, get to, pinpoint, uncover, zero in, determine, identify*
- Nouns – core, heart, essence, key, meat, root, nut, nub, bottom line, the one



2. COME TO A CONCLUSION

- Action words – *decide, determine, agree, wind up, finish, end*
- Nouns – decision, recommendation, result, choice, agreement, termination



3. VALIDATE CONCLUSIONS

- Action words – *prove, convince, challenge, demand, show me, demonstrate, verify, substantiate, confirm, sanction, affirm, back up*
- Nouns – proof, evidence, validation, confirmation, authenticity, verification



4. RELY ON EXPERIENCE

- Action words – *trust, count on, refer, depend, know*
- Nouns – experience, history, knowledge, support, evidence, past



WARM RED: MAKE DECISIONS BASED ON EMOTIONS AND GUT INTUITION

1. VALUES DRIVEN

- Action words – *decide, commit, act, believe*
- Nouns – right or wrong, decision, beliefs, values, feelings, commitments



2. TRUST YOUR HEART

- Action words – *know, feel, intuit*
- Nouns – right or wrong, deep knowledge, feelings, emotions, in the moment

SPEAK AND WRITE TO DEVELOP UNDERSTANDING THROUGH ANALYSIS AND COMPASSION



COOL YELLOW: SEEK KNOWLEDGE AND UNDERSTANDING THROUGH ANALYTICAL THINKING

1. SCAN THE SITUATION

- Action words – *research, gather, search, discover, seek out, look around, listen, notice, hunt for, learn, read, review*
- Nouns – information, data, facts, research, knowledge, situation, issues, forces and factors, strengths and weaknesses, opportunities and threats, trends, emerging issues, history, context



2. STRUCTURE INFORMATION

- Action words – *organize, categorize, line up, arrange, order, classify, sequence, lay out, systematize*
- Nouns – information, data, facts, research, knowledge, issues, forces and factors, strengths and weaknesses, opportunities and threats, trends, emerging issues, history, context



3. CLARIFY UNDERSTANDING

- Action words – *clear up, simplify, explain in detail, lay out, show, demonstrate, find out more, learn*
- Nouns – confusion, misunderstanding, details, information, data, facts, research, knowledge

WARM YELLOW: COMPASSION TO SEEK EMOTIONAL UNDERSTANDING AND EMPATHY FOR OTHERS



1. TUNE IN TO FEELINGS

- Action words – *sense, watch, listen, connect, notice, feel, tune-in, align, relate, search, learn, shift focus to, experience*
- Nouns – feelings, emotions, body language, tone of voice, facial expression, eyes, tension, pacing, energy, spirit, attitude, sensations



2. EMPATHIZE WITH OTHERS

- Action words – *feel, tell me more, be in their shoes, experience, be, reach out, touch, affirm, share, acknowledge and accept, I can't imagine how/what you...*
- Nouns – feelings, emotions, ideas, thoughts, intentions, concerns, energy, spirit, attitude



3. EXPRESS FEELINGS

- Action words – *say, show, demonstrate, reach out, touch, affirm, share, acknowledge and accept*
- Nouns – feelings, emotions, ideas, thoughts, intentions, concerns, energy, spirit, connections

SPEAK AND WRITE TO GENERATE IDEAS, OPTIONS, ALTERNATIVES AND INSIGHTS

COOL GREEN: CREATIVE THINKING TO GENERATE NEW IDEAS, OPTIONS, ALTERNATIVES AND INSIGHTS



1. BRAINSTORM IDEAS

- Action words – *brainstorm, generate, list, come up with, imagine*
- Nouns – ideas, options, alternatives, new ways, improvements, solutions, out of the box ideas, additions



2. CHALLENGE ASSUMPTIONS

- Action words – *question, confront, pose, dispute, dare, dispute*
- Nouns – rules, standards, beliefs, conditions, rules, givens, hypothesis, theory, practice, doctrine, dogma, principle, information, data, research, knowledge



3. REFRAKE PROBLEMS INTO OPPORTUNITIES

- Action words – *shift, rethink, perceive, view, change, re-describe, find, seek*
- Nouns – possibilities, differences, potential, alternatives, opportunities, silver lining, solutions



4. ENVISION POSSIBILITIES

- Action words – *imagine, map, draw, invent, conjure up, picture, dream, plan, visualize, make up, foresee, project*
- Nouns – scenarios, solutions, desired future, success, accomplishment, vision, possibilities, potentials, achievement, results

SPEAK AND WRITE TO BUILD MOTIVATION AND EMPOWER



WHITE: POWER UP PERSONAL SPIRIT

1. BUILD A POSITIVE OUTLOOK

- Action words – *appreciate, find, open up, love, like, embrace, smile, sense*
- Nouns – appreciation, gratitude, opportunity, opening, possibility, potential



2. INCREASE SENSE OF CONTROL

- Action words – *empower, can do, restrain, regulate, reach out*
- Nouns – action, scope



3. TAKE INITIATIVE

- Action words – *commit, act, decide, initiate, strive, reach, lead, start, drive, introduce, stand up*
- Nouns – risk, reach, initiative, cause, plan, action, solution

Lesson 1: Writing as an Essential Skill

INTRODUCTION

In this age of constant communication, everyone needs basic writing skills in order to make it in today's workplace. At some point, people have to be able to write simple texts, short reports, briefing notes, incident reports, emails and descriptive notes on what was said or what happened. Writing is a skill that employers and governments globally have identified as essential in the 21st century workplace.

In this lesson you will learn how to use simple colour-coded language to help you write better sentences and paragraphs. You will also learn how to write for different audiences. You will learn how to plan, write and revise your written message so that others can understand what you want to communicate. The most important thing you will do in this module is write, write and write. Like shooting hockey pucks at a net, or making a home-cooked meal, the only way to ever get better is to keep doing something over and over again. There are no shortcuts to writing. Like anything worth doing well, it is hard work.

As one person said: "There are only two rules to writing: (1) Butt in chair. (2) Words on page." It is amazing how much better you can get by continuously writing and revising your work to make it as simple and clear as possible for the person or people to whom you are writing.



Experience Exercise: Stories and TV Shows

Good thinking is behind all good writing. Good writing is behind the TV shows we like, the movies that move us and the stories in the books that we enjoy the most.

Think back to your favourite books, movies you loved, or TV shows that you found interesting. What is it about the writing that made them interesting, educational or entertaining for you?

What type of writing style works for you and makes you most interested? What type of writing style doesn't work for you?

NOTES:



Need to Know: Writing As An Essential Skill

Employers say they need workers who are able to write in order to communicate a clear, correct and complete message that is easily understood by others. To make this happen, the writing must be appropriate to the purpose, the audience and the situation, and contain proper spelling, grammar and punctuation.

Workplace writing may include a short entry in a form, an email to a supervisor, a note for a co-worker, the filling in of a template, instructions for others, or the preparation of an incident report. The writing may be formal or informal, detailed or quite brief.

Writing is a process. It involves planning and organizing, writing, revising and proofreading. Effective writing is well-thought out before the first word is even written, and the thinking doesn't stop after the first draft. Most writing experts suggest the following: 25% for planning/organizing, 25% for writing, 45% for revising and 5% for final proofreading.

The first step in planning and organizing is to analyse the writing task. This involves identifying the purpose and thinking about the requirements of the task (length, format, tone, writing alone or writing with others, casual note or formal document, etc.). Also important is anticipating who the audience is and what their needs are. Use all of this information to help you determine what you say and how you say it. Use it to adapt the tone, the format and the language used.

Once you've written something, read it over. Remember to read it from your audience's perspective – not your own. Ask yourself: Is what I have written logical and does it tell someone what they need to know? Does it fit the audience, the purpose and the situation? Is only relevant information included? Have I used the correct grammar, punctuation and spelling? Can this be made clearer?

Like any skill, writing improves with continued practice.

This module will help you to communicate your written message more effectively.



Experience Exercise

1. What are the situations or times when you require basic writing skills in order to perform or keep a job?

2. What situations have you been in where you wish your writing skills were better?

3. What type of writing would be most helpful for you to learn in order to get or keep the job you want?



Need to Know: The Colours of Good Writing

Once you have learned the SmartSkills language to speak and communicate more clearly with others, you can use the same language to improve and develop your writing skills. The value of SmartSkills is that it can help you plan and organize what you want to communicate, and then provide you with the necessary key words and phrases to help you get your message across when you want to write it down.

A simple and practical way to organize your writing is to use the colour-coded smart tracks. Use the colours to target your writing.

BE COOL WHEN YOU WRITE

Most writing is done in the three cool colours:



- **cool red** – get to the point! Only write short notes on what is essential and most important. Writing less is more in Cool Red. “We need to... We must... The evidence is clear that... We need to agree that...”



- **cool yellow** – write down all of the facts. Collect and record all of the data. List all of the analysis. Make charts and graphs. Write out all of the background information. In Cool Yellow, writing more is always better than writing less. “The facts are... The data shows... To clarify, the correct answer is...”



- **cool Green** – write down your new ideas. Write out the options you want people to think about. Draw and chart out the possibilities and alternatives that people can choose from. Be clear. Be imaginative. “What if... Options to consider are... The ideas from what others are doing are...”

CHOOSE WARM YELLOW AND WHITE WHEN FEELINGS ARE IMPORTANT



- **Warm yellow** – write notes to express and communicate your feelings in a caring manner. Most helpful when people are coping with a difficult situation or a happy occasion. “I am sad to hear... I hope you are feeling better... My heart goes out to you during this difficult...”



- **White** – write to express appreciation or gratitude. “Thank you very much for... I appreciate your...”

USE WARM RED AND WARM GREEN CAREFULLY IN THE WORKPLACE



- **Warm red** – write to express your own personal values and beliefs. Write down why you feel passionate about something. “I believe... I am committed to... It is vital that we...”



- **Warm Green** – not usually used in writing unless you are proposing a breakthrough type of idea or proposal.



Practice Skill: Writing One Sentence in Each Colour

Use the prompts below to write one to three sentences about a simple topic or event in each of the colours.

1. **cool Red** – get to the point!

2. **cool Yellow** – write down all of the facts.

3. **cool Green** – write down your new ideas.

4. **Warm Yellow** – write notes to express and communicate your feelings in a caring way.

5. **White** – write to express appreciation or gratitude.

6. **Warm Red** – write to express your own personal values and beliefs

7. **Warm Green** – not usually used in writing, except for breakthrough ideas and proposals.



Apply @ Work: Writing as Essential Skill

1. Identify specific situations or work tasks where it is essential that you have basic writing skills.

2. What are the consequences for being unable to write clearly and properly?



Need to Know: 8 Guidelines for Clear Writing

Here is a set of key points to help you write better:

1. **clear Purpose** – is the intent of the writing clear? Were you clear on what the speaker/writer wanted to communicate?
2. **clear and Simple Words** – are the words clear, simple, easy to understand and explain to others?
3. **Active, not passive Voice** – is the subject doing the action, or is action being done by the subject?
4. **language to Match purpose** – does the colour code of the language match the purpose?
5. **Short, Single point Sentences** – are the sentences short and make one key point?
6. **Sensible, logical Sequence** – is there a clear sequence with a beginning, middle and end to make it easy to understand and follow?
7. **constructive** – does the writing contribute to identifying what the problem/issue is, including what could be done versus blaming, attacking or avoiding responsibility?
8. **clear conclusion** – does the writing conclude with a clear message, a call to action, an 'ask', a recommendation or a request?



Practice Skill: Write Examples for Each of the 8 Guidelines

Review the list of key guidelines for good writing. Discuss each point to ensure clarity of understanding. Pick a topic and write out word choices, sample sentences and paragraphs for each one.

1. clear purpose

2. clear and simple words

3. Active, not passive voice

4. language to match purpose

5. Short, single point sentences

6. Sensible, logical sequence

7. constructive

8. clear conclusion



Practice Skill: 5 Uses of Your Writing

Discuss which of the 8 Guidelines from page 19 are most important for each of these uses of writing. Select key words and phrases for each use.

1. informing

2. Making a request

3. Persuading

4. inspiring

5. Recommending action



Smart How To's: Use the Coloured Building Blocks to Plan Your Writing

When writing any document, the structure is critical to your success. Once you have a simple set of structures to follow, you can organize your thoughts and words in ways that make sense for your reader and for you as well. These structures are the same as the Smart Tracks. They can be set up in a row, like a set of containers that each hold different types of ingredients. These ingredients can be organized and combined in different ways to get the results you want. Use these colour-coded core containers as your building blocks to organize your thinking.



1. THE YELLOW CONTAINER – usually the start and the middle, and sometimes the implementation plan at the end

- The situation description – the facts and feelings
- The data and analysis
- The context – forces, factors and relationships
- The plan and steps to follow



2. THE RED CONTAINER – for the beginning and the end

- the statement of the big why; the core and crux of the issue
- the problem or opportunity
- the conclusions – what to do
- the 'ask'
- the solutions and recommendations
- the proof and evidence
- past experiences and comparables
- the values



3. THE GREEN CONTAINER – usually in the middle

- Ideas and options
- Solutions and proposals
- Future possibilities and scenarios
- Breakthrough insights



4. THE WHITE CONTAINER – often frames the opening and closing

- An appreciation of the opportunity and the people
- Empowerment of the readers and users
- Bold initiatives
- Motivational spirit builders



Apply @ Work: Write a Two-Step Communication

Think of a topic to write about. Develop a two-step plan to communicate this subject.

1.

2.

Lesson 2: How to Prepare a Writing Plan

INTRODUCTION

One of the big challenges when writing anything, including this workbook, is to work out a plan or structure for what you want to achieve. Think of a plan as your map to follow to get you where you want to go while wasting as little energy as possible. There are many guidelines on how to map out, plan and organize your writing. It takes some Green creativity to think up the plan and to re-organize it in new ways to make it work better, just like we did with this workbook. The Yellow needed is in finalizing a simple and clearly structured plan. The Red keeps you relevant and practical, helping you remove the excess information and other “nice to have’s” in the text.

This lesson provides you with several different approaches to planning your writing. It also will help you learn how to write for a particular audience or person in order to capture their attention and respect.



Experience Exercise

Reflect on what works best for you and how you like to receive written information in these different situations:

- Someone is trying to explain what they want you to do – sign up, commit, take action
- You are new to a challenge, task or situation and know very little

Discuss the best and worst of writing from your experience.

NOTES:



Smart How To's: Use the Smart Tracks to Plan Your Writing

The Smart Tracks help you plan your writing by setting up a sequence to follow. Here are a set of five different sequences to use to plan your writing:

1. **YELLOW TO YELLOW.** To inform and clarify is to stay in Yellow
2. **RED TO YELLOW TO GREEN TO RED.** To persuade and convince others, focus on Red at the outset and use Yellow information and Green options to arrive back in Red to make recommended conclusions
3. **YELLOW TO RED.** To make a request, rely on Yellow to describe the situation in as much detail as necessary, and shift to Red in order to zero in on why it's important and to frame your request
4. **YELLOW TO RED/YELLOW.** Teach and instruct. Start in Yellow and lay out your sequence from there. Provide corrective or evaluative feedback in Red or Yellow
5. **WHITE TO GREEN TO RED.** To inspire, use White and Green to focus on future success. Then end in Red with a call to action



Practice Skill: Develop a Simple Writing Plan

Think of how you would lay out a simple three-step sequence to get a point across or to convince someone to act. Keep it simple. This is similar to applying the Smart Tracks from problem solving to planning out your writing plan. What is a sequence you could use? What is a different sequence? Discuss why you chose each step in your sequence and how one container or step leads to another.



Need to Know: The W5 and Smart Tracks

There are many ways to organize a writing plan. Here are three primary ways: the W5 Plan; the Smart Tracks – Two-, Three- and Five-Step and Customized; and the Mind Map.

1. THE W5 PLAN: START WITH WHAT AND WHY, OR START WITH WHO

One of the best ways to organize your writing is to use a consistent framework to put your thoughts into a logical order. The W5 method is an excellent, easy-to-use and repeatable model that works well.

1. **WHAT** – what is the situation. This is a short clear description of the situation, identifying several key points – Yellow scanning and clarifying
2. **WHY** – the big why or the crux of the issue. This is the core reason for the writing, the one thing that needs attention and action
3. **WHO** – the person or group you are sending this to
4. **WHERE** – where is this a problem? Where does it ‘sit’? Describe the location of the issue and the context it is placed in
5. **HOW** – the method or solution you propose for how to deal with the issue
6. **WHEN** – the timeline you propose a decision is needed or when other key events are happening that could impact on the situation

There is a variation in this process when it is the person who is the key factor in the writing and presentation. Here is a variation of the W5 method that focuses on the person who will make the decision or is in a position of authority.

1. **WHO** – the person or group you are sending this to. If you have a sense of their thinking style, you can adapt your writing to fit how they like to receive information
2. **WHAT** – a short, clear description of the situation, identifying several key points – Yellow scanning and clarifying
3. **WHY** – the crux of the issue, the one thing that needs attention and action
4. **WHERE** – the location of the issue and the context it is placed in
5. **HOW** – the method or solution you propose for how to deal with the issue
6. **WHEN** – the timeline you propose a decision is needed or when other key events are happening that could impact on the situation

2. THE TWO-STEP SMART TRACK – SITUATION + PROPOSED ACTION

One of This simple two-step Smart Track covers two phases and is best suited for a simple problem that does not need a lot of effort to figure out. This two-step method is a straightforward approach and can be covered in one or two paragraph sentences for each step.



1. **YELLOW** – the situation



2. **RED** – what to do about it – the conclusion and proposed action. The more complicated or complex the issue, the less likely this short approach fits.

3. THE THREE-STEP SMART TRACK – OPENING, MIDDLE, CLOSING

This three-step method is easy to use and follows a simple three-step structured process. It is a popular approach. If you use the colour-coded language, it can be even more effective with more precise language in each phase.



1. **OPENING** – this is typically the statement of the problem and poses a question or issue to be addressed. It usually combines a Yellow descriptive statement in a sentence, followed by a Red crux of the issue statement in the second sentence



2. **MIDDLE** – this is the body of the writing. It focuses on the Yellow information, often summarizing events and the information collected



3. **CLOSING** – this is the Red conclusion, the call to action, the ‘ask’ or the recommendation. It is where your writing converges on what you want or need, or what you think needs to be done to deal with the situation

4. THE FIVE-STEP SMART TRACK – CRUX TO CONCLUSION

Smart Tracks are colour-coded thinking plans that help you organize your thinking in ways that make it easy to follow, both for you the writer and for the person you are writing for. The Smart Track is another consistent framework to use when writing to make a request, to persuade, to convince, or to propose a solution. It assumes you know to whom you are writing.



1. **YELLOW** – Describe the situation in one sentence or paragraph. Keep all extra background information in a separate document or file



2. **RED** – Pinpoint the crux of the issue – the big why that needs to be decided or resolved, and the three criteria to use to select a solution.



3. **GREEN** – Identify the three best-bet types of options to address the issue



4. **RED** – Propose your solution and how it meets the criteria



5. **YELLOW** – Outline a proposed schedule and steps for dealing with the issue

5. CUSTOMIZED SMART TRACKS

When the writing you have to do is more complex, it can be helpful to lay out your own track. This can be a multi-step process. Remember:

5 RED 3 STEPS n issues, big whys, conclusions, proof, experience from other comparables, the values

5 YELLOW 3 STEPS n situation, background data, method to follow, facts, figures, feelings

5 GREEN 3 STEPS n options, opportunities, insights, ideas, proposals

5 WHITE 3 STEPS n appreciations, personal actions, initiatives

This type of track is best suited for when the issues and challenges are difficult to deal with and simple processes just won't cut it.

6. THE MIND MAP

The mind map is particularly useful for more complicated tasks. The mind mapping technique described above is an excellent planning tool, particularly when there are many competing issues and a lot of stuff to think through and figure out. You can use the mind map as the outcome – producing a visual map. You can also use the mind map as a means to an end. This means using it like a sketchpad to get all of your thoughts and all of the key information out there first. Next, you can use the map as the starting point to build out your written plan with a W5, or a Three-Step or Five-Step Smart Track.



Practice Skill: Use the Smart Track Planners

This is an opportunity to become familiar with the different approaches to planning your writing, and experiment with one or two methods that work well for you. In the practice session, you will develop different writing plans using the different methods.

You have been asked by your supervisor to write out a plan for the purchase of a new refrigeration unit for your company. Prepare a writing plan to describe the steps you will follow in making the right purchase for the company. Do not solve the problem. Write out the steps to arrive at a recommendation for the purchase.

Step 1. Use the Five-Step Smart Track to outline your purchase plan. Use the Smart Track Worksheet to write out the tasks for each of the phases. Submit your plan for analysis by two other learners.

Step 2. Each person works with a learning partner to analyse the structure and clarity of the plans they review.

Step 3. Evaluate based on the criteria in The Smart Writing and Communication Guide of this document.

Step 4. Debrief on tips and techniques for developing solid writing plans.

NOTES:



Practice Skill: Use Smart Track #5

You have been asked by your supervisor to write out a plan to recommend how to (pick one or make up another task): make the workplace safer/purchase a new piece of equipment/upgrade the communications system/plan the summer company picnic/recruit students for summer employment/develop an employee orientation program, etc. Prepare a writing plan to describe the steps you will follow to build the plan. Do not solve the problem. Write out the steps to arrive at a recommendation.

Step 1. Use the Five-Step Smart Track to outline your plan. Use the Smart Track Worksheet to write out the tasks for each of the phases. Submit your plan for analysis by two other learners.

Step 2. Each person works with a learning partner to analyse the structure and clarity of the plans they review.

Step 3. Evaluate based on the criteria in The Smart Writing and Communication Guide of this document.

Step 4. Debrief on tips and techniques for developing solid writing plans.



Need to Know: Mind Mapping

Using a mind map is an effective way to organize your thinking on a topic. A mind map is most helpful when you have to put different information, thoughts and ideas together in order to communicate clearly. It will help you to organize your writing, and also increase your ability to inform and persuade. A mind map frees you from having to make a linear list and sequence before it is a useful thing to do. A mind map is like a visual picture of the core issue in the centre, with the themes and related points radiating out from the centre. Mind mapping is a highly effective way of getting information in and out of your brain. It helps you to literally map out all of your ideas and link them through the central focus in the middle. Mind mapping combines both creative and structured ways of note taking that maps out your ideas, or the information you are listening to or reviewing.

Here is some information on mind mapping from mind www.mindmapping.com.

All mind maps have some things in common. They have a natural organizational structure that radiates from the center and uses lines, symbols, words, colour and images according to simple, brain-friendly concepts. Mind mapping converts a long list of monotonous information into a colourful, memorable and highly organized diagram that works in line with your brain's natural way of doing things.



One simple way to understand a mind map is by comparing it to a map of a city. The city center represents the main idea; the main roads leading from the center represent the key thoughts in your thinking process; the secondary roads or branches represent your secondary thoughts, and so on. Special images or shapes can represent landmarks of interest or particularly relevant ideas.

A mind map is the external mirror of your own radiant or natural thinking. It gives you the freedom to use a



Smart How To's: The Five Essentials of a Mind Map

These are the core essentials for making a mind map:

1. The main idea, subject or focus is like the crux or solution in a central image.
2. The main themes radiate from the central image as 'branches'.
3. The branches focus on one key image or key word drawn or printed on its associated line.
4. Topics of lesser importance are represented as 'twigs' of the relevant branch.
5. The branches together form a connected structure.



Practice Skill: Use the Mind Map Planner

You have been asked by your supervisor to write out a plan to recommend how to (pick one or make up another task) make the workplace safer/plan the summer company picnic/recruit students for summer employment/develop an employee training program, etc. Use the mind map technique to prepare your writing plan, and describe the steps you will follow to build the plan. Do not solve the problem. Instead, write out the steps to arrive at a recommendation for the plan.

Step 1. Use the Five-Step Smart Track to outline your plan. Use the Smart Track Worksheet to write out the tasks for each of the phases. Submit your plan for analysis by two other learners.

Step 2. Each person works with a learning partner to analyse the structure and clarity of the plans they review.

Step 3. Evaluate based on the criteria in The Smart Writing and Communication Guide of this document.

Step 4. Debrief on tips and techniques for developing solid writing plans.

NOTES:



Smart How To's: Six More Smart Writing Guidelines

Here are six more tips and techniques on writing longer pieces effectively:

1. **Write with the reader in mind** – always write from the reader's point of view. Put yourself in his or her shoes and write to make it clear and accessible for the other person
2. **State what you want** – be clear on what your 'ask' is so that the reader can respond accordingly
3. **Be constructive** – focus on solutions and what can be done, even in dire circumstances. Avoid blaming others and finger pointing
4. **pose a question to engage the reader at the outset** – turn the problem or issue into a question. "What if... Imagine if... Should the X be... or not? How can we assist the people who are most affected by the ...?"
5. **Be clear** – avoid long sentences, repetition and unnecessary words
6. **Be diplomatic, respectful and engaging** – you don't want to be blunt or dismissive

NOTES:



Practice Skill: Apply the Guideline to Plan What to Say and Do

1. Write with the reader in mind – think of someone you want to write for and get a sense of the colours of his/her mind.

2. State what you want – be clear on what your ‘ask’ is.

3. Be constructive – focus on solutions and what can be done. What words will work best here?

4. pose a question to engage the reader at the outset. Turn the problem or issue into a question. “What if... Imagine if... Should the X be... or not? How can we assist the people who are most affected by the ...?”

5. Be clear – avoid long sentences, repetition and unnecessary words.

6. Be diplomatic, respectful and engaging – you don’t want to be blunt or dismissive. What words will work best here?



Apply @ Work: Make Writing Plans

Topics to choose from include:

- Plan an e-mail to a supervisor on a recommendation for change and improvement
- Develop a writing plan to produce a brochure
- Develop a writing plan for a 3 minute written presentation to a company on why they should hire you
- Develop a writing plan to advise others in how to search for and find employment in another city

In this final phase of this lesson, the task is to create 2 writing plans – using the Three-Step or Five-Step Smart Track, the W5 or the Mind Map. The outcome is a set of two plans that meet the writing criteria of:

1. clear purpose – is the intent of the writing clear?

2. clear and simple words – are the words clear, simple, easy to understand.

3. Active not passive voice – is the subject doing the action.

4. Purpose – does the color code of the language match the purpose?

5. Short, single point sentences.

6. Sensible, logical sequence – is there a clear sequence – beginning, middle, end.

7. constructive – does the writing contribute to identifying what the problem/issue is and what could be done.

8. clear conclusion – does the writing conclude with a clear message, a call to action, an ask, a recommendation or request?

Lesson 3: How to Write to Record, Report, Request and Persuade

INTRODUCTION

In today's workplace, smart employers recognize that a big part of their competitive advantage is their people, especially in the knowledge, experience and ingenuity that employees bring every day into the office, warehouse, factory, etc. In smart organizations, people are expected to think for themselves, and to be able to write and communicate in order to inform, make requests, provide explanations, persuade others and make convincing arguments.

In this lesson, the focus is on three different writing purposes:

1. To inform and share clear information to produce understanding – a focus on Yellow
2. To request information or a response – a focus on producing either:
 - enough Yellow background information and a request for further information or clarification on a topic; or
 - Yellow background information and a Red argument consisting of the crux of the issue, the conclusions you have come to, and the validation or proof, including comparisons and evidence for the best course of action.
3. To persuade and recommend – a focus on developing a logical argument for a better approach, a new way to reduce waste or costs. etc. This requires the use of Red critical thinking to construct a 'business case' for why your recommendation is superior to current practice, and the White initiative to bring it forward



Experience Exercise: Analyze, Assess and Improve

In this exercise you will be given a news story that reports on a current event. Read it over. Then, as a group, make notes on a large piece of paper to answer the following:

1. Specify the writer's overall intention – what does the writer want to communicate? Is it Yellow/inform, Red/evaluate or Green/generate?

2. identify the colour of the language that was used – select specific words to identify Yellow, Red or Green language

3. Assess the effectiveness of the writing – identify what works well and what does not

4. recommend improvements to the writing

5. Prepare two requests to the writer for more information

Debrief in the full group. Explore the keys to both good effective writing and ineffective writing for job success.

NOTES:



Need to Know: How to Write to Inform, Request a Response or Persuade and Convince

The key to good writing is to have a set of effective writing tools. Words are the most important tools you have. To get your message across it is vital to pick the words you use with great care. Be mindful of what you choose to use. Reduce confusion and misunderstanding by selecting the right words that fit the audience and the task. The Smart Writing and Communicating Guide contains a complete color coding of the different types of words to use when you need to communicate a message to inform, report, list information or persuade others.

WRITE TO INFORM

When your goal is to inform others and tell them about something, make sure that the words you choose match the need to inform. Here are some key criteria you can use to ensure that your writing is informative:

1. Be clear and descriptive – does your writing clearly describe the situation
2. Show relevance – does it only focus on need to know information vs. nice to know
3. Be accurate – are all of the facts correct and precise and verified?
4. Be timely and appropriate - to the task or person – does your writing contain timelines that match the level of importance or urgency for a response?

WRITE TO REQUEST INFORMATION OR A RESPONSE

When your objective is to request more information or to ask for a response, you need to construct a way of writing to get the results you want. Here are some guidelines:

1. Describe the needed information or response
2. Point out the crux of the problem
3. Propose a conclusion or recommendation
4. Validate the conclusion you have come to – use comparisons and descriptions of the benefits
5. Make your 'ask' or specify the type of response you want

WRITE TO PERSUADE, CONVINCE AND RECOMMEND A SOLUTION

When your objective is to propose a new solution or innovative approach (to save money, reduce waste, increase safety, etc.), you are taking initiative. Expect to encounter resistance. Make sure that your recommendation delivers a superior result to what is currently in practice. You need to construct a way of writing in order to get the results you want. Here are some guidelines:

1. Describe the current situation – Yellow background
2. Identify the crux of the problem – Cool Red
3. Describe the opportunity for improvement -what could be better, different, faster, simpler, easier – Green envision and Yellow clarify
4. Propose your recommended solution – Red conclusion
5. Validate the new solution – use Red proof, evidence, benefits, comparisons
6. Make your 'ask' or specify the type of response you want or process you propose to check out the recommendation – focus on one clear Red conclusion



Practice Skill: Write to Inform and More

The goal of this practice is to start writing and begin to improve your skills. The focus is on how to write simple, clear and accurate messages – a clear yellow activity. It avoids Red words of judgment and Green options. It is all about the facts – just the facts.

This exercise can be repeated over and over again with different objects, just like practicing a shot in hockey or basketball. Repetition builds skill. Feedback builds skill.

Here are some simple ways to start.

1. Select a writing format:

- a list of five to seven points – in bullet point form
- a paragraph or set of descriptive sentences

2. Select a topic to write about. Here are some options to choose from:

- a random article from the table, your pockets or purse, or from anywhere in the room

3. complete a short writing plan– your intention, key points, sequence, closing

4. Write about it to inform others - complete the first draft

5. Share and compare with others to get constructive feedback – with one, two or three group members – use criteria to assess

6. revise and produce a second draft based on the feedback

7. Share and compare

8. revise and produce a third draft

9. de-brief the exercise

This type of workout exercise can and should be done quickly, starting with producing one sentence and simple point form productions. Expand to one paragraph, and then two-paragraph productions later. The goal is to increase accurate listening and to just start writing.



Practice Skill: Expand the Experience

Select another simple object and practice four outcome- based writing approaches with the same object:

1. INFORM – describe the five key physical facts of the object in order to explain what it is and what it does.

- in point form
- in a paragraph
- in an e-mail
- in a product brochure

2. REQUEST INFORMATION – prepare an evidence-based argument for why this object is useful and persuade others with three reasons why it should be or should not be selected

- in point form
- in a paragraph
- in an e-mail
- in an ad

3. PERSUADE AND CONVINCE – prepare a simple argument why this product, item, etc..., is superior and should be selected

4. RECOMMEND SOLUTIONS – propose three or four or alternative uses for the object.



Practice Skill: Pick the Words to Write to Achieve Your Objective

Select key words from the Smart Writing and Communicating Guide and write the following on topics selected by you, a member of your group or the course leader.

1. WRITE TO INFORM – pick key verbs and nouns

2. WRITE TO PROPOSE IDEAS AND OPTIONS – pick key verbs and nouns

3. WRITE TO PERSUADE AND CONVINCE – pick key verbs and nouns

4. E-MAIL TO INFORM – write an e-mail to describe and inform

5. E-MAIL TO CLARIFY – write an e-mail with questions requiring clarification

6. E-MAIL TO PERSUADE – write an e-mail to persuade and convince

7. ONE SHORT PARAGRAPH – write one paragraph to report and inform

8. ONE SHORT PARAGRAPH – write one paragraph to persuade and convince

9. ONE SHORT PARAGRAPH – write one paragraph to instruct



Practice Skill: Adapt Your Writing to Fit the Need and Goal

Use these activities to build skills in listening, observing and recording relevant information and then in writing to achieve specific goals.

1. WRITE TO RECORD: Use three to five questions to interview a learning partner about their favorite TV show, sport or meal. Use the information to write a point form description of the conversation.

2. WRITE TO INFORM Listen to a fact based story or read a fact-based article.

List five key facts to explain the story or topic.

- in point form
- in a paragraph
- in an e-mail
- in a note to a friend

3. WRITE TO PERSUADE – prepare an evidence-based argument for why the previous story/information is useful, and then persuade others with three reasons for why it should be or should not be selected for others to listen to.

- in point form
- in a paragraph
- in an e-mail

4. WRITE TO RECOMMEND – propose three or more or alternative uses of the information in the previous story/article.



Practice Skill: Refine Your Skills

1. Write short, clear, simple messages using two or more of these forms to a supervisor about an event they need to know about.

- a Twitter message @ 140 letters or less
- a point form note
- a few sentences in a logbook
- a three to five sentence paragraph
- short email

2. Match your language with the writing task. Use the Smart Skills language and phrases to colour-code what you have written as Yellow, Red, Green or White.

3. review what you have written with a partner. Look at the style used for the audience and the thinking behind how it was written.

4. Give feedback:

- **clarity** – how clear is the writing
- **brevity** – is it brief and does it only include essential information
- **sequence** – is there a beginning, middle and end
- **logic** – does it make sense
- **simplicity** – is it easy to understand

5. revise your writing. Think about the feedback and what you can do to make what you have written even better.



Need to Know: Take Accurate Notes and Record What Was Said

One good way to get ahead in the world is to build your skills in listening and note taking/recording information. This is a valuable skill in the workplace, as well as in life. The focus is on shifting into and staying in Yellow thinking and writing – to accurately record and write what was said so that it can communicate the right message to others.

The three skills of analytical thinking for writing to record are:

-  • **Scan** – take in as much information as possible, without judging any of it
-  • **Structure** – record the information and organize it into categories
-  • **clarify** – ask questions to make sure that you are writing down the information or message accurately

In order to be a good recorder, it is essential that you shift your focus outside of yourself. Recording is not about you. It is about helping the others involved. Listen carefully to exactly what is being said. All of your questions should be about clarifying precisely what was meant and what was said. You don't need to write everything down.

You do need to listen carefully to capture all of the key points. A memory map can be helpful. A good pen and lined paper can make it easier. Recording on your smart phone is an excellent way to ensure that you can back up or check what you wrote to make sure it matches what was said and the meaning in the message. Taking accurate notes is an important skill. It is not easy work to do for many people, but you will get better with practice.



Practice Skill: Writing Drills for Recording

1. Pick one page from a book and highlight the most important points in the page. Select the five most important points and record them in a point form list. Share and compare with others. Make a second list that captures the five most important points that the small group selected.
2. Watch a TV news clip for exactly 60 seconds. Make a point form list of the key points covered in the clip. Repeat. Build skills by watching 90-second and two-minute clips. Compare notes. Review the clips again and produce another point form summary.
3. Prepare an email on the key points covered in the TV clip. Listen to the three-minute, eight-second presentation by Australian Lieutenant General David Morrison on YouTube. Produce one or more of the following to inform others of his message:
 - a point form note to summarize his key points
 - a memo to high school students to persuade them to act with respect for others
 - a short explanatory email to persuade a leader in your company or group to watch this video and consider showing it to people in the organization
 - a one-page document with introduction, key points and a conclusion or call to action
4. Listen to a three-minute conversation between two members of your group on the topic. Take notes on the discussion and prepare one of the following:
 - a point form summary of the points raised
 - a mind map of the points raised
 - a group critique of each document
 - a revised document to improve its clarity and simplicity
5. Listen to a talk show or panel discussion. Write out:
 - a point form note to summarize one person's key points
 - a short explanatory email to persuade a leader in your company or group to watch this video and consider showing it to people in the organization
 - a one-page document with introduction, key points and a conclusion or call to action



Practice Skill: Choosing the Right Words to Record Notes

One of the best ways to take accurate notes is to review the list of action words in the Yellow sections of the Smarter Writing and Communicating Guide. These words are non-judgmental and give you the tools you need to record more clearly and accurately. Review the Yellow sections and pick out five to seven action words that will become part of your tool kit.

Record those words here:

This image shows a blank sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Discuss why the specific words you chose are useful in doing this type of Yellow-focused activity in a work setting, or in a situation where knowing and recording what actually happened is both useful and essential.

Lesson 4: Writing Skills Workouts for Different Audiences and Tasks

INTRODUCTION

When you write, sometimes you know exactly to whom you are writing. If you know how they think and what they need, then you can adapt your writing to get your message across in the way that they like to receive their information. This means you can target your writing to meet the specific requirements of that person. If the person is in a senior position, you need to approach the writing differently than if they are a friend or on the same level professionally.

This lesson provides some tips on how to write to different people. It also has a number of writing skill-building exercises to play with, sharpen your writing skills, and use to build your confidence as a person who can write well enough to succeed.



Experience Exercise

1. Think of when you have to read something from a government agency or company.

Talk to each other and reflect on:

- What works best in the writing?
- What do you find difficult to understand?
- Why do you find it difficult?
- What you would like to recommend to the people who prepare this type of document?

2. Think of when you have to write something to make a request to a government agency or a company.

Talk to each other and reflect on:

- What do you find easy about doing this type of writing?
- What do you find difficult?
- What you would like to know more about to help you do this type of writing?



Need to Know: Write to How Your Audience Thinks

To produce the desired outcomes, focus tightly on the needs of the person you are writing and communicating to. If you know the person you are writing to, then you can use the Smart Writing and Communicating Guide to select the best words to frame and shape the message to fit the way they like to think. If you know the nature of the task or situation, you can also customize your writing and shift how you like to communicate, and also select the words and elements that meet the task requirements.

Here are some simple guidelines for selecting the right tone and language to meet the needs of your audience when you write. Use the colour coding to write the outcomes, and prepare the style of writing to appeal to the needs of your audience.



s ,/')# ! , 4 () . + % 2 3 Critical thinking/Cool Red outcomes. These are the types of words that make an impact and are effective in communicating with logical thinkers: identify why, determine, conclude, decide, prove, convince, demonstrate, persuade, show experience and evidence, complete, produce, achieve, succeed. Focus on benefits, outcomes, actions and deliverables



s 0 ! 3 3) / . ! 4 % ! . \$ 6 ! , 5 % 3 \$ 2) 6 %. Values driven/Warm Red outcomes. These are the types of words that make an impact and are effective in communicating with people who have strong values and beliefs: want, commit, fight, fight for, advocate, convince, inspire. Focus on winning for our side versus the other side. Focus on the deeper issues of meaning and values – family, environment, faith, justice, righteousness, fairness.



s . % % \$ 4 / + . / 7) . & / 2 - ! 4) /. Analytical/Cool Yellow outcomes. These are the types of words that make an impact and are effective in communicating with people who are analytical and enjoy data: list, scan and gather, map out, graph, organize, categorize, clarify, specify. Focus on presenting complete, detailed information to satisfy the need for more data, clarity, accuracy and knowledge



s 2 % , ! 4) / . 3 () 0 3 ! . \$ % - / 4) / . 3 Compassionate relationship/Warm Yellow outcomes. These are the types of words that make an impact and are effective in communicating with people who are sensitive to feelings and emotions in themselves and others: connect, tune in, reach out, feel, attend, empathize, listen, connect, communicate, relationships. Focus less on action. Focus more on building rapport and understanding.



s \$ 2) 6 % & / 2 . % 7 ! . \$ \$) & & % 2 % . 4 Creative/Green outcomes. These are the types of words that make an impact and are effective in communicating with people who are creative, innovative and like what is new: generate, reframe, challenge, envision possibilities. Focus on new alternatives, fresh ideas, the future, possibilities and opportunities ahead.



s % - 0 / 7 % 2 - % . 4 ! . \$ - / 4) 6 ! 4) /. Personal Spirit and outlook, sense of control and initiative/White outcomes. These are the types of words that make an impact and are effective in communicating with highly motivated people: inspire, appreciate, act, engage, involve, initiate. Focus on building people's positive beliefs in appreciating what they have, empowering themselves to make a



Need to Know: Write to How Your Audience Thinks

difference and take the initiative.



Practice Skill: Do's and Don'ts in Writing for Impact

Identify three key do's and don'ts to meet the needs of each audience

	DO'S	DON'TS
 LOGICAL THINKERS		
 PASSIONATE AND VALUES DRIVEN		
 NEED TO KNOW INFORMATION		
 RELATIONSHIPS AND EMOTIONS		
 DRIVE FOR NEW AND DIFFERENT		
 EMPOWERMENT AND MOTIVATION		



Need to Know: The Background and Context of the Issue and the Audience

Think of the person you are writing to as your ‘target audience’. Use this simple set of guidelines to determine what the realities are for the task, issue or project you are writing about, who the audience is, and how you need to write.

S, %6%, /& 4(% 0%23/. – lower, same level, one level above, senior level. The higher above you they are, the sharper and clearer your writing must be, and the more formal approach you need to take.

S &/2-!,)49 – low, medium, high. This refers to following procedures. Some organizations or jobs require you to follow strict procedures and protocols in all written communication, while others are less rigid. Make sure that your writing follows the organization’s culture and administrative guidelines.

s 3').)&#!.#% /& 4(% 4/0)# - low medium, high. Some issues are more significant to an organization and to the audience than others. Match the quality and precision of your writing with the significance of the task. Do not go overboard on a small issue. Do not underestimate the importance of treating a big issue with careful consideration.

s).4%.3)49 /& 4(%)335% – low, medium, high. The higher the emotions are on a topic or issue, the cooler and more objective your writing needs to be. The lower the emotions, the more informal you can be.



Practice Skill: Writing to the Person and Situation

Write down some simple do's and don'ts for each of these four key aspects

1. LEVEL OF THE PERSON

- High
- Medium
- Low

2. FORMALITY

- High
- Medium
- Low

3. SIGNIFICANCE OF THE TOPIC

- High
- Medium
- Low

4. INTENSITY OF THE ISSUE

- High
- Medium
- Low



Practice Skill: Write to Different Audiences

Here are some simple practices that will help to expand your skills when writing to a specific person. Use these as simple writing drills.

1. A supervisor has asked you to prepare a plan to make a recommendation to senior management on improving safety in the shop. Use Red critical thinking and the Five-Step Smart Track to come to conclusions, prove a point and convince others.
2. A former co-worker has been laid off and is not sure what to do. Use a Three-Step Smart Track to advise them on how to look for a new job.
3. A relative in another town wants to buy a new appliance. Use Cool Yellow thinking to explain, present, analyse and organize a plan on how to make the best purchase.
4. A close friend has had a death in their family. Use the Three-Step Smart Track to express your Warm Yellow compassion and Warm Red values in writing in order to connect with how they are feeling.
5. Construct a message to a political or organizational leader on a topic that is important to you. Follow the Three-Draft approach of three rounds of draft writing – plan, write + share and get feedback, revise + share and get feedback, write + get feedback – and then debrief.
 - Select a topic to write about and a format to produce – point form, email, paragraph, etc.
 - Complete the writing plan – no matter how brief – intention, key points, sequence, closing
 - Complete the first draft
 - Share and compare with others to get constructive feedback – one, two, three, group.
 - Use criteria to assess
 - Revise and produce a second draft based on the feedback
 - Share and compare
 - Revise and produce a third draft
 - Debrief the exercise



Practice Skill: Pump Up Workouts

Here are some writing practices. Pick out different topics for each exercise.

- 1. Write down simple messages to inform people of what has happened** – what broke and the impact, a report on the daily tasks, etc. Simply record the relevant, essential information in a clear way.
- 2. Write down a set of requirements for a daily task** – how to use a microwave to cook something; how to order a product online; how to shop for five household supplies at your local store; how to start up and log in to your computer; how to change a diaper, etc. Think through the task from start to finish, and explain the steps in point form or in a detailed list.
- 3. Share a skill** – think of something you know how to do well such as chop wood, cook, play a sport, sing, fix the plumbing, repair a motor, take care of a sick child, make people feel comfortable, etc. Imagine having to communicate what to do in writing to someone who knows nothing about the topic. What would you put into that step-by-step process on how to do it? Your challenge is to prepare point form instructions for another person on how to carry out this task. Put yourself in their shoes.
- 4. Think like a reporter.** Read and review different pieces of writing and assess what the writer or presenter is doing – key points and the types of language used to convey the message. You can read/review the following:
 - newspaper article – local paper
 - cooking article or sport article
 - blog
 - magazine page, ad or article
 - video clip from TV
 - presentation by a learner or facilitator
 - story told by a learner, guest or facilitator
- 5. Write a simple description of the object or event.** Write three drafts to complete the task, and follow this format:
 - complete a short writing plan – your goal intention, key points, sequence
 - select key yellow action words from the Smarter Writing and Communicating Guide
 - complete the first draft
 - share and compare with others to get constructive feedback – work with two others
 - revise and produce a second draft
 - share and compare
 - revise and produce a third draft
 - debrief the exercise

Repeat the exercise with a different writing task. Expand your skills by choosing different subjects.



Practice Skill: Build More Writing Muscles

Pick a product that you know and like. Use these writing exercises to expand your writing skills.

Step 1: – Write a simple message to inform others in your community of the most relevant and timely information about this product. Select the type of information that will be most useful to them.

Step 2: – Write a letter to the makers of the product to request information on what other products they make, and where they can be purchased.

Step 3: – Write a message to persuade and convince others of the value and benefits of this product.

Step 2: Write a recommendation – write a recommendation to the makers of this product on how they can improve it to better meet your needs and the needs of others.

Step 3: Write a commercial – write a 30-second to one-minute commercial to convince others to purchase the product.

Step 4: Write a list of FAQs – write up a list of FAQs (Frequently Asked Questions) about this product. Write up the answers to each of these questions in point form



Practice Skill: Produce an Employment Pitch on Each Person

Work in groups of three. Each group is responsible for producing three one-page documents – one for each member of the group - that informs an employer about the member and persuades the employer to offer the member a job interview. The documents will contain the key points on the background, experience, skills, interests and work goals of the member. Use the key words from the The Smart Writing and Communication Guide to get your message across in writing.

[illegible]



This image shows a blank sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.



Practice Skill: Writing and Interview Skills

Working in threes, plan and write a job interview script. Then take turns using the script to interview each other.

Step 1. develop a list of key questions to ask in an interview, and write each question onto a card.

Step 2. organize the questions into a logical sequence with a beginning, middle and end.

Step 3. Using the questions, write the interview script.

Step 4. conduct interviews with one person acting as the recorder, another person asking the interview questions, and the third person responding to the questions.

Step 5. Rotate roles until all three members have been interviewed and have had the opportunity to record notes.



Apply @ Work: Pitch to the Supervisor

1. PITCH TO RED: You have a supervisor who likes to work in Red. Write a message to the supervisor to request a new piece of equipment.

2. PITCH TO YELLOW: You have a supervisor who likes to work in Yellow. Write a message to the supervisor to request a new piece of equipment.

2. PITCH TO GREEN: You have a supervisor who likes to work in Green. Write a message to the supervisor to request a new piece of equipment.



Apply @ Work: Write to Promote the Success @ Work Program

Here are a series of writing assignments that will help to improve your writing skills at work. Each of these is designed for a practical application. The first one is to practice writing about this program.

S).&/2- – write a simple message to inform others in your community about the most relevant and timely information regarding this program. Select the type of information that will be most useful to them

S 2%15%34).&/2-!4)/. – write a letter to the organizers of the program to request information on how others can join, and what information they need in order to sign up

S 0%235!\$% – write a message to persuade and convince others of the value and benefits of this program

S 2%#/--%.\$ – write a recommendation to the instructors of this program on how they can improve the program to better meet your needs and the needs of the other students

S 2%#/--%.\$ – pick the part of the program with which you are most familiar and happy. Write a business case style of presentation, using the framework shown above, to propose improvements or changes that will produce better results

S 2%#/--%.\$ – write a commercial advertising this program to convince others to sign up for the program

S 2%15%34).&/2-!4)/. !.\$ 72)4% 4/).&/2- – write up a list of FAQs about this program. Write the answers to each of these questions in point form

ALL ABOUT YOU

As you complete this program, you will have a unique passport to success in the 21st century. Anywhere you go, you will know how to think better. You will know how to solve problems faster. You will be able to communicate and collaborate with others. You will have a stronger personal spirit. You will have the skills to work smarter. These smart skills will be your inside edge to face difficulties, overcome challenges and make the most of your opportunities.

You are already smart. Your 4D-i helps you know more about how you are smart, in your own unique way. Appreciate this. Celebrate what you learn about yourself. The good news is that we can all get smarter. Brains can change and grow. Grow yourself. Be more adaptable. Work on your game. Choose to practice, practice, practice. Put in the effort. Over and over. This is your opportunity. You are in charge.

We are all wired to keep growing and get better. Continue to build your skills in all 4 dimensions.

- Go green – to expand your skills in how to generate more creative ideas
- Slow in yellow – to deepen your skills in how to analyze and organize information and connect better with others
- Get to red – to sharpen your critical thinking skills and make smarter decisions
- Ignite your white – to tap into the power of your personal spirit to appreciate, persevere and initiate.

Support, encourage and help others to get ahead. Reach out. Teach others how to use the traffic light model to shift their thinking. Help them get better results too. Make your mark. Help us all build a smarter, better world.

ABOUT SMARTSKILLS®

Thinking is the core competency for the 21st century. SmartSkills was developed by Bob Wiele and his team at OneSmartWorld. The SmartSkills advantage is its one integrated platform to deliver five essential 21st century skills. It is like having a 4 wheel all terrain vehicle for your mind. SmartSkills is a system of thinking skills, strategies and thinking processes to help people think better, work smarter and get better results. The five skills are thinking, problem solving, communications in speaking and writing, collaborative teamwork and resilience in personal spirit. SmartSkills was designed as an educational innovation to implement the work of the Partnership for 21st Century Skills, the government of Canada's essential skills and the insights of many educational thought leaders. The SmartSkills system has been adopted by many progressive businesses, government workforce development programs and educational institutions.

ABOUT BOB WIELE

Bob Wiele, founder and President of OneSmartWorld, is a relentless innovator committed to help make the world a smarter, better place. His focus is on developing practical tools for individuals, organizations and nations to harness their brainpower, as their key to success in the 21st century. Bob and his team have built powerful thinking skills tools like the 4D-i and the SmartSkills system. He has a BA from McGill, a Master's degree in adult education from the University of Toronto and over 40 years of learning from his mistakes, ventures and efforts. Bob the author of a number of programs, books and papers. He has a great family and lives happily with Mandy in Collingwood, Ontario, Canada. Bob is still working hard to find new ways to get a little bit smarter every day.

NOTES

Thinking and Problem Solving

Igniting Personal Spirit

Communicating



Writing

Working with Others

THE 21ST CENTURY SKILLS CHALLENGE

±To WYGGeeH in oYrJaWtGhanKinK [orPH [e aPPneeH to FeGome more
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THE SMARTSKILLS® PROGRAM

- 1) 8LinkinK anH 4roFlem SolZinK
- 2) -KnitinK 4ersonal STirit
- 3) STEakinK 4resentinK anH CommunicatinK
- 4) ;ritinK to 6ecorH 6eTort anH 4ersuaHe
- 5) ;orkinK CollaForatiZely [itL 3tLers

Think Better. Work Smarter.

SmartSkills®: 21st Century Skills for Success

created by &oF ;iele

Fearless Diamond Press 2015

IGNITING PERSONAL SPIRIT

By Bob Wiele



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IGNITING PERSONAL SPIRIT AND CONTINUOUS LEARNING

Igniting Personal Spirit and Continuous Learning and the LEAP® System for Learning 1

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PROFICIENCIES IN PERSONAL SPIRIT AND CONTINUOUS LEARNING

The goal of this module is to equip you with the knowledge, skills and confidence to strengthen your personal spirit, increase your resilience and take charge of your own personal and professional development.

In this module, you have the opportunity to develop proficiency in the these skills:

1. Take more responsibility for own learning and life and take daily actions to achieve goals
2. Set personal goals and prepare realistic personal learning and action plans
3. Demonstrate interest, initiative, resourcefulness, perseverance and effort in pursuing one's goals
4. Seek out, identify and access resources and opportunities to improve your skills to achieve goals
5. Use your experience, adversity and mistakes as positive opportunities for learning and growth
6. Offer and act to help others achieve their goals

THE LEAP FRAMEWORK FOR LEARNING

The LEAP framework for learning is a simple framework for learning, developed by Bob Wiele, to accelerate skill development and improve your success .

LEAP consists of the following core components.

L – LeARN. This has two elements – one that outlines the what and the why of the knowledge and the second that provides procedures and tips on how to use the information



- **Need to Know** – short information capsules on the current research and theories on the topic



- **Smart How To's** - a list of key pointers on how to implement the knowledge into life and work



e–exPeRIeNCe—opportunities to reflect on one’s experiences and what the learner already knows



A- Apply@ WorK AND ASSeSS

- **Apply @ Work** – poses a challenge on how best to transfer what you learned to the workplace

- **Assess** – this component is not included in the books but is for the instructor to use with you to help you know how you are doing. It assists you grow your skills.



p – prAcTice SKills – a focus on repeated practice of the concepts, the language and the behaviors to build your skills, your confidence and improve your results.

Lesson 1: Learning and the New Smarts

‘If you want to improve your performance and build your productivity, start by studying your thinking. . . Things are the way they are because of the way that you think.’

– Jason Womack, *Your Best Just Got Better*

This first lesson is all about how people are smart in different ways and how important it is to keep an open and curious mind, so you can continue to learn and adapt to change throughout your life.

The new research clearly shows that thinking is a skill and, like any skill, can be improved with disciplined practice. It is not how smart you are that is important. It is *how* you are smart. The good news is – you can get smarter, by continuously developing your core thinking skills.

This lesson covers the difference between people with a fixed mindset and a growth mindset. It describes how our understanding of intelligence has changed over the years from something only some people have to something anyone can develop and improve. The lesson explains the importance of moment to moment choices in 3 Me’s – Smarter Me, Automatic Me and Setback Me. It describes the Hope model as a practical way to plan personal change.



Experience Exercise: What Did You Learn at School?

For many people, school days don't always bring back the best memories, especially when you focus on what you had to learn and how you had to learn things.

Think back to your days in school. Discuss these questions.

- What was the best part of your school experience?
- What were the most difficult or frustrating parts of school?
- How do you like to learn something new?
- What doesn't work for you?
- What advice can you give the facilitators about how you want to learn here?

NOTES:



Need to Know: The Seven Common Mind Traps

Continuous learning requires an open mind and the willingness to bounce back and move beyond obstacles. These mind traps are the enemies of learning and of high quality thinking. They undermine the probability of getting good results at work and in everyday lives. They literally trap you into a non-productive cycle and keep you from achieving your goals.

MIND TRAP #1. CLOSED MIND

This is the fixed mindset where you are unwilling to consider different points of view. This mind trap means the mental door is already closed. No new information or alternatives will be considered.

MIND TRAP #2. DIVING IN WITHOUT THINKING

In this mind trap, you leap in to solve a problem without having a plan or process. Part way through you realize you failed to consider useful information or other options.

MIND TRAP #3. CATASTROPHIZING

This is the Chicken Little syndrome – the sky is always falling. Every situation is a catastrophe waiting to happen. The result – high stress levels, wasted energy and a cycle of fear.

MIND TRAP #4. SOLVING THE WRONG PROBLEM PERFECTLY

Paint the deck while the ship is sinking. This mind trap comes from failing to diagnose the real problem by doing only a superficial analysis.

MIND TRAP #5. OVERCONFIDENCE IN ONE'S OWN JUDGMENT

The more you think you know it all, the more vulnerable you are to making a big mistake. This trap closes the door on gathering new information or exploring competing ideas in favour of doing the same old thing.

MIND TRAP #6. BUSY SPINNING WHEELS

This mind trap is one where you end up confusing busyness with real progress and productivity. You are putting off dealing with the real issues. This is like the hamster in the circular cage, running forever and getting nowhere. Your procrastination results in – poor performance, deadlines missed, high stress levels, wasted time and energy and failure.

MIND TRAP #7. MINDLESSNESS

The center of this trap is thoughtless, mindless behaviour. You don't think things through, you react too quickly and don't pay attention to the impact of your actions.



Experience Exercise: Mind Traps and Me

THINK, PAIR, SHARE

1. Select the 1 or 2 traps that you get caught in, that cause the most problems. Identify the specific situations each occurs in.

2. Discuss the situations, the mind traps – what you actually think, feel, say and do – and the results you get.

3. Share your experiences in the larger group



Practice Skill: Overcome Mind Traps

BUILD A SIMPLE ANTI-MIND TRAP COACHING PLAN

Shift beyond the mind trap and what you have learned about the power and impact of these traps. Share your wisdom with others.

1. Develop some simple pieces of advice to teach teenagers about the problems of using one particular trap, and what it does. Recommend a set of simple guidelines and techniques to escape this trap, such as some do's and don'ts to increase success.

2. Present the plan to the class with a description of the mind trap you selected and a demonstration of what to do and what not to do.

3. De-brief each round with what happened and the key lessons learned.

4. Complete the exercise with reflective journal work on how to deal more effectively with the mind traps.

5. Select 2 steps you will take to escape a trap, and what you can do to get back on track.



Need to Know: Better Outcomes from Smarter Thinking

Thinking skills really help us in the AVUCA world. If things are uncertain and keep changing, then how well you can think will help you to figure out what to do.

David Perkins is one of the world's leading researchers on what makes for good thinking skills.

RESULTS OF SMART THINKING

Here is David Perkins list of the results that people get who use smart thinking strategies:

1. **Superior results**
2. **Sounder decisions**
3. **Better solutions**
4. **deeper insights**
5. **More reliable conclusions**
6. **Better innovations and products**

Ian Mitroff, author of *Smart !inking*, describes the types of skills the *Success @ Work* program is designed to deliver for you.

“The ability to spot the right problems, name them correctly and implement appropriate solutions is the true competitive edge that will separate the successful individuals and organizations from the also-rans.”

David Perkins also identified a number of actions we can each take to be more effective thinkers. In other words, he focused on the things you need to do to think better and work smarter.

Here is his list of strategies. Notice how his 7 strategies align with the strategies in your 4D-i:

- **challenge existing assumptions**
- **Generate more options and ideas**
- **imagine incremental and breakthrough solutions**
- **collect more and better data**
- **Achieve more precision in data analysis**
- **learn how to improve your reasoning skills and make better decisions**
- **learn to balance objectivity and emotions**

A smart how-to skill in continuous learning is to be able to choose and use the right type of thinking strategy at the right time. The 4D-i gives you a more expanded set of the right thinking tools to choose from. The key to continuous learning is to keep an open mind and to build your versatility in how to use each thinking tool at the right time.



Apply @ Work: Thinking @ Work

Think of the jobs you have had or applied for. What type of thinking was essential for you to perform well? What % of time were you ever expected to use any of the 7 strategies? When you think of the work you enjoy most, what type of thinking would motivate you the most?



Experience Exercise: Know Your Mindset Quiz

Think about each of the following statements. List your response to each one using the rating system by checking the box.

INTELLIGENCE	DIS- AGREE	SOMEWHAT AGREE			AGREE
1. Your intelligence is something very basic about yourself that you can't change very much.	1	2	3	4	5
2. You can learn new things, but you can't really change how intelligent you are.	1	2	3	4	5
3. No matter how much intelligence you have, you can always increase it a lot.	1	2	3	4	5
4. You can always substantially change how intelligent you are.	1	2	3	4	5
TOTALS					

PERSONAL QUALITIES AND CHARACTER	DIS- AGREE	SOMEWHAT AGREE			AGREE
1. You are a certain kind of person and there is not much that can be done to really change that.	1	2	3	4	5
2. No matter what kind of person you are, you can always change substantially.	1	2	3	4	5
3. You can do things differently, but the important parts of who you are can't really be changed.	1	2	3	4	5
4. You can always change basic things about the kind of person you are.	1	2	3	4	5
TOTALS					



Need to Know: The Fixed and Growth Mindsets

Carol Dweck is the author of *Mindset: The New Psychology of Success: How We Can Learn to Fulfill Our Potential*. She has worked with thousands of learners. She discovered that people's deep beliefs about themselves are the key to their success. As Henry Ford once said:

“If you believe you can or you believe you can't, you are right.”

Your mindset is the starting point for success in continuous learning. Your beliefs determine your ability to grow or not, to get smarter or not, to get better or not, to be able to learn what you need or not. Change your mindset and you can change your results. That is good news because it puts you in the driver seat.

Here are the two mindsets Carol Dweck discovered.

THE TWO MINDSETS

FIXED

Leads to a desire to look smart and, therefore, a tendency to:

- **Avoid challenges**
- **Give up easily due to obstacles**
- **See effort as fruitless**
- **ignore useful criticism**

GROWTH

Leads to a desire to learn and, therefore, a tendency to:

- **embrace challenges**
- **persist despite obstacles**
- **See effort as a path to mastery**
- **learn from criticism**

Each of the two mindsets leads to completely different types of thoughts and actions, leading to totally different outcomes.

FIXED MIND SET

In the fixed mindset, you believe you have to succeed in the right way and look great. You expect that either you have an ability or not. If not, then you drop it, because you don't want to look bad or stupid by trying and not getting it right away. If you have it, you have it. If you don't, you don't. In the fixed mindset, you only stay interested when you can do well right away. If not, you avoid new challenges, so you won't look bad to others.

“The fixed mindset stands in the way of development and change. The growth mindset is a starting point for change, but people need to decide for themselves where their efforts towards change would be the most valuable.”

—Carol Dweck

GROWTH MIND SET

In the growth mindset, you recognize that everything is learning and any new skill takes time to develop. Instant success is a delusion and a distraction. The real work is buckling down and putting in effort to get better. The growth mindset is all about not worrying about looking stupid. You just get in there to learn and stretch yourself and get smarter, one small step at a time.

“With practice, training and above all, method, we manage to increase our attention, our memory, our judgment and literally to become more intelligent than we were before.”

—Carol Dweck

The power of your own beliefs about yourself strongly affects what you want and whether you believe you can succeed at getting it. The beliefs you have of yourself will direct the way you live your life.

The mindset you choose will determine how far you go. The good news is you can choose the growth mindset if you want to. The good news is by working hard and practicing carefully and deliberately and not getting impatient or frustrated all the time, you will get better.

The growth mindset is a shift in your approach to learning, to work opportunities and to life. Change your beliefs about yourself and you can change your results.

NOTES:



Smart How To's: Shift to Using the Growth Mindset

Here are 5 tips on how you can shift your focus to using the growth mindset.

1. **MAKE THE SHIFT FROM 'NO CAN-DO' TO 'WILL TRY HARD'** – take a past event that was a failure or a difficult time and reflect on it. Feel all the emotions that go with it. Now, put on a growth mindset. Look honestly at your role in it. Shift from a feeling of failure and “this defines who I am” - to - feeling this is all part of the ongoing, continuous life long learning journey. Ask “what can I learn from this experience and use it to grow?”
2. **EFFORT** – drop always having to be cool. Make putting in real effort and working hard part of the new you.
3. **ACCEPT BOTH MINDSETS** – can you be a mix of both? Absolutely. Everyone is. Sometimes, you react in the fixed mindset. Other times you respond from the growth mindset. The more you choose to be in the growth mindset, the more you will be ready for the workplace.
4. **CHANGE IS IN YOUR HANDS** – can you change? Yes – first just by knowing there are two mindsets to choose from. Second – by catching yourself having to be a know it all and having to be always right and defensive. Third – by choosing to switch into a new way of “ I don't have to know it all, all the time. I can get better by working on my game.”
5. **FOCUS ON YOUR 'HOW', AND NOT ON YOUR RESULTS** – smart performers focus on the way they do things as key to their performance. Smart performers worry less about the results. They learn how to adjust how they operate to get better. Watch what you do. Watch how you do it. Think about how you can improve how you do it. Try stuff out. Make mistakes. Make every mistake a step on your learning journey. Take small steps. Every day. The results will follow

NOTES:



Experience Exercise: The Trade-Off

1. What do you gain and lose from staying in the fixed mindset? What do you lose?

2. What do you gain and lose from the growth mindset? What do you lose?

3. What do you have to do differently to shift to the growth mindset?



Practice Skill

SKILL-BUILDING PRACTICE: NEW BELIEFS FOR GETTING TO THE GROWTH MINDSET

What you would have to do everyday to truly believe and live these two statements:

1. I can change how smart I am if I work on it everyday.

2. I can change basic things about the kind of person I am if I want to.



Need to Know: The New News about Intelligence

In the old days, we all thought that people who got high results on tests were more intelligent. We now know that was wrong. People who got high marks on tests knew how to get high marks on tests. This does not necessarily make them more intelligent.

“With practice, training and above all, method, we manage to increase our attention, our memory, our judgment, and literally to become more intelligent than we were before.”

– Alfred Binet, developer of the original IQ test

Your personal intelligence is your own set of skills and strategies that you use to figure things out. These smart skills help you think better, solve problems, communicate, collaborate and work smarter with others.

THE EVOLUTION OF INTELLIGENCE



1. WHO IS SMART AND WHO IS NOT

1865 – Galton: Superior biology of the upper class

1904 – Spearman: 'G' intelligence. You have it or you don't

2. THE BRAIN AND INTELLIGENCE ARE FIXED

1913 – Ramon Y Cajal: “The adult brain is fixed, ended, immutable”

3. HOW SMART ARE YOU? IQ AND SAT MEASURES IT

1916 – Terman's Stanford Binet IQ test. How to measure it

1926 – SAT. Need to score well to get into college

4. HOW YOU ARE SMART – MORE THAN ONE WAY

1983 – Gardner: multiple intelligences

1989 – Sternberg: creative, analytical, practical intelligences

1995 – Goleman: emotional intelligence

5. YOU CAN GET SMARTER – NEUROPLASTICITY

1960's – Hebb: “Neurons that fire together wire together”

1987 – Flynn: massive gains in IQ – higher order thinking

1990's – Maguire: London cab drivers' brains grow to adapt

1997 – Ericsson: deliberate practise - 10,000 hours

2001 – Wiele: total intelligence and 21 strategies

2006 – Dweck: Mindsets – fixed and growth belief mindsets

2007 – Doidge: The Brain that Changes Itself

2009 – Coyle: The Talent Code – building smarter brains

2013 – Kaufman: Ungifted – develop your personal intelligence

Every person is smart in their own unique way. You are smart in your own unique way. People with all different kinds of minds can achieve extraordinary results, in their own way and at their own pace.

Intelligence is what you do everyday. It is not simply what you have. A person acts intelligently every time they decide to do something that moves them toward a goal they have. They don't act intelligently when they make decisions without thinking things through.

Intelligence is much more about your personal learning journey and what you do with what you have. Intelligence has little to do with a mark on a test that you got in school or what a teacher predicted for your future.

In 1994, a group of 52 experts in the scientific study of intelligence and related fields provided the following definition of intelligence:

“Intelligence is a very general mental capability that, among other things, involves the ability to reason, plan, solve problems, think abstractly, comprehend complex ideas, learn quickly and learn from experience. It is not merely book learning, a narrow academic skill or test-taking smarts. Rather, it reflects a broader and deeper capability for comprehending our surroundings – ‘catching on’, ‘making sense’ of things or ‘figuring out’ what to do.”

Now the researchers have shown us that people's brains can grow and adapt and improve performance throughout our lives. You can get smarter – if you choose to do so.

SOME OF THE THINGS WE NOW KNOW ABOUT INTELLIGENCE:

- What you do with what you have, not just what you have
- A drive and perseverance to get better
- Adaptation – the more adaptable you are, the smarter you will act
- real engagement in what you do – not sitting on the sidelines
- A drive to know more about something you love

Intelligence is now more up to you than ever before. Before we thought it was something people had or didn't have. Not true! Intelligence grows the more you learn, the more passionate you are about mastering a skill, the more you commit totally to getting better at something you love to do and the more time you put in. That is good news for everyone.

NOTES:



Practice Skill: Develop A Smarter Day Plan

What has prevented you from getting better results than you have?

If you decided you really could get smarter, what specific choices and different actions would you take? Develop a simple plan for living a smarter day. List some do's and don'ts to make your day a smarter day.

TASKS	DO'S	DON'TS
My approach to the day		
How I use my time		
How I work		
How I complete tasks		
How I work with others		
How I learn		



Apply @ Work: Smarter Day

1) How would you apply these practices in seeking a job or succeeding at work?

2) What 3 steps should you take?

3) What obstacles would you face?

4) How would you deal with and overcome these obstacles?



Need to Know: Learning Practices of Great Performers

Great performers are normal people who do extra ordinary things. They have developed 3 key practices as part of their lifelong learning.

1. KNOW SELF Great performers spend time understanding and knowing themselves well.

“Exceptional individuals have a special talent for identifying their own strengths and weaknesses.”

– Howard Gardner, Extraordinary Minds

2. USE ADVERSITY CONSTRUCTIVELY Great performers know how to reframe adversity and setbacks into hard won learning. They choose a growth mindset to keep moving forward, instead of packing it in. They have the special ability to convert life’s setbacks as part of their path to achieve future success.

3. WORK HARDER THAN OTHER PEOPLE In a survey of 143 researchers, the number one ingredient in creativity was perseverance, not special talent or genius. Great performers work harder, they work smarter and they work longer than other people do. They focus intently on the small things that make a difference. They have the perseverance and resilience to keep going forward.

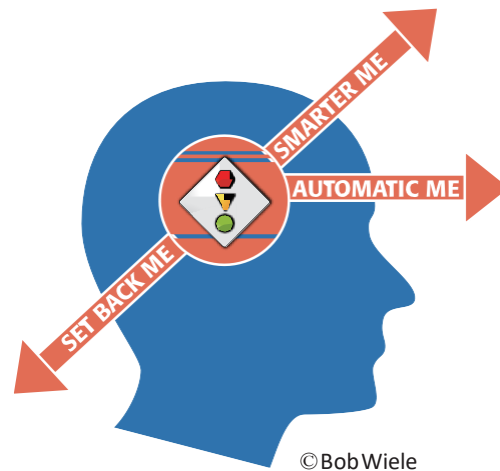
“There is no such thing as a natural born pilot. Whatever my aptitude or talents, becoming a proficient pilot was hard work, really a lifetime’s learning experience... The best pilots fly more than the others; that is why they are the best.”

– Chuck Yeager - legendary test pilot.



Need to Know: The 3 Me's

Intelligence is having to figure things out when you aren't sure what to do next. It is really a series of moment to moment decisions that add up over time. In the moment, in any moment, you always have 3 choices for what to do. These are the 3 Me's:



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- 1 **AUTOMATIC ME** – this me is the same old me, doing what I always do, in the same ways. No real thinking is involved. I just do what I do. It is mindless and automatic – like tying shoes, driving a car, ordering the same food from the same place and reacting to a friend or work mate in the same way without thinking. This type of thinking is good when you have repeatable routines in place to get simple things done. Automatic me is not a good choice when things change, become more complex, uncertain and require some thinking.
2. **SET BACK ME** – this me is when I make dumb choices, bad decisions that take me off track and away from my goals. Setback me is not stopping to think things through and damaging health, relationships and opportunities to move forward. The Setback Me choices literally set you back – like one step forward and 2 steps back. A lot of Setback Me comes from fast, unconscious warm red emotional reactions
3. **SMARTER ME** – this me slows down, looks carefully at the situation or person involved, gathers some information, thinks about the options and then takes action. Smarter Me is really smarter and makes you smarter. Smarter Me fits the new definition of intelligence – taking actions and decisions that move you forward and reduces the gap between where you are now and where you want to be in the future.

The 3 Me's are always there. The key in your continuous learning and development is to go to Smarter Me as often as you can. Make more Smarter Me choices “in the moment” everyday. This means you are thinking more and reacting less. It puts you more in control of where you want to go and, importantly, more in control of the ways that work to get you there. Smarter Me helps you make progress every moment, everyday, towards where you want to end up. You leave behind the habits and how-to's that really don't move you, your relationships and your career forward. Smarter me is continuous learning in action.



Apply @ Work: Refl

on 3 Me's

Think back over the past week. What are some specific examples of your 3 Me's in action and what were the consequences of each one.

3 ME'S	EXAMPLES	CONSEQUENCES
SMARTER ME		
AUTOMATIC ME		
SETBACK ME		

What do you notice in these examples?

At work, in what types of situations or tasks would you need to use your Smarter Me?



Practice Skill: Smarter Me

WRITE YOUR OWN LIST OF SMARTER ME PLANS

1. **Create** 2 simple daily slogans to remind yourself to choose your own Smarter Me
(eg. “New day, new way”, “think, think, think”, ”I think I can, I think I can”)

2. **Choose** 3 situations where this would be most helpful

3. **Pick** the one thing you would have to stop doing



Practice Skill: Develop a Smarter Day Plan

MAKE A ONE DAY SMARTER ME PLAN FOR TOMORROW

MORNING	• Early morning	
	• Mid morning	
	• Late morning	
AFTERNOON	• Lunch	
	• Early afternoon	
	• Mid afternoon	
EVENING	• Late afternoon	
	• Early evening	
	• Late evening	



Smart How To's: Getting to Where You Want to Go

To be successful in the workplace you need to figure out where you want to go. To succeed, you can't simply get some basic knowledge and skill and sit on what you know. You need to continually commit to learning more. Top performers take responsibility for their errors. They frame them as necessary learnings, no matter how difficult the lessons are: particularly from losses and close calls. Top performers never stop learning. They set specific technique-based goals and strategies for themselves. They have thought through what they need to work on.

1) KNOW AND ENVISION WHAT HIGH PERFORMANCE IS FOR YOU – build your own mental model of what your future success means for you. Be as clear, specific and as detailed as possible so you know what your destination looks like for you.

2) FOCUS HARD ON WHAT IS ESSENTIAL – be decisive about what you pay attention to. There are so many distractions out there. Focus on what you need to know and do next to develop your skills. Focus on the **ONE THING** that is really important and relevant to your goals. Avoid distractions. Avoid bright shiny objects.

3) PLAN FUTURE ACTIONS – think through your own mental plan for how you hope to achieve your goals. Think step by step. Be deliberate and thorough. Make sure you plan for what will likely happen next and how you can best respond.

4) SET PERFORMANCE GOALS NOT RESULT GOALS – plan your own step by step goals that you need to carry out to get to where you want to go. Be as detailed and cool yellow as possible.

5) ZERO IN ON HOW TO IMPROVE YOUR OWN HOW-TO STEPS – assess the steps you took this week, yesterday, today, the past hour. Look at how well you carried out your own how-to's to prepare and perform. Find out what worked. Find out one thing to improve and do it. Repeat everyday.



Apply @ Work: Best Ways of Working

Imagine you have the opportunity to meet with a job counsellor or an employer to talk about your future plans. Reflect on the specific ways and 'how-tos' that you can use to organize yourself everyday and get quality work done. Make a list of your own 'secret sauce' for success, when you use your Smarter Me.

1.

2.

3.

4.

5.



Need to Know: The Hope Model for Achieving Success

One of the best ways to understand what it takes to achieve success is the simple Hope model. It was developed by researchers who studied how important hope is to learning and to life.

People with high hopes share four core beliefs.

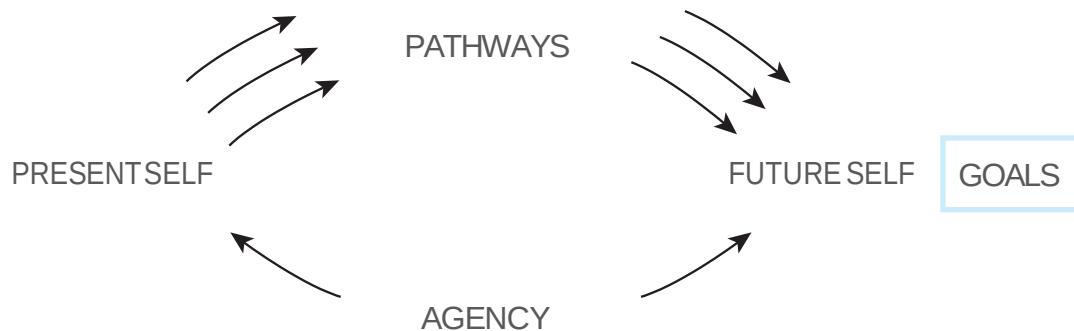
BELIEF #1: The future will be better than the present. This is a positive outlook on life and a belief that tomorrow holds promise and with some work things can change for the better. This belief is shared by most people. In global polls, 89% of people expect their life to be as good or better in 5 years.

BELIEF #2: i have the power to make it so – a learned sense of personal control over having an impact on one's future destiny, often reinforced by family, friends, experiences or a community.

BELIEF #3: There are many paths to my goals – I have the ability to find, create and develop different ways to where I want to be in the future.

BELIEF #4: No path is free of obstacles – nothing is easy. No surprises. Challenges and obstacles are a part of everyone's life. This is to be expected and initiative will be needed to overcome and persevere.

Shane Lopez, one of the researchers who wrote *Making Hope Happen*, identified four components of the Hope model.



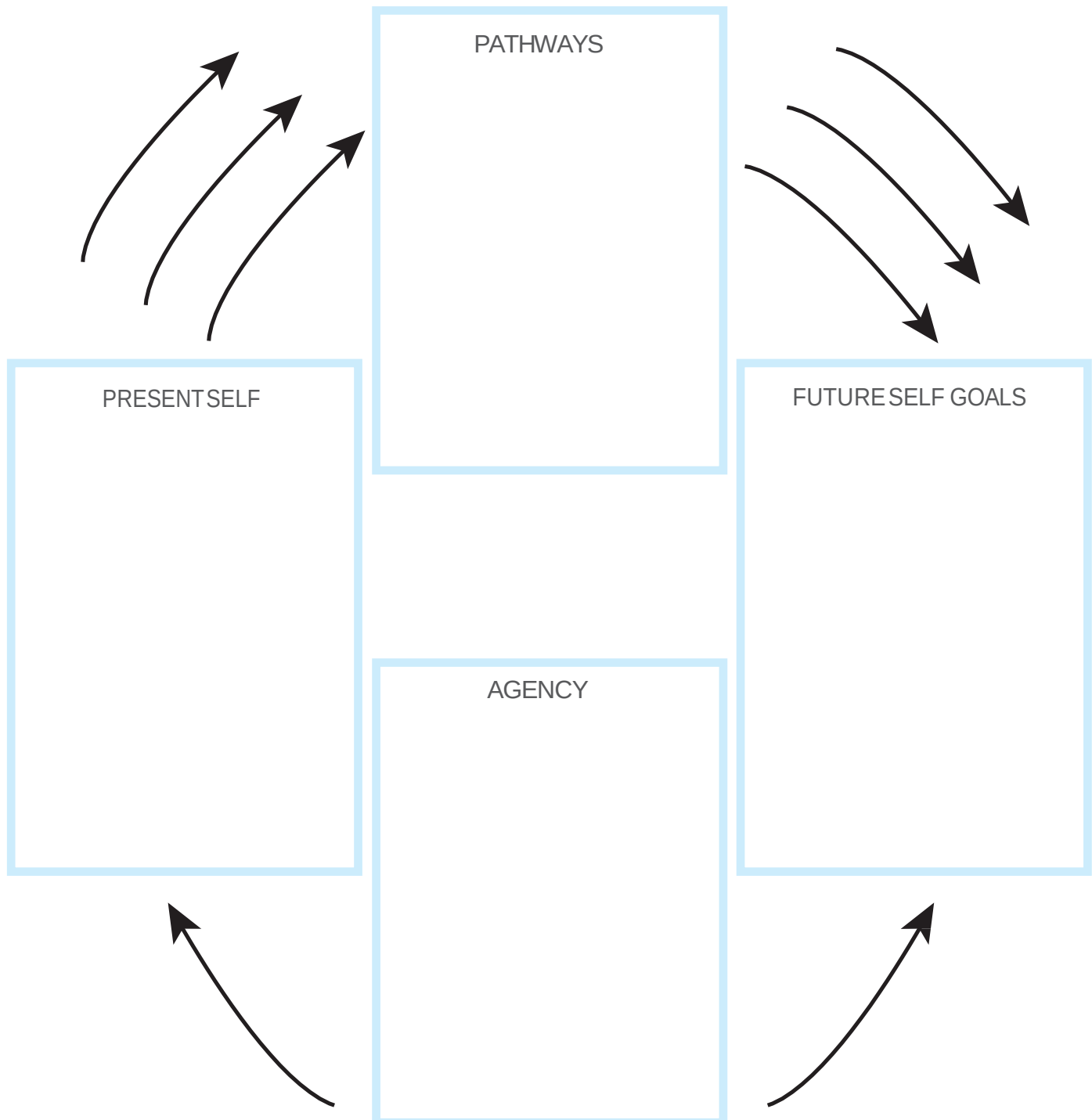
- **PRESENT SELF** – where you are now: good, not so good is all right. This is where you are right now
- **GOALS** – the important pictures of your future showing where you want to go, what you want to accomplish and who you want to be
- **AGENCY** – your belief in your ability to be in control enough to shape your life day to day
- **PATHWAYS** – you seek out a number of different ways, and make specific plans to achieve your goals, adapting along the way

To move forward, hope is essential. To learn continuously, everyone needs to shift into a growth mindset to focus on possibilities and realities. Use hope's four beliefs as your fuel. Work on your own personal plan to find and follow the pathways to take you from where you are now to get to the goals that are most important to you.



Practice Skill: Make Your Hope Happen Plan

Make your own 'hope' map on the diagram. Write in your notes about your present self, key goals you have for yourself, some pathways you see to achieving those goals and your beliefs about your ability to make this all happen as your own 'agent' for change. Coach one or more learning partners on how to build and sharpen their Hope Plan – their present self, the goals, the pathways they choose and their own beliefs about their ability and commitment to get there.





Apply @ Work: Takeaways

Write a 5-point summary of key points you found particularly useful in this lesson and could apply in a workplace.

1.

2.

3.

4.

5.

Lesson 2: Resilience: How to Manage Adversity Better

INTRODUCTION

We all live in stressful times. We all experience setbacks and obstacles. If we never tried to achieve anything in life we would never make mistakes, be disappointed or be hurt. A certain amount of difficulty in life makes our day-to-day world a bit more exciting and memorable.

Resilience is our bounce-back skill that we all have. Some people have more resilience than others. In certain situations, people can be more or less resilient.

This lesson introduces resilience. Resilience is at the heart of personal spirit. Resilience is your ability to bounce back from setbacks and adversity. It is like your reserve generator and power source.

The lesson highlights the seven most common mind traps that can sabotage and undermine your ability to handle pressure and manage difficult circumstances. The lesson explains what resilience is. It offers some simple ways and an exercise to strengthen your resilience. Like everything in the *Success @ Work* program, you can learn about resilience and you can learn to improve it.



Experience Exercise: Take Stock of Stages

WORKING WITH ONE OR TWO PEOPLE, DISCUSS

1. What situations are causing you the most stress these days?
2. Which ones are the most difficult for you to deal with?
3. What is the impact of these stressful situations on you and those around you?
4. What are some of your coping strategies?
5. What skills would really help you cope better?

NOW IDENTIFY

- The place you go when you are feeling down and need some time to think?
- What activities you do that help give you perspective on the problem? (eg. Walk in the forest, watch funny videos, think of others in less fortunate circumstances, volunteer, work out at the gym, talk to friends)
- How long you give yourself before you typically start to tell yourself to snap out of it? (one hour, two days, till the weekend etc.)
- Actions you take to get the issue out of your system? (eg. Write it all out in a letter that you don't send anywhere, give yourself a good talking to in the mirror, write your thoughts and feeling in your journal, do a tribal scream in a forest, participate in a physical activity or sport, chop wood, punch a pillow, play an imaginary set of drums to loud rock music)
- Phrases/mantras/slogans that you tell yourself to help you understand the issue (eg. "This too shall pass", "that's another notch in my belt", "I won't make THAT mistake again")

PICK THREE

From all of the above ideas choose 3 things that connect with you that you could potentially use to help move you from being in the recovery stage to moving forward.

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.



Need to Know: The Resilient Mind, Heart and Spirit

Life isn't fair. Can you shake off setbacks, or do you suffer a meltdown? Facing a difficult emotional challenge, can you muster the persistence and determination to keep going or do you feel so helpless that you simply surrender? When you're knocked back on your heels, do you bounce back or do you melt down?

RESILIENCE

- Is in **every** person
- Is **what you do**, not just something you have
- Is your **bounce back**-ability
- Is **coping well** with high degrees of uncertainty and change
- Can be **strengthened**
- Shifts from focusing on 'poor me' and setbacks to '**yes I will**' and learning
- Deals with, harnesses and **masters stress** positively
- Is a **core foundation** for success

Our thoughts and feelings are the invisible drivers of our behaviors. The more we know ourselves, the better able we are to take greater control of the emotions and thoughts that sap our resilience. To increase your resilience in times of change, you need to be able to park your fears and focus on finding the possibilities and opportunities that are out there for you.

People with a high level of resilience skills have a significant advantage over those who get stuck in a 'victim/poor me' helpless and hopeless mindset. Employers rely on people who know how to bounce back and not get trapped in what can't be done. Some people take a while to recover from difficulties and setbacks. Others bounce back quickly. If you learn some of the skills in this Continuous Learning module you will be able to overcome adversity and bounce back more quickly.



Smart How To's: Build Your Resilience

Many of the key work skills in the 21st century are inside skills. These are the essential skills like thinking, problem solving, communication, working with others. To acquire these skills and get better, you need to commit to continuous learning throughout your life. You can build your resilience with your own mental training. High performers in the spotlight use mental preparation techniques to calm themselves and prepare for their high stress events. Resilience is something you can work on building everyday. Here are ten tips on how to strengthen and build your resilience.

10 TIPS TO BUILD RESILIENCE

1. **MANAGE YOUR EMOTIONS CAREFULLY** – catch and release the difficult ones
2. **REAPPRAISE AND REFRAKE NEGATIVE EVENTS** into something you can act on
3. **CONTINUE** to work daily towards your goals – focus on the one thing to do
4. **CHOOSE A REALISTIC OPTIMISTIC APPROACH** to all adversity and to life
5. **NOW. HERE. THIS.** Practice mindfulness. Practice how to be in the now – the right now. Practice shifting your attention to being right here and right now. Focus only on this – this thought, this feeling, this person you are experiencing.
6. **GET FIT** – the more physically strong and healthy you are, the better
7. **ACCEPT CHALLENGES THAT STRETCH** you – not too much, not too little
8. **DEVELOP AND MAINTAIN SOME CLOSE FRIENDS**
9. **ASK FOR HELP** from others
10. **IMITATE PEOPLE WHO ARE RESILIENT**

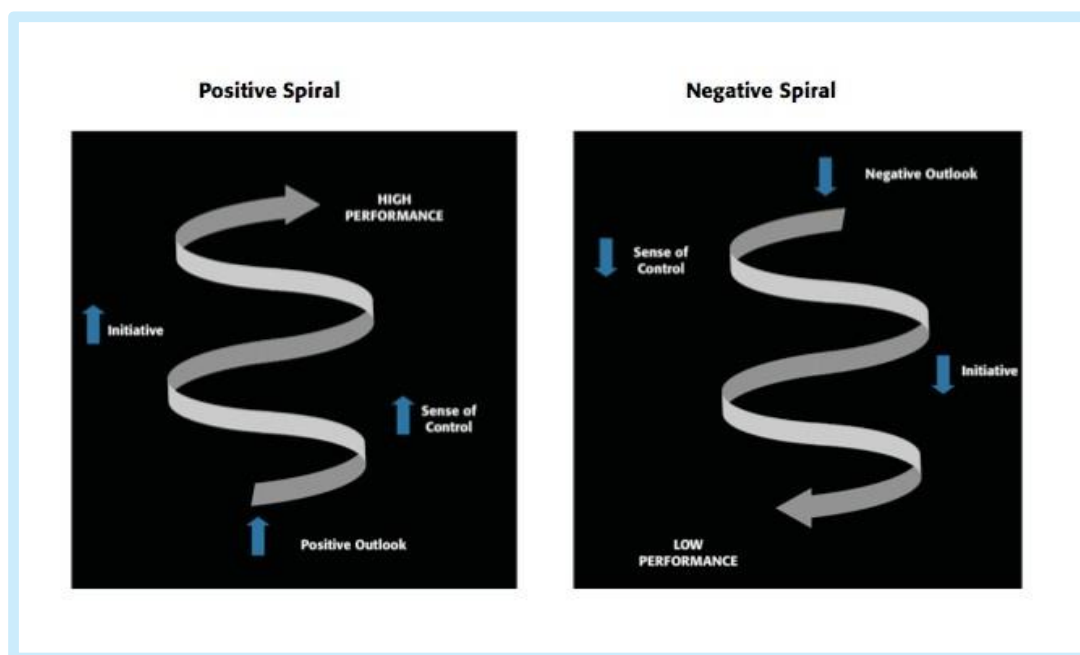


Need to Know: Personal Spirit is Your X Factor in Resilience

Personal spirit is based on positive psychology, brain-based research and ongoing research on what specific thoughts, feelings, behaviours, skills and practices make for higher levels of thriving and flourishing.

The great news is that you can strengthen your personal spirit the same way you learn anything else – with focus, commitment, effort and ongoing practice. People with a high personal spirit have a stronger degree of resilience. When facing adversity, they lean into it and make positive adjustments to deal with challenges. They know how to use hope, optimism and a sense of control to keep on the path to achieving their goals.

High performers in all walks of life think and operate differently. This is what makes them special. They are not more intelligent or gifted. They have developed different personal routines, rituals and practices. You can too. High performers have developed more effective and efficient ways of working with what life throws at them. They use their time carefully. They choose their thoughts and emotions with the same precision a healthy person will regulate their diet or an athlete will select the exercises they need to improve their physical performance.



“But the big news” from our research is that most people’s inner work lives shift a great deal over time as a function of the events they experience—not as a function of their personalities. Unwelcome events will trigger down days even for people who are basically upbeat. Nearly everyone in our study has days when inner work life soared and days when it plummeted. Such days can happen quickly.”

—Teresa Amabile *! e Progress Principle.*

If you learn to pay attention to each of the three key success factors in personal spirit, you can begin to consciously choose to be more positive and empowered.

- ◆ **OUTLOOK** - The most successful people know that life is what you make of it. Smart people work hard to reframe problems into opportunities. They appreciate the positive and see how the future unfolds from the present. They can see the oak in the acorn.
- ◆ **SENSE OF CONTROL** - This key success factor is about your sense of self-efficacy. The higher your sense of control, the stronger your belief that you can have an impact and influence the circumstances you are in.
- ◆ **INITIATIVE** – Initiative is one of most powerful work and life skills. Initiative is when everyday you work to move things forward. You take on responsibilities. You know that ‘someone has to make things happen and solve the problem’ and you see yourself as that person. When you take initiative, you add value to the organization – period.

Life’s events have an impact on personal spirit. The work environment, the boss, the usual range of external events can converge with a crushing impact on an individual.

Fortunately, all 3 factors in personal spirit can be strengthened with deliberate practice. The bottom line is that anyone can learn to strengthen their personal spirit by learning to slow down, appreciate what they have, express gratitude to others and by making plans and developing practices that shift from a can not focus to a can do focus.

Hope is essential in life. Joanna Macy and Chris Johnson in their book *Active Hope* describe hope as different than optimism. Active hope links our personal spirit with the important things we want to do in our lives. Active hope is like a daily practice. First, it starts with taking a clear view of reality for what it is. Next we decide what is important to us and the direction we want to move towards, based on what we value. Third, we take the right steps to get us moving towards what will make a positive difference in our life and the lives of others.



Practice Skill: Build Resilience to Feel Strong

This exercise, described in *Buddha's Brain* (Rick Hanson's book on brain science and performance), will help you build your resilience and feel stronger. You can practice on your own with your eyes open or closed. When you practice with your eyes open, you're learning how to do it anywhere, anytime, whenever you want.

STEP 1. Take a deep breath and come into yourself. Be aware of the thoughts going through your mind but do not engage them. Watch them come and go. Feel the strength of the awareness of being in control of your own awareness.

STEP 2. Now sense the vitality of your own body. Notice how your breathing has a strength of its own. Sense your muscles and your own animal strength.

STEP 3. Recall a time when you felt really strong. Imagine the situation as intensely as you can. Bring to mind the strength you felt – in your breathing, the energy in your arms and legs, the same strength that beats in your powerful heart. Continue to open up to these feeling of being strong. Know that you are strong. Know you are clear and determined. Now feel what it feels like to be strong and how good it feels to be strong. Let the strength soak into your entire being.

STEP 4. Now continue to feel strong and bring to mind a person or a group that supports you. Make this as real as possible. Imagine the person's face, their smile, the sound of their voice and feel totally supported, valued, believed in. Notice how this feels to you – how it feels to be valued and strong.

STEP 5. Notice all feelings that arise – feelings always come and go. So just notice, don't engage them. Turn your attention simply to feeling strong.

STEP 6. Finally, abiding in your sense of strength, bring to your awareness a challenging situation. Think about it as you feel solid in your strength. Feel an openness around that difficult situation. Feel a sense of distance and a sense of control over your responses and options. Allow it to be what it is, while you continue to feel strong and centred. Be clear on your intentions – how you want to be, how you want to feel and what you want to do. Be strong, feel strong without any need to act or grasp at anything. Feel relaxed, feel easy and graceful in your strength. Feel the strength in your moment-to-moment breathing, in your awareness, in the clarity of your mind in the moment and in the wholeness of your body and in your good intentions. As you go through the day, notice how good it is to feel strong. Let strength sink into your entire being.

The key to building your resilience, getting better and acting smarter is to use daily repeated and deliberate practice with this exercise. The more you repeat this exercise, the more you fire positive neural pathways in your brain. Reinforce the right pathways in your brain to strengthen your skills at feeling strong.



Apply @ Work: Resilient Workplaces

Here are some ways to build your own resilient workplace:

CRUSH OR BUILD RESILIENCE

1. Describe what resilience is and why it is important in the workplace.

2. What crushes resilience in the workplace?

3. What builds resilience up?



Apply @ Work: Resilient Workplaces

BUILD A RESILIENT TEAM OR WORKPLACE

1. **PERSONAL:** Describe how you could increase your own resilience at work. Produce a simple personal plan of what to do and how you can use your Smarter Me to ensure you are healthy and resilient at work.

2. **ADVANCED** – working with a learning partner, develop a plan to increase workplace resilience. Build the plan using the coloured smart track method.



1) Define the crux of the workplace stress problem



2) Collect information that explains the economic and human costs of stress on the business and on people



3) Develop different options to consider



4) Make recommendations on how to build resilience into a team or workplace

Lesson 3: Harness the Power of Your Outlook

INTRODUCTION

This lesson introduces the power of your outlook on your performance and your life. Outlook is like your own internal light switch that you can turn on or off or use like a rheostat to increase the light in your life. This lesson covers how to deal with your ‘hot thoughts’ that take you off your game and take over your emotions. It explores how to be an ANT exterminator, by eliminating your own **A**utomatic **N**egative **T**houghts that we all have. It has tips and how-to’s to increase your positivity and shows how to use it to achieve your goals.



Experience Exercise

It takes all kinds of people. Think about the most positive and the most negative people you know and have worked with.

POSITIVE PEOPLE. First, think of the most positive people you know or have seen. What do they say and do? What impact do they have?

POSITIVE PEOPLE SAY AND DO

IMPACT

NEGATIVE PEOPLE. Second, think of the most negative people you know or have seen. What do they say and do? What impact do they have?

NEGATIVE PEOPLE SAY AND DO

IMPACT



Need to Know: What is Your Outlook?

Your outlook is the first of the three key success factors that make up your personal spirit. Outlook is more than just putting on a happy face. It is an active way of engaging in the world, finding possibilities and potential where others don't and making the choice to see positive opportunities, with realistic optimism.

Your outlook is like a special setting in your mind. Your outlook is:

A belief that an optimistic, constructive approach to life enables one to find the positive, hidden potential and meaning in any situation, task or person.

You have control over your outlook. You can set it at negative or set it at positive. Depending where you plug your mind in, you will get positive or negative energy.

YOUR OUTLOOK

FOCUS	i appreciate what's good and possible
THINK	i open up mind and heart to find the potential
FEEL	i feel positive, open and hopeful
SAY	What's going well? What are positive ways of seeing this?
DO	engage only in finding constructive approaches
ACHIEVE	open-hearted hope

NOTES:

WHY: Taking a positive outlook is hard work. It doesn't just happen. Martin Seligman, Ph.D. and Salvatore Maddi, Ph.D. describe the importance of a positive outlook in performance, stress management and life success.

“It is the belief that good things may happen and are worth pursuing, but that effort, problem solving and planning are necessary to bring them about.”

A positive outlook builds up our resilience. A positive constructive outlook is at the heart of personal spirit. It opens up your mind and heart to see more and feel more things. It fuels persistence and perseverance under pressure.

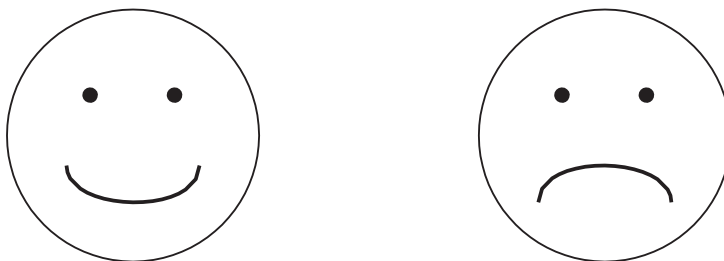
Positivity helps you bounce back faster from setbacks. A positive outlook helps you reduce the strain and drain of worry. It broadens your scope and the options you are open to.

WHAT: Your outlook on life, whether positive or negative, predicts how you experience life and what you get back from life. If you have an open, positive, optimistic outlook, then you will likely experience other people as friendly, cooperative and kind. If you have a closed, negative, pessimistic outlook on life, then you often experience others as angry, upset and difficult to deal with. What you send out, you get back.

HOW: Your outlook is an active process of how you perceive the world around you:

- Choose to experience life's events optimistically – not pessimistically
- Look for what's right, not what's wrong with others
- Focus on finding the positive, hidden potential in any situation
- Find ways to turn negative events into useful learning opportunities

WHEN: It is particularly important to turn on a positive, constructive outlook when difficulties occur. Learn to monitor your own reactions. Every difficulty offers potential for growth. See it that way. Strive to maintain a positive outlook all the time.





Practice Skill: Rating and Improving Your Outlook

STEP 1: Read over these 8 behaviour statements and rate your outlook by circling a number on each 1 to 5 scale. Select 1 behavior to build into your way of operating that would have the most impact on you and your performance at work and life.

1 = COMPLETELY NOT TRUE 2 = A LITTLE TRUE 3 = ABOUT 1/2 TRUE 4 = MOSTLY TRUE 5 = COMPLETELY TRUE

1. I appreciate my situation in life	1	2	3	4	5
2. People describe me as a positive, optimistic person	1	2	3	4	5
3. I believe in basic goodness in the world	1	2	3	4	5
4. I have a positive, proactive approach to dealing with difficulties	1	2	3	4	5
5. I believe things usually work out for the better	1	2	3	4	5
6. I believe my life is moving forward in a positive direction	1	2	3	4	5
7. I see potential opportunities in any problem that I face	1	2	3	4	5
8. I cope positively and constructively under pressure	1	2	3	4	5
TOTAL					

STEP 2: Add up all your scores and multiply by 2.5. This equals your score out of 100.

MY SCORE _____ X 2.5 = _____

STEP 3: Discuss what each means and how you feel about each one.



Apply @ Work: To Improve Your Outlook

Review the work you completed on the 8 behaviours on the previous page.. Identify the 3 actions you could take that would brighten your outlook and improve your chances for success in finding work or improving your performance in the workplace.

1. Read over the 8 behaviours and describe what each one means in everyday life.

2. Select the 1 behaviour to adopt that would have the most impact on you.

3. List 3 specific actions you will try out daily to build your outlook.



Practice Skill: Power Words

POWER WORDS

You have choices everyday on how you choose to be. Like the food you eat, you can be a Smarter Me if you choose words that lift your spirit. Here is a set of 'power words' to help you choose your mood and select your approach for the next few minutes or for the day. Pick a word. Practice being and acting that word.

- | | | | |
|--|---------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| ☐ AMAZING | ☐ CURIOUS | ☐ INSPIRED | ☐ QUICK |
| ☐ AWESOME | ☐ EMPOWERED | ☐ INVINCIBLE | ☐ RESILIENT |
| ☐ BRILLIANT | ☐ ENERGIZED | ☐ MARVELOUS | ☐ TENACIOUS |
| ☐ CARING | ☐ ENTHUSIASTIC | ☐ OUTSTANDING | ☐ UNSTOPPABLE |
| ☐ COMPASSIONATE | ☐ HOPEFUL | ☐ PHENOMENAL | ☐ VALUABLE |
| ☐ COURAGEOUS | ☐ INGENIOUS | ☐ POWERFUL | ☐ VERSATILE |

BE THE POWER WORD.

Practice being that word when you meet and talk with others.

Reflect on this practice.



Smart How To's: 12 Techniques to Increase Your Positivity and Outlook

Positivity is a verb. Positivity is action. It is what you do, not what you possess. Here are some techniques from Barbara Fredrickson's work in positive psychology and her book *Positivity*. These techniques will help you strengthen your personal spirit.

TECHNIQUE #1: REFRAME TO FIND THE POSITIVE MEANING

- Use the strategy of reframing problems into opportunities
- Actively seek out the hidden potential in every situation
- Ask yourself and those around you – What is the positive potential in this?

TECHNIQUE #2: BE A LEARNER, NOT A JUDGER

- Practice keeping an open mind for two minutes. Practice it for 10 minutes.
- Stop judging. Instead, open up and experience what is happening right now, and take things in as they are.
- Use the motto of “Now. Here. This.” Just be right here, now, doing this.

TECHNIQUE #3: PRACTICE DELIBERATE KINDNESS

- Tune in to others – reach out and do something that will bring a smile to other people.
- Express your appreciation to someone.
- Be kind to yourself. Take a moment to smile at all of your efforts, and feel good about what you are trying to accomplish.

TECHNIQUE #4: DEVELOP POSITIVE DISTRACTIONS

- Make 2 lists for yourself: healthy distractions and negative distractions.
- Under healthy distractions, list the specific things you can do to feel better and stay on track.
- Under negative distractions, list the useless worrying, anxieties or self-doubts that hold you back.

TECHNIQUE #5: DISPUTE NEGATIVE THINKING

- Connect with your inner critic and engage with a positive “Yes, but...”.
- Write down on one file card one thought or self-talk phrase that you use to criticize yourself or beat yourself up. Repeat this exercise until you have a set of internal unkind phrases that you use the most.
- Pick one thought card and dispute it. Come up with real evidence for when you weren't like that. Produce constructive statements to reduce the impact of the negative statement and to empower yourself.

TECHNIQUE #6: FIND NATURE NEARBY

- Take a walk in the woods, in the park, by the water, and away from distractions.
- Find a quiet place, open up your mind and heart and let nature relax you.
- Savour the wonder of the trees, birds, waters and sounds of nature.

TECHNIQUE #7: APPLY YOUR STRENGTHS

- Make a list of three strengths that you have. Complete the sentence: “I am good at..... and my strengths are....”
- Reflect on each statement and how each one makes you unique.

TECHNIQUE #8: MEDITATE MINDFULLY FOR 2 MINUTES OR MORE

- Take a few minutes to stop everything. Stop thinking. Stop feeling badly. Simply pay attention to your breath going in and out.
- Just breathe – notice your breath, notice the air around you, notice, don’t worry.
- Watch your thoughts and feelings come and go.

TECHNIQUE #9: RITUALIZE GRATITUDE

- Pick 3 things everyday to be grateful for.
- Pick small things. Pick a person. Pick something that happened. Pick a moment.
- Take stock of 3 things at the end of each day that you feel especially grateful for.

TECHNIQUE #10: SAVOUR POSITIVITY

Select something positive in your life – now, in the past or in the future.

- Think about it deeply and differently for a few minutes.
- Conjure up the event, person or situation. Visualize it in detail.
- Focus on the happiness and positivity it brought to your life.

TECHNIQUE #11: VISUALIZE YOUR SUCCESSFUL FUTURE

Find a notebook or journal and write down how you imagine yourself in six months, one year, three years, five years and ten years if everything has gone well:

- Visualize where you are, what you are doing and how you feel. Repeat.
- Focus on the ways you hope to get there.

TECHNIQUE # 12: CREATE HIGH QUALITY CONNECTIONS IN THE MOMENT

Find the magic in the moment with the people you meet.

- Treat everyone you meet as if he or she is a close friend.
- Smile. Make eye contact. Speak warmly and engage the other person or people.



Practice Skill: Build Positivity into a Life Practice

Employers appreciate people who bring a positive, constructive approach to work everyday. Read over the 12 techniques. Pick one to practice. Write it down here. Plan to start immediately.

1. The technique I will work on:

2. How I will use it:

3. The results I want to achieve:



Practice Skill: Cool Down Hot Thoughts to Brighten Your Outlook

- adapted from *Thoughts and Feelings - Taking Control of your Moods and Your Life*, Fourth Edition

Matthew McKay, PhD, Martha Davis PhD, Patrick Fanning

Hot Thoughts are negative thoughts that sabotage your performance, undermine your confidence and get in the way of workplace success. The purpose of this exercise is to increase your control over the mental hijacking by a negative 'hot thought'.

Use the Thought Journal to work through this exercise

STEP 1: Select a typical situation that you struggle with. Write down the Hot Thought that pops into your mind. Rate its feeling impact on you from 1-100. List the things you were thinking just before and during the unpleasant event or feeling.

STEP 2: identify evidence that supports the Hot Thought – the facts and evidence that support having that particular hot thought.

STEP 3: Fight back against the hot thought. Take the other side. Ask yourself:

- Is there another way of interpreting this situation?
- Is the hot thought really accurate or have I exaggerated it?
- What factors were out of my control?
- What would my best friends tell me about my reaction and the situation?
- What are other possible consequences to this?
- Could there be another conclusion?
- Could I come up with a plan to change it?

STEP 4. come up with a different response. Select a more balanced thought.

STEP 5 Rate your mood again based on this new set of evidence and approach.

STEP 6. record and keep these alternative thoughts and use them again

STEP 7. Practice using these more balanced thoughts in different situations

STEP 8. develop your own action plan. Write out 3 specific action steps you will take to move things forward and put you back in control.



Practice Skill: Exterminate Your Own ANTS

Everyone has their own colony of ANTS. These are our **AUTOMATIC NEGATIVE THOUGHTS**. They pop up everyday and undermine our outlook and our sense of control.

1. Write down one of your personal ANTS.

2. Write out the self-talk to use to exterminate your own personal ANTS.

3. Write out 3 positive replacement thoughts that will exterminate your ANTS.

4. Practice saying these new positive replacement thoughts to yourself and to others



Practice Skill: Build Outlook Skills through Gratitude

Every day for a week, do these three exercises:

1. Write down one positive characteristic of yourself and one positive characteristic of someone you regularly interact with. Do this three times a day. Ideally, you'll write down a different trait each time, but if you're stuck on how "helpful" your work mate or colleague is, that's okay.

2. express gratitude regularly. Pay attention to times you say "thank you." When you do, look directly into the eyes of the person you are thanking and muster as much genuine gratitude as you can. Make notes on what you do.

3. compliment others regularly. Seek opportunities to compliment people for a job well done - at work, in a store, what someone has done or how they look today. Look directly into the eyes of the person you are complimenting. Practice random acts of complimenting others.

After a week of this, spend a little time reflecting on what changes you noticed in your Outlook style and how people respond to you.



Apply @ Work: Build Your Own Positive Support System

Make your physical world and the people around you work to build your outlook.

1. Fill your work space and home with upbeat reminders of happy times and people who give meaning - pictures of people you love or places you like. List here:

2. Find like-minded positive people who boost your spirit, not bring you down with their negativity, cynicism or sarcasm. Who do you choose to be around to lift your spirits?



Smart How To's: Plan for Success

Here is a practical way to put your mind to work for your success.

STEP 1. RELAX AND VISUALIZE - think about what you want to work on.

STEP 2. WRITE OUT YOUR PROBLEM BEHAVIOR—describe the situation and the problem behaviors and your thoughts in detail as a series of steps – first this happens and I ..., then this happens and she/he ...

STEP 3. WRITE OUT YOUR DESIRED BEHAVIOR—next select the same situation and write out how you would like to respond if you were in better control. Map it out like a storyline you want - first I do this and he/she responds by....

STEP 4. DESCRIBE THE CONTEXT—practice imagining the context or situation where the problem behaviour occurs. Hold this image clearly for about 15 seconds and repeat it for 15 seconds. Record what you saw in your mind's eye. "I imagine the... and the scene around me is..."

STEP 5. IMAGINE PERFORMING THE DESIRED BEHAVIOR—imagine yourself performing the desired sequence of behaviors and thoughts, first with some difficulty and then successfully. Focus on the how to's of what you will do. Make an audio recording to reinforce your plan

STEP 6. ROLE PLAY THE DESIRED BEHAVIOR—test out your plan with yourself, with co-learners and friends

STEP 7. PREPARE COPING STATEMENTS—write up a couple of positive affirming statements to help you plan in advance how you will relax, stay on track and get through the situation. If X happens, then I will say, "Stay calm." "Relax." "Stay positive and empowered." "I feel great and in control of my reactions"

STEP 8. PERFORM THE DESIRED BEHAVIOR IN REAL LIFE—show time. Select a specific time and situation. Remember that things take time to learn and get right. Use every instance of success and setback as your personal learning opportunity.



Practice Skill: Job Interview Preparation

PERSONAL PLAN FOR IMPROVING JOB INTERVIEW PERFORMANCE

Write a personal script for yourself to prepare for a job.

1. Use positive descriptions of how you will prepare for the interview.

2. Visualize and write out your plan for how you will enter the room and greet people.

3. Write down how you will feel and describe yourself in positive, constructive words.

4. Select 3 positive statements to make about yourself.

5. Describe 3 positive ways you will perform in the job interview.



Apply @ Work: Your Positive Outlook Plan

Reflect on what you have learned in this lesson on your outlook. Workplaces often have people who are toxic and undermine others. Make a plan on how to deal with negativity and how you can contribute to creating a more healthy and positive workplace.

1. REDUCE NEGATIVITY

Make list of 5 things you could do or say to reduce the negative impact of negative people at work.

2. INCREASE POSITIVITY

Make a list of 5 things you could do or say to create a positive impact at work.

Lesson 4: How to Increase Your Sense of Control

INTRODUCTION

A person's sense of control is at the heart of lifelong learning and success. Your sense of control drives your learner mindset and your growth mindset to find solutions when adversity hits. The more in control you feel of your life, your thoughts, your feelings, your actions, your finances and your future, the stronger and better you feel and perform. Your sense of control is not about controlling others. It is about acting as if you are in control of you and your responses to life.

Your sense of control is powered by small wins and gains. The more small wins you make every single day, the more you will increase your sense of control and well-being. In this lesson you will learn about self-efficacy and how important self-efficacy is to your health, your work success and your relationships. You will learn a number of techniques. Like many of the factors covered in the Continuous Learning module, your sense of control can be increased. It is an inner skill set that helps you with the inner work you need to do. Without a sense of control, you can feel like a helpless victim, blaming others for your situation or condition. Using your sense of control, you can take full responsibility for your life and make the decisions that harness your Smarter Me.



Experience Exercise: Control or No Control

Every one of us has times when we feel completely overwhelmed by life. During different periods of our life, this can be how we feel a lot of the time. Like the weather, our sense of control can come and go.

OVERWHELMED: Reflect on and discuss the situations when you feel overwhelmed and have lost your sense of control over your inner and outer worlds. How do you feel? What factors and forces contributed to those feelings? How do you cope?

IN CONTROL: Reflect on and discuss the situations when you feel good and on top of things: when you feel in control over your inner and outer worlds. How do you feel? What factors and forces contributed to those feelings? How do you cope?

HOW DO YOU KNOW: When you feel as if you are in control of your life and your inner responses, how do you know? What difference does that increased sense of control have on you and your work and results?



Need to Know: Your Sense of Control

WHAT IS SENSE OF CONTROL?

This is the second personal spirit success factor. People use it to gain greater direction over their life and their performance, particularly under pressure and stress.

A belief that one can exert personal control, through one's own efforts, to impact on an outcome.

Karen Revich is an expert on resilience. She says that inner control is key to dealing with stress. The successful person gains control over their own knee jerk reactions and fixed beliefs so they can make better and smarter decisions.

“Resilient people are able to regulate their emotions and control their reactions so they respond appropriately in any given situation.”

Ken Pelletier, Ph. D. is another expert on how successful think and operate. He describes people who have a high sense of control as having:

“...an abiding certainty, based on past experience, that they can influence the course of their lives to a major degree.”

- Ken Pelletier, Ph.

YOUR SENSE OF CONTROL

FOCUS	i do what i can do, not what i can't do
THINK	i can, i will, i will find a way
FEEL	i feel in charge, empowered
SAY	What can i do next? What can i impact now?
DO	Anything to increase control of the process or outcome
ACHIEVE	confidence, results, resilience

HIGH PERFORMANCE AND SENSE OF CONTROL

Having a sense of control is a key to high performance at work and in everyday life. When you feel helpless and overwhelmed, you need to find ways to regain and maintain a sense of being in control in order to manage stress and for your own health and well-being.

Your sense of control is all about:

- **FEELING** as if you are in the driver's seat of your own life
- **THINKING** that you can make a difference
- **ACTING** as if you can affect the outcome of the situations you are in

A sense of control gives you a belief that no matter how difficult and challenging the situation, you can do something about it.



Practice Skill: Rating Your Sense of Control

STEP 1: Read over these 8 behaviour statements. Discuss what each mean and how you feel about each one. Describe what specific actions you would have to take to demonstrate the behaviors for each of the 8 statements in the workplace.

1 = COMPLETELY NOT TRUE 2 = A LITTLE TRUE 3 = MEANS 1/2 TRUE 4 = MOSTLY TRUE 5 = COMPLETELY TRUE

1. I can control my reactions to negative events	1	2	3	4	5
2. I can influence others to do what I want	1	2	3	4	5
3. People describe me as someone who is good under pressure	1	2	3	4	5
4. My success comes from my own hard work	1	2	3	4	5
5. I am able to achieve my goals	1	2	3	4	5
6. I am able to deal with challenging situations	1	2	3	4	5
7. I can achieve whatever I want	1	2	3	4	5
8. I can control what happens to me more than fate does	1	2	3	4	5
TOTAL					

STEP 2: Add up all your scores and multiply by 2.5 to get your total out of 100.

MY SCORE _____ X 2.5 = _____

STEP 3: Discuss what each means and how you feel about each one.



Apply @ Work: Increase Your Sense of Control

Review the work you have completed on the 8 behaviours on the previous page. Identify the 3 high yield actions you should take that would increase your sense of control and your chances for success in finding work or improving your performance in the workplace.

1. Read over the 8 behaviors and describe what each one means in everyday life.

2. Select the 1 behavior to adopt that would make the most impact on you at work.

3. List 3 specific actions you will try out to increase your sense of control.



Need to Know: Self-Efficacy of Control

+ Sense

Efficacy simply means the power to produce an effect. It is like a lever. No efficacy, no effect, no impact. High efficacy and you get an effect, you get an impact and you get a result. Self-efficacy is about having an effect and making an impact.

People high in self-efficacy...



Albert Bandura, the researcher who discovered self-efficacy and its importance to success, was born into a large family in rural Alberta. Bandura was selected one of the world's 5 most influential 20th century psychologists.

“Self-efficacy is a person’s belief in his or her ability to succeed in a particular situation.”

—Albert Bandura.

THE 3 ELEMENTS OF SELF-EFFICACY

- 1. **Beliefs** – **believe it or not.** Whether you believe you can or cannot, you are right. Your underlying beliefs wire you for success or failure. Small beliefs = small results. Big beliefs = big results. People often have to re-wire their beliefs about themselves and their world to succeed at work and life.
- 2. **Skills** – **you need skills to make an impact on your work life.** If you have competence and skill in something, you are on your way. If you don’t have the skills, then go out and get the skills you need. It will give you the tools you need to perform.
- 3. **Situations** – **self-efficacy can vary from one situation to another.** A person can have a high degree of self-efficacy in one situation and little self-efficacy in another, based on their beliefs and their abilities in that situation.

Self-efficacy is like empowerment. When you feel empowered, you feel you can make choices and act on your own to make things happen. This *Success @ Work* program is designed to increase your self-efficacy, by giving you some simple tools to develop your thinking skills.



Smart How To's Tips: 4 Ways to Improve Self-Effi

Self-efficacy and your sense of control are like biceps. They can be strengthened with regular workouts. The more you use it the stronger it becomes. Louisa Jewell, a Canadian leader in positive psychology, has identified 4 ways to improve personal self efficacy.

1. PERFORM AND JUST DO IT

- Set goals and make action plans
- Use one small baby step at a time actions

2. MENTAL TRAINING

- Think through how successful people do it –plan it out step by step
- Use mental rehearsal of excellent performance to perfect it first in your head

3. COACHING AND SUPPORT

- Give it and receive coaching from others
- Give and receive support from others

4. REFRAVE AND RE-AIM EMOTIONAL STATES

- Make shifts from anxiety to positive energy
- Work to find opportunity in adversity
- Each of these ways can work for you. Link them to your Hope work.



Experience Exercise: What I Have Got Going for Me Now

Reflect on where you are right now.

1. In what situations do you experience the greatest sense of control?

2. What work abilities and life skills are you competent in?

3. What beliefs do you have about yourself that make you feel confident?



Experience Exercise: What I Want to Have

Reflect on how you want to improve.

1. In what specific situations do you want to have a greater sense of control?

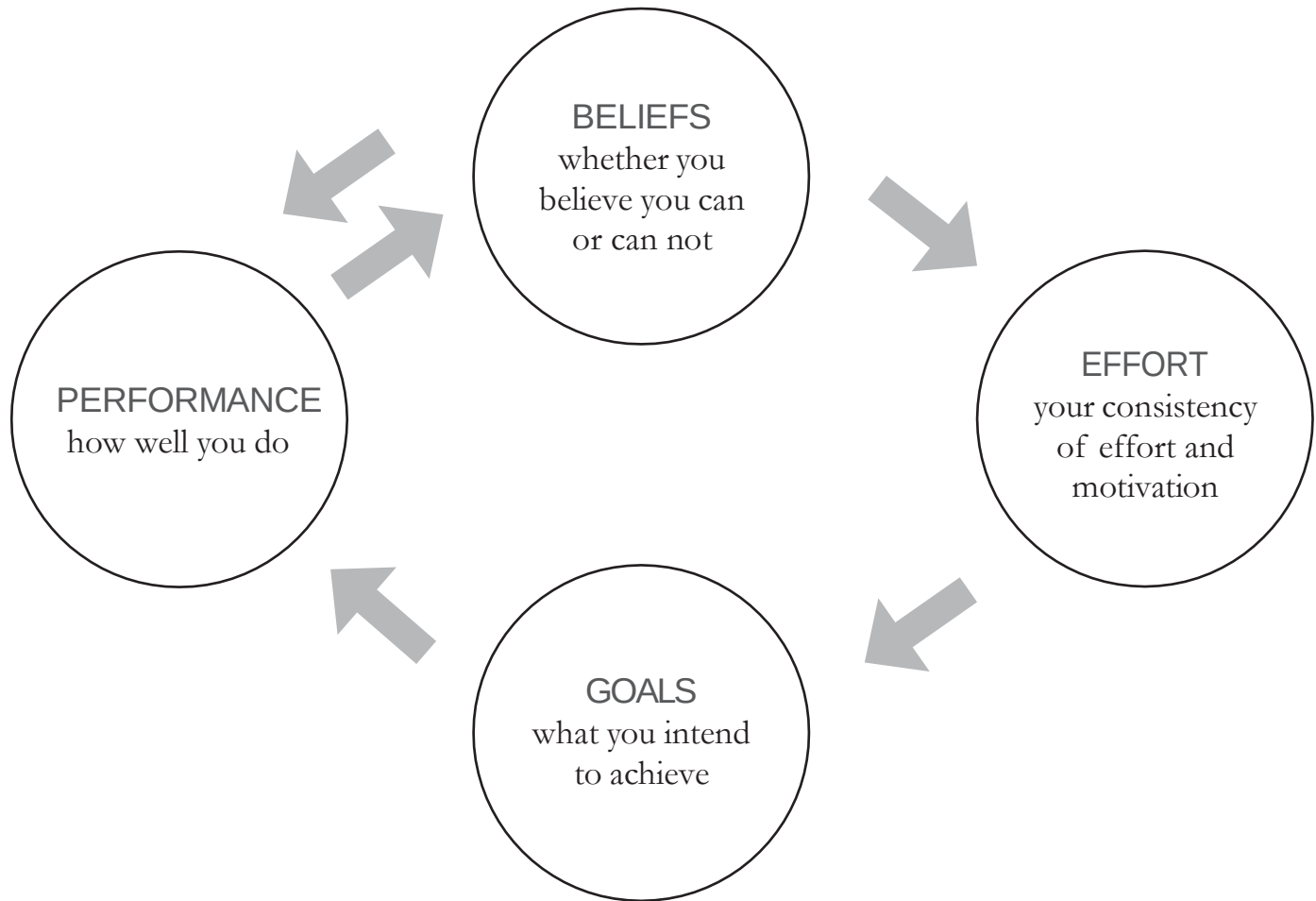
2. What specific work abilities and life skills do you want to build competence in?

3. What beliefs about yourself that, if you changed, would make you feel more confident?



Smart How To's Tips: Goals + Beliefs x Efforts = Performance

Self-efficacy is based on your belief in your own ability to succeed in a particular situation. Effort is your multiplier. The more time on task, the more deliberate your practice is, the greater your results.



THINK - FEEL - SAY - DO → RESULTS

These beliefs shape every aspect of your moment to moment performance. They shape what you:

THINK – how you think, what you think

FEEL – your emotions – positive or negative

SAY – your inner self-talk and your choice of words

DO – how you behave – what you do

RESULTS – what you get

Experience Exercise: WW X DO?

Think of a person you admire and respect, someone who gets things done without complaining. Think about this person as a role model for you. Identify *What Would* _ *Do?*

1. What do they do under pressure?

2. What do they say?

3. What is their attitude?

4. What are their beliefs in their own ability?

5. How are they with others?



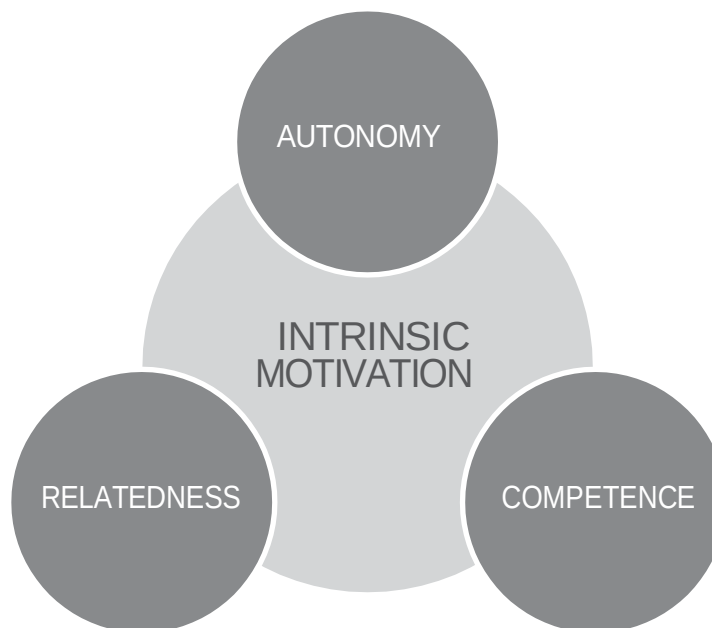
Need to Know: The Big 3 Human Needs That Motivate Us All

We all need to feel as if we are in control of our lives. We all need to be skilled at something. We all need and want to have friends and relationships.

Scientists have discovered we are all motivated by 3 deep needs. The more we can understand these needs and support them, the greater our sense of control and the more we can learn and achieve.

THE BIG 3 NEEDS IN HUMAN MOTIVATION

1. **COMPETENCY** – to be able, to be skilled, to achieve mastery
2. **AUTONOMY** – to feel in control of your work and your life; ability to make decisions
3. **RELATIONSHIPS** – to connect, be accepted, be respected and cared for



To be successful at work, the most important need is to be competent: to gain competency and skills in something. A key to continuous learning is to work hard and get better and more skilled at something that is important to you. In finding a job, employers want to know what are your skills and competencies. What can you do? How well can you perform? Can you think for yourself? Can you solve problems? Can you communicate effectively? Can you work well with others? Are you committed to your own growth and development? The more of these higher level skills you have, the more valuable you are to employers and to yourself. These are especially important if you want to start a business.



Apply @ Work: The Big 3 and Me

Think back to the work that you have done - paid and unpaid - and the type you enjoyed the most. What do you want in your future?

s !54/./-9 – freedom to make some decisions

s #/-0%4%.#9 – did you have the right skills and level of skills to do the work

s 2%,!4)/.3()03 – were you able to have some good friends

What impact did these motivations have on your performance and how you felt about the work?

	PREVIOUS WORK	TYPE OF WORK	FUTURE WORK
AUTONOMY: FREEDOM TO...			
COMPETENCY: RIGHT SKILLS & LEVEL OF SKILLS			
RELATIONSHIPS: SUPPORTIVE PEOPLE			



Smart How To Tips: Changing Self-Talk to Improve Control

One of the practical ways to shift from self-doubt and low sense of control to increased self-efficacy and higher self control is to change your self-talk or what you say to yourself and to others around you. Here are some guidelines to writing your own life script and self-talk.

FROM		TO
i can't	→	i can do
i won't	→	i will
I am afraid	→	I am afraid and still I will
Poor me	→	Proactive me
I wait	→	I initiate
Their fault	→	i am responsible
I avoid	→	I engage
I hesitate	→	I commit
i am negative	→	i am positive
I worry	→	I go for it
i blame	→	i take responsibility
you always	→	i accept

Pay close attention to what you say to yourself and to others. Take control of your self talk and the phrases you use to increase your self-control and self-efficacy.

NOTES:



Skill Practice: Change Your Story

Change your own self-talk by re-writing your own scripts. Pick topics about you. Write the negative things you can say to yourself. Change the game and write positive self-talk that over-rides the negative statements.



NEGATIVE SELF-TALK



POSITIVE SELF-TALK

	→	
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	→	
	→	



Smart How To Tips: 5 Solutions to Increasing Your Sense of Control

Work on these five tasks to get ahead and build your self efficacy and sense of control.

1. CLARIFY YOUR PURPOSE - Know where you want to go and why you want to get there. Look at purpose from different levels.

s */' 0520/3% Know what you hope to achieve in this job

s #!2%%2 0520/3% Understand what your overall career goals are

s ,)&% 0520/3% Understand what you would like to do with your very important life

s &!-,9 0520/3% Understand how you support and develop your family and vice versa

s 7%%+,9 0520/3% Where would you like to be at the end of this week?

s \$!-,9 0520/3% What will you achieve in this one day?

2. IMPROVE YOUR OWN PRODUCTIVITY We all want to get more done in less time. Think better. Work smarter with lists, plans, priorities and time blocks.

3. ASK THE RIGHT QUESTIONS Great questions help you to focus your attention and energy on the right things. Start by asking questions like -What is the best use of my time right now? How will what I am doing now help me? How could I be 10X more successful?

4. DEVELOP YOUR PRESENTATION SKILLS Everyone has to step up and speak out a some point in time. You need to be able to develop and use good presentation skills.

5. BUILD SIMPLE DAILY RITUALS Rituals and practices help us make the most of our time and energy. Rituals give a structure to our days and keep us on track. Rituals help us keep learning, get things done, stay healthy, improve our relationships and keep our workplaces and homes organized.



Skill Practice: Clarify Your Purpose

Work on these five tasks to get ahead and build your self-efficacy and sense of control.

STEP 1. KNOW WHERE YOU WANT TO GO

Knowing where you want to go and why is key to getting there. Look at purpose from these levels. Take a minute to jot down your responses to these levels of purpose

1. JOB PURPOSE

2. CAREER PURPOSE

3. LIFE PURPOSE

4. FAMILY PURPOSE

5. WEEKLY PURPOSE

6. DAILY PURPOSE

STEP 2. WORKOUTS

Do 3 short 3 minute workout rounds to get your purposes clearer

1. PERSONAL LIFE PURPOSE – what's your ideal clear view of what you want for yourself?

2. JOB PURPOSE – what you want to be doing

3. FRIENDSHIP/FAMILY – list the things you want and value most in your friendships or family – current and desired

STEP 3. REVIEW AND REVISE

Review and revise to get the focus right, clear and simple to carry out.



Skill Practice: Improve Your Own Productivity

Work on these five tasks to get ahead and build your self efficacy and sense of control.

IMPROVE YOUR OWN PRODUCTIVITY – We all want to get more done in less time. How to? Think better. Work smarter.

1. **MAKE A SIMPLE TO DO LIST** – get more productive by listing the tasks you want to get done – big and small. Check off the items as you complete them.
2. **MAKE PLANS** - make smart plans for each section of the day, week and month.
3. **PICK THE ONE THING** – identify the most important thing to do right now to move you forward
4. **BLOCK OUT WORK TIMES** - Create blocks of time to do work. Use chunks of 15 minutes, 30 minutes, 45 to 60 minutes of uninterrupted time to carry out a task. Do this for small stuff and big stuff. Put all the distractions away. Focus, focus, focus. Get ‘er done.
5. **USE 10 MINUTE TIME BLOCKS** - set short term 10 minute time blocks to get things done

SKILL PRACTICE: PRODUCTIVITY

Think of the things you have to do today or tomorrow.

1. Make a list of your things to do
2. Put them in priority – highest to lowest – write H for high, M for medium and L for low beside each item
3. Pick you top 3 and estimate an amount of time for each
4. Set a block of time for your top 3 priorities
5. Pick the one thing you will start with and block off the time

	PRIORITY	TOP3	TIME



Skill Practice: Ask the Right Questions

Here are some great questions to help you focus your attention and energy on the right things. Work in pairs or threes and ask these questions to build your skills.

1. What is the best use of my time right now?

2. How will what I am doing now help me?

3. What is most important to me right now?

4. How could I be 10 times more effective?

5. What would my most admired person do?

6. How could I improve how I am working?



Skill Practice: Develop Your Presentation Skills

Here are some ways to build your skills in presenting to others. Prepare a short presentation on something you know about, practice and present

PLAN AND PRACTICE PRESENTATION SKILLS

1. **STUDY GREAT SPEAKERS** – watch TED talks, watch Robin Sharma and others to pick up techniques
2. **ONE STEP AT A TIME** – work on the parts of your presentation to get better
3. **ALWAYS INCLUDE STORIES** – use your own experience. Beg, borrow and steal great stories from others' experiences or from the media
4. **DO 60 SECOND AND 2 MINUTE SKILL DRILL PRACTICES** – pick a topic or read from a script or article. Speak about it out loud for one minute only. Do it again. And again working on the how's of what you say.

PRACTICE AND DELIVER PRESENTATIONS.

1. **COMMUNICATE EYE TO EYE** – look the person in the eye, pick one person in different sections and speak directly to them
2. **PAUSE. DO NOT. RUSH** – when you speak – go slow. Practice where you will put your breaks
- 3 **VARY YOUR VOICE** – mix up the pacing and the loud to softs to keep it interesting
4. **PRACTICE USING GESTURES AND YOUR HANDS TO MAKE YOUR POINTS** – stand in front of a mirror or learning partner

NOTES:



Skill Practice: Build Simple Daily Rituals

Rituals and practices help us make the most of our time and energy. Rituals give a structure to our days and keep us on track. Here are some ways to increase your sense of control by building in simple rituals into your day and week.

1. **CONTINUOUS LEARNING RITUAL** – get ahead. Be a constant learner. Read articles, watch videos, read blogs on the work you want to specialize in.

-
2. **ANTI-PROCRASTINATION RITUAL** – think about your day every morning – first thing. Visualize it running well and in your control. Make a list of to do's in the morning or the night before.

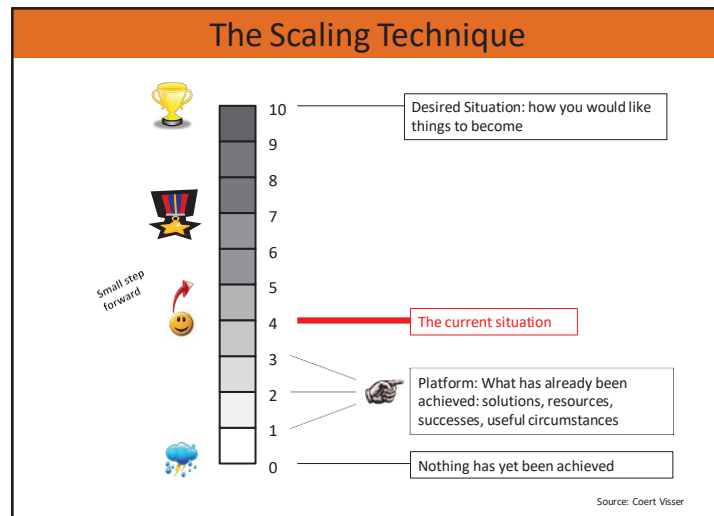
-
3. **SOCIAL LIFE IMPROVEMENT RITUAL** – make friends and family a priority. Make a list of the friends that are important to you. Identify people who are positive and who could help you. Set a target for who you will meet and when each week. Make one call or send an e-mail to get things moving. Make it a habit.

-
4. **CLEAN HOME RITUAL** – build a plan to keep your house clean and organized by budgeting times every week to do specific chores.

-
5. **HEALTH AND FITNESS RITUAL** – long term, your health is critical at work and in life. Start today. Make time to get some exercise, walk, play and eat properly. Keep a list of things to eat and not eat, things to do.
-



Apply @ Work: Solutions-Focused Scaling Questions



WORK ON YOUR GAME

1. On a scale of 0-10, with 0 representing the worst and 10 the outcome you want, where are you now?

2. What does 10 look like to you? What is happening at 10 that is not happening now?

3. Why do you think you are at X and not lower?

4. What strengths, resources and accomplishment put you there?

5. What is different about X and 0?

6. What is one small step you can take to move you one point higher?

7. Who or what can help you do that?



Smart How-To: Tips to Get Started One Small Step at a Time

Change can be scary and often overwhelming. Take one small step at a time. Get your sense of control moving up. A small step unsticks you and gets you moving forward.

START SMALL/THINK SMALL: What is one small step I can take right now that will move me towards my goal?

1. **ASK SMALL QUESTIONS** to overcome fears and develop understanding.
2. **THINK SMALL THOUGHTS** to find ways to move ahead. Work with what you have.
3. **TAKE SMALL ACTIONS** to guarantee success. Take one step at a time.
4. **SOLVE SMALL PROBLEMS** even in the face of overwhelming problems.

SMALL HOW-TO'S ON FOUR CHALLENGES:

Start by choosing a particular question to ask yourself everyday, several times a day if necessary. Think about this question and look for its answers.

1) **UNHAPPY BUT NOT SURE WHY** Ask “If I were guaranteed not to fail, what would I do differently?”

2) **REACHING A GOAL** Ask everyday “What one small step can I take today that will help me reach my goal?”

3) **SEEKING IMPROVEMENT** Ask “What is one small step I can take today that will help me improve at...?”

4) **IMPROVING YOUR OUTLOOK ON YOURSELF/OTHERS** Ask “What is one small thing that is good about me and the other person?”



Skill Practice: Use Mental Rehearsal to Handle Pressure Events

Elite athletes and high performers in many areas think differently. They use mental rehearsal as a valuable technique to mentally prepare to succeed under pressure. Job interviews. Meeting with a supervisor. Dealing with stressful situations. You can use your mind as your own private practice facility to build performance skills that will help succeed under pressure.

1. Think of a task that you are afraid to do or one that makes you feel uncomfortable. Give yourself a lot of time to work on it – before you actually have to step up and perform or deal with it.
2. Decide how many seconds or minutes you are prepared to devote to mind sculpting each day. Allocate 30 seconds to 60 seconds a day. Repeat it daily to get better results more quickly.
3. Sit or lie down in a quiet, comfortable place with no distractions. Close your eyes.
4. See the situation and the whole the scene – what do you see? What people? What are they doing? Wearing? The physical surroundings?
5. What do you sense, smell, feel around you?
6. Shift your focus now to a you having a successful performance – what do you see yourself doing, thinking, feeling and saying? What does your voice sound like? How does it vibrate through your body?
7. Visualize people responding positively – imagine what they are doing and saying. Play and replay it over and over..
8. Imagine a worst case situation and imagine how you would deal with it effectively. Play and replay it.
9. Do more practice to improve your likelihood of success. Extend the time by 30 seconds, 60 seconds or as much as you need to reprogram your brain.



Apply @ Work: Do One Thing

Take control. Do one thing to move you forward on the path. Think small steps and small actions to speed up your progress. This is a daily practice that will increase your sense of control and results.

1. Select your target for change – improve your time management, be kinder, be less impatient, be more focused, eat less, be better organized, learn more, etc..

2. Pick one thing and ask yourself – what is the ONE thing that if I did it right now, or today, or this week that will move me towards my goal?

3. Work with a friend or learning partner. Ask the same question repeatedly - what is the ONE step I could take next that would move me toward my goal?

4. everyday – pick the ONE thing –and just do it.



Need to Know: Kaizen and Continuous Improvement

Kaizen is the Japanese method and philosophy for small incremental change by continuously improving what you do and how you do it. You exercise and build your sense of control every time you take one small step forward. Small actions tell your fearful and contracted brain that you are shifting into action. A small step unsticks you. Take control by starting and by taking small steps every day toward your goal.

THE CORE TACTIC IS THE QUESTION AND THE ACTION –

“What is one small step that I can take right now that will move me towards my goal?”

Kaizen is all about managing your attention and focusing like a laser on what is the most important thing to do – right now. Continuous improvement is based on continuous learning. The overall goal is to reprogram your brain to increase your sense of control by learning to take small steps that lead you toward your goal.

THE KAIZEN SMALL STEPS APPROACH INVOLVES:

“A journey of a thousand miles begins with a single step” –Lao Tzui

1. Ask small questions to dispel fears
2. Think small thoughts to find ways to move ahead
3. Take small actions to guarantee success
4. Solve small problems even in the face of overwhelming problems
5. Bestow small rewards to mark progress
6. Notice small but crucial moments and details that make a difference

Continuous learning is continuous movement forward and learning by doing. Here are some simple need to knows about moving forward using small ways.



Skill Practice: Continuous Improvement and the Small Approach

PRACTICE: SMALL QUESTIONS

Start by choosing a particular small question to ask yourself about everyday, several times a day. The key is to be open to any and all answers that arise for you.

Pick one question. Write it down here.

1. ASK SMALL QUESTIONS

2. THINK SMALL THOUGHTS

3. TAKE SMALL ACTIONS

4. SOLVE SMALL PROBLEMS

5. BESTOW SMALL REWARDS

6. NOTICE SMALL CRUCIAL MOMENTS



Smart How To's: Learn to Use Chunking To Solve Problems Big and Small

Your sense of control increases if you can take any problem and break it into small bite-sized chunks. Use the same approach to identify and work on small problems before they become big ones.

HERE ARE A FEW APPROACHES TO TEST OUT

LOOK BACK

Recall a major mistake you made. Think back on what happened.

1. What did you do to contribute to it?
2. What didn't you do?
3. What could you have done differently?

LOOK HERE AND NOW

Identify one small mistake you made today. Be gentle on yourself.

1. What does that mistake teach you?
2. What is one small kaizen continuous learning step you can take tomorrow to make sure you don't repeat it?

LOOK AHEAD

Identify one important problem you face. Practice breaking it into smaller chunks and parts.

1. Identify big chunks

2. Put these chunks in a sequence - what chunk would you solve first, second, third?

3. Repeat this process for every problem and you'll find they become easier to understand and manage.



Apply @ Work: Increase Your Sense of Control

In some jobs you have lots of autonomy - freedom - and in others you don't.

1. What specific things can you do when you prepare for work or when you are looking for work to increase your autonomy?

2. What can you build into your daily events that will increase your sense of control?

Lesson 5: How to Take Initiative

INTRODUCTION

This lesson introduces the power of your initiative on your performance and your life. Initiative means stepping up and doing something important. It is like a power throttle in a boat or plane. When you push it forward, the boat and plane take off. This lesson covers what initiative is, how to build it, what employers look for in high performers and a set of tips and exercises. The lesson offers a variety of ways to plan and set goals – both big and small, long-term and short-term goals too. The lesson also offers tips for learning how to stand out and increase your value in the workplace.



Experience Exercise: Star Performers and Average Performers

Think of someone who is a star performer at work or in life. Get that person vividly in your mind. Now think of an average performer. Compare the two and make a list. Share and compare what separates them.

STAR PERFORMERS SAY AND DO

AVERAGE PERFORMERS SAY AND DO

NOTES:



Need to Know: Initiative Makes You a Star Performer at Work

Initiative is the third key success factor in personal spirit.

Initiative is the belief that one should go above and beyond conventional boundaries to do what it takes, to complete important tasks and assist others.

Initiative is what you can do everyday to see things that need to be done and take action. It is not what you have – like height or gender or money - initiative is what you do.

Employers need people who will use their initiative to step up, spot problems, come up with solutions and make things happen.

YOUR INITIATIVE

FOCUS	i seek better ways to make things happen
THINK	I choose what will make a real difference
FEEL	i feel courageous and confident
SAY	What actions will take it to the next level?
DO	Whatever it takes – alone and with others
ACHIEVE	Success and impact

In Robert E. Kelley's research study on star performers, *How to Be a Star Performer at Work*, initiative was the single most important quality separating high performers from average performers in the workplace. What he found was:

“It was not what these stars (performers) had in their heads that made them stand out "om the pack, it was how they used what they had.”

—Robert E Kelley

WHAT STAR PERFORMERS ARE NOT:

- Are not people with higher IQ's
- Are not more self-confident
- Are not better problem solvers and more creative.
- Are not more driven and ambitious.
- Are not more outgoing.

WHAT STAR PERFORMERS DO:

To achieve and maintain their high performance, star performers do different things and do things differently. Here is what researches say about high performers who take initiative.

Star performers identify the challenges that need to be dealt with and take action

Star performers focus on the processes and how's to get better

Star performers help the team achieve its goals

Star performers prepare rigorously prior to any performance

Star performers meet the demands of the task/situation

Star performers prepare their pre-work preparation

Star performers set and objectives after each performance

Star performers have high self efficacy

Star performers take initiative to make things happen

NOTES:



Smart How-To Tips: The 9 Strategies on How to Be a Star Performer at Work

“The stars we studied are not geniuses...they are more like us than we care to realize. Almost everyone can be a star at something, and you can find the star within you.”

Here are the 9 work strategies, listed in order of importance, that can make you a star performer at work

1. **TAKE INITIATIVE** This is the number 1 quality that will help you stand out and succeed. Rise above and beyond work you are doing to contribute ideas and energy to help others.
2. **NETWORK** Reach out and make a point to build relationships with people who can make things happen and help you.
3. **MANAGE SELF** Work continuously on learning and developing your skills. Don't stand still. Continue to grow yourself.
4. **KEEP BIG PICTURE IN MIND** Do your job. Keep perspective on where work is going. Make sure your work fits the bigger picture of what is important.
5. **FOLLOW WELL** Check your ego. Work well with others.
6. **BE A GREAT TEAM MEMBER** Be there for your team and your team members. Contribute your ideas, information, advice and energy to you team members.
7. **LEAD WHERE YOU CAN** Be a small L leader. Offer to step up, lead and contribute wherever you can.
8. **GET ORGANIZATIONAL SMARTS** Take time to really learn 'how things are done around here'. Learn as much as you can about the organization's culture and how things work.
9. **SHOW AND TELL** Use your smart communication skills when you have to speak, meet or present.



Skill Practice: Rating and Strengthening Your Initiative

STEP 1: Read over these eight statements and:

1. Discuss what each means and how you feel about each one
2. Come up with personal examples or of people you know who demonstrated each of the behaviors.
3. Describe what specific actions you would have to take to demonstrate the behaviors for each of the 8 statements in the workplace
4. Select the 1 behavior that would make the most impact on you and your performance at work and life

1 = COMPLETELY NOT TRUE 2 = A LITTLE TRUE 3 = ABOUT 1/2 TRUE 4 = MOSTLY TRUE 5 = COMPLETELY TRUE

1. I go out of my way to help when others are in need	1	2	3	4	5
2. I demonstrate personal commitment to my initiatives, from start to finish	1	2	3	4	5
3. I look for opportunities and act on them	1	2	3	4	5
4. People know me as someone who takes initiative	1	2	3	4	5
5. I am not afraid to take responsibility above and beyond my job	1	2	3	4	5
6. I begin projects and follow through until completion	1	2	3	4	5
7. I always look for ways to make a positive difference to benefit others	1	2	3	4	5
8. While others may hold back, I take initiative	1	2	3	4	5
TOTAL					

STEP 2: Add up all your scores and multiply by 2.5. This equals your score out of 100.

MY SCORE _____ X 2.5 = _____

STEP 3: Discuss what each means and how you feel about each one.



Apply @ Work: Increase Your Initiative

Review the work you have completed on the 8 behaviours on the previous page. Identify the 3 actions you should take that would increase your initiative and your chances for success in finding work or improving your performance in the workplace.

1. Read over the 8 behaviors and describe what each one means in everyday life.

2. Select the one behavior to adopt that would make the most impact on you and your work.

3. List 3 actions you will take daily to increase your initiative.



Need to Know: How to Set Goals

One of the best ways to take initiative is to set goals, make plans and carry them out. Anyone can be more successful by setting goals. Goals are essential to getting to where you want to go. The more you spend time creating, crafting and clarifying your own goals, the more likely you will achieve the results you want.

“Success is more likely when you focus on the right details in the right way.”

SET DIRECTION

The first step in getting anywhere is to know where you want to go. The key to effective goals is not only the goals you set for yourself but, more importantly, how deliberately you set these goals:

- What do you want to accomplish – set difficult, challenging and specific goals
- How do you plan to get there – the tasks, steps, plans and milestones

HARD-NOTEASY- GOALS

The researchers on goal achievement found that people are more successful if they set very specific, difficult goals. Easy goals don't engage us and are quickly forgotten.

- The more specific your goal, the greater your focus and the less the distraction
- The more difficult your goal, the more it pushes you to increase your effort and commitment

Goal setting is hard work. It is a skill that will help you increase both your sense of control and your initiative. These are three keys to think about goals and goal setting:

THREE KEYS TO GOAL SUCCESS

1. **FOCUS ON THE WHY** –the ‘why’ is about what you want to accomplish and why it is important to you. Specify your own big why in setting your goals.
2. **FOCUS ON THE WHAT**- the ‘what’ is the clear description of what the goal is and what goal achievement looks like.
3. **FOCUS ON THE HOW** – the ‘how’ is all the nitty gritty ‘how to’ that describes in detail what you will actually do to achieve success. This is the real step-by-step plan of the specific steps you need to take to achieve success.

When you think about your goals, focus on the real ‘what and how ’ and the actual steps you have to take to achieve the goal.



Skill Practice: Goal Setting

Select 3 areas in your life where you want to learn more and achieve success. Select tasks or dreams that are important to you. Examples include – a project around the house, self improvement, finding a job or getting a better job....Sketch out the 3 aspects of each goal

GOAL 1

• The Why

• The What

• The Hows

GOAL 2

• The Why

• The What

• The Hows

GOAL 3

• The Why

• The What

• The Hows



Need to Know: The Types of Goals that Work Best

The most effective goals are mastery goals. These goals focus on getting better by developing your skills and abilities versus trying to prove something to someone else. Mastery goals are all about a commitment to continuous learning. They use the learner and growth mindsets.

Outcome Goals – these goals focus on the outcome – to win, to prove yourself and outperform others. Performance goals are usually fixed. You are out to prove yourself. They are all or nothing goals. You win or you lose. They use the Learner and Growth Mindsets.

Process Goals – these goals focus on achieving results through self-improvement. Mastery goals harness the experiences you have on the goal path to build skills, experience and knowledge, while you strive for success. These goals focus on continuous learning, growth and a genuine desire to get better. With mastery goals, you judge success based on progress and the process you follow vs. the final performance.

‘Get Better’ mastery goals are about striving. They build your resilience. They strengthen your initiative. They increase your sense of control. Get Better goals zero in on the ‘hows’ and the ‘whats’ you need to get better. When your goal is to get better, you tend to enjoy the ride more and focus on the quality of experience and the nature of the journey instead of an all or nothing destination. You are more likely to ask for help when you need it. Get Better goals often end up with greater performance. When you focus on getting better, you are in the growth mindset so you rarely make the mistake of giving up too soon.

NOTES:



Smart How To's: Tips on Setting Goals

“By failing to prepare, you are preparing to fail.” Ben Franklin.

Goal setting uses all 4 dimensions of high performance thinking – your creativity to stretch yourself, your analytical skills to plan, your critical thinking and your values to make the right decisions and your spirit to aspire to greater things for yourself. Quality goal setting requires a lot of cool Yellow work – scanning, analyzing, thinking things through, organizing with precision, specificity and clarity. Here are 4 tips to guide you:

1. CHOOSE GOALS THAT NURTURE YOUR PERSONAL SPIRIT. Some goals are better than others because they nurture our human spirit and meet our deeper needs. Choose goals that build your competency and skills. Choose goals that increase your self-direction and autonomy and reduce your dependence. Choose goals that expand and improve your relationships.

2. CHOOSE INSIDE VERSUS OUTSIDE GOALS—choose goals that really will motivate you personally. Choose goals that meet your own inner motivational needs for competence, autonomy or relatedness. Avoid goals that only are there to meet other people's expectations.

3. BUILD IN “IF...THEN...” PLANS TO BOOST YOUR SUCCESS RATE.—when you set a goal, decide exactly when, where and how you will accomplish it. Plan ahead to deal with obstacles and the unexpected like “If ... happens, then I will...” Put a timeframe on it to focus your efforts to get things done and manage distractions.

4. DECIDE THE SPECIFIC ACTIONS YOU WILL TAKE. Be precise and clear and step by step in your plan. Decide what you will do, when you will do it and where.



Skill Practice: Set Fast Goals

Try out the My Fast Goals technique. Fast goals jump-start your initiative. A fast goal is quick and helps you focus your attention on getting one thing done quickly. Fast goals are goals in chunks. Ask yourself this simple goal setting question: “What is one thing I will accomplish and get done in the next 5 minutes? In the next 15 minutes? In the next hour” Set your fast goal around just one Red decision, one Yellow plan completed or one human connection, one set of Green options, one Personal Spirit boost. Try this out now.

MY FAST GOALS

What is one thing I will accomplish and get done in the next 5 minutes?

How to steps: _____

What is one thing I will accomplish and get done in the next 15 minutes?

How to steps: _____

What is one thing I will accomplish and get done in the next hour?

How to steps: _____



Skill Practice: Taking Initiative

Here are questions developed by Louisa Jewell, a Canadian leader in positive psychology. These questions will strengthen your self-efficacy and initiative.

PRACTICE: SOLUTIONS FOCUSED CONFIDENCE QUESTIONS

Work with a partner and interview each other

1. What is already going well for you? What successes have you had so far?

2. How can you do more of what is already going well?

3. How did you manage to get this far and what did you do?

4. What does that tell you about yourself?

5. Tell me about a time when you were successful?

6. What did you do then that made a difference?

7. What is one thing you did then you are not doing now?

8. What personal strengths or resources do you have that will help you be successful?

9. What ideas do you have for solving this or moving forward?

10. What's one small step that will move you forward?

11. Who can help you with this?

12. What's your next move?



Skill Practice: Goal Setting

PRACTICE: MAKE A SIMPLE GOAL PLAN

Start small and build a simple goal plan.

STEP 1 Write down a wish or concern about something you are thinking of doing or want to do

STEP 2 Describe a happy outcome or ending

STEP 3 Identify an obstacle

STEP 4 Identify a positive aspect (and be realistic)

STEP 5 Make a specific plan for the steps you will take to achieve your goal

- Decide what specific things or actions you will do – be clear and precise so you will know exactly what is to be accomplished or carried out.

-
- Decide when and where and how you will do this. Be as specific as possible to help your brain program itself for success. “I will do this at this time and in this way.”

-
- Formulate an if this/then this plan for dealing with obstacles – be as specific as possible to deal effectively with situations and obstacles that can turn up – “if this happens, then I will...”
-

STEP 6 Write these simple plans down in a notebook.



Smart How-To Tips: How to Increase Your Value to Your Employer

Star performers think smart and work smarter. Here are seven ways star performers make a difference.

1. DO YOUR JOB WELL – the better you perform, the more people will recognize the value of your work.
2. FIND WAYS TO SAVE MONEY - look for simple ways to reduce costs or increase revenues in the organization.
3. DEMONSTRATE YOUR PERSONAL COMMITMENT – bring your spirit, show up, get things done and follow through on your commitments everyday.
4. STRETCH AND GROW – focus on increasing your versatility and adaptability so your employer knows you can contribute in more than one way.
5. CHOOSE TO WORK ON PROJECTS THAT BENEFIT OTHERS – volunteer to work on projects that benefit the organization, its customers, the community.
6. REFRAME PROBLEMS INTO OPPORTUNITIES – actively find ways to turn problems into possibilities and opportunities. Do something to move things forward.

NOTES:



Apply @ Work: Looking for Great People

“If you were starting a new company and could hire only five workers, what skills and behaviors would you look for in hiring these people?”

1. KEY SKILL:

2. KEY SKILL:

3. KEY SKILL:

4. KEY SKILL:

5. KEY SKILL:



Smart How To's: Get Smarter Goal Planner

Here is another excellent goal planner Use this 7 step goal planner to think through, plan and set your larger life and career goals.

STEP 1: THE BIG WHY: DESCRIBE THE CRUX OF YOUR SITUATION

1. Ask why do you want to do this exercise and what is the future you want
2. Identify the key challenges to address – health, family, work, growth, life...
3. Decide the 3 most important criteria to assess each goal on

STEP 2: MY BIG GOALS: PICK GOALS THAT MATTER MOST

1. Envision the key goal areas that will energize and motivate you the most
2. Select the goals that are most critical and important to deal with your Big Whys

STEP 3: PICTURE SUCCESS: WRITE EACH GOAL AS CLEARLY DEFINED ACCOMPLISHMENTS

1. Write your goals for each as if they are achieved
2. Define each one in deliberate detail to describe what is in place in the future
3. Use positive language to describe how the goal achievements add to your life

STEP 4: REALITY CHECK: TEST IT WITH YOURSELF AND TRUSTED FRIENDS

1. Write it down and check it for inspiration, stretch and relevance to you
2. Show the from/to shift – the core shift from what you do now and how you spend your time- to - what you will do differently and where to put your focus
3. Talk it over with others who appreciate you and whose views you value

STEP 5: EXECUTION PLAN 1: THINK IT THROUGH

1. Think creatively about different ideas and strategies to achieve each goal
 - Envision different pathways. Ask 'what if' to stretch yourself
 - Challenge existing assumptions – ask why and why not do this or that
 - Reframe your challenges into constructive opportunities
 - Brainstorm a lot of options to choose from, before you make a choice
2. Select the best steps to get you there. Use the 3 criteria from Step 1 to validate your plan.
3. Make a detailed list of the actual steps needed to accomplish each goal
4. Rehearse what you need to do differently to get there – list the actual steps and the key actions needed to execute the strategies and what you will do when problems crop up

STEP 6: EXECUTION PLAN 2: MAKE HOW, WHEN, WHERE AND WHO PLANS

1. Make your When/Where plans for each day, each week, each month – make simple daily and weekly lists of the tasks you commit to and need to accomplish
2. Make Your When/Where Eliminate Distraction plan – what you will do to stay on track and get back on track when distractions pop up

STEP 7: TRACK PROGRESS: SELECT A WAY TO RECORD YOUR ACTIVITIES

1. Select your own Tracking device - use a simple notebook, a journal or online tools to track your progress
2. Select ways to celebrate success and reward yourself as you make progress!



Practice Skill : 7 Step Get Smart Goal Planner

STEP 1: THE BIG WHY

DESCRIBE THE CRUX OF YOUR SITUATION:

1. Why do you want to do this exercise and what is the future you want?

2. Identify the key challenges you want to address - health, family, work, growth, life...

3. Select the 3 most important criteria to assess each goal - importance, time, money, effort, impact on life.

STEP 2: MY BIG GOALS

PICK GOALS THAT MATTER MOST

1. Envision the key goal areas that will energize and motivate you the most.

2. Select 2 target goals that are important to deal with your Big Whys.

STEP 3: PICTURE SUCCESS

WRITE EACH GOAL AS CLEARLY DEFINED ACCOMPLISHMENTS

1. Describe the target outcome for each goal as if it was already achieved.

2. Describe in detail what is different and in place in the future.

3. Describe the benefit of each goal achievement

GOAL SUCCESS OUTCOMES AND DETAILS	BENEFITS OF GOAL ACHIEVEMENT

STEP 4: REALITY CHECK

TEST IT WITH YOURSELF AND TRUSTED FRIENDS

1. Identify the key opportunities and obstacles for each goal

KEY OPPORTUNITIES	KEY OBSTACLES

2. Describe the from/to shift - the core shift from what you do now and how you spend your time - to - what you will do differently and where to put your focus.

FROM	TO

3. Talk it over with others who appreciate you and whose views you value.

STEP 5: EXECUTION PLAN 1

THINK IT THROUGH

1. Think creatively about different pathways and strategies to achieve each goal.

- Envision different pathways. Ask 'what if' to stretch yourself
- Challenge existing assumptions - ask why and why not do this or that
- Reframe your challenges into constructive opportunities
- Brainstorm a lot of options to choose from, before you make a choice

2. Select the 3 best fit steps to get you moving forward.

3. Make a list of the actual tasks needed to accomplish each goal

STEP 6: EXECUTION PLAN 2

MAKE HOW, WHEN, WHERE AND WHO PLANS

1. Decide on a format for recording your When/Where plans of the tasks for each day, each week, each month

2. Make Your Eliminate Distractions plan - what you will do to stay on track and get back on track when distractions pop up

3. Mentally rehearse what you need to do differently to get there - list the actual steps and the key actions needed to execute the strategies

STEP : TRACK PROGRESS

SELECT A WAY TO RECORD YOUR ACTIVITIES

1. Select your own Tracking device - use a simple notebook, a journal or online tools to track your progress

2. Select ways to celebrate success and reward yourself as you make progress!



Apply @ Work: Coach Each Other on Goals and Initiative

Work in pairs or teams to coach, analyze, evaluate and improve each other's goals plan.

ALL ABOUT YOU

As you complete this program, you will have a unique passport to success in the 21st century. Anywhere you go, you will know how to think better. You will know how to solve problems faster. You will be able to communicate and collaborate with others. You will have a stronger personal spirit. You will have the skills to work smarter. These smart skills will be your inside edge to face difficulties, overcome challenges and make the most of your opportunities.

You are already smart. Your 4D-i helps you know more about how you are smart, in your own unique way. Appreciate this. Celebrate what you learn about yourself. The good news is that we can all get smarter. Brains can change and grow. Grow yourself. Be more adaptable. Work on your game. Choose to practice, practice, practice. Put in the effort. Over and over. This is your opportunity. You are in charge.

We are all wired to keep growing and get better. Continue to build your skills in all 4 dimensions.

- Go green – to expand your skills in how to generate more creative ideas
- Slow in yellow – to deepen your skills in how to analyze and organize information and connect better with others
- Get to red – to sharpen your critical thinking skills and make smarter decisions
- Ignite your white – to tap into the power of your personal spirit to appreciate, persevere and initiate.

Support, encourage and help others to get ahead. Reach out. Teach others how to use the traffic light model to shift their thinking. Help them get better results too. Make your mark. Help us all build a smarter, better world.

ABOUT SMARTSKILLS®

Thinking is the core competency for the 21st century. SmartSkills was developed by Bob Wiele and his team at OneSmartWorld. The SmartSkills advantage is its one integrated platform to deliver five essential 21st century skills. It is like having a 4 wheel all terrain vehicle for your mind. SmartSkills is a system of thinking skills, strategies and thinking processes to help people think better, work smarter and get better results. The five skills are thinking, problem solving, communications in speaking and writing, collaborative teamwork and resilience in personal spirit. SmartSkills was designed as an educational innovation to implement the work of the Partnership for 21st Century Skills, the government of Canada's essential skills and the insights of many educational thought leaders. The SmartSkills system has been adopted by many progressive businesses, government workforce development programs and educational institutions.

ABOUT BOB WIELE

Bob Wiele, founder and President of OneSmartWorld, is a relentless innovator committed to help make the world a smarter, better place. His focus is on developing practical tools for individuals, organizations and nations to harness their brainpower, as their key to success in the 21st century. Bob and his team have built powerful thinking skills tools like the 4D-i and the SmartSkills system. He has a BA from McGill, a Master's degree in adult education from the University of Toronto and over 40 years of learning from his mistakes, ventures and efforts. Bob the author of a number of programs, books and papers. He has a great family and lives happily with Mandy in Collingwood, Ontario, Canada. Bob is still working hard to find new ways to get a little bit smarter every day.

NOTES:

Thinking and
Problem Solving

Igniting
Personal
Spirit

Communicating



Writing

Working with
Others

THE 21ST CENTURY SKILLS CHALLENGE

"To succeed in our fast changing world, we all need to become more versatile, agile and adaptable. We need to acquire a new set of 21st century 'smart skills'. These skills empower us to improve how we think, problem solve and become great collaborative teammates."
– Bob Wiele, Founder, OneSmartWorld

THE 5 SMART SKILLS PROGRAM

1. Thinking and Problem Solving
2. Igniting Personal Spirit
3. Speaking, Presenting and Communicating
4. Writing to Record, Report and Persuade
5. Working Collaboratively with Others

The 4D-i[®] Story

The Why, What, Who and How

eDevelopment of the 4 Dimensions Inventory
and Toolkit to Build Skills in
inking, Problem Solving and Collaboration
for Business, Education and Life

The 4D-i Story

The 4D-i®, or 4 Dimensions Inventory, is an online thinking style preferences psychometric questionnaire, first developed in 2000-2001, as an assessment for learning. It assesses preferences for using 4 essential dimensions of total intelligence – creativity, understanding, decision-making and personal spirit. The original construct of total intelligence, developed by Bob Wiele, brought together three layers of intelligence into one integrated framework – cognitive thinking strategies or mind, emotional thinking strategies or heart and personal spirit strategies or resilience. The 4D-i integrates 11 cognitive strategies, with 7 emotional strategies and 3 strategies in personal spirit, into one conceptual framework.

The 4D-i instrument is organized into two sections. The first measures individual preferences for the use of each of the 18 cognitive and emotional strategies within the first three dimensions. This section of the 4D-i contains 45-paired choices, organized into nine clusters of different scenarios. Five clusters focus on personal situations, two focus on inter-personal situations and two focus on group settings. The second section of the 4D-i contains 24 self-rating statements to determine levels of personal spirit. The 4D-i produces results based on a normative database, as described below, in five levels of preference – low, low average, average, high average and high. Both high and low results represent one standard deviation from the norm.

Each of the first 3 dimensions in the total intelligence model is colour coded. It utilizes a traffic light as a mnemonic device in order to make the system and language easier to remember and use in every day life. Red is the color for decision-making. It signifies a preference for and a shift in thinking to stop and decide. Yellow is the color for understanding. It signifies a preference for and a shift in thinking to slow down and understand. Green is the color for creativity. It signifies a preference for and a shift in thinking to go and create. White is the color for personal spirit. It signifies a preference for and a shift to positivity and self-control.

The Four Uses of the 4D-i Elements

Each dimension, mindset and strategy in total intelligence is designed to have four core applications.

The first application is measured by the 4D-i instrument and shows the user's thinking style preference. It highlights the specific dimensions, mindsets and strategies that the user prefers or does not prefer to use.

The second application of the system is as a portfolio of 21 essential skills needed for higher order thinking and working, problem solving and collaboration. These skills can all be learned and mastered, regardless of one's preference. The 4D-i empowers people with information and coaching advice to increase creativity, deepen understanding,

improve decision-making and strengthen person spirit. This second application goes beyond typical strengths type indicators to encourage people to build additional foundational competencies to improve their results.

The third application describes each dimension, mindset or strategy as a specific and unique state of mind. Each state of mind produces different results – ideas from green creativity, analysis and compassion from yellow understanding, arguments and conclusions from red decision-making. Individuals and teams can use the language to direct the personal and collective shift into different states of mind to match their thinking with the demands of a task or needs of a person. The common language makes it easier for two or more people to redirect attention and align their thinking to get on to the same page, to work on a task.

The fourth application uses each dimension, mindset or strategy as a building block to design specific outcome based thinking processes. These can be used for both simple and complex tasks. This application produces superior results by using carefully designed color-coded, sequential thinking processes, called smart tracks, to achieve an outcome.

Background

In 2000, Bob Wiele, B.A., M.Ed. (McGill, University of Toronto), founded OneSmartWorld® Inc. The overall purpose was to improve the quality of thinking, problem solving and collaboration, in business and education, around the world. The task was to design and develop a 21st century system and toolkit to help people and teams master different thinking skills to empower them to deal with the rapid changes and uncertainties in the 21st century.

There were five key development challenges to address.

The first challenge was to develop a new precision thinking skills framework that integrated cognitive and emotional intelligence with resilience into one model. The fundamental intent was to identify discrete and learnable thinking skills, that anyone could use and master. This resulted in the identification of the four dimensions of high performance thinking and 21 core thinking strategies.

The second challenge was to build a scientific, research-based psychometric instrument. The objective was to develop a method and model to measure people's preferences in the use of these thinking strategies. The instrument was developed in 2000 and 2001, using test-working titles including 3SI, 3Qi and 4D-i. The 4D-i is the 4 dimensions inventory. It also refers to the 4 dimensions of total intelligence.

The third challenge was to design specific learning tools for personal skills development in all 4 dimensions and strategies as mapped out in the 4D-i. The 4D-i as an assessment for learning, by building an online interactive application of the psychometric that

people could use to identify their thinking style preferences, as well as to identify which thinking skills they could also develop to improve their competencies and results.

The fourth challenge was to design a simple common visual process language for thinking. The thinking design approach used the color coded visual language and strategies to formulate different 'smart track' processes to achieve outcomes. This would help individuals and teams more easily decide which type of thinking was needed for a particular task or situation and shift into that mindset. This would enable diverse groups of people to come together more quickly and to shift their collective thinking in a deliberate way, phase by phase, to think through complex issues together.

The fifth challenge was to produce learning materials and programs that individuals and groups could use to build skills in all 4 dimensions, 7 mindsets and 21 strategies of total intelligence, based on their results in the 4D-i.

The Conceptual Framework for Total Intelligence and the 4D-i

The 4D-i was constructed on the total intelligence conceptual framework of 4 dimensions, seven mindsets and 21 strategies of high performance thinking, and personal spirit. The first 3 dimensions of the model, creativity, understanding and decision making each have a cognitive or thinking mindset, and an emotional or feeling mindset. The thinking mindsets were named 'cool' to align with accessing and using more objective cognitive thinking strategies. The emotional mindsets were named 'warm' to align with accessing and using more subjective, sometimes intuitive emotional thinking strategies.

Creativity is the first dimension of total intelligence. It is visually represented by a green circle. It has six strategies. There are four strategies in the creative thinking or cool green mindset – brainstorm ideas, challenge assumptions, reframe problems into opportunities and envision possibilities. There are two emotional strategies in the creative intuition or warm green mindset – flow and flash of insight.

Understanding is the second dimension. It is visually represented by an inverted yellow triangle. It has six strategies. There are three strategies in analytical thinking or the cool yellow mindset – scan the situation, structure information and clarify understanding. There are three emotional strategies in the compassion or warm yellow mindset – tune in to feelings, empathize with others and express feelings.

Decision-making is the third dimension. It is visually represented by a red stop sign. It has six strategies. There are four strategies in the critical thinking or cool red mindset – get to the crux, conclude, validate the conclusion and rely on experience. There are two emotional strategies in the emotion-based decision-making or warm red mindsets – beliefs based/values driven and gut intuition/trust your heart.

Personal spirit is the fourth dimension and is visually represented by a white diamond. It has three strategies. These are named outlook, sense of control and initiative.

The model of total intelligence and the development of the 4D-i are described in Wiele's book, Smart for Life. It contains detailed descriptions and applications of the 4 dimensions, 7 mindsets and 21 strategies. More information on each mindset and strategy is embedded into the online 4D-i instrument's dashboard. It has four key functions. The first, My 4D-i, offers detailed descriptors of each of the mindsets and strategies and interpretive information on each person's results. The second function, Coach, offers personalized advice on how to capitalize on one's strongest preferences and recommendation on how to expand one's capabilities in all the mindsets and strategies. The third function, Portfolio, produces a 36 page individualized report that contains detailed graphs and summaries plus personal development planners. The fourth function, Search, is a talent management and human capital management system application to make everyone's thinking a resource to other team members...

The Sources for the Total Intelligence Construct and the 4D-i Instrument

For several decades, Wiele has conducted informal research and compiled data from ongoing review of the literature in brain development, thinking styles, psychology, learning, sport psychology, mental fitness and high performance thinking skills. Wiele's search for foundational thinking strategies to construct the total intelligence framework was inspired and informed by a wide range of thought leaders, authors and researchers in a variety of disciplines, including learning, brain development, education, psychology, leadership development and sport psychology.

Key sources for the development of the total intelligence framework included some of the following people: Robert Sternberg and his work on the three types of thinking in successful intelligence – practical, analytical and creative thinking¹ – and Jerry Rhodes' seminal work in the UK and Europe, on the three elements of effective intelligence - to judge, to describe and to realize. Rhodes stands as a significant pioneer in coding thinking skills with his identification, classification and organization of 'thunks', as specific conceptual tools that comprise his work in effective intelligence. Chogyam Trungpa, Geshe Michael Roach and other Buddhist teachers' writings provided insight and guidance on the importance of compassion, mindfulness and mental self-management. Mihaly Csikszentmihalyi's work on flow was vital in the development of the two strategies in creative intuition. The research and writings of Peter Salovey, John Mayer and Daniel Goleman were useful in applying and integrating elements of emotional intelligence in the 4D-i. Edward Russo and Paul Schoemaker's work on decision making, and Gary Klein's research on the use of gut intuition and deep experience in decision-making were useful in formulating some of the strategies in decision-making. Wiele researched other thought leaders' work on thinking dispositions, thinking styles and the elements of critical and creative thinking. Some of these included Robert Sternberg's work on thinking styles, David Perkins' identification of key thinking dispositions, John Clarke's Patterns of Thinking and Art Costa's Habits of Mind. Wiele's

five-year collaboration from 1986 to 1990 with the Canadian sport psychologist Peter Jensen²⁴ contributed to the understanding of the techniques required for developing mental fitness and harnessing high performance thinking under pressure.

The 4D-i is based on thinking skills and strategies, and not on personality traits or styles. It does not include any references to personality constructs.

The 4D-i was the first psychometric to incorporate a dimension on personal spirit. Personal spirit was built into the original 4D-i research in 2000 as a key factor in increasing resilience, health and human performance. Personal spirit is a construct that is aligned with a number of other psychological constructs, including Albert Bandura's self-efficacy, Salvatore Maddi and Suzanne Kobasa's research on hardiness at the University of Chicago, Martin Seligman's research on learned helplessness and optimism, Barbara Fredrickson's research on positivity, and the work on grit developed by Angela Lee Duckworth in 2007. The selection of initiative as a key factor in personal spirit was based on Robert Kelley's research on star performers at Bell Labs.

The evolution in the uses of the 4D-i has matched ongoing developments in brain-based learning, the uses of attention management to produce disciplined focus, and the emergence of intelligence as more personal, applied, adaptable and contextual, and not fixed or hardwired.

The Scientific Method and Research Team in the 4D-i Development Process

The formal research process to develop the 4D-i instrument was initiated in 2000. The first phase concluded in 2001. The early versions of the tool were code named the 3 Q-i based on the three layers of cognition, emotion and personal spirit that the 4D-i was based upon.

The scientific research team was made up of organizational psychologists from Jackson Leadership Systems, an Ontario based, global leadership development firm. Chuck Evans, Ph.D. was the lead researcher on the 4D-i project. Evans was assisted by Kim Snyder, Ph.D., Murray Stainton, Ph.D., and by Professor Kevin Kelloway, Ph.D., from St Mary's University. Dan Clements led the project team. Clements and Lynn Iles both contributed significantly to the research and conceptual design of the total intelligence model. Clements was instrumental in the design and development of the online interactivity in the 4D-i instrument. Evans' research team used accepted scientific research protocols to refine and validate the initial assessment test items, based on the 4 dimensions and the 21 strategies. Mandy St. Germaine and a group of colleagues from across North America, provided useful advice and critical feedback during the early phases and subsequent revisions, both to the development of the total intelligence platform and the content produced for the users of the 4D-i.

The 4D-i was designed to function as an 'assessment *for* learning', self-discovery and self-awareness. It was also designed to be an 'assessment *as* learning' to act as a

launching pad for people to acquire the fundamental rubric for a language for thinking. The 4D-i is designed to assess preferences and predispositions. It is not designed as an 'assessment of learning' or as an assessment of proficiency. The total intelligence framework is intended be used as a method to develop specific competencies in thinking skills and as a toolkit to use assess performance in thinking performance in different contexts.

The first version of the 4D-i was normed on a research population of approximately 1,000 working people from 11 countries. This research process refined the conceptual model of 7 mindsets and the clustering of the 21 strategies. A subsequent re-norming project in 2004 was based on the profile results of 8,000 people. A third norming project in 2008 used the 4D-i results of 25,000 people.

The 4D-i assessment produces online and print portfolio results that use a common, color-coded, symbol-based language to identify thinking styles. Edward de Bono also developed his six thinking hats as a color-coded language for thinking. The 4D-i assessment is used to enhance thinking skill development and as a framework to direct thinking efforts in everyday tasks such as self-management, planning, problem solving, decision'making, collaborating and innovating.

Applications and Uses in Business

A core intent of the 4D-i is to provide tools and skills to help people improve personal and professional effectiveness. The 4D-i empowers learners with increased self-understanding through the highlighting of individual thinking styles and preferences. It helps users learn a simple common language for everyday direction of their thinking. It is based on a set of skills and strategies that can be developed to achieve competency in all 4 dimensions.

The uses of the 4D-i are to provide a simple-to-learn conceptual framework for thinking, and to build explicit thinking skills for use in education, workforce development and business. The 4D-i 's uses are aligned with recent discoveries of neuro-plasticity and the brain's inherent potential for adaptation to both external and internal stimuli.

A critical use of the 4D-i is to empower the user to understand and harness the brain's potential for change. It is based on a 'know yourself' and 'grow yourself' approach. The 4D-i harnesses the individual's ability to grow and change his/her thinking. It is closely aligned with Carol Dweck's work on fixed vs. growth mindsets. The 4D-i provides information to 'know self' and specific coaching advice and tools to 'grow self' by expanding one's repertoire of thinking skills.

For business, the 4D-i was designed to address the shifts in the workplace and provide a common language and practical tools to help people understand their world better,

increase their versatility, harness cognitive style diversity, improve decision making and accelerate collaborative teamwork and innovation.

Highlights

In 2003, the 4D-i was rated as the number one leadership development instrument from a pool of 120 assessments from around the world, by an expert panel from Simon Fraser University, Camosun College and the University of Victoria. It was selected for the government of British Columbia's *Leading the Way* program to train over 6,000 managers and executives. The 4D-i has been selected by a wide range of institutions seeking new tools to develop leaders, build teams and support cultures of accelerated collaboration and talent optimization.

In 2004, the 4D-i was the first psychological assessment to be recognized and accepted by the government of Canada's Scientific Research and Experimental Development program. The 4D-i was classified as a scientific advance in measurement theory and practice.

In 2009, the use of the 4D-i and the OneSmartWorld system for accelerating collaboration and results in meetings produced a 558% ROI for a leading Canadian airline. This was documented *in Investing in People*, a formal three-year evaluation study, sponsored by the government of Canada, on the return on investment of corporate training. This result was the highest recorded ROI ever measured and achieved in a corporate training program.

Shell Canada used the 4D-i to map and tap their internal talent on a series of difficult issues and produced a \$40 million dollar return within six months. A large Canadian financial institution used the 4D-i and OneSmartWorld system to accelerate business results and produce new revenues in key financial markets. Organizations across North America use the 4D-i in leadership development programs, to reduce time wasted in meetings, and to accelerate collaborative teamwork and innovation.

The 4D-i in Education: Developing 21st Century Skills for Success

To meet the growing needs for 21st century skills in education, Wiele and his team created the SmartSkills® system, an application of total intelligence to education. The focus of 'smart skills' is on building higher order thinking skills using the 4D-i as a foundational 'assessment as learning'. The 4D-i is used as a portal for mastering higher order thinking and behavioural skills in critical, analytical and critical thinking, problem solving communication, collaborative teamwork and resilience.

The 4D-i has been selected in elementary schools, colleges and universities as a 21st century tool to differentiate instruction, by profiling how each learner likes to think and approach tasks. It helps learners increase their self-awareness and build self-efficacy by mastering all the strategies. It enables them to build appreciation for diversity in

thinking. It helps them develop skills in collaborative group work. Because thinking and language are at the foundation of all higher order skills, educational leaders use the SmartSkills as a unified platform to save time and money to deliver five of the higher order 21st century competencies viz. thinking skills – creative, analytical and critical thinking skills – problem-solving skills, inter-personal communication skills in speaking and writing, collaborative teamwork skills, and resilience.

Teachers and instructors use their student 4D-i results to differentiate instruction, to personalize learning and coach specific skill development in each learner, based on their 4D-I results. They use the common language and smart track thinking processes to improve individual student performance and group work. Academic leaders use the aggregate results of the 4D-i as advanced learner analytics to identify issues and design ways to improve results in key performance indicators such as retention, student success, academic achievement and employer satisfaction.

In 2010, a number of school jurisdictions and community colleges began introducing the 4D-i into courses and programs.

In 2012, a research project on 1000 at-risk learners in six learning centres at the Simcoe County District School Board in Ontario identified a pattern of a low preference for analytical thinking, which hampered their performance in school and life. Teachers developed specific curriculum interventions to build thinking skills in the three strategies of analytical thinking. This increased student performance and retention results.

In 2014, a research project at Centennial College, Scarborough, Ontario, found that students in a business course who showed a high preference for analytical thinking were most likely to achieve higher academic results.

In 2015, the government of Manitoba launched its Success @ Work: Thinking Skills for Today's Workplace, a five-module program for delivering the higher order essential skills. All of the modules are based on the common language, core strategies and processes in the total intelligence platform. In 2015, the 4D-i and the SmartSkills: 21st Century Skills for Career and Life Success was selected for the government of Ontario's youth job readiness program.

In 2016, the British Olympic Team's scientific support team adopted the 4D-I to build their team's collaborative skills for working together under pressure at the Rio 2016 Games.

In 2017, the 4D-I was rebuilt on the HTML5 platform to make it mobile-friendly and accessible on all platforms. The online Dashboard was redesigned to incorporate My Resources with a suite of PDF based downloadable workbooks and print materials and videos to make it a complete learning resource. Two new reports were developed. The 4D-I PDP/Professional Development Portfolio is a 24-page document with 7 Smart Tools

to enhance transfer and everyday use. The 4D-I SSB/Smart Skills Builder is a 12-page report for student and workforce development use.

The 4D-i ® is a registered trademark of OneSmartWorld Inc., a Canadian corporation based in Collingwood, Ontario, Canada.

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SMART FOR LIFE

Powerful Techniques
for Achieving Personal
Success and High
Performance

Bob Wiele



Smart For Life

Powerful Techniques for Achieving
Personal Success and High Performance

Bob Wiele

What People Are Saying About the 4D-i and OneSmartWorld

“The business opportunities that can be maximized from applying the 4D-i principles are unlimited. Sales people can approach calls more effectively and efficiently. Meetings are more focused and the participants more engaged. Communications planning and delivery are streamlined for maximum impact.”

Catherine Macdonald, Business Management Consultant

“Becoming a OneSmartWorld community has had a significant impact on leadership development in our school division. The introduction of a simple common language and the understanding and celebration of diverse ways of thinking as we problem solve has led to improved collaboration and synergistic solutions to the challenges that we face.”

Jim Gibbons, Superintendent of Schools, Chinook’s Edge School Division

“The 4D-i is pretty amazing. It is easy to use and the coaching tips are excellent. The 4D-i brings a different dimension to putting teams together and is ideal for multi-national companies.”

Brian Beiles, International Consultant

“The 4D-i provides a springboard into a wide range of business applications, that can be adapted to client needs by using the outstanding array of OneSmartWorld support materials.”

Colin Morrison, President, Business Fit Solutions Inc.

“Smart for Life is relevant to us all. It changes the way you think and work with your colleagues, your manager, your friends and your family. The material crosses all professions at every level. As a facilitator, I am thrilled to be helping make the world smarter, one class at a time.”

Melanie Dillon, President, Skills Quest

“The 4D-i is a quantum leap in reaching organizational potential and human relationship building. It shows you how to work smarter, not harder.”

Pat Boon-Anderson, School Principal

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To Bill Cassidy, Kay and Eric Wiele
for the joy and inspiration
you each gave me
while you were here

To Lisa, Matt and Jay
for the fearless ways you live your lives
and the never-ending joy you give me now

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Preface

I believe that people can achieve remarkable things if they can learn how to tap their full potential.

At OneSmartWorld, we are dedicated to helping people, teams and organizations accomplish their goals – better, faster and smarter. The *Smart for Life* program has a variety of new power tools for your mind, your heart and your spirit. You will be able to use them, everyday, to figure out how to deal with the increasingly complex challenges you face in work and in life.

Everything in the *Smart for Life* program is here to support you. Our universal color coded language is easy to learn and remember. The 4D-i online profile and personal coaching system is available to you, 24 hours a day, 7 days a week. This book, the bookmark and the electronic tools are all designed to support your application of the *Smart for Life* program in whatever you do.

As you begin to use the strategies and tools in the *Smart for Life* program, you will solve problems faster. You will improve the quality of your relationships with others. You will make better, smarter decisions. Tap into the deep wellsprings of your own personal spirit and you will achieve the success you want.

Do this and you are on your way to being smart for life.

Bob Wiele
Founder and President
OneSmartWorld

Acknowledgements

Smart for Life, OneSmartWorld and the 4D-i System for Success are built upon four foundation blocks:

The first foundation block is the work of many writers and researchers in the field of human performance improvement. They have influenced my thinking and writing in the development of the OneSmartWorld system and this book. I hope that our work makes a positive, constructive contribution to the field. See the Bibliography for a complete set of sources used in developing *Smart for Life*, the 4D-i and the OneSmartWorld system. I owe special thanks to the pioneering writings and work of three people – Jerry Rhodes, Robert Sternberg, and Chogyam Trungpa. Rhodes and Sternberg both delineated three primary types of thinking styles. Rhodes’ brilliant work on effective intelligence is the finest system I know for mapping the true landscape of the thinking mind at work. Robert Sternberg’s writings on intelligence, specifically *The Triarchic Mind* (1988) and *Successful Intelligence* (1996), refined the three domains of practical, analytical and creative intelligence. His work on thinking styles and IQ were particularly useful. To the late Chogyam Trungpa, I owe deep gratitude for explaining how the opportunity to express one’s personal spirit, fearlessness and compassion exist in every moment of our lives. His writings on training the mind and awakening the heart were extremely helpful.

The second foundation block was the extensive scientific research, data collection and analysis that were critical to the development of the 4D-i system. The 4D-i is based on beta testing of the instrument on 1300 people from 11 countries. The research project was conducted by Jackson Leadership Systems, a team of industrial and organizational psychologists. Their role in the development of the 4D-i and in the formation of our overall model of human performance was invaluable. Thanks to Chuck Evans, Ph.D. project leader, Kim Snyder, Ph.D., and Murray Stainton Ph.D. from Jackson Leadership Systems and to Kevin Kelloway Ph.D., professor of business at St. Mary’s University. Special thanks to Dave Jackson, Ph.D. for his sage counsel in the development of the role of the personal spirit dimension our model. Glen Clarke and his team at Echo Consultants designed and developed the interactive database and the team at Epiculture created the web interface. Thanks to Tara Pain Rowlands for the powerful design of our OneSmartWorld logo and to Holger Meiche for his professional excellence and commitment in the design of all our print materials.

The third foundation block was the ongoing dialogue and critical analysis from a remarkable group of friends, family, clients and colleagues who provided feedback as well as emotional support through many of the challenges we faced. These people were committed to our vision of building a world class, leading edge performance improvement solution. I am grateful to them for their support – Debra Amidon, Vince Battistelli, Paul Bonwick, Ron Bowen, Anne Cassidy, Jim and Myra Colby, Rudy De Paoli, Daniel Ferrari, Don Gallinger, Jim Gibbons, Dan Gordon, David Gouthro, Ramona Greer, Barry Halman, Lisa Kidd, Jack Kinch, Ray Latta, Ken MacKeracher, Candice Martin, Cam McConnell, Colin Morrison, Robert Neilson, Bob Nihill, Ron Percy, Cathie Potts, Steve Robinson, Penny Skelton, Ralph Turfus, Cathy and Steve Vaccaro, Rainer von Konigslow, Barbara Weider, Eric Wiele, Matt Wiele, Brenda and Bob Woodburn, Anne Marie Wright, and Gary Young.

The final and most important foundation block in developing this system was the contribution and personal spirit of two remarkable people, Dan Clements and Lynn Iles. Dan and Lynn worked as true team mates in the two years it took to develop the OneSmartWorld performance improvement solution. Dan's project leadership from the outset, his objectivity and sparkling green intelligence throughout the development process, contributed to the success of many of the essential aspects of OneSmartWorld. I am grateful to have had the opportunity to work with him. Lynn's systematic analysis, her diligence, insights and consummate writing skills were essential to the development of many aspects of the system and this book. Lynn's ability to take a concept and quickly turn it into sensible, understandable prose is remarkable. Dan and Lynn's friendship and contributions were significant every step of the way. Our collective ability to surmount an endless series of challenges and obstacles, by sitting down and trusting that we could always figure it out, was the best example I have ever experienced in truly putting intelligence to work.

Special thanks to Mandy Sweet Germaine for always being there with me, for her unfailing support and her consistently valuable insights and suggestions.

Bob Wiele

1. Smart For Life

1. Smart For Life



Introduction

Smart is all about making the most of what you have in the situations that you find yourself in.

People who are smart know how to:

- collect their thoughts under pressure
- find and organize the information they need
- pinpoint the real crux of any problem
- turn problems into opportunities
- generate many creative options and alternatives
- resist the impulse to act on their first thought
- ask questions that stimulate openness and inquiry
- maintain a cool head under pressure
- continue to stay open throughout a problem solving process
- build relationships with compassion and a warm heart
- trust their intuition
- take initiative
- make decisions wisely

Does that sound like what you are seeking? If you work on improving your thinking and emotional skills, you will improve your life. *It's really that simple!*

The bottom line is that the better you become at learning to manage your head and your heart, the better you will master life's challenges and the happier you will be. When you learn to think better, you will make fewer mistakes. When you learn to control your emotions better, you will improve your relationships. When you learn to work well under pressure, you will make wiser decisions. When you can consciously change how you think and change how you feel, you will change how you operate and improve the results you get.

Your Operating Style	Results You Get
Think Smarter	Make Fewer Mistakes
Control Emotions Better	Improve Relationships
Work Well Under Pressure	Solve Problems Faster, Make Wiser Decisions
Change Thoughts and Feelings	Change Results

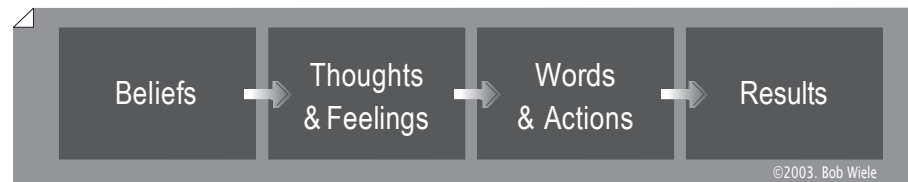
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Your Inside Edge

As the pace of life increases, there are more problems to deal with than ever before. The problems are more complex. To make things worse, problems come at us faster than ever. How are you going to deal with this pace and these complexities, now, and in the future?

Are you as smart as you need to be? What skills will you need to manage the problems of the future? What can you do to boost your capacity for better problem solving and decision-making? What tools will you need to be smart enough for the life ahead of you? How can you expand your repertoire of skills?

When there is so much going on, our brains feel overloaded. Stress takes its toll. You can't control everything that happens around you, but you can learn to control and harness your own internal resources to deal with the outside world.



William James, the pioneering American psychologist said:

"The greatest discovery of our generation is the discovery that human beings, by changing the inner attitudes of their minds, can change the outer aspects of their lives."

Smart for Life is about training the mind and the heart to respond more successfully to life's challenges. It's about finding your personal inside edge. You will get further, faster, if you develop your inner skills instead of just trying to control all aspects of your outer world.

Get Smart: 1 Profile, 2 Learn, 3 Apply

The *Smart for Life* system provides you with scientifically-based knowledge, practical tools and proven skills you can use every day to improve your results. This system is simple to learn and easy to use. It will help you to master your emotions, improve your thinking powers and boost your spirit.

Smart for Life blends three phases of learning to increase your retention of these powerful concepts and to apply what you learn in your everyday life. It incorporates the 4D-i online profiling instrument, with practical classroom training, as well as print and electronic tools to support your use of the system, at work and in all aspects of your life.

Phase 1: Profile – you complete the online 4D-i Profile, prior to the *Smart for Life* training program, to gain more self awareness and familiarize yourself with the system.

Phase 2: Learn Skills in the *Smart for Life* Training – increase understanding of your 4D-i results, build skills and make plans for applying what you have learned at work and at home.

Phase 3: Apply to Your Life – after the program is over, apply your new skills daily when you:

- Use your online 4D-i Profiler as your personal coach. It is available to you 24 hours a day, 7 days a week.
- Use the web-based electronic Smart Tools to help you manage your time and relationships more effectively.
- Use this book and the *Smart for Life* bookmark as reinforcement tools to help you work smarter and achieve greater success.

This *Smart for Life* book is designed as a companion piece to your 4D-i online profile. It has important information that is useful for gaining a deeper understanding of your 4D-i results. It also provides practical techniques for improving your performance in the areas that you are most committed to developing.

The book covers the following topics:

- One universal language for self awareness and collaboration
- The power of your personal operating style
- Four dimensions of high performance
- The 7 different mindsets and how to use each one to achieve better results
- How to use the 18 success strategies for putting your intelligence to work
- How to tap into the 3 key success factors in your personal spirit
- Typical mind traps and how to avoid them
- How to apply what you have learned – mindfulness and The Believe It To Achieve It Success Cycle

Use the book in conjunction with the bookmark. The *Smart for Life* bookmark is your portable job-aid that contains all the strategies and success factors for everyday reference.

Practice, Practice, Practice

There is an old story about a tourist in New York who wanted to visit Carnegie Hall, the famous concert auditorium. When the tourist asked a New Yorker, “How do I get to Carnegie Hall?” the New Yorker replied, “Practice, practice, practice.”

To be smart for life is all about having a wide range of skills and tools to draw upon when you have to figure things out. *Smart for Life* is a set of practices and strategies. Practices are what you do when you want to achieve a goal that is important to you. Practices are personal disciplines to follow in order to get the results you want. If your goal is to get fit for life, you train your body. If your goal is to be smart for life, then you train your mind, your heart and your spirit. Like other skills, you can improve these with everyday practice.

It's Up To You

Real change requires commitment. Quick fixes never work. Just as you can improve the power, flexibility and strength of your body through commitment to regular exercise, you can improve your success at relationships, decision-making and problem-solving with regular practice. Make this *Smart for Life* program your personal launching pad into self improvement.

Remember that you can consult your 4D-i results, anytime, anywhere with Internet access. Make sure you record your 4D-i OneSmartWorld log-in and password number in a safe place so you can revisit your profile at www.onesmartworld.com. You can return there again and again to check out the coaching tips, use the electronic Smart Tools and to e-mail your profile to a friend.

“Look. This is your world! It is your feast. You inherited this; you inherited these eyeballs; you inherited this world of color. Look at the greatness of the whole thing. Look! Don't hesitate – look! Open your eyes. Don't blink, and look, look, – look further.”

Chogyam Trungpa

“...intelligence is what you use when you don't know what to do. This captures the element of novelty, the coping and groping ability needed when there is no 'right answer', when business as usual isn't likely to suffice...”

William Calvin



2. Intelligence, Personal Operating Style & the 4D-i

2. Intelligence, Personal Operating Style & the 4D-i



Intelligence: What Is It?

Everyone wants to be smart. Most of us would probably like to be a bit smarter than we are. Research shows that most people do increase their intelligence, learning from their life experience, as they get older. While some skills may diminish, wisdom and knowledge increase with age.

Intelligence, as used in *Smart for Life*, has no relationship to IQ or intelligence quotient.

Many scholars have attempted to define intelligence. The best definitions are those that are grounded in everyday reality:

“Intelligence is what you need to use when you don’t know what to do.”

Jean Piaget

“Intelligence is the process of guessing well.”

William Calvin

“Intelligence is the process of mental self management.”

Robert Sternberg

Intelligence is “...*a potential for processing information in certain ways to solve problems or fashion products that are valued in a culture or community.*”

Howard Gardner

In a nutshell, a practical working definition of intelligence is:

Intelligence is what you need to use when you don’t know what to do next. It is what you use when you need to figure things out, to solve problems and to produce useful results for others. Intelligence involves being able to:

- learn from experience
- adapt to the environment you are in
- guide and direct your own thinking, in the moment, under pressure

Making the most of the intelligence you already have and acquiring any new skills that you need, is vital for anyone who is serious about being smart for life.

The Brain Power Poll

In informal surveys in meetings, in training sessions and in online polls, our company has asked thousands of people the following question:

“What percentage of your brain power (your experience, intelligence, education, motivation, knowledge, personal spirit) do you have an opportunity to use at work every day?”

We have done this survey time and time again in all types of organizations. We have done it at every level – with executives, managers, professionals, technical experts, customer service representatives, and others. We ask people not to comment on how busy they are. Most people are busy all the time. What we ask is how much of their intelligence they actually have the opportunity to use on a daily basis. In other words, regardless of what you have, how much are you really being called upon to use?

The overall average answer is 25 %. While the range is anywhere from 1% to 90%, the average is 25%. The answers reveal a picture of so many people working at a fraction of their capacity. This means that, on average, there is only a 25% ROI (return on the investment in intelligence) in the workplace. Imagine a hotel, a hospital, an airline, a company, an athlete or team working at 25% of their capacity. What a waste!

There is a tragic under-utilization of human capital in the workplace every day. The invisible cost of people working at a fraction of their potential is staggering. For the individual, it is a mind-numbing, spirit-killing cost. For organizations, it is a major root cause of under-performance on every indicator used to measure business results. For managers and leaders it is the next frontier – how best to map, tap and harness all their human capital to develop a sustainable, competitive advantage.

The big questions are: What do people do when they use their intelligence? How do people operate? What are the generic strategies that people use when they have to figure out what to do? How can you increase the percentage of brain power used on a daily basis? What can be done to help people and organizations realize their full potential? These are the questions that drove the development of the 4D-i and the *Smart for Life* program.

Mapping the Territory

Many outstanding writers and researchers have focused on different aspects of human performance. Some have looked exclusively at thinking. Some have focused their efforts primarily on the emotions. Other researchers have addressed the human spirit.

In the thinking field, authors like Edward de Bono, Ned Hermann, Jerry Rhodes and Robert Sternberg have done excellent work describing thinking styles and thinking skills. In the emotional area, Rueven Bar-On, Robert Cooper, Daniel Goleman, Esther Orioli, John Salovey and others have highlighted the role of emotional intelligence. Salvatore Maddi, Ken Pelletier, Martin Seligman and Chogyam Trungpa are among those who have explored the dynamics of the human spirit and how lifelong happiness and health are the result of conscious work on one's own inner world.

In creating the 4D-i and the *Smart for Life* program, the challenge was to put mind, heart and spirit into an all-in-one model of human performance. We wanted to develop a new, practical, easy-to-use system that connected three levels of human performance:

- 1) how people think – core strategies used in thinking processes
- 2) how people feel – core emotional strategies that people use
- 3) how people approach life – deep beliefs about operating in the world

The goal was twofold:

- first, to create a better way of understanding human behavior, based upon a set of strategies and success factors people actually use and;
- second, to develop practical tools people could use anytime, anywhere, with anyone, to achieve success

We envisioned a system that would equip everyone from students in school to people at work, from families to organizations and communities, with simple tools and processes they could use to achieve their goals.

Making the Case: The Science Behind *Smart for Life*

Our research set out to identify and then test the actual mental and emotional strategies people use in problem solving and decision-making. Jackson Leadership Systems, a professional team of industrial and organizational psychologists, was hired to conduct the empirical research and assist in the design of a preference

assessment instrument. The goal was to establish a core set of generic, learnable mental strategies that people could use on any problem, in any situation, with anyone. Like tools in a toolbox, these strategies could be selected at different phases of a task or problem. (For a more detailed description of the overall development process, see the Building the OneSmartWorld High Performance Business Solution at www.onesmartworld.com).

After a thorough review of the current literature and a survey of other training systems in the marketplace, the decision was made to use a four-dimensional model of human performance. The first three dimensions—creativity, understanding and decision-making—reflected some of the current research on types of thinking. Robert Sternberg, IBM Professor of Psychology and Education, Yale University, and Jerry Rhodes, an outstanding researcher and consultant in the UK, both identified three primary types of thinking that people do: creative thinking, analytical thinking and practical thinking. The fourth dimension, personal spirit, is the catalyst or force that energizes people to take initiative and be all they can be.

From there we decided to open up the emotional side of the three types of thinking. Thoughts and emotions are like two sides of the same coin. They operate closely together. You can't have one side without the other. Again, after an extensive review of various models and research in thinking styles and emotional intelligence, we identified over 100 different thinking and emotional skills. A set of 18 strategies was selected as essential for developing cognitive and emotional competency in creativity, understanding and decision-making.

There are obviously many different strategies and skills that other researchers have identified. Our goal was to focus on a set of core strategies and to make them easy-to-use on a daily basis.

The next task was to identify key aspects of personal spirit, the hard-to-define life force that high performers everywhere seem to radiate. Again, after extensive research, we isolated three key factors—outlook on life, sense of control and initiative.

Developing the 4D-i Instrument

There are many personality assessment instruments in the marketplace. Most personality profiles are helpful to the person who completes it. The *Myers-Briggs Type Indicator* or MBTI is the most well known. It has many variations like *True Colors* and *Insights*. These all focus on describing personality traits and characteristics.

Personality tends to be fixed. We wanted to create an all-in-one system that went beyond psychological type into personal and organizational improvement. We wanted to focus on how people actually operate. Our goal was to determine the core skills people can learn and use to achieve the success they want. The key was to answer the “so what?” questions: so what do I do with these scores? So what can I actually do with my profile results to improve my performance and increase my chances of success?

From the outset, the challenge was to develop a simple-to-use platform that could be adapted for use by everyone from secondary school students who are faced with difficult career choices to working people in all walks of life.

In 2000, the psychologists at Jackson Leadership Systems developed prototype versions of the 4D-i preference assessment instrument. They conducted focus group testing to determine the accuracy, simplicity and reliability of the instrument items.

In 2001, a beta test of the 4D-i instrument was conducted on-line with 1300 people from 11 different countries (over 90% of whom were from North America).

Survey Says

Some of the initial findings from the research study showed:

- a clear right brain—left brain orientation in the model. Left brain is the more rational, analytical and logical side. Right brain is more holistic, creative and non-linear
- intuition emerged as a subset of emotional strategies
- intuition has two core functions—generating spontaneous ideas and making decisions
- people make decisions three ways—use their critical thinking to determine the most logical, practical decision; use their values and beliefs to determine the right thing to do; and use their intuitive gut feelings to decide quickly
- compassion—is a very different way of developing understanding than analysis of information
- values driven decision-making is a unique, stand alone strategy than does not usually connect with any other strategy
- there are two clearly different access routes to creative ideas—creative thinking and creative intuition
- the 4D-i is gender free. There are no significant male-female differences in 4D-i scores

Once the results were reviewed, a number of significant changes were made to the original model to reflect accurately what the research showed regarding how people actually operate. The 18 core success strategies were re-organized into the emotional and cognitive aspects of the three primary dimensions of intelligence – creativity, understanding and decision-making. There were also a number of refinements and additions made to improve the 4D-i instrument. Test and re-test measures, conducted according to current research protocols, showed the overall high reliability of the 4D-i.

The 4D-i as Passport

The 4D-i is the passport into the OneSmartWorld system. It provides entry into a system of mindsets, strategies and success factors needed for effective communications, problem-solving and decision-making.

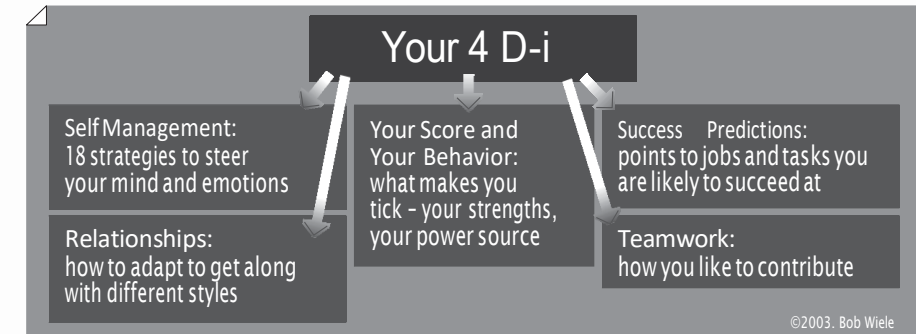
Your 4D-i scores are for you to see and use. You are free to e-mail your profile to anyone you want. Most groups and companies like to have people share their scores in order to build greater appreciation and acceptance of differences. This can accelerate the development of a more collaborative culture. In these organizations, the only data that is available online to others are the individual scores on overall preferences for creativity, understanding and decision-making. The details of your score will never be made available to others without your permission.

The 4D-i Reveals Your Personal Operating Style

When you put mind, heart and spirit together, you define a person's operating style – a multi-dimensional way of describing how the person likes to function.

How you operate is so important to your success. The 4D-i is a comprehensive map of how people with similar scores prefer to operate in the world. It identifies the strategies and success factors that you like to rely on to manage the people and the tasks you encounter. It gives you information on what likely motivates you and what frustrates you. The results can be used to help you pinpoint the type of tasks or jobs that best match your operating style.

Personal operating style affects your every action. When you effectively harness the full power of your mind, heart and spirit, you get your best results. When you don't, you make mistakes or get into unnecessary conflicts and can end up making poor decisions.



Your personal operating style contains the mental and emotional strategies that you use when you deal, moment to moment, with life. It is at the core of who you are, and why you do what you do.

Thinking and emotions are closely tied together. All thoughts have an emotion attached. All feelings have thoughts attached. When emotions run high, it is often difficult to think clearly without practical strategies and skills to fall back on. Learn to control your emotions and you improve your thinking under pressure. On the other hand, if you live in your head too much, it can create a real disconnect between yourself and others around you. Learn to listen to the wisdom of your emotions and you will make better friends and decisions.

In the 4D-i, your personal operating style is made up of the strategies you like to use to deal with life. The 4D-i profile shows how you prefer to make decisions, understand your world and how you prefer to generate ideas. It shows your preference for leading with your head (a cool/cognitive preference style) or your heart (a warm/emotional preference style). It depicts how intuitive you are in making decisions or in creating insights.

The map is not the territory – you are more than your 4D-i profile can ever show. No instrument can tell you everything you need or want to know about yourself. The 4D-i measures your personal operating style in four dimensions. It shows your preferences for the 18 success strategies and how you harness the 3 key success factors of personal spirit. You are much more than what your results show. The 4D-i is a map. It is not you. The map is only a picture of the landscape; it is not the actual landscape. It can not capture the fullness of the complex, dynamic, living person that is you. It is a map to gain greater understanding of yourself and a guide to where you want to go.

The 18 strategies and the 3 factors in personal spirit are your tools to be smart for life. Regardless of your personal profile, the strategies and factors are a lifetime toolkit for you to achieve success. As you learn to use each tool at the right time, you will increase your productivity and performance. Think of them as a set of mental tools for your mind, heart and spirit.

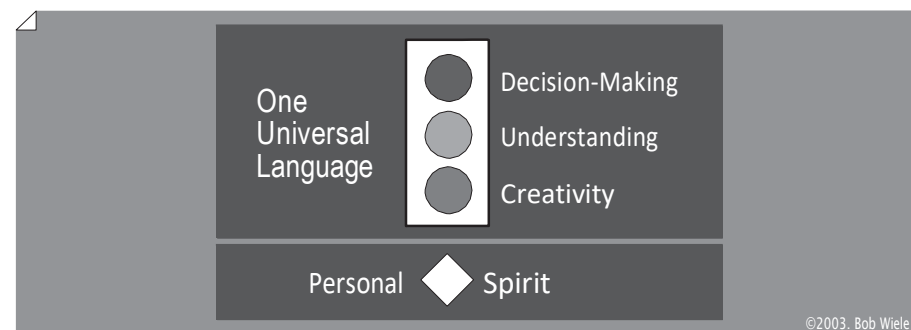
Managing your personal operating style is the key to success. As you gain life experience you learn to rely on habits that come naturally and that work well most of the time. But sometimes you feel that you could have done better, that you were misunderstood, or that things just didn't work out the way you had planned. When you truly know how your personal operating style leads to the results you get, then you can harness the full power of your mind, heart and spirit to improve your performance.

Choosing to leverage your strong preferences, or to expand your skill set, takes commitment, focus and practice. If you are 100% happy with the results you are getting now, then the 4D-i profile results will be interesting for you to understand more about what makes you tick. If you want to find ways of improving your performance, then the 4D-i will give you vital clues on what your strong preferences are, and how to work on your game.

A Universal Language of Colors and Symbols

In keeping with our goal to make a system that is simple to use and easy to remember, we developed a universal language of colors and shapes to depict the four dimensions.

Many other systems use colors to depict personality styles. Profile instruments such as, *Insights* and *True Colors* use various colors to depict personality style preferences. Other systems use colors to depict thinking styles. Edward de Bono's *Six Hats*, the *Hermann Brain Dominance Inventory*, and Jerry Rhodes' *Effective Intelligence* all use colors as a helpful way to depict different types of thinking.



Smart for Life uses a universal language of four colors and symbols, one for each dimension, to make the whole system easy to learn, remember and use.

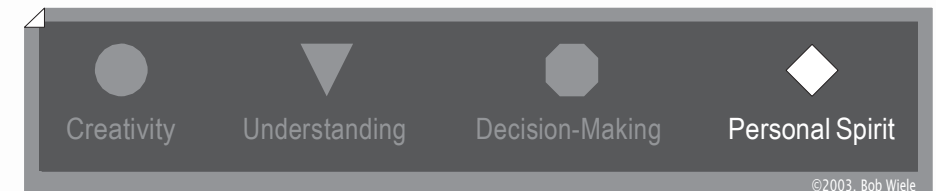
The three colors of a traffic light are the simple metaphor for the first three dimensions in the model. These are the three colors for describing how the mind and heart work.

The color red means to stop and decide. The red octagon stop sign is the symbol for decision-making.

The color yellow means to slow down and develop understanding of our world and compassion for the people we interact with. The inverted yellow triangle is the symbol for understanding.

The color green means go and create ideas, options and insights. The green circle is the symbol for creativity.

White is the color of personal spirit, a set of core beliefs and ways of operating in the world. The white diamond is the symbol for personal spirit. It represents the deep source of one's life view, courage, and commitment.



One Universal Language in Five Performance Settings

The intent behind OneSmartWorld is to help build a better, smarter world by creating an international standard with one universal language. The 4D-i profile is the passport to enter into a wide variety of applications. We did not want to build just another profiling tool. Our goal is to deliver a powerful, all-in-one, easy-to-use, management solution that people, teams and organizations will use to achieve success. A suite of electronic tools was built to support the successful attainment of these results.

The universal language is based upon how people operate. It acts as a simple bridge builder in relationships as well as an accelerator for improving business performance. The OneSmartWorld system can be scaled from one person, to a team, or to an entire organization.

There are five broad areas in which people need to operate competently. The OneSmartWorld system is designed to enable high performance and productivity in all five areas:

- 1) Self-management – this is the basic building block of the *Smart for Life* program. The 4D-i, the 18 strategies and the 3 key success factors are designed to help you improve your personal performance and productivity by learning to think better, operate more successfully and work smarter.
- 2) Interpersonal relationship management – the universal language and the seven mindsets provide you with ways to work smarter and better with others – connecting more effectively with co-workers, friends and family, in managing conflict, in customer relationship management, selling, making presentations and whenever you relate one to one.
- 3) Team and meeting management – you will save time and maximize the use of the brainpower in meetings by using the universal language and the problem-solving processes to get team work done faster and better.
- 4) Organizational human capital management – the results for the first three dimensions of creativity, understanding and decision-making from the 4D-i can go into your own organization's database. This allows you to put better teams together and access all the brainpower in the organization. It accelerates collaboration and innovation across divisions, departments and between levels in large organizations.
- 5) Task Analysis – analyze any job or task according to the type of work it requires. Select the person or team members who enjoy that type of work.

Self-management and achieving personal success is the focus of this *Smart for Life* book.

Looking At Your 4D-i Scores

All the scores in your 4D-i Profile are shown in percentiles. This allows you to compare yourself with how the rest of the world operates. The database averages are updated every time someone completes the 4D-i. Your own scores contribute to updating the 4D-i database.

In your 4D-i profile there are 5 levels of scoring:

- **high** – this puts your score in the top 16% of the population – in other words, you really like this dimension or strategy. Your high score is statistically significant, representing one standard deviation from the norm.

- **high average** – you prefer to use this somewhat more than most people do, in the 66% to 83% range.
- **average** – this means that your score is pretty much the same as the rest of the population – normal levels of use, around the 50th percentile.
- **low average** – this means that you prefer to use this dimension, strategy or factor somewhat less than most people do, in the 17% to 33% range.
- **low** – this puts your preference in the bottom 16% of the population. This shows that although you may be competent in this, you clearly do not prefer to use it when compared to the other choices in the 4D-i system. This low score is statistically significant. It represents one standard deviation from the norm.

Interpreting Your 4D-i Profile

Look at your scores with a positive outlook. Zero in on your high scores. These are your strongest preferences and give you a real indicator of the keys to your operating style. They show what you enjoy doing. Be aware that:

- Everyone gets 100% – there is no pass or fail
- There is no ideal profile or score
- No one type of profile is better than another
- No one can score high or low in all areas
- High scores are high preferences and strengths to build upon
- Low scores mean low preference, not low performance
- You can reframe low scores into opportunities for skill development
- All the strategies in the 4D-i can be learned and the 3 success factors in personal spirit can be strengthened
- To achieve high performance, find tasks that match your operating style
- To achieve high performance, find people who are high where you are low

You may be competent in all aspects that are measured in the 4D-i. Your scores show what people like you enjoy doing when planning, solving problems and making decisions.

Think about the work you do and how well it matches up with what the 4D-i shows you enjoy doing. The better the match, the more likely you will be happier and your performance will be high.

Since the 4D-i forces you to make choices, it is impossible to score high in everything, due to the way the instrument is constructed. Regardless of your scores, to be smart for life means gaining competence in all four dimensions of the 4D-i and in using all 18 strategies and 3 key factors to achieve success.

Cool, Warm, Balanced + A Color

When you get your overall 4D-i score on the screen, you will be Cool, Warm or Balanced + a color – Green, Yellow or Red. This means two different things.

First, it shows a key aspect of your operating style – your overall preference for using your head or your heart in dealing with life’s everyday challenges:

- *Cool* means you prefer using your head over your heart, thinking your way through issues more than listening to what your heart says.
- *Warm* means you prefer using your emotional side to figure out what to do – working with what your heart tells you, more than with what your head is telling you.
- *Balanced* means you have no distinct preference for one over the other and are equally comfortable with cognitive or emotional approaches.

Second, the + sign means that as well as having a preference for a Cool, Warm or Balanced approach, you also have a preference for another key part of your operating style, described as Green, Yellow or Red. This shows which of the first three dimensions in the 4D-i is your highest overall preference.

Green means you prefer to use creative approaches to deal with life.

Yellow means you prefer to develop understanding about what is going on.

Red means you prefer to make decisions.

Look at the three bars on the 4D-i dashboard. There may be only a few percentile points between your highest score and the second highest. The computer only reports on the highest, although you may prefer both dimensions almost equally.

The Graphs and Measures in the 4D-i Profile

Your 4D-i Profile measures your personal operating style in different ways:

Graph 1: Your Dominant Style (D1, D2, D3). Look at the first three color bars in your 4D-i Profiler. These three colors represent three primary ways or dimensions you prefer to use to achieve your goals – to generate ideas and insights (green); to develop understanding of situations and people (yellow) and to make decisions (red).

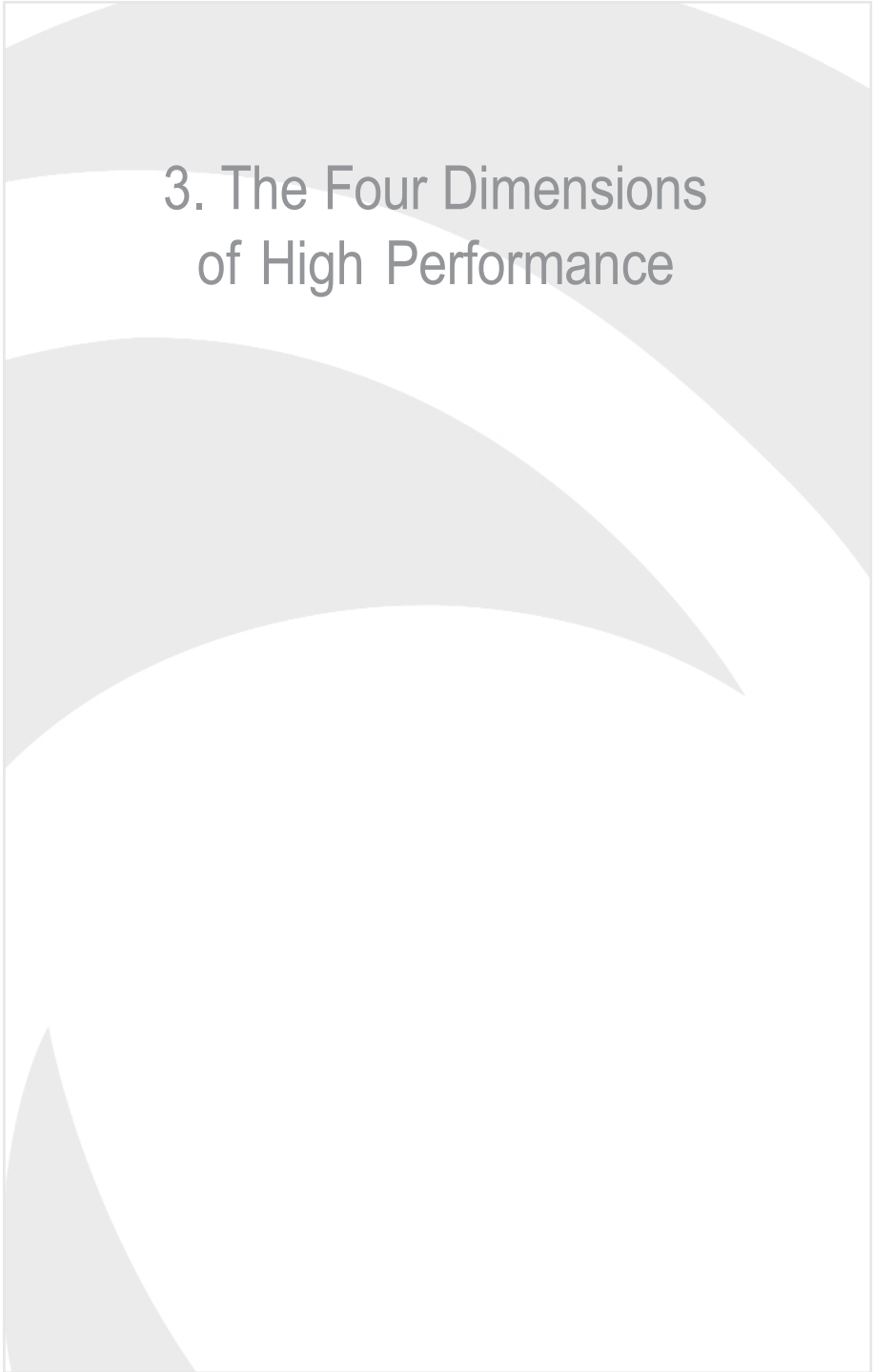
Graph 2: Your Personal Spirit Style (D4). The fourth dimension of high performance maps out your preference for three key success factors in harnessing your personal spirit – your overall Outlook on life, your overall Sense of Control over your life and your degree of Initiative. This fourth dimension of personal spirit is a measure of your personal power.

Graph 3: Your Cognitive - Emotional Style – Cool, Warm or Balanced. This graph gives you a rich understanding of your overall preference for using your head or your heart to address life’s challenges and tasks. A score of Cool refers to a having cool head. It means that you prefer to think through problems and use cognitive strategies more often. A score of Warm refers to a warm heart. It means that you prefer to listen to your heart and use emotional strategies more often. A score of Balanced means that you have an equal preference for each approach. Since there are 11 cognitive strategies and only 7 emotional ones, the scores are weighted to produce your overall preference for Cool or Warm.

Graph 4: Your Intuitive Style – This graph shows your overall preference for using three emotional strategies in intuition. Intuition has two key functions: one is for generating “Aha!” types of creative insights, and the second is to use your intuition to make quick decisions. A higher score in intuition simply means that you show a stronger preference for using intuition and a lower score shows that you prefer not to use it as much.

Graph 5: Your 18 Strategy Summary – This is a color-coded summary of the 18 strategies that make up the first three dimensions. It shows your specific scores in the 11 thinking and 7 emotional strategies. This 18-strategy graph illustrates the full range of the six strategies for being creative, the six strategies for achieving understanding and the six strategies for decision-making. All the 11 cognitive strategies are light colored (Cool) and are divided into 3 zones or types of thinking styles – creative thinking, analytical thinking and critical thinking. All the 7 emotional strategies are darker colored (Warm) and divided into 4 zones or types of emotional approaches – creative intuition, compassion and two emotion-based decision making strategies – values driven and trust your heart.

The next chapter of this book describes in detail the four dimensions of high performance.



3. The Four Dimensions of High Performance

3. The Four Dimensions of High Performance



In the *SmartforLife* system, there are four key dimensions or building blocks of high performance. These are creativity, understanding, decision-making and personal spirit. Together, they make up your personal operating style. This is the integrated profile of how you like to think, feel and tap into your spirit.

The four dimensions capture what you do when you need to use your intelligence to figure things out:

1. generate creative ideas and insights
2. understand the world and the people you encounter
3. make decisions
4. use your courage and personal spirit

The fourth dimension is a vital key to personal success.

As you will discover, we each need all four of these dimensions if we wish to reach our full potential. Each one of us may choose to operate differently. What links us together are the four dimensions that we all share, despite our differences in preferences.

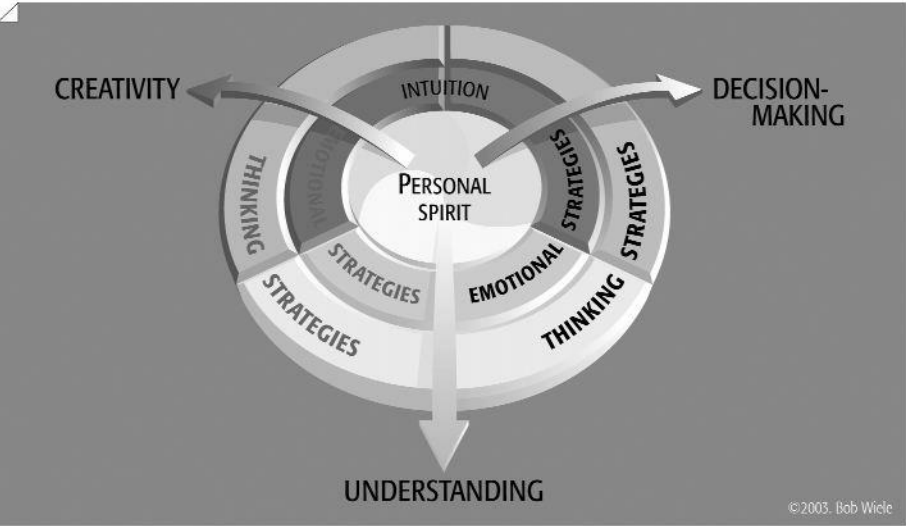
Mind, Heart and Spirit

The 4D-i model is based upon a simple replication of the way the brain works. The three layers represent mind, heart and spirit – your thinking, your feelings and your deep source of action.

The model is depicted by three concentric circles:

- Outer layer – representing the mind – that uses thinking strategies.
- Middle layer – representing the heart – that uses emotional strategies.
- Core – representing the spirit – that uses core beliefs as a power source for action.

The model, in a simple way, parallels how the human brain works. The outer layer, which wraps around the rest of the model, represents the thinking or cognitive aspects of our mind. In the brain, the outer layer is the cerebral cortex and contains the so-called higher order thinking functions of the mind. It is wrapped around the emotional brain, found in the middle layer.



Thoughts and feelings are inter-connected. All your thoughts have a feeling connected to them. All your feelings have thoughts connected to them. The top two layers work as an interactive system. It is hard to think well when your emotions flood your mind. Similarly, it is impossible to connect with people when you stifle and suppress your true feelings.

Thinking Strategies: Cool Head

This outer layer of thinking strategies is nicknamed the cool layer. It represents the importance of keeping a cool head to think well under pressure. In the outer layer, there are 11 thinking strategies for success:

- four for critical thinking
- three for analytical thinking
- four for creative thinking

The 4D-i Matrix		18 Strategies	
		11 Cognitive	7 Emotional
	Decision-Making	4	2
	Understanding	3	3
	Creativity	4	2
	Personal Spirit	Outlook, Sense of Control, Initiative	

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Emotional Strategies: Warm Heart

The middle layer of the model represents the feeling aspects of the emotional brain. This middle layer is made up of a set of emotional strategies, nicknamed the warm layer. It highlights the importance of having a warm heart when we operate in our daily lives. The middle layer represents the emotional domain of intelligence. It contains seven strategies. These seven strategies are the keys to emotional success:

- two for emotion-based decision-making
- three for developing compassionate understanding
- two for accessing creative intuitive insights

Intuition is a sub-set of the emotional layer. Notice how intuition sits in the middle layer, astride the green and red dimensions of the model. Intuition’s place emerged as one of the key findings in the 4D-i research. Intuition combines two core functions – the spontaneous generation of creative insights and the gut instinct used for rapid, emotion-based, decision-making.

Personal Spirit: Deep Spirit

At the core of the model is personal spirit. If thinking is the cool outer layer and emotions are in the warm, middle layer, personal spirit is deep in the core of who you are. Your personal spirit is a vital power source for your overall effectiveness. It

contains three, inter-related success factors that define how you see yourself and what your operating style is. These factors guide your behavior:

- *Outlook* is a measure of your overall outlook on life and how optimistically you approach life's challenges
- *Sense of control* illustrates the extent to which you feel like an actor or a spectator in your life
- *Initiative* shows how ready you are to make a difference by doing what needs to be done

Describing the Four Dimensions of High Performance

The 4D-i was developed to profile a person's operating style. The 4D-i is built upon four dimensions of high performance. It shows what your preferences are for each of the four. To achieve success and high performance, it is important to learn how to master all four dimensions and the strategies they contain.

D1: Creativity

Green is the color code for creativity. Creativity is an essential dimension of human performance. It is a vital part of your personal toolkit for life. Creativity in the 4D-i does not mean the production of world class, breakthrough ideas. In the context of the 4D-i and the *Smart for Life* program, creativity means the generation of a wide variety of options, ideas, alternatives and fresh ways of approaching difficult situations. The more you like to use creativity, the more options you will likely generate, and the more choices you have when you go to make a decision. The bottom line is that you will make better quality decisions the more ideas you have to choose from.

Using your creativity gives you options when you are trying to figure out how to juggle work, family, community and personal commitments. It is at the root of innovation. It is the source of fresh approaches to everyday challenges.

In the 4D-i model, there are two distinctly different paths to creative outputs.

Creative Thinking – Cool Green

The first pathway is creative thinking. This is a cognitive approach that uses a set of four creative thinking strategies. They are:

- 1) *brainstorm ideas*
- 2) *challenge assumptions*
- 3) *reframe problems into opportunities*
- 4) *envision possibilities*

These are active, conscious strategies used to develop the new ideas or options that you need to make a good decision. You can use these strategies on your own or in a group setting.

Creative Intuition – Warm Green

The second pathway to creative outputs is more emotionally based and is called creative intuition. It delivers spontaneous “Aha!” type of insights. These emerge, all of a sudden, from somewhere inside you. This pathway is more difficult to access because of all the noise in our lives. However, it is a powerful source for insights that lead to breakthroughs on problems. The insights cannot be predicted or planned. In creative thinking, you can brainstorm a list of 50 ways to lose weight or land new customers. With your creative intuition, new ideas or insights arrive suddenly, often without warning. The point is that you can't force intuitive insights. You can create the conditions for them to appear. The trick for you is to have your antenna up so you can notice these insights when they arrive and capture them before they disappear.

This second pathway uses two emotion-based strategies:

- 1) *go with the flow*
- 2) *flash of insight*

These two strategies often work together to produce ideas. The first one, go with the flow, is when you completely immerse yourself in a challenge or task. Out of nowhere, a spontaneous insight will arise. Sometimes the opposite tactic, leaving the task or challenge behind, is needed to get there. One friend says he likes to ‘soak’ on a problem for a day or two. Another says she goes for a run and during the run, her mind figures things out. A third friend says she'll ‘sleep on it’ and in the morning the answer will be there. However you get there, your creative intuition is a powerful source of insights and solutions.

D2: Understanding

Yellow is the color code for understanding. In this dimension, you achieve a sense of fulfillment by spending the time and effort needed to gain a complete understanding of the situation, problem or relationship that you are in. Understanding is useful in its own right. At the same time, this dimension is an essential element in the quest for better problem solving and decision-making. Understanding acts as a bridge and connector between the ideas and insights from green creativity and the drive to decision-making in red.

Understanding is deeper than knowledge. It goes beyond describing reality. It encompasses both cognitive and emotional ways of knowing. Understanding is the dimension that will give you a solid grasp of the facts, forces and feelings that are at play in everyday life. In this dimension, you stay open and aware, gathering information by using all your senses and your sensibilities. You refrain completely from judging. The intention is to ensure that you have what you need to map out the dynamics and factors in the situation.

There are two ways to gain understanding and six success strategies to master.

Analytical Thinking – Cool Yellow

The first pathway for gaining understanding is to use your head and harness your analytical thinking. The output of this mindset is a clear analysis and an understanding of the task or situation. The three thinking strategies to build understanding are:

- 1) *scan the situation*
- 2) *structure information*
- 3) *clarify understanding*

These three strategies, used together and often in a sequence, are designed to produce a well-organized grasp of the situation. They also deliver the breadth of understanding and the depth of clarity you need before you proceed to the next phase of problem solving or decision-making.

Compassion – Warm Yellow

The second pathway to understanding is through your heart. Compassion is the emotional side of understanding. It focuses on gaining a deep, empathetic understanding of the emotions and feelings that others are experiencing. To gain understanding through compassion, there are three specific emotional strategies:

- 1) *tune-in to feelings*
- 2) *empathize with others*
- 3) *express your feelings*

These strategies work together to build genuine rapport, understanding and a sense of caring for the other person.

In true compassion, you can use these three strategies at two levels – with others and with yourself. With compassion, you focus on what the other person is feeling. Sometimes you also may need to be more compassionate with yourself. Take time to tune-in to your own feelings as well as those of others.

D3: Decision-Making

Red is the color code for decision-making. This dimension is where all the creative ideas you generated in green and the in-depth understanding you have gained in yellow, can be used to make the best decision.

The research that we carried out in developing the 4D-i showed that there are three distinct ways in which people make decisions. They:

- use their critical thinking – what makes the most sense?
- use their personal values and beliefs – what do my values tell me to do?
- listen to their heart and their intuition – what does my gut tell me to do?

Each of the three ways works well on its own. The best approach is to use all three on important and complex issues. Do this and you will improve the quality of every decision that you make.

Critical Thinking – Cool Red

Critical thinking uses logic, argument and rational thought to come to a practical decision. Critical thinking relies on four cognitive strategies:

- 1) *get to the crux*
- 2) *conclude*
- 3) *validate the conclusion*
- 4) *rely on experience*

These four success strategies give you objectivity and clarity of thought under pressure. They keep you from getting too emotional. The four can be used over and over again to determine what the real problem is and then to arrive at a conclusion. When you have come to a conclusion, you can check out if it is the best one. Do this by looking back over your past experience in similar situations and asking tough questions to ensure the quality of the conclusion.

Emotion Based Decision-Making – Warm Red

Although many decisions are made by using your critical thinking, most of the important decisions also use emotions to guide decision-making.

The two emotion-based decision making strategies are:

- 1) *values driven*
- 2) *trust your heart*

Values Driven – Warm Red

This is a very powerful type of decision-making. It needs to be used with care. It is best employed as a deep, personal compass to guide you through a difficult issue. Your values are your guide when it comes time to decide. This strategy is often used to over-ride what the facts tell you or what makes sense. Instead you choose to rely on what your own deep values tell you to do. Used in isolation from the power of your critical thinking and from the power of your deeper intuition, it can be an ineffective, even dangerous strategy. Used in conjunction with critical thinking, values driven decision-making adds a compelling emotional basis for action.

Trust Your Heart – Warm Red

Trust your heart is the third type of decision-making strategy. It can be used in conjunction with critical thinking, with values driven, or on its own. Many of the worst decisions that are made occur when someone over-rides what their gut instinct tells them to do. Trust your heart gives you a quick, deep, intuitive sense of what the right thing to do is.

D4: Personal Spirit

White is the color for personal spirit. This fourth dimension is the deep source of your spirit, your commitment and courage. It is a central dimension of your own personal operating style. This is the dimension that gives people that certain special energy. It is a fearless drive to make the world a better place. It is a commitment to help others. It is a positive force not to be overwhelmed by life but to transform adversities into constructive life lessons and actions.

This fourth dimension of the 4D-i model acts as the power switch deep inside you. This is your catalyst for action and impact. It contains three success factors:

Outlook: is your overall sense of realistic optimism and a deep belief that life and events will generally turn out for the best.

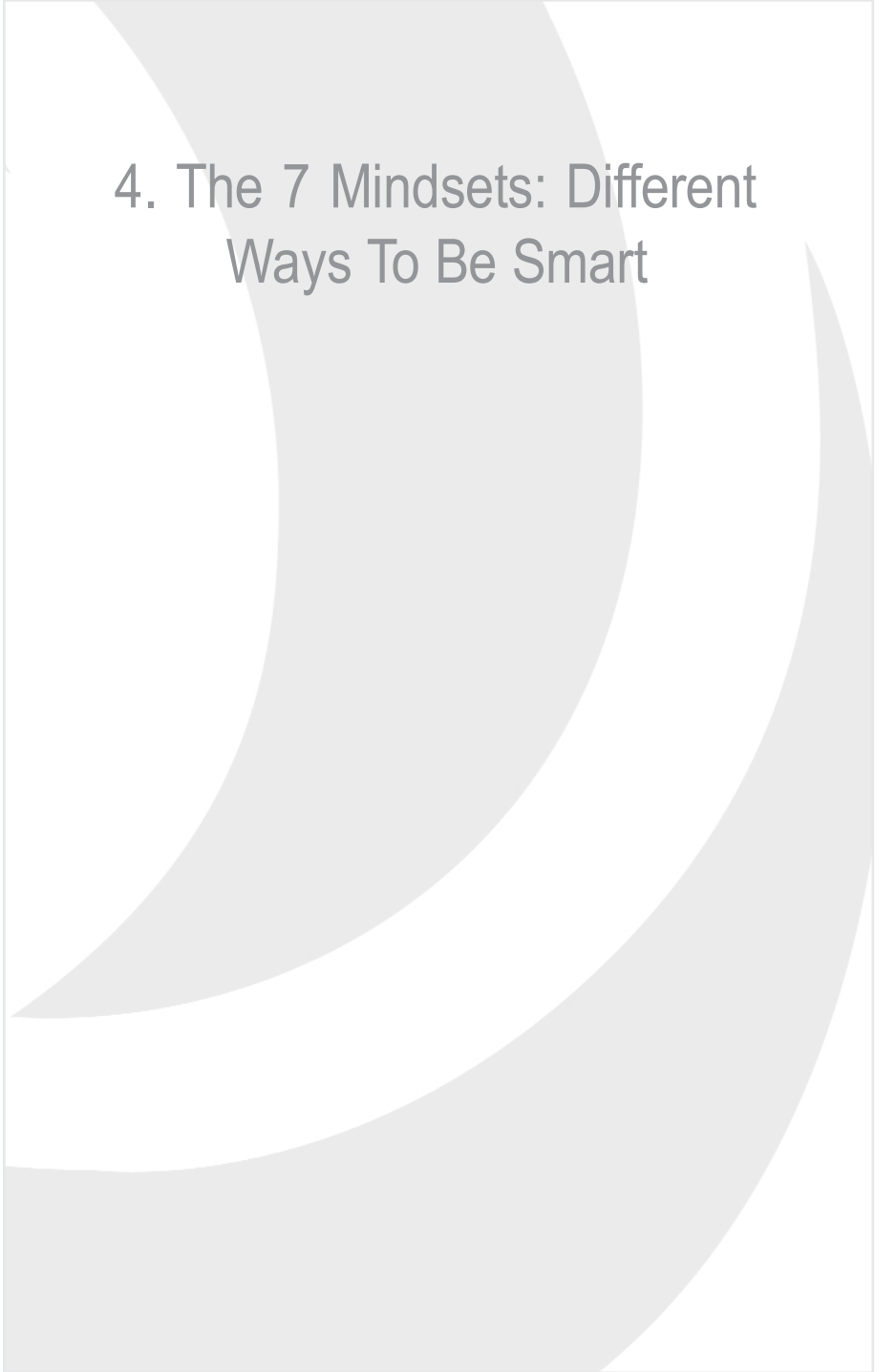
Sense of Control: is your overall sense of personal empowerment. It is about being able to make a useful impact and have influence on the events, the circumstances and the people around you, by using your will power and intelligence.

Initiative: is your overall commitment to making a difference, going the extra mile and doing what needs to be done. It means demonstrating a willingness to help others regardless of whether or not you are supposed to.

All three of these success factors are recurring themes in the study of healthy high performers everywhere. High performers tend to have a more positive outlook than others. It empowers them to use whatever life throws at them in a

constructive way. This positive outlook has an impact on their sense of control and vice versa. The greater the sense of control over life, the better the outlook about life in general. High performers take initiative. They don't wait for others to take the lead. They see what needs to be done and they do it. They see when others need help and they step up to take action.

The next chapter explores the seven mindsets of creativity, understanding and decision-making in more detail. Personal spirit is addressed in Chapter 6.



4. The 7 Mindsets: Different Ways To Be Smart

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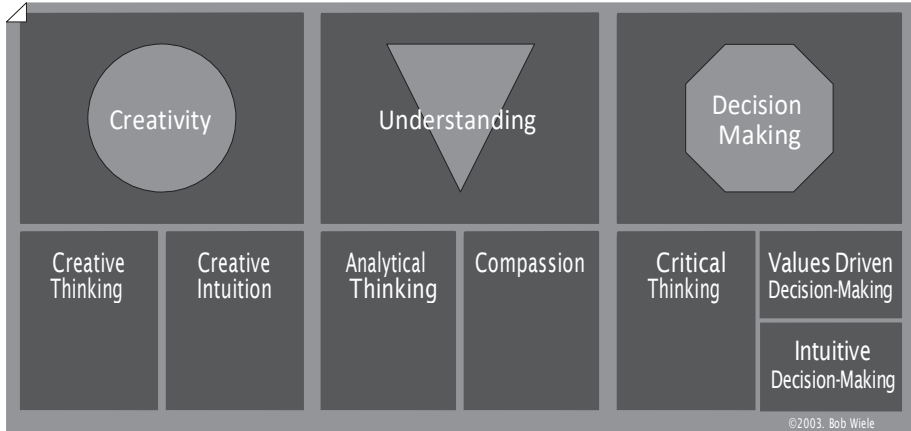
The 7 mindsets are seven different ways to be smart. Like sections for clubs in a golf bag, the more sections you can go to and the more clubs you can use well, the better your score will be. It is the same with using your head and your heart. The greater the range of behaviors you can draw from, the more successful you will be.

The 4D-i shows you which strategies and which mindsets you personally prefer. To be smart for life, it is better to learn how to use each of these 7 mindsets, regardless of whether you like them all or not. What the mindsets give you is a consistent set of approaches and a range of ways to adapt to the demands of different situations or people.

Just like you wouldn't use a knife to drink soup, you wouldn't expect to get creative ideas while you are arguing. *Smart for Life* is knowing how to match the right mindset to the task at hand.

The 7 Mindsets

There are three thinking mindsets and four emotional mindsets. Each of these mindsets can be learned. Once you have mastered them, you will have a set of essential life skills to solve any problem, anytime, with anyone.



The Three Thinking Mindsets – Cool Head

The three thinking mindsets are creative thinking (green), analytical thinking (yellow) and critical thinking (red). The distinguishing factor among all three is their focus on the use of cognitive or thinking strategies to figure out what to do. All three rely on staying emotionally distant from the problem. In these three mindsets, every issue can be resolved by thinking it through.

To be smart for life, you need to master the three thinking mindsets. You need to learn when to use each one and how to shift into and out of the mindset, depending on the type of task you have to accomplish.

Creative Thinking – Cool Green

The output of creative thinking is a wide variety of ideas, options, possibilities and alternatives. Ideas are brainstormed. Assumptions are challenged. Problems are turned into opportunities. Future possibilities are explored. This creative thinking mindset is characterized by enthusiasm, openness, a can-do attitude, a sense of fun and humor. Creative thinking is particularly useful to shift into when you:

- are at the beginning of a task
- run into a roadblock or obstacle
- are at a loss for what to do next
- are stuck in a rut and need fresh thinking
- need to shift from the past to future possibilities

Analytical Thinking – Cool Yellow

The output of analytical thinking is a clear, objective understanding of the situation or challenge you are dealing with. Information is gathered, analyzed, organized and clarified. The analytical mindset is characterized by a sense of calm, dispassion, objectivity, and systematic thoroughness. This mindset is particularly useful when you:

- need the facts
- need an in-depth understanding
- are disorganized and need some structure
- are putting a plan together
- are confused or feeling overwhelmed
- need to explain something very clearly to others

Critical Thinking – Cool Red

The output of critical thinking is a practical decision. This decision is based on a disciplined inquiry into what the real problem is. A conclusion to act is reached. The conclusion is validated through tough questioning. Finally by relying on one's past experience, you make the decision that makes the most sense. This mindset is characterized by objectivity, practicality, a push for closure, and a desire for a sensible, validated conclusion. This critical thinking mindset is particularly useful when you:

- have to make an objective decision
- have to determine what is the real issue before proceeding
- have to come up with proof for why you recommend a solution
- need to cope with tough questions from another person
- need to argue logically to convince others

The Four Emotional Mindsets – Warm Heart

In these four mindsets, an issue is not a problem to be solved by thinking it through. Rather, it is a set of mysteries that rely on the heart to provide guidance.

The four emotional mindsets are creative intuition, compassion and two emotionally based decision-making strategies—values driven and trust your heart. All four tap into the wisdom of the heart to produce their results. These mindsets require a subtle sensibility. They use a different type of attention than the thinking mindsets. They require a deep focus on one's inner feelings, intuition and emotions.

To be smart for life, you need to master the four emotional mindsets. You need to learn when to use each one and how to shift into and out of the mindset, depending on the type of task you have to accomplish.

Creative Intuition – Warm Green

The output of the creative intuitive mindset is a flash of insight or breakthrough “Aha!” type of solution. It requires engaging and getting into the flow state to produce an insight. While creative thinking is hard work, creative intuition is based upon getting into a receptive state of mind and trusting in one's internal creative workings to produce an insight. This creative intuitive mindset is particularly useful when you:

- are blocked in your thinking
- need fresh insights
- require a real shift in approach to get a better solution
- recognize that conventional approaches won't give you what you need
- really need a breakthrough

Compassion – Warm Yellow

The output of the compassionate mindset is a deep understanding and acceptance of the feelings and basic humanity of another person. The fulfillment one seeks in this mindset is the understanding that comes from an open heart. In compassion, what you strive for is a deep connection with the other person. This connection comes from unconditional acceptance and caring. There is no judging. There are no attempts at trying to solve anything. The compassionate mindset can also be directed to oneself – building a deep understanding, acceptance and caring for the current emotional realities you are experiencing. The compassionate mindset is particularly useful when you:

- need to connect deeply with another person
- are experiencing pain in a relationship
- are with someone who is struggling
- need an in-depth understanding of the other person's emotional state
- are experiencing conflict and want to get to the root of it

Values Driven Decision-Making – Warm Red

The output of values driven decision-making is a decision that feels right to you. This is an emotionally based decision that is in alignment with the values that you hold near and dear to your heart. This mindset is characterized by deep subjectivity. It is based on what feels right and good to you. It will disregard facts, arguments and what others believe in favor of your own strongly held values. This mindset is particularly useful when you:

- face a difficult dilemma and there is more than one workable solution
- want to convince others by using your own passionate commitment
- have an inner sense that a particular course of action is right
- know what you want regardless of other evidence and information
- want to use your values, as well as your critical thinking and trust your heart mindsets, to ensure the right, best decision

Intuition - Gateway to Insights and Gut Instincts

Thomas Stewart's article, *How to Think with Your Gut*, gives some compelling evidence on the value of intuition as both an idea generator (flash of insight) and as a source for rapid decision-making (trust your heart).

"What the science suggests is that intuition – or instinct, or hunch, or learning without awareness, or whatever you want to call it – is a real form of knowledge. It may be non-rational, ineffable, and not always easy to get in touch with, but it can process information on a more sophisticated level than most of us ever dreamed ... The practical implications of all this are profound. People who make decisions for a living are coming to realize that in complex or chaotic situations – a battlefield, a trading floor, or today's brutally competitive business environment – intuition usually beats rational analysis. And as science looks closer, it is coming to see that intuition is not a gift but a skill. And, like any skill, it's something you can learn."

He highlights the US Marine Corps official doctrine that reinforces the importance of intuition:

"The intuitive approach is more appropriate for the vast majority of decisions made in the field ... rapidly changing conditions of war when time and uncertainty are critical factors and creativity is a desirable trait."

Stewart, a distinguished writer on intellectual capital and business issues states:

"Situations in which rules supply all the answers are becoming an endangered species in business and everywhere else. Command and control management went out with tail fins. Risks are both greater and less predictable. As companies outsource, globalize, and form alliances, they become more inter-dependent. ... More and more, all you can do is admit that you simply don't know and go with your gut."

Intuitive Decision-Making – Warm Red

Intuition is a powerful source to tap into for rapid decision-making. The output of trust your heart decision-making is a decision that comes from your intuitive sense of what to do. It is more spontaneous and in the moment. It requires an openness and an ability to listen to your own inner wisdom. This mindset is like an internal tuning fork that you can consult when faced with tough choices. This trust your heart decision-making mindset is particularly useful when you:

- face a difficult dilemma and you need to act quickly
- have too many facts and you need to tap into your heart to guide you
- have an inner sense that a particular course of action is not quite right
- have to make a difficult decision and you want to ensure the right decision

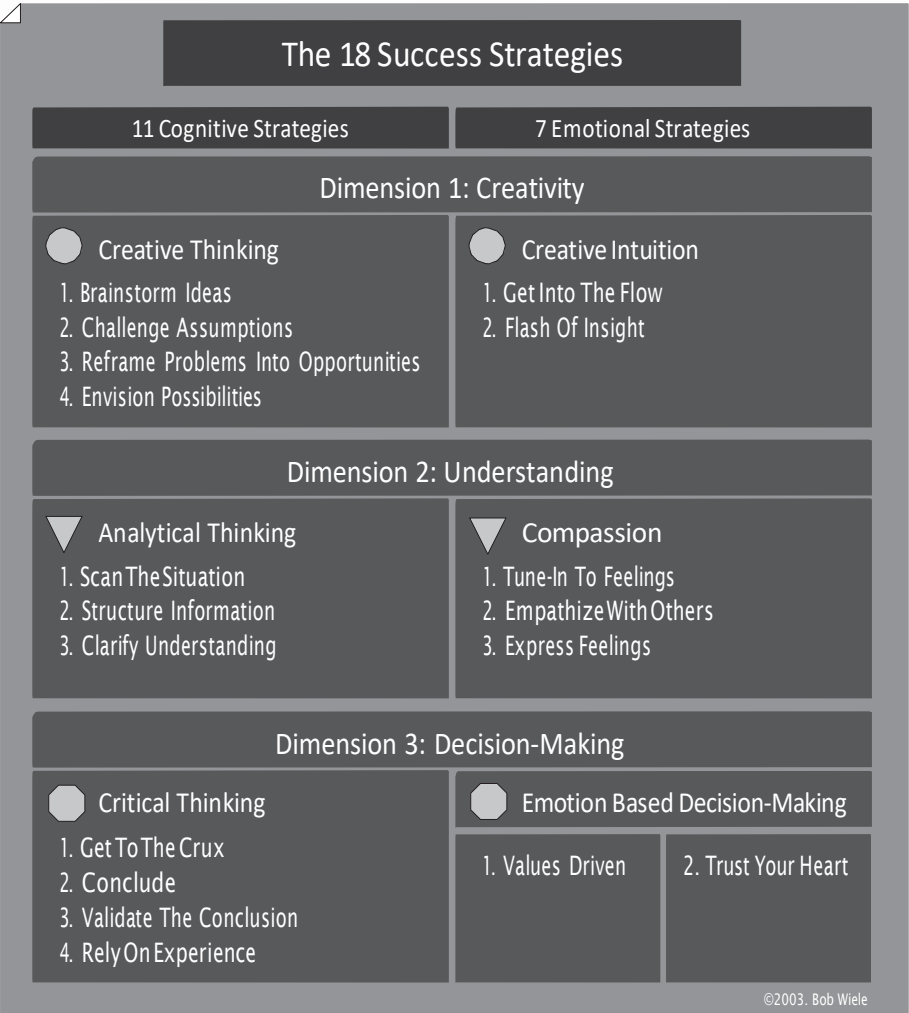
Conclusion: Use All Seven Mindsets to Be Smart For Life

The more comfortable and competent you are in using all seven mindsets, the better you will be able to cope with anything life throws at you.

Smart for Life means that you can switch from one mindset to another, to select the best way to approach a task or a person depending on the situation. You will not generate any great new ideas if you are locked into the critical thinking mindset. You will not develop deep rapport and connection with another person if you are always in the creative thinking mindset. You will not make a decision if you are engrossed in the analytical thinking mindset.

Once you know your own preferences for each of the seven mindsets from your 4D-i profile, the next task is build confidence and skills in using each one. The best way to do that is to learn the specific strategies that make up the mindsets.

The next step in our journey is to drill down into the seven mindsets and unpack the strategies that make up each one.



5. The 18 Success Strategies

5. The 18 Success Strategies



The 18 success strategies are precision tools for you to use to be *smart for life*. Think of them as a set of standard exercises, like aerobics or yoga for the mind and heart. The 18 strategies provide a basic repertoire of mental and emotional moves that will keep your mind and heart strong, supple and fit for life. These 18 strategies are lifelong, repeatable ways that you can employ anytime, anywhere. You can use them to get your work done better, faster and to ultimately achieve the results you want.

They are practical, generic tools to use when you need to figure out what to do next. There are 11 strategies for cognitive thinking and 7 for using your emotional intelligence. All are easy to learn, and once mastered, can be called upon under pressure, to get you through difficult challenges successfully.

Why Strategies?

A strategy is a conscious choice of how you decide to use your mental resources to reach your objectives. In other words, the strategies are most effective when you carefully select the ones you need to achieve the specific result you want. The more you use these strategies in a conscious way, the less you become a victim of habitual patterns that undermine performance.

These strategies are choices in how you decide to act. They can be used on their own or in combination with others to assist you in harnessing your intelligence to create ideas, develop understanding and to make better decisions.

What Your 4D-i Profile Reveals about You

Your 4D-i Profile shows you which strategies you really enjoy using. These are your *high* scores. Any strategy that you scored 84 or more is significantly higher than the general population. This type of high score is a distinguishing mark of your operating style. It is part of what makes you unique. You should be proud of this score. This means that this strategy is one that you rely on as one of your favorites.

While high scores do not necessarily indicate high competence, high scores show strengths of preferences compared to other people. This means that the outputs you get from using these strategies are likely to be useful and valuable, when you apply the strategy appropriately. To be successful, learn to leverage these strong preferences. The key is to use the right strategy at the right time.

In your profile, you will likely find strategies that you scored as *high average*. This means that these strategies are also favorites of yours, although not to the same

extent as the ones you scored *high* in. Again, these are strategies that you are likely very comfortable in employing.

The strategies that you scored as *average* are ones that you are comfortable enough using. However, unlike the high and high average scores, you do not like to use these any more or less than anyone else. A strategy that you scored as *low average* indicates that you like to use it slightly less than the average person.

Any strategy that you scored as *low*, shows that people like you do not prefer to use it on a regular basis for dealing with life’s challenges and situations. A low score means that 84% or more of the population prefer to select this strategy more than you do. A low score does not mean low competence. You can be competent in something but never particularly enjoy it.

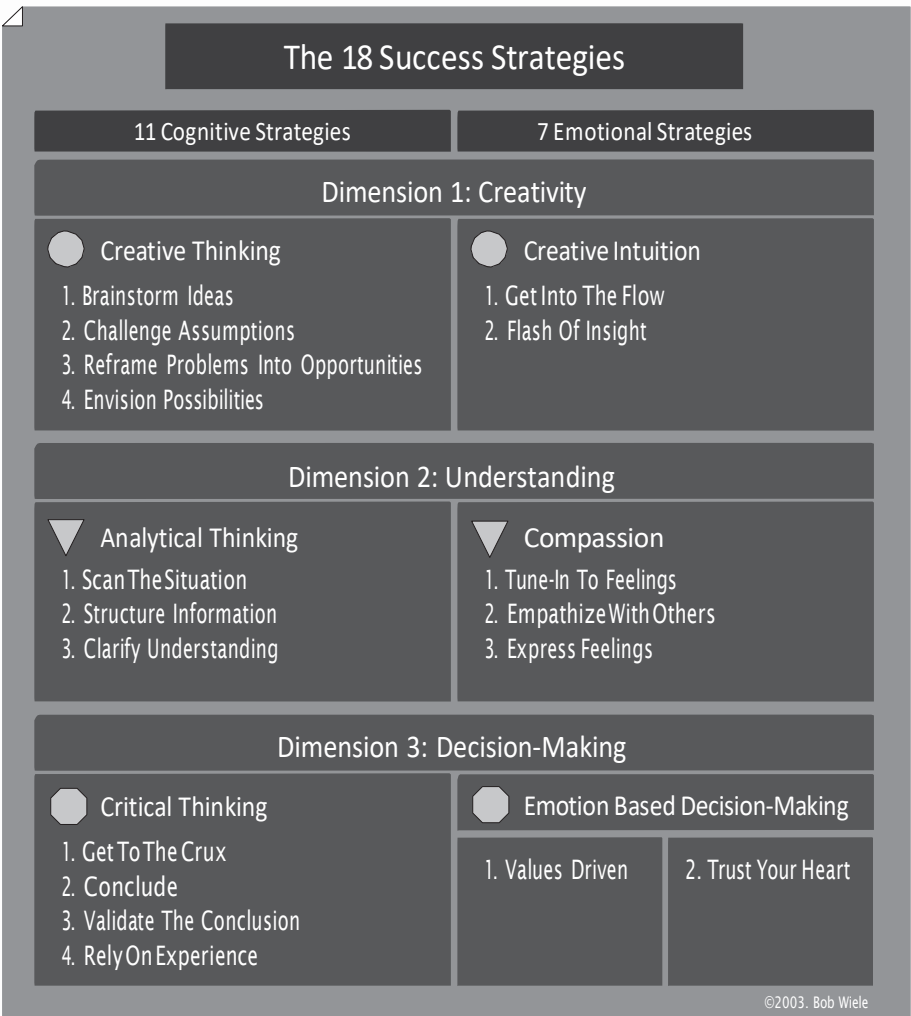
Low scores are particularly useful for you. Embrace them as keys to taking your performance to the next level. Pick one or two to work on. Pinpoint strategies you could pay more attention to. Once you start to pay attention to something, then you are on your way to using it more successfully.

A low score is not bad, nor does it indicate failure. It is simply a low preference. It means that you probably avoid using this strategy, preferring others instead.

The 18 Success Strategies Format

To help you understand and use the 18 strategies, we have developed a common format for explaining each one:

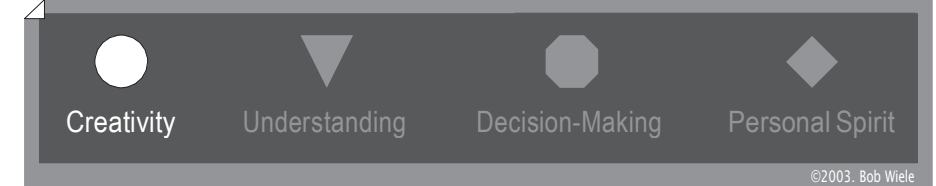
- A Definition of the Strategy – organized by color, symbol, number and mindset
- Why This Strategy is Important – a description of the value and function of each strategy
- Use It When – tips on timing and in what situations to use the strategy
- What To Do – key behaviors to try out
- Skill Builders – techniques to increase competency
- Believe It to Achieve It Success Cycle – how to use the strategy by lining up your beliefs with your feelings, your thoughts, your words and your actions to achieve the result you want (for more detail, see chapter 7)
- Inappropriate Use – things to avoid
- What to Ask – key questions to unlock and use the strategy
- Final Thoughts – a few comments on the strategy at work



In any problem-solving process or relationship management situation, you will use one or more of these strategies. Over time, you will be able to develop simple sequences of strategies that will work for you in difficult situations. You can use these sequences over and over, as processes you can rely on, to achieve better results. They will provide a pathway to a solution.

The more conscious you are of your mental repertoire and the more conscious you are of the particular strategies that you have chosen, the more control you will have over the outcome.

Developing Creativity: Six Success Strategies



To develop your skills in creativity, there are six core strategies—four cognitive strategies for creative thinking and two emotional strategies for creative intuition:

Creative Thinking

1. Brainstorm Ideas
2. Challenge Assumptions
3. Reframe Problems Into Opportunities
4. Envision Possibilities

Creative Intuition

1. Get Into The Flow
2. Flash Of Insight

Brainstorm Ideas

Unrestrained idea generation of a wide range of options prior to analysis or decision-making.

Creative Thinking

This strategy is the first of your four creative thinking strategies. It is one of the simplest and most commonly used strategies in creative thinking.

Why This Strategy Is Important

Brainstorm ideas is the strategy that will deliver you a wide variety of options, ideas and alternatives to choose from. It is a systematic approach to the persistent generation of multiple options. This strategy is the one to use to open up a range of alternatives or ideas when you want to find a better solution.

Use It When:

- You face a complex or difficult problem and conventional solutions are not good enough.
- You are stuck and are unsure how best to proceed
- You need fresh ideas to give you a new set of options and alternatives to choose from

What To Do:

- Write down every idea no matter what it is
- More is better – focus on getting quantity not quality
- Piggy back on the ideas of others to generate more ideas
- Hold all judging and evaluating until later
- Free flow with whatever ideas come out
- Budget appropriate time to do this properly

How To Build Your Skills:

- Use “could”, not “should”; use “what if” not “why”; use “might do” not “must do” in what you say
- Generate 25% more ideas to choose from before making any decision
- Focus on positive, spontaneous, constructive ideas
- Hold the judging – put that red mindset on hold while you brainstorm
- Be open minded to every idea no matter how unusual or wacky it may sound
- Build on other people’s ideas to create better ideas together
- Commit to always brainstorming 10 constructive options to choose from before you make an important decision

Believe It To Achieve It: Brainstorm Ideas

Intention:	To generate as many ideas as possible
Believe It:	This is time well spent – it will give me more and better choices
Feel It:	I feel positive, enthusiastic, creative, and open to all ideas
Think It:	More ideas now = better solutions later
Say It:	Every idea is OK!
Do It:	List all ideas, recombine, do not judge or evaluate
Achieve It:	Many ideas, options, alternatives to choose from

Inappropriate Use:

- Not helpful when you need to listen to others or when it is time to decide
- Not helpful when it is used as a way to escape the reality of having to understand a problem or make a commitment

What To Ask:

- “In what ways can I ...?”
- “What other options can I come up with?”
- “What new alternatives can I get by combining the ideas I already have with those of others?”

Final Thoughts

Go green and use this strategy of brainstorming ideas when you are at the beginning of a project. Use it when you feel blocked and need a fresh set of ideas before moving forward. Think of it as your most reliable strategy when you need new ideas fast.

Challenge Assumptions

Questioning assumptions, the status quo and accepted wisdom in order to create new ideas, options or fresh ways of dealing with the problem or task at hand.

Creative Thinking

This is the second of the four creative thinking strategies. *Challenge assumptions* should be used as your strategy for questioning the whys of the current situation. It is most useful for challenging how things have always been done. It's like your mental can opener, taking the lid off to open up new thinking.

Why This Strategy Is Important

Sometimes the real problem is the way we are looking at the problem. When the old ways of dealing with the problem aren't working, it is time to challenge some of the assumptions and conventional ways of thinking. This strategy of challenging assumptions will produce the new approach or ideas that you need.

Use It When:

- The old ways just don't seem to be working
- You need to challenge the status quo
- The way the problem is posed is the problem
- The way the problem has been approached in the past, may be the real problem
- You need to step outside the box to find creative ways around tough issues

What To Do:

- Ask "why?" and "why not?" to find fresh new ways to approach a problem or situation
- Search for solutions by challenging current practice, hidden assumptions, sacred cows, or implicit barriers
- Question prevailing wisdom in a positive manner to discover new ideas

How To Build Your Skills:

- Ask "why?", "why not?" and "what if?" rather than just accepting or going along with traditional ways
- Pick a problem and list five assumptions or boundaries that stand in your way - then - re-write them in their exact opposite form and look for insights or opportunities
- Be positive, not negative in your approach. Question, don't criticize
- Look for ways to eliminate, add, reverse, substitute, modify and change assumptions or traditional practices
- Identify all the sacred cows or the 'givens' and see if you really need them
- Question your definition of the problem and your approach to it

Believe It To Achieve It: Challenge Assumptions

Intention:	To develop new approaches to old problems
Believe It:	The way I am approaching it is the real problem
Feel It:	I feel positive, bold, courageous, persistent
Think It:	What assumptions can I question?
Say It:	Why, why, why, what if I did, what if I didn't...?
Do It:	List and question all assumptions and conventions
Achieve It:	Breakthrough solutions or alternatives

Inappropriate Use:

- Challenging everything just for the sake of questioning it
- Tiring others with your incessant challenges of Why? Why? Why? that may be misinterpreted as criticisms or as annoying behavior

What To Ask:

- "Why am I doing it this way?"
- "What are the sacred cows?"
- "Is there a better way of doing this?"
- "What is standing in my way of seeing this from a new angle?"

Final Thoughts

When the current, conventional ways don't seem to be working, step outside the box and challenge the assumptions you have been using. Ask why are we doing it this way? Look for a better way by examining the things that have been taken for granted. Take a positive, constructive, can-do approach to get fresh insights.

Reframe Problems Into Opportunities

Creating new ways of looking at a problem or situation and generating new opportunities and ideas by shifting the approach, angle or way of thinking about it.



This is the third of the four creative thinking strategies. It is a powerful strategy for you to use whenever you are confronted by circumstances beyond your control. It can literally transform problems into opportunities.

Why This Strategy Is Important

Reframing problems into opportunities is a vital personal survival strategy for when you run into setbacks, problems or apparent failures. It won't get rid of the problem. It will give you new ways of seeing the hidden possibilities in it. It will deliver you options you hadn't realized you have. It is the most important creative thinking strategy to go to when you are experiencing tough times.

Use It When:

- You are stuck in a difficult situation
- You need to find positive, constructive, alternative ways of seeing beyond the situation in order to create options for moving forward
- You need to transform problems into opportunities or find the hidden potential in a difficult situation or relationship

What To Do:

- Find opportunities where others find only obstacles
- Believe that there is always more than one way to interpret a situation
- Look at situations from a variety of angles to come up with new, positive opportunities

How To Build Your Skills:

- Redescribe everyday problems into opportunities – ask what is the upside here?
- Consciously look for the silver lining in every situation
- Reflect back on events in your life and explore how the results could have been worse – see the opportunity in the past
- Pick negative life events (e.g. you get fired, break a leg, have a fight with your neighbor, your car breaks down in traffic...) and try finding at least one hidden opportunity
- Everytime a difficulty arises, commit to finding a positive message and opportunity

Believe It To Achieve It: Reframe Problems Into Opportunities

Intention:	To generate different ways to deal with a problem
Believe It:	There are many ways to interpret any situation
Feel It:	I feel empowered, in control and optimistic
Think It:	There is hidden potential to be discovered in this situation
Say It:	Where are the positive opportunities in this? What is the hidden potential here?
Do It:	Explore the situation from every conceivable angle to give you new ways of looking at it
Achieve It:	Breakthrough solutions, empowering ideas, or fresh approaches to deal positively with the problem

Inappropriate Use:

- Escaping responsibility for solving a problem by focusing on the opportunities but failing to act on them
- Being blindsided by failing to consider the negative aspects and realities of a situation

What To Ask:

- “What’s the positive opportunity here?”
- “Where is the hidden potential in this situation?”
- “How can I transform this problem into a useful lesson or positive step forward?”

Final Thoughts

When bad things happen, use this creative thinking strategy to turn problems into opportunities. Remember, this strategy won't change the original event. It will give you alternative meanings and interpretations that will empower you to act in a proactive, constructive way.

Envision Possibilities

Creating mental pictures or imagining “what if...” scenarios about future possibilities or solutions.



This is the fourth of four creative thinking strategies. This one triggers your imagination to look into the future. This strategy will help you create goals, plans and a vision to draw you forward.

Why This Strategy Is Important

To *envision possibilities* is a powerful planning and problem solving tool. Used effectively, it delivers superior results and better decisions. It is your mental laboratory where you go to experiment with and visualize ideal solutions or future states. It is the creative thinking strategy that taps your imagination to come up with possible solutions and clear pictures of where you want to get to.

Use It When:

- You want to imagine a clear picture of the desired results
- You want to start with a vision of the end or goal in mind
- You have to develop scenarios about what might or could happen before making a decision

What To Do:

- Picture the future – describe it in detail as if the solution was already achieved
- Focus first on where you want to end up, then work backwards from there
- Use pictures, metaphors or analogies to help see and describe future states
- Leave today’s details behind and imagine what could be, without judging

How To Build Your Skills:

- Pretend you’re in a helicopter, rising above a difficult situation you are in and flying ahead to the future. What possibilities do you see?
- Explore one interesting possibility each day (e.g. What if I had the perfect life? What if I had this problem solved? What if I were boss for the day?)
- Always ask “what if...?” when faced with a challenge or problem. Suspend your critical judgment and let the ideas flow about future possibilities
- Experiment with drawing your ideas or creating mental pictures
- Find pictures that depict the future that you want – post them in a prominent place so you can see them every day

Believe It To Achieve It: Envision Possibilities

Intention:	To open up creative thinking by focusing into the future
Believe It:	The best way to predict the future is to describe the one I want to achieve
Feel It:	I feel positive and optimistic about the future
Think It:	Imagine what if...
Say It:	What could I achieve if I am really successful?
Do It:	Draw pictures, make models, work alone and in groups to develop portrayals of the desired future
Achieve It:	Powerful future scenarios, new solutions, and visions of a desired outcome to aim for

Inappropriate Use:

- Always looking to the future, rather than dealing with the here and now realities
- Impractical ideas or failure to push for closure when action is required

What To Ask:

- “If this were solved, what would a great solution look like?”
- “What’s my vision of this?”
- “What are the worst possible and the best possible outcomes that could happen?”

Final Thoughts

To *envision possibilities* is a powerful strategy. It lifts you out of the details of your current circumstances. Too often our problems arise because we do not have a clear picture of where we want to end up. This strategy gives you pictures of the future that you want to create for yourself. This image of possibilities can act like a magnetic force that pulls all your thoughts, words and actions towards the desired outcome that you want.

Get Into The Flow

Being fully immersed in creative thinking; tolerating ambiguity and conflicting information and feelings; staying patient, refraining from decision-making, and anticipating the arrival of a better idea.

Creative Intuition

This is one of the two strategies for achieving creative insights from your intuition. This strategy combines two complementary elements of the creative intuitive mindset – a tolerance for ambiguity and the flow state of mind.

Why This Strategy Is Important

This strategy sets you up for getting the insights that come from being in the high performance zone, as athletes like to describe it. This strategy is about getting into the flow state, a precondition for the Eureka! type of insights. It involves being completely absorbed in the task. It is a state of mind.

Use It When:

- You want to find fresh insights into a complex issue
- You need to defer decision making until you have more creative options and potential solutions to choose from
- You want to wait and see what emerges in the process

What To Do:

- Immerse yourself in the challenge. Trust your intuition and the creative process to deliver you insights
- Use it as a strategy to stay loose, relaxed and let go of the compulsion to act or decide right now
- Tolerate ambiguity, trusting that a superior solution or insight will emerge

How To Build Your Skills:

- Immerse yourself in the next problem that comes along. Listen to your own inner voice and let go of the need to control the outcome or produce the answer
- Defer making the next decision you have to make, just a little longer. Simply wait and see what happens or what thoughts come to you
- Reflect on your own high performance pattern. List the right conditions you need to be successful. Put them in place next time you have a challenge
- When in doubt, take a break and do something different or go somewhere else to open up your mind

Believe It To Achieve It: Get Into The Flow

Intention:	To open up creative thinking
Believe It:	When I am in the flow I can get great “Aha!” insights
Feel It:	I feel completely open and receptive
Think It:	Don’t think – just go with the flow
Say It:	Nothing
Do It:	Become completely absorbed - or - take a break
Achieve It:	A state of mind, a high performance zone, a readiness for breakthrough intuitive insights

Inappropriate Use:

- If you use this as an escape from dealing with realities
- If you have little or no experience with an issue, your insights may not be that useful

What To Ask:

- “What do I need to do to create the right conditions for getting into the flow state of mind?”
- “How can I best immerse myself completely in this task?”
- “What if I just relax, take a break, let go and see what happens?”

Final Thoughts

Get into the flow requires a complete immersion into the creative process of problem finding and solution finding. Think of it as a set-up strategy for getting a flash of insight. You become like a fisherman, putting yourself in the right place, waiting for the right idea to strike. To use this strategy successfully, you have to let go of the compulsion to find an immediate answer.

Flash Of Insight

Knowing without conscious reasoning and producing insights or hunches.



This is the second of the two emotion-based creativity strategies. This strategy produces breakthrough, “Aha!” type of insights. It is a way of quickly recognizing hidden patterns in a situation or challenge.

Why This Strategy Is Important

Our intuition is a powerful problem solving tool. It bypasses the logic of analytical and critical thinking processes. Intuition generates a deep inner knowing. It produces sudden, spontaneous insights and solutions. This *flash of insight* strategy works in tandem with the *get into the flow* strategy to create the hunch. It is vital in complex, fast changing, chaotic situations when there is not enough time to analyze data.

Use It When:

- You are in a complex, ambiguous situation and you want to access your own intuition to generate new insights or creative options
- You are working in uncharted territory and you need fresh ideas that go beyond conventional wisdom or obvious facts

What To Do:

- Value your own hunches as a trusted source for generating insights and breakthrough ideas
- Keep an open and flexible mind, knowing that a *flash of insight* cannot be called up on demand
- Create the conditions for your own success in getting insights

How To Build Your Skills:

- Choose a problem to work on. Trust yourself to generate an “Aha!” *flash of insight*. Wait. Don’t force it. Go for a walk. Sleep on it. Meditate. Relax. Let your unconscious mind mull it over and form connections. Be prepared to record your insights as they come
- Pay attention to any gut reactions or physical feelings that you have (e.g. which elevator door will open first? will the coin fall heads or tails?). Look for patterns
- Be open to possibilities and random ideas out of nowhere on your problem. Let your deep mind make associations from seemingly illogical sources
- Keep a notepad handy. Write down insights immediately

Believe It To Achieve It: Flash Of Insight

Intention:	To open up your creative mind for new insights
Believe It:	When I get in the right state of mind, I will get an “Aha!”
Feel It:	I feel relaxed, open and trusting in my creative intuition
Think It:	Not too hard
Say It:	I am waiting for a flash of insight
Do It:	Meditate, go for a walk, get absorbed in a task, make notes, draw pictures, leave it behind for a while and wait and see what arrives
Achieve It:	Powerful insights - breakthrough ideas

Inappropriate Use:

- Waiting for a *flash of insight* when you really need to be making a decision
- Ignoring critical facts or information that call for more objective, rational decision making

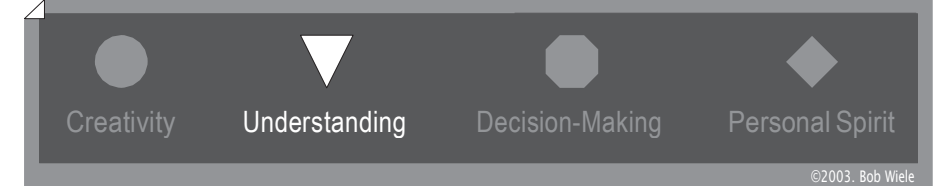
What To Ask:

- “What’s my hunch about this?”
- “What are my deep feelings telling me?”
- “What’s the deeper message?”

Final Thoughts

Intuition is a natural human capacity that we all have. Tap into it and you will be rewarded with a rich source of ideas and solutions. Avoid listening to what your intuition tells you and you risk making serious errors. If you are facing a tough problem, stew on it. Wait and see what your creative mind brings forward for you. Sometimes the magic works, sometimes it doesn’t. Make sure you have a pen handy to jot down the insight when it arrives.

Developing Understanding: Six Success Strategies



To develop your skills in understanding, there are six core strategies – three cognitive strategies for analytical thinking and three emotional strategies for compassion:

Analytical Thinking

1. Scan The Situation
2. Structure Information
3. Clarify Understanding

Compassion

1. Tune-In To Feelings
2. Empathize With Others
3. Express Feelings

Scan The Situation

Survey the environment, person or situation to gather as much information as possible.

Analytical Thinking

This is the first of three analytical thinking strategies. This strategy is useful when you have to gather information in a systematic way in order to gain a better understanding of the situation that you are in.

Why This Strategy Is Important

When you use this strategy you are in the information gathering mode. It focuses your mind's attention on systematically gathering as much information as you can from a wide variety of sources. By gathering this data, you will gain a more comprehensive picture of the situation you are dealing with. This strategy is essential in providing the basis for high quality decision-making. It is also important when explanations are required, or analysis is needed before taking the next step.

Use It When:

- You need to grasp the real truth
- You need a lot of facts and information to understand a situation in depth
- You need to gather information before you can develop a plan, solve a problem or make a sound decision

What To Do:

- Gather lots of information from a variety of sources before proceeding
- Strive for a thorough understanding and a comprehensive picture of the context in all situations
- Know how much information is enough and take the time to get it before making decisions
- Scan in circles – from the immediate situation out to the larger context

How To Build Your Skills:

- For each problem that you face, determine how much and what type of information you need and make a list of different sources to go to
- Build up your powers of observation. Set aside 3 minutes each day. Choose a random object (watch, pen, apple) and describe it in detail. Notice everything. Control the urge to let your mind wander. Stay on task – it's only 3 minutes. List as many descriptive characteristics as you can
- Stop and look around. Notice everything around you. Look up and see as far as you can. Notice what you observe

Believe It To Achieve It: Scan The Situation

Intention:	To develop a comprehensive understanding of a situation or issue
Believe It:	The more information and data that I can gather, the better I will be able to understand what is going on
Feel It:	Confident in my skills to learn as much as I can
Think It:	I keep my eyes wide open, collecting information everywhere so I can understand fully
Say It:	What can you tell me about...?; What info do you have on...?
Do It:	Look, listen and list; ask questions and more questions to gain understanding; research, collect data
Achieve It:	Comprehensive information and understanding for analysis and decision-making

Inappropriate Use:

- Collecting more and more information that really does not add value
- Overwhelming others with the sheer volume of data and not using it to take action or to help create positive constructive plans

What To Ask:

- “How much and what type of information do I need?”
- “What sources can I go to for the information I need?”
- “What do I notice when I sit back and scan the situation I am in?”

Final Thoughts

Scan the situation is a valuable knowledge-building strategy. It gives you a sound and thorough grounding of facts, data and other information. When in doubt, check it out. Scanning is an excellent strategy for learning about new topics. Strive to find the proper amount of information – too much will swamp you, too little and you run the risk of making mistakes.

Structure Information

Organize information, data, people, resources and processes in meaningful and systematic ways.

Analytical Thinking

This is the second of the three analytical thinking strategies. It is the core strategy used to bring systematic order and meaning to information.

Why This Strategy Is Important

The purpose of this strategy is to focus your attention on organizing and structuring the information that you have collected into clusters, categories and systems. It is essential when you need to plan, control and carry out any set of tasks. This strategy brings discipline and organization to every task. It is particularly useful in complex situations where structure is essential for rational analysis.

Use It When:

- You are at the beginning of a new situation and need to get organized
- You feel overwhelmed or confused by large amounts of information
- You have to manage and access growing quantities of information

What To Do:

- Sort and organize all items and information into groups or categories
- Develop systems and processes to effectively manage information, people, resources, tasks
- Make sense of large amounts of information by clustering it and assigning it to different categories

How To Build Your Skills:

- Choose something that you want to organize (closet, CD collection, book shelf, filing cabinet, garage, recipes). List at least 5 different ways that you could organize it (by season, priority, color, favorites, date, etc.)
- Commit to getting better organized. Make a 'to-do' list everyday. Use a Day-Timer type planner or Palm Pilot. Take a course on time management or self-organization
- Use the online Smart Day Planner that comes with your 4D-i – structure your day by type of work – red/decide today; yellow/communicate, administer; green/ideas for future; white/time out for you
- Make lists and assign priorities and times for each task

Believe It To Achieve It: Structure Information

Intention:	To organize everything in a sensible, systematic way for access and use
Believe It:	Organized is good! The best way I can manage in complex times is to be organized
Feel It:	I feel calm, cool and collected
Think It:	How can I organize this well?
Say It:	A place for everything and everything in its place
Do It:	Organize everything carefully and systematically
Achieve It:	Organization, systems and structure to help you find information and make decisions

Inappropriate Use:

- Stifling creativity, adaptability and flexibility by imposing too much structure
- Slowing down to the point of inaction by using structures that over-complicate access
- Making the system and categories more important than the person – over-riding common sense by rigidly adhering to rules and procedures

What To Ask:

- “How can I organize this information?”
- “In what ways can I sort, classify or cluster these ideas?”
- “How can this information be easily organized, stored and accessed?”

Final Thoughts

Structure information is the core strategy for getting organized. It is particularly valuable when there is a lot of information to deal with or when you are feeling overwhelmed. The key task is to develop categories that you can use easily. The more complex the task and the more information you gather, the more vital this strategy becomes.

Clarify Understanding

Sharpen the understanding of a situation by gathering information and asking questions.



This is the third of the three strategies for analytical thinking. This strategy focuses your attention on getting clear on the task, challenge, issue or situation.

Why This Strategy Is Important

This strategy is essential for developing deep understanding. It is designed to deliver clarity prior to proceeding to action. It is not used to assess or judge. It is used to eliminate muddled thinking, illogical arguments or fuzzy ideas. It is a vital tool for doing analytical thinking well.

Use It When:

- You want to clear up any ambiguity to get precise information
- There is unclear information
- You are confused or feel you do not fully understand what is happening

What To Do:

- Ask many questions to gain increased depth and clarity of understanding
- Insist on specific, accurate, precise information
- Demand clarity
- Persistently research, study and compile information that gives a complete picture

How To Build Your Skills:

- Practice the 5 W's — Ask who, what, where, when, why (and how)
- Listen to the news or read the paper. Pick a feature story and uncover the 5 W's
- Act like a detective. Gather as many facts as possible and zero in on any items or issues that are muddy or not specific enough
- In a meeting, continue to ask questions of clarification until you have a full and complete understanding
- In any situation, decide to take nothing for granted. Always ask 3 questions of clarification to ensure your complete understanding

Believe It To Achieve It: Clarify Understanding

Intention:	To know and understand fully and completely what is going on, what is expected...
Believe It:	More questions will yield better understanding
Feel It:	I feel calm, cool and clearly focused
Think It:	I can not move forward until it is crystal clear for me
Say It:	Can you clarify that for me please?
Do It:	Make notes, ask questions of clarification until you have the level of understanding that you need
Achieve It:	In depth understanding and clarity

Inappropriate Use:

- Asking too many questions and annoying or frustrating others
- Stalling a move to action by continuing to want more and more detail
- Insisting on perfect clarity before moving on. Often clarity only comes once you start actually working on a problem

What To Ask:

- “What exactly do you mean?”
- “What? Where? When? Why? Who? How?”
- “Can you be more specific? Can you clarify that point?”

Final Thoughts

This strategy is like an information quality check. You put your attention on clearing up any misunderstandings while working to stay objective and non-judgmental. Go to it when there is confusion or when expectations are not clear. Achieving clarity is a very helpful tool in managing conflict and in working on issues in a relationship.

Tune-In To Feelings

Sensing and connecting with the emotional dimensions in a situation, other person or group.



This is the first of the three heart-based strategies in the compassion mindset. *Tune-in to feelings* provides the emotional data you need for building a caring, and considerate relationship.

Why This Strategy Is Important

The *tune-in to feelings* strategy is used to focus your complete attention on the emotions the other person is feeling. It is an effort to truly understand how he or she is feeling. *tune-in to feelings* is a key step in building compassion because it gives you the emotional data you need to develop a deeper understanding. It can also be directed within, to tune-in to your own feelings.

Use It When:

- You want to uncover the real emotional truth
- You believe that there is more to the situation than what meets the eye
- You want to connect with how the other person is feeling

What To Do:

- Pick up on the subtle emotional cues, the facial expressions, tone of voice, and body language
- Listen, notice and sense without judging
- Connect with how the person is speaking and operating, not just what they are saying

How To Build Your Skills:

- Start with yourself – Ask yourself in the middle of any human encounter – how am I feeling about this? Then ask – how is she/he feeling right now?
- Do some people watching. Sit in a mall, street corner, park, cafeteria or other busy public place. Choose one or two people to study. Observe, with total awareness, what they do and how they do it. Try and determine their mood, how they are feeling
- Shift from your head to your heart – tune into the other person and ask yourself “how is he or she really feeling?”

Believe It To Achieve It: Tune-In To Feelings

Intention:	To connect at a deeper emotional level
Believe It:	Feelings tell the true story
Feel It:	I feel open, caring and compassionate
Think It:	The other person’s feelings are important to understand
Say It:	How are you feeling?
Do It:	Listen, watch, and acknowledge the other person’s feelings
Achieve It:	A deeper, more complete understanding of the emotional dynamics

Inappropriate Use:

- Reading more into a situation than what is really there
- Staying ‘tuned-in’ rather than using your understanding to work towards a solution

What To Ask:

- “How is the other person feeling about this? About me?”
- “How am I feeling about this — what’s the emotional climate here?”
- “What do I notice about their body language, mood, expression, tone of voice, and gestures, that will help me understand how they are feeling?”

Final Thoughts

Tune-in to feelings is a key building block in developing relationships and compassion. It is helpful when you are in a conflict or in an emotionally difficult situation. Take the time to shift your attention away from yourself. Learn to discipline yourself to focus completely on how the other person is feeling. This way you can make a deeper, more authentic connection.

Empathize With Others

Showing kindness, caring, compassion, tolerance and deep understanding for, and a connection with, another's thoughts, emotions and situation.



This is the second of the three heart-based strategies in the compassion mindset. This strategy is used to focus your complete attention on developing a deep understanding and acceptance with how the other person is feeling.

Why This Strategy Is Important

The focus is on achieving a deep level of emotional understanding and a selfless demonstration of genuine caring for the other person. This means an authentic, emotional reaching out and connecting. Genuine empathy creates a powerful emotional bridge and bond between you and the other person. Relationships are built on shared empathy.

Use It When:

- You need to understand all the different emotional viewpoints and perspectives
- You need to offer emotional support to another person
- The other person needs your full understanding and acceptance

What To Do:

- Build rapport by putting yourself in the other person's shoes
- Value, listen to, tolerate the other person's circumstance or perspective
- Demonstrate care and compassion by offering unconditional understanding
- Accept how the other person is feeling, without any judging

How To Build Your Skills:

- Practice effective listening. Create a comfortable setting for dialogue. Give your total attention to the other person. Ask them questions that probe their situation and feelings. Hold your fire — don't interrupt with your opinions or interpretation. Don't judge — keep an open mind. Experience their reality
- Put yourself in someone else's shoes: Choose another person — a friend, spouse, boss, peer, hero — Ask yourself, if I were in their shoes, what does that feel like?
- Building trust and rapport takes effort — practice listening, with an open stance, uncrossed arms and active attention to let them know you care
- Practice not interjecting your ideas, your analysis, or your opinions. Focus only on their needs

Believe It To Achieve It: Empathize With Others

Intention:	To give kindness and compassion in order to gain a deeper connection and understanding
Believe It:	I believe that the other person's feelings are more important than mine right now
Feel It:	I feel genuine warmth, caring, and compassion
Think It:	What can I do to connect with what they are feeling?
Say It:	Tell me how you feel
Do It:	Look into the other person's eyes; accept and not judge whatever they tell you
Achieve It:	Deep connection and understanding of the other person's emotional realities

Inappropriate Use:

- Empathizing with everyone in every situation. Sometimes you must take action or express your own views
- Compromising, being too nice, or giving in all the time

What To Ask:

- “What are you experiencing?”
- “How can I help you?”
- “What is troubling you right now?”

Final Thoughts

Empathize with others is an essential foundation for building trust and understanding. It shifts your attention away from your own needs to the emotional needs of the other person. It is particularly helpful when they are suffering or in some difficulty. Empathy requires an emotional discipline, an opening up of the heart to hear what the other person is feeling and what they need. Empathy does not mean that you necessarily agree with their point of view. It does mean that you accept it as very real for them.

Express Feelings

Selecting and using the appropriate emotional and verbal language or communications method to get your true feelings across



This is the third of the three heart based strategies in the compassion mindset. This strategy is used to focus your attention on tapping into your emotions when you express yourself to another person or group.

Why This Strategy Is Important

This strategy is used to share your true feelings. It is particularly effective when it is powered by the other two strategies in compassion – the degree to which you have been able to tune-in to feelings of others and how well you have developed empathy with the other person. As part of the compassion mindset, the purpose of this strategy is not to vent negative emotions. It is to focus your attention on how to express your feelings within the context of caring for the other person.

Use It When:

- Anytime you are communicating with another person, be it through speech, written word, or tone of voice
- You need to connect more deeply with someone and let them know what is going on inside you
- You want to motivate or move someone by connecting at the feeling level

What To Do:

- Listen attentively and talk with others in ways that ensure mutual understanding
- Express true feelings openly and honestly
- Readily adapt and change the way the message is conveyed so it is authentic and understood by all

How To Build Your Skills:

- Pick a person who you want to influence, present to, or communicate with. Decide to connect emotionally with them. Express your true feelings
- Consult a mentor. Observe and model yourself after someone whom you consider to be an effective communicator. Note what they say and do in various situations and consider what might be useful in your situation. Ask how would they present the message you have to convey
- Practice expressing your true feelings daily

Believe It To Achieve It: Express Feelings

Intention:	To create emotional honesty and authenticity
Believe It:	I believe there is deep truth in my emotions
Feel It:	I express myself deeply, truly, completely
Think It:	Think feelings not thoughts
Say It:	I feel... what I am feeling is...
Do It:	Tap into your deeper emotions when you speak
Achieve It:	Authentic communications that deepen mutual understanding and motivation in others

Inappropriate Use:

- Putting words in people’s mouths and expressing their feelings for them
- Talking too much and not listening enough
- Venting your feelings regardless of how others feel

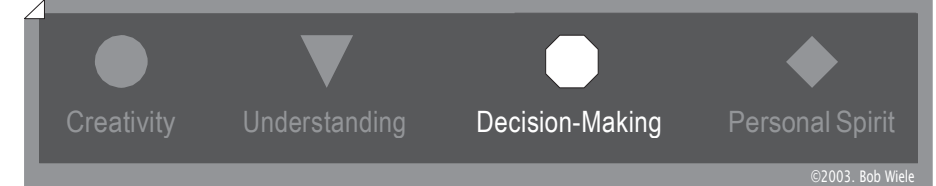
What To Ask:

- “How can I say this directly from my heart?”
- “What do I need to say and do to make the emotional connection with this person (Red, Yellow, Green)?”
- “What is the best way to express my real feelings?”

Final Thoughts

This third compassionate strategy is the one to use when you need to make an emotional connection with someone else. The focus of your attention should be on the messages from your heart and the true feelings that you have. Be authentic. Communicate your real feelings in a way that the other person will be able to understand and connect with.

Developing Decision-Making: Six Success Strategies



To develop your skills in decision-making, there are six core strategies—four cognitive strategies for critical thinking and two emotion based decision-making strategies:

Critical Thinking

1. Get To The Crux
2. Conclude
3. Validate The Conclusion
4. Rely On Experience

Emotion Based Decision-Making

1. Values Driven
2. Trust Your Heart

Get To The Crux

Determining the essence or most critical aspect of a problem or situation in order to take action.



This is the first of the four strategies for critical thinking. It is essential in effective problem solving and decision-making. The crux means the centre or heart of an issue or problem. This strategy is used to determine what the real essence or crux of the issue is before moving forward.

Why This Strategy Is Important

Get to the crux is most effective when used in a positive, constructive way to zero in on what the real issue is. It is essential in determining where to put resources to address the issue. It is intended to help you get a firm grip on what is the real problem.

Use It When:

- You have to set priorities and decide what is most important
- It's time to zero in on the heart of an issue
- You need to decide on what the real problem is before going ahead

What To Do:

- Ask tough questions that strip away the surface issues and get right to the meat of the issue
- Focus on priorities and on what matters most
- Be relentless and objective when it comes to getting at the heart of the matter

How To Build Your Skills:

- When confronted with a problem, ask yourself "what is the REAL problem here?" and "why is this a problem?" Then ask "why is this a problem?" at least four more times, each time stripping another layer off the surface until you reach the heart of the matter
- Focus your attention on getting to the crux of an issue. Present yourself with hypothetical scenarios that force you to set priorities, like "If I could only do one thing today, what would it be?" "If I were to keep just three things in my world, what would I keep?" "If my report could convey only one message, what should it be?"
- In meetings or working in teams, ask "what are we trying to accomplish?"

Believe It To Achieve It: Get To The Crux

Intention:	To zero in on the real issue, not the symptoms
Believe It:	If I spend time determining what the real problem is, I will save time and resources later
Feel It:	I feel strong, objective, tough minded
Think It:	What is the crux of this issue?
Say It:	What is the crux of this issue?
Do It:	Push hard to find the real root cause
Achieve It:	Powerful grasp of the real issue to be addressed

Inappropriate Use:

- Taking a narrow focus too early and closing your mind to other ideas or information
- Jumping to the bottom line, ignoring more subjective input, like insights and emotions
- Rushing in, failing to take enough time to determine the real issue

What To Ask:

- "What is the heart of the issue?"
- "What is the real problem here?"
- "What is the crux of the issue... What is the real crux?"

Final Thoughts

This is your go-to strategy when you need to stop analyzing and you have to cut to the chase. *Get to the crux* will help you drill down to the core of the issue at hand. The more time you spend at the beginning thinking through what the real issue is, the more time you will save later. Do it well and you will be rewarded in time and resources saved.

Conclude

Reach a logical decision or resolution about the best way to proceed.



This is the second of the four strategies for critical thinking. This strategy is all about coming to a conclusion. Once the creative ideas have been generated, the data analyzed, then the task becomes – what should I do?

Why This Strategy Is Important

This strategy shifts your attention to decision-making. The focus is to determine the best conclusion. It is there to help make meaning of all the work done to date. This is where the rubber meets the road in decision-making.

Use It When:

- You must decide what to do next
- It is time to seek closure and make sensible choices
- You have to move to action and away from arguing, generating ideas or analyzing information

What To Do:

- Base your conclusions on sound analysis and the crux of the issue
- Move to closure using common sense and logic
- Focus on practical, objective solutions

How To Build Your Skills:

- Practice coming to a conclusion. Pick any controversial issue. Tell others what your conclusion is and what should be the logical thing to do. Choose a side. Don't sit on the fence or take the middle ground
- Set a logical direction on your next project. State your challenge. Give yourself a target. Set criteria — “What do I want to achieve? Preserve? Avoid?” Write down options, ideas and choices on how to proceed. Make three piles: positive, negative and interesting. Assign your options, ideas and choices to a pile. Come to a conclusion. Make a decision
- Practice making decisions. Pick a few items that you have not dealt with and decide what is the best thing to do and take action
- Collect information and then commit to saying... “and therefore, it makes sense to... to do...”

Believe It To Achieve It: Conclude

Intention:	To set a proper course of action to follow
Believe It:	It's time to make a practical decision
Feel It:	I feel decisive
Think It:	What is the most sensible conclusion?
Say It:	It is time to decide on what is the best solution
Do It:	Conclude what the best thing to do is
Achieve It:	A decision or resolution to act

Inappropriate Use:

- Being impatient and pushing too hard
- Coming to a conclusion too quickly, thereby missing important, relevant ideas and information

What To Ask:

- “What is the most logical conclusion?”
- “What is the best way to proceed?”
- “What's the option or plan that makes the most sense?”

Final Thoughts

In this strategy, you focus your attention on coming to closure on an issue or problem. It is time to determine what is the best thing to do. Your conclusion should be practical and sensible.

Validate The Conclusion

Posing tough questions to eliminate inferior options and poor quality information in order to critically assess and ensure the best decision.



This is the third of the four strategies for critical thinking. In using this strategy, the focus of your attention is on coming up with objective proof and evidence to support the conclusion you have come to.

Why This Strategy Is Important

This strategy is essential to ensuring the quality of any decision you wish to make. When you put your attention on validating the conclusion, it means that you have to adopt a tougher, more critical mindset to get the best result. This strategy is crucial if you wish to avoid serious problems later. The purpose of this strategy is to test out the relevance and viability of your conclusion.

Use It When:

- You have to assess the strengths and weaknesses of any idea, before making a final decision
- You are in the test and prototype phases of a project
- You need proof and evidence

What To Do:

- Put things to the test to see if they measure up to standards or not
- Objectively weigh pros and cons to eliminate inferior options
- Demand proof or evidence before deciding

How To Build Your Skills:

- Build a repertoire of tough questions and practice them (e.g. How is this relevant and useful? What's missing? Where is the proof?)
- Choose a newspaper article. Read it, then use tough questions to find flaws in the argument
- Appoint a Critics Panel. Choose 2 or 3 trusted friends or colleagues who are objective, tough-minded and critical. Share a plan with them. Ask them to critique it
- Before any decisions, force yourself to come up with good answers to tough questions. If you can't answer them, go back and re-examine your solution

Believe It To Achieve It: Validate The Conclusion

Intention:	To make the best decision by critically evaluating it
Believe It:	Convince me or I will not support it
Feel It:	Powerful, tough minded
Think It:	What could go wrong? Why is this the best?
Say It:	Show me. Prove it to me. Why should I do this?
Do It:	Ask tough questions relentlessly until you are convinced of the quality and validity of the conclusion
Achieve It:	Powerful conclusions and decisions

Inappropriate Use:

- Questioning the validity of everything and everyone's views all the time
- Acting like the prosecuting attorney when the situation calls for understanding
- Inhibiting creativity with tough questions

What To Ask:

- "Why and how is this the most worthwhile solution?"
- "Can you prove it to me? What could go wrong?"
- "What's your rationale? Why should we do this?"

Final Thoughts

The best way to use this strategy is to adopt a positive, hard-nosed frame of mind. Be relentless in your quest for proof. If the conclusion can meet the test of hard scrutiny, then support it. If not, then go back to the drawing board. Make sure you don't focus on shooting down proposals for the sake of shooting them down. When you use this strategy in a constructive way, you will quickly find out what is the best thing to do.

Rely On Experience

Relying upon and using past experience to guide decision-making and problem-solving.

Critical Thinking

This is the fourth of the four strategies for using your critical thinking to make good decisions. One of the most reliable ways to make a good decision is to consult your past experience.

Why This Strategy Is Important

The research on decision-making shows that the best decisions tend to come from people who have had more experience in an area. This strategy can be used as a check and balance before committing to a course of action. You reflect on your own past experience in similar situations, or rely on the experience of others, before deciding to act.

Use It When:

- You are trouble-shooting or locating the source of a problem
- You are faced with a difficult decision
- You are unsure how to proceed and need guidance

What To Do:

- Learn from everyday experience and don't make the same mistake twice
- Reflect on what you've learned in similar situations
- Balance past experience with current information
- Ask others for their advice

How To Build Your Skills:

- Accelerate your base of experience by keeping a journal of lessons learned, big and small
- Get experience by trying new things. Volunteer for projects that will stretch your limits and build experience
- Put new ideas to the test. "From my experience, do I think this will work?"
- Be open-minded
- Read case studies, articles and books. Learn from other people's experiences
- Watch TV shows where experts describe how to carry out tasks properly

Believe It To Achieve It: Rely On Experience

Intention:	To make solid decisions that rely on past experience
Believe It:	The past gives me some answers for the future
Feel It:	I feel confident
Think It:	Where have I seen this type of situation before?
Say It:	From past experience, the best thing to do is...
Do It:	Consult your own past experience in similar situations
Achieve It:	Powerful decisions based on lessons learned

Inappropriate Use:

- Using the same old approach every time
- Saying we've always done it this way and closing down other approaches
- Blocking creativity and change by saying "it will never work"

What To Ask:

- "What has worked for me in the past when making this type of decision?"
- "What has past experience taught me about what to do here?"
- "What other circumstances resemble this one and what can I apply here?"

Final Thoughts

Your past experience provides guideposts when you face new situations that demand a decision. Learn to trust the lessons learned from your previous experiences. Make your own life a learning journey, getting better and smarter with each experience. Ask others for advice. Be open to using their experience to help you make better decisions.

Values Driven

Making decisions based on your personal core beliefs about what is good or bad, right or wrong.

Emotion Based
Decision-Making

This is one of two very different and distinct strategies for emotion based decision-making. This strategy relies on making decisions based upon your own personal, deeply held values and beliefs.

Why This Strategy Is Important

Some decisions are harder to make than others. This decision-making strategy taps into your own personal values and beliefs to guide you in what to do. When you use it, you make your decision on what you deeply believe is right, regardless of what others believe or what the facts or logic might dictate. It is a powerful strategy and needs to be used with care and consideration, especially when others are involved.

Use It When:

- It's time to take a stand
- You have to make a decision based on what you believe is right
- You are passionate and committed to taking action

What To Do:

- Use your core beliefs and values to guide important actions and decisions
- Decide when it is appropriate to be passionate and strongly committed to what you believe in and when it isn't appropriate
- Balance your *Values driven* decisions with the common sense of critical thinking and with what your gut instinct tells you to do

How To Build Your Skills:

- Practice speaking in the first person. "I want" "I need" "I believe" "I feel"...
- Write down a list of values that you believe in. Pick one that is very important to you. Commit to acting on this value for three days. Use this value as part of a conscious strategy for guiding your actions
- Pick an issue that touches your heart. Take action on it

Believe It To Achieve It: Values Driven

Intention:	To make decisions that are true to your own values and beliefs
Believe It:	My way is the right way
Feel It:	I feel right and empowered to act
Think It:	This is the right thing to do
Say It:	What I want to do is based on what I value and believe
Do It:	Take strong positions, make a stand
Achieve It:	Decisions based on personal values and beliefs

Inappropriate Use:

- Ignoring other sources of information and making decisions based on values only
- Rigid, unilateral decision-making – "my way or the highway" – always imposing your values and beliefs on others.

What To Ask:

- "What really matters most to me?"
- "What do my personal values tell me to do?"
- "What do I believe is the right thing to do?"

Final Thoughts

Values driven is one of the most powerful strategies of all. It needs to be used with care and personal discipline in order to be effective. There are times when you must assert your own personal values. There are also times when you need to listen to others and respect their values as well. The best decisions will come when you can combine the practicality of your critical thinking with your values and gut instincts.

Trust Your Heart

Listening to your heart and feelings as a guide for making decisions about what to do.

Emotion Based Decision-Making

This is the second of the two emotion based decision-making strategies. It focuses your attention on what your heart tells you is the right thing to do. It is often very spontaneous in providing you direction and decisions.

Why This Strategy Is Important

The *trust your heart* strategy turns your attention to what your inner voice is telling you. Your intuition is a powerful source of information for making good decisions. Much like a flash of insight will suddenly appear, the *trust your heart* strategy will give you a gut feeling on what to do. This strategy is essential to use in fast moving, chaotic situations, where you have to decide quickly.

Use It When:

- You're facing a difficult decision and you need to get in touch with your gut feelings
- The facts aren't enough to guide you – you have little time to plan
- Logic is telling you one thing, but your feelings are telling you something different

What To Do:

- Tap into your heart as a reliable source of wisdom and guidance
- Supplement facts and opinions with your own deep instinctual feelings
- Use *trust your heart* as a short cut to decision-making when under pressure

How To Build Your Skills:

- Before deciding, stop and ask yourself “what feels like the right decision?” Does it feel like the right decision? Listen carefully to what your heart is telling you. If the answer is no, then you may need to reconsider
- Access your intuitive power. Pick a decision that you are facing that has two alternatives. Go to a quiet spot. Think hard about the decision. Using a coin, label alternative A, heads, and alternative B, tails. Tell yourself that you will make your decision based on the coin toss. Take three breaths, focus and flip the coin. As soon as you see the result (heads or tails), tap into your deepest feelings. Do you feel relief or disappointment? What has your heart told you? Do it again to confirm the result
- Practice, practice, practice – work on tuning-in to your gut instincts. Write down what your intuition is telling you to do

Believe It To Achieve It: Trust Your Heart

Intention:	To make the right decision
Believe It:	My gut will give me guidance
Feel It:	I feel in touch with what my heart is telling me
Think It:	Not too much – listen to your heart
Say It:	My gut tells me that... is the right thing to do
Do It:	Listen to what your heart tells you to do
Achieve It:	Decisions that are grounded in your own inner wisdom

Inappropriate Use:

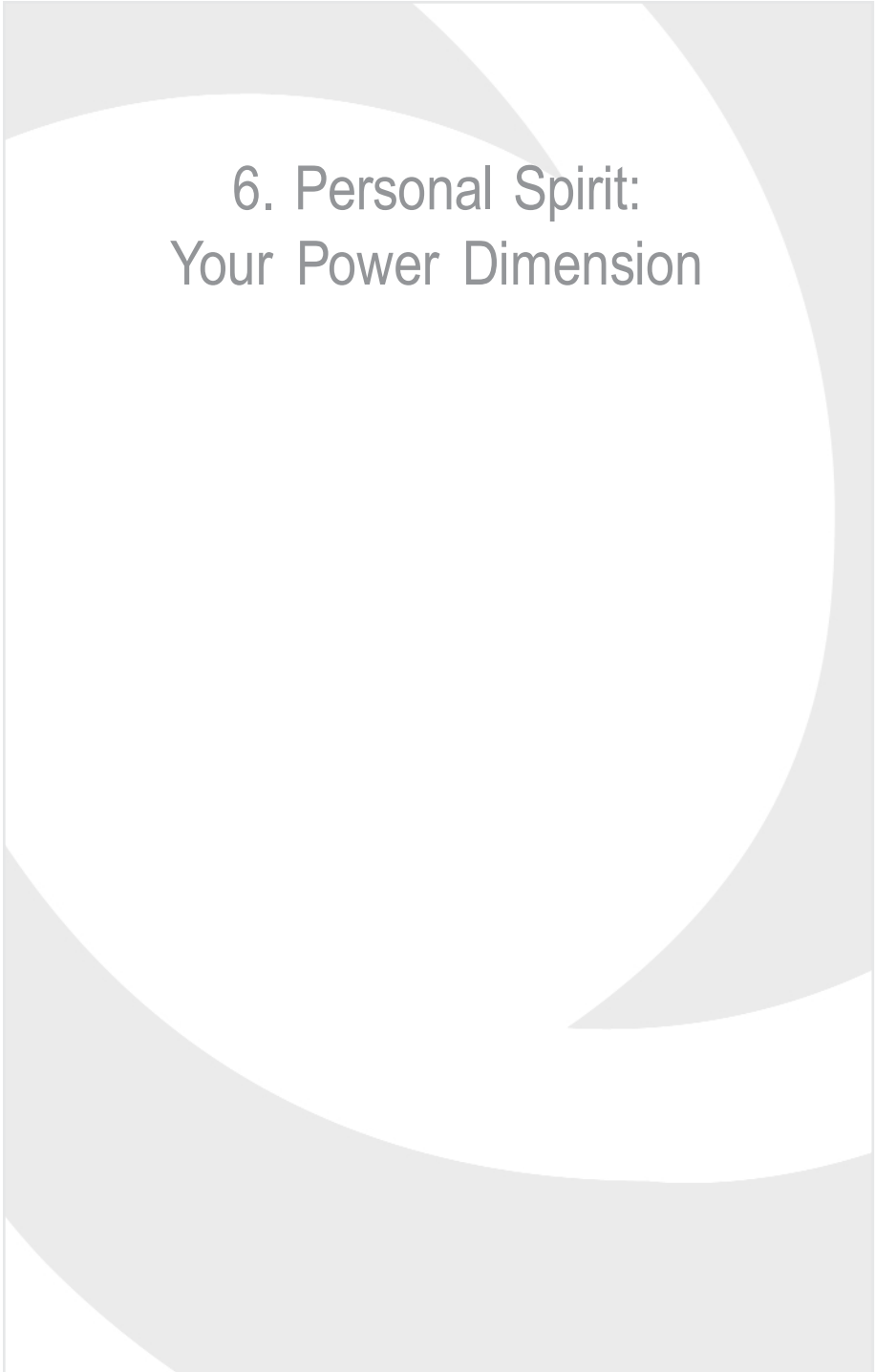
- Ignoring critical thinking strategies, relying solely on hunches and gut feelings to make all decisions
- Short-circuiting thinking processes with emotional ones

What To Ask:

- “In my heart of hearts, what do I really feel is the right thing to do?”
- “What is my gut telling me?”
- “Despite the all facts and logical conclusions, what do I feel is the right thing to do?”

Final Thoughts

Intuition is a vital source to use in making a decision. It is ideal for rapid decisions under pressure, when there is not enough time to analyze data. The best decisions will come when you can combine and align the practicality of your critical thinking with your intuition and your values.



6. Personal Spirit: Your Power Dimension

6. Personal Spirit: Your Power Dimension



Personal Spirit in your 4D-i profile is, in many ways, the most important dimension of all four. It is the expression of your own positive life force. Something like this is not easy to measure or capture in an instrument. Personal Spirit is the invisible, inner force that can take you and your performance to the next level. Your Personal Spirit is based on your beliefs about the world, about yourself, and how you act on those beliefs to make a positive difference.

A strong personal spirit acts as a positive energy source and a catalyst for making things happen. A weak personal spirit acts like an inner brake that always holds you back.

Personal Spirit is not about your spirituality but about the spirit and dynamism that you bring to your life. It is your catalyst for action. It will help you do something worthwhile with the understanding you gain. It will power up your decision-making with a can-do spirit.

Three Key Success Factors

In the 4D-i, Personal Spirit is made up of three key success factors:

Outlook: There is a growing body of evidence that shows how important a person's overall *outlook* is for their health as well as for the results they achieve. The more positive the *outlook*, the more optimistic one is about dealing with life's challenges, the more a person is likely to be happy, healthy and successful.

Sense of Control: This is a key predictor for how well people function under pressure. The greater the *sense of control*, the more personal power you can tap into. This will allow you to control your own responses when there is a high degree of stress.

Initiative: According to the research of Dr. Robert Kelley, *initiative* is the best predictor of star performance in the workplace. The greater the *initiative* taken, the higher the level of performance and the better the results.

These success factors empower you to act. They were drawn from a large body of research on the roots of high performance and health. They are vital in helping you to overcome anxiety, fear and helplessness. All three work together as a system. They are mutually reinforcing. Once you start to work on one, it can have a direct impact on the other two factors. For example, if you are feeling overwhelmed, begin to get a handle on what is happening and what you need to do. Do that and you increase your sense of control. When you feel more in control, your *outlook* brightens. With a positive *outlook*, you feel confident to take initiative. And so it goes.

If you are serious about working on your game and improving your performance, learning to leverage the three success factors is the best place to start.

The Power of Your Outlook:

What It Is

Your *outlook* is a key defining aspect of your personal operating style. It determines how you see life and what you get out of it. In the 4D-i, a high score in *outlook* refers to a positive, constructive way of experiencing life. Your *outlook* is both a rose-colored lens to see the world through and an active way of processing the world. It is founded on the deep belief that there is a basic goodness in the world and that with the right effort, things will work out. This aspect of personal spirit operates from the enduring belief that, no matter what happens, an optimistic approach to life will always help you deal with any person or task, no matter how difficult the challenge is.

Your *outlook*, positive or negative, is the result of an ongoing series of moment-to-moment choices you make. It is a deep part of who you are. It shows how you experience life and how others experience you. Your *outlook* acts like a self-fulfilling cycle. How you see life is what you get back from life.

Your *outlook* has a powerful effect on your relationships, at home and in the workplace. Some people carry their own weather with them. You can infect others with a positive, constructive *outlook*. You can also bring them down with a negative *outlook*.

Outlook: The Research

Martin Seligman, Ph.D. and Salvatore Maddi, Ph.D. are two outstanding scientists whose work has shown the importance of a positive *outlook* in performance, stress management and life success.

Seligman focuses on the importance of optimism as a factor in both happiness and success:

“It is the belief that good things may happen and are worth pursuing, but that effort, problem solving and planning are necessary to bring them about.”

What a positive *outlook* will give you is the ability to transform problems into opportunities. A positive *outlook* transforms adversity into part of your life journey.

There are about 100 articles on negative emotions for every article on happiness. The research from the new field of positive psychology shows the impact of one's *outlook* on performance, happiness and health. In study after study, people with a

strong positive *outlook* outperform those who have a negative outlook. They expect to succeed. They feel more control over their life, more empowered and less helpless. They tend to be healthier, get sick less often and when they do, recover faster. Studies show that people with a positive, optimistic *outlook* tend to live longer than others who lacked this approach to life. This optimism and way of experiencing the world is good for you. It is a buffer to illness and stress, a gateway to consistent high performance.

How To Develop Your Outlook

When adversity or setbacks happen, notice how you react. At a very deep level, do you believe that things will turn out all right or do you immediately focus on the worst case scenario? Notice your feelings—are you full of optimism and a sense of challenge or are you overcome with instant negativism?

Listen carefully to your own self-talk and the words that come out of your mouth. Do you look for the positive upside? Do you tend to focus on the downside?

Happiness is what most people want in their lives. Choose the positive *outlook* and you are on your way to being smart for life.

Outlook

A belief that an optimistic, constructive approach to life enables one to find the positive, hidden potential and meaning in any situation, task or person.

Personal Spirit

This is the first of the three key success factors that make up your personal spirit. Having a positive, optimistic, constructive approach to life is one of the defining characteristics of a person’s operating style. *Outlook* is more than just putting on a happy face. It is an active way of engaging in the world with realistic optimism.

Why This Factor Is Important

Your *outlook* on life, whether positive or negative, predicts how you experience life and what you get back from life. If you have an open, positive, optimistic *outlook*, then you will likely experience other people as friendly, cooperative and kind. If you have a closed, negative, pessimistic *outlook* on life, then you will often experience others as angry, upset and difficult to deal with. What you send out, you will get back.

Use It When:

- It is particularly important to turn on a positive, constructive *outlook* when difficulties occur. Learn to monitor your own reactions. Every difficulty offers potential for growth. See it that way. Strive to maintain a positive *outlook* all the time.

What To Do:

Your *outlook* is an active process of how you perceive the world around you:

- Choose to experience life’s events optimistically not pessimistically
- Look for what’s right, not what’s wrong with others
- Focus on finding the positive, hidden potential in any situation
- Transform negative events into useful learning opportunities

How To Build Your Skills:

Choose to take ownership over how you experience the world. Select the optimistic lens. Try these tactics to improve your overall *outlook*:

- Spend time with people who have a positive outlook. Avoid people who are chronically negative
- Write down all the reasons you are fortunate and what you can be thankful for
- Catch yourself in mid-thought when you start to slide into the negative
- Turn each adversity into just another stepping stone along the path of life

Believe It To Achieve It: Outlook

Intention:	To act as if you have a positive, optimistic way of experiencing life
Believe It:	People and life are basically good. Things will work out
Feel It:	I feel great about myself and about my life
Think It:	Where can I find the positive, hidden potential in this situation?
Say It:	I can figure this out and move forward
Do It:	Take a ‘can do’ approach. Work to find positive, constructive solutions
Achieve It:	Better results and greater feelings of empowerment

Avoid:

- Putting on a happy face and saying everything is fine when it is not
- Pessimistic approaches
- Cynical, hostile responses to what happens to you
- Negative reactions and negative emotions like anger

What To Ask:

- “Where is the silver lining in this problem?”
- “How can I switch to a positive approach?”
- “What positive, constructive lessons can I get from this difficult experience?”

Final Thoughts

You will be happier and more successful in your life when you choose to be positive. Using this key success factor means that you begin to respond consciously to life, not just react. It may not change the challenges or events in the external world but a change in your *outlook* will alter how you react to what happens to you.

The 4D-i Core Sources and Resources for AI Prompts

THE 4D-i SOURCES AND RESOURCES FOR THE AI

These are the source documents that contain all the information and references to provide the AI based answers to the work on the prompts that follow

The 4D-i Story

You are just confusing things right now

Let me know when you are finished so I can add the links - will do

[Working Smarter with Others Job Aid](#)

[Communication](#) Speaking, Presenting and Communicating Workbook

[Working Collaboratively with Others](#) Workbook

[Igniting Personal Spirit](#) Workbook

[Writing to Record, Report and Persuade Workbook](#) Thin...

The A+UCDI document

Smart for Life Book

Background - use the 4D-i Story paper

Q- Where did the 4D-i come from?

Q- Who developed the 4D-i(R)

A - Smart for Life book Acknowledgments page

The 4D-i Story

Q How do I understand my results?

Page 21 Thinking and Problem Solving book (de-brief explanation by strategy)

Q How does the scoring work?

A The scoring based on percentiles. Both a low score and a high score represent a standard differentiation from the rest of the population.

- A low score is a standard deviation from the norm and is statistically significant. It means that you scored much lower on liking to use it than 85% or more of the rest of the population

A high score is a standard deviation from the norm and is statistically significant. It means that you scored much higher on liking to use than 85% or more of the rest of the population

Q Is the 4D-i scientifically valid?

A Smart for Life book page 14

What research is behind the 4D-i

Q What does 4D-i stand for?

A Four Dimensions Inventory.

How is the 4D-i designed?

How many questions are there? 45 paired choices in the first section and 24 self rating statements in the second section

How long does it take to complete -15 to 20 minutes

What can I use the 4D-i for? -

Q Can we use the 4D-i for hiring?

A *The 4D-i is not intended for hiring purposes but can offer useful information when adding new members to teams. It can also identify gaps in the thinking on existing teams?*

Q Describe what thinking styles are?.

A Page 4 Thinking and Problem Solving Book (The 5)

Q How does the 4D-i help me be a better thinker and problem solver?

A Page 8 Thinking and Problem Solving Book

How is this a common language? - Page 10 Thinking and Problem Solving book

How would I use the 7 mindsets? Page 15 Thinking and Problem Solving book

What are the different ways I could use the 4d-i? Page 16 Thinking and Problem Solving book

What are some guidelines to improve performance in thinking and problem solving Page 22 T and PS book

Q Which are the strategies that make up the Intuitive Measure-

A Page 23 Smart for Life book

Colours in action

What does it mean to be in the red zone?

How can I tell what colour thinking someone else is using?

How do I work with someone who is high in a different colour than mine

Should I switch my thinking or should the other person switch their thinking?

What do I do to relate to someone high in

How do I shift my thinking?

Results

Will my results change over time

Should I take my 4D-i again

When can I take my 4D-i again

Do I have to pay to take the 4D-i again?

Can I buy one for a friend

Is there a discount to buy a second 4D-i?

Problem Solving Thinking and Problem Solving Work Book

How do I get the other person to move through the stages of problem solving?
What are some common mistakes people make in problem solving page 38 t and ps book
What is some advice in general problem solving? Page 38 T and PS Book
How do I know if I am overusing or underusing each colour in problem solving page 42 and 43
What happens when I overuse the colour in problem solving Page 42 and 43
What is the right use of each colour in problem solving? Page 42 and 43
What is the right time to use each colour in problem solving page 45 T and PS book
What are some processes I could use to solve problems - page 48, 49,50, 51, 52,53,54,55
What are some questions to help me get into each colour page 58 t and ps book, page 39 communication book
What are some tips to stimulate each colour thinking? Page 63 t and ps book
What is a good process for one to one meeting? Page 62 and page 64 communication workbook
How can I improve one to one conversations? Page 62 and page 64 communication workbook

Communication Speaking, Presenting and Communicating Workbook (WEM version)

What are some tips on what to say to convince and persuade someone in each colour? Page 15
Speaking, presenting and communicating WEM version
What are some different ways to shift into the red mindset to convince and persuade someone? Page 15
What are some tips to connect, clarify, describe something to someone. Page 17
What are some tips to be in cool and warm yellow page 17
What are some tips to shift into the green mindset page 19
What are some tips to shift into the creative mindset page 19
How do I shift into the white mindset to inspire others page 19
What are some things I can say to inspire others page 19

What are some tips on making good conversation page 21
Do you have any tips on how to listen well page 27
What are some good communication tips page 67
What is a good way to plan a presentation page 68
What should I do if I am presenting to someone high in red

or yellow or green

How do I write or speak to someone high in warm red page speaking, presenting and communicating (WestJet version) page 16
How do I write or speak to someone high in cool red page 16
How do I write or speak to someone high in green page 15 and 16
How do I write or speak to someone high in cool yellow page 13 and 16

How do I write or speak to someone high in warm yellow page 13 and 16

Personal Spirit

Describe each colour, mindset, strategy

Underuse and Overuse of each colour

What words do I use to speak in - the different mindsets and colours

What questions do I ask to bring out each colour in the other person

Thinking Tracks

If I need to solve a problem

Goal Setting

How do I prepare for an important performance event, presentation, interview?

Achieve it to Believe it Planner- attach Page 33 and 34 Thinking and Problem Solving book

How do I mentally set goals for an upcoming project/event/presentation Page 33 and 34?

A+UCDI -

What is a good coaching for performance process ? page 55 communication book

What is a good conversation process page 55 communication book

WORK IN PROGRESS - OSW TO SUPPLY DATA

*****How do I get along with people who think differently? The heads

How do I communicate with someone who is in (7 different mindsets)

Pairings

How do they relate to each other

Coaching Function

AI looks at individuals results

How do I get better at..

Relevant to individuals results

What should I work on?

If I want to get into leadership what should I work on?

1. I have a job interview coming up, how can my 4D-i help me?

AI response - Hi Mandy, Congratulations on your upcoming interview.

(AI looks at the person's High 5 and Low 5 strategies to provide answers relevant to interviewing)

2. I am writing my resume for a new job, what should I keep in mind?

(AI looks at the person's High 5 and Low 5 strategies to provide answers relevant to resume writing)

3. I am chairing a team meeting, and everyone is high in green what should I do? (AI looks at the person's High 5 and Low 5 strategies to provide answers relevant to chairing a meeting with green people)

4. I am meeting with my manager who is very high in cool yellow....

(AI looks at the person's High 5 and Low 5 strategies to provide answers relevant to communicating with people high in cool yellow)

5. I am meeting with my manager who is low in cool yellow.....

(AI looks at the person's High 5 and Low 5 strategies to provide answers relevant to people low in cool yellow)

6. I have a selling conversation with a prospective new client...etc. Etc.

7. I have a performance review discussion

8. I have a meeting to scope out a new project

9. I have a committee planning meeting

10. I am having a coaching conversation with my direct report

11. Is there an ideal profile for a leader?

Q What should I work on?

A There is not an ideal profile and the goal of the 4D-i is that you would be able to use all of the thinking strategies as they are needed in life? I see in your profile that you have a preference to

overuse It would be good for you to use these strategies to work on some of your lower preference strategies.

Q What is the difference between Brainstorm and Challenge

A. Brainstorm is helpful when you are facing a new situation you've never experienced before and you need new ways of working. Brainstorming requires great imagination to come up with brand new things that haven't been created before.

Challenge Assumptions is helpful when you want to improve how you are doing something. People who are brought into make change are often high in Challenge Assumptions. Challenge involves questioning how and why things have been done as they are. Challenging can annoy others who are vested in how things have always been done, so use your skills in tune-in to pitch your message appropriately, when suggesting new ideas that challenge others.

Q How is *Brainstorm Ideas* different from *Challenge Assumptions*

Q What is a situation where each strategy is ideally suited?

Q What is a situation when each strategy is the right strategy to use

Brainstorm Ideas page 54 Smart 4 Life book When you need a new solution to a new challenge.

An example would be -

Brainstorm

Challenge Assumptions page 56 Smart for Life book

An example would be- During the pandemic closures businesses had to evolve and "pivot" as health regulations changed, almost daily. The restaurant industry was greatly impacted when customers were not allowed to enter restaurants. In order to stay in business many focused on making food and drink that customers could consume at home. They created take out windows. They sold alcohol in individual servings. They created kits of food and drink that people could make at home. They cooked outside. They stopped selling food and became bottle shops where only alcohol was purchased. They delivered their products using electronic payments and porch pick ups, so there was no human interaction. They questioned how they had always worked and used examples from other industries to improve their offerings.

Reframe page 58 Smart 4 Life book

An example would be- You have had an injury and for a short time your mobility is limited and you are struggling with pain. You sit back and observe life in general and have the opportunity to see the world with a new perspective. Because it's hard to leave home, you have opportunity to sit quietly and work on all the projects you were too busy to work on before. You are more empathetic of others who live with chronic pain. You now realize how difficult it is to get around in a wheelchair and are more appreciative of the struggles that many people live with. You have

time with your friends who come to visit you and sit and talk with you. You are more appreciative of your regular life when you don't experience pain. You develop new self care habits to ensure you don't reinjure yourself.

Envision- Focuses on seeing future possibilities. People who are high in Envision can often see pictures of how things will be in the future. Your future visions inspire you to move towards the goals and plans you create for yourself. To prompt your envisioning you can ask yourself questions like "Where do I want to be in a year?" "When I am finished this job/course/ project how will my life be different? "If I don't make any changes what will my life look like in a year?" "What will my life look like, if I don't find a new job?" By doing this you are visualizing the outcome of your efforts. This can be inspiring to keep going to reach that positive goal and it may also be motivating to modify your work and habits so that you can create a better future for yourself.

Flow

An example would be

When you are in flow you put off making any decisions so that you remain open to new intuitive insights and ideas that could present new solutions. This is helpful when you are just starting something or when you don't have tight deadlines and have time to explore many possibilities. When you are relaxed and in flow, your mind is open and you aren't judging or deciding yet, you are giving yourself time to see what intuitive insight will arrive.

An example would be

Flash of Insight

An example would be

Scan- Scanning for information is a good strategy to use when you need to have a deep understanding of a situation. If you have a job interview coming up, having the logistical details will help you to get to the right place, with time to relax and compose yourself in advance. You also need to have a deep understanding of the role you have applied for, an overview of the company, and the value that you would add to the company.

When making a major purchase, scanning for information about the product, comparing to similar items, reading the customer reviews about the quality, usage recommendations, delivery options, care instructions etc. will ensure you are making an informed choice.

Structure

Creating structure from information, resources, time, etc is helpful when you need to get organized to complete a task and you need to make a plan or set up a list of things to do and a sequence to do them in...using a system or structure to categorize or analyze data to increase understanding and meaning.

Clarify- Asking questions of clarification ensures that you understand and are on track to success. Questions such as “You’d like me to arrive an hour before the event, is that correct?” “Is there public parking available nearby?” “The fire hydrant we need to repair is the only one on the south side of Peel Street, is that correct?” The questions can be as specific or as general as needed and are about clarifying that you understand the situation correctly.

Tune in to Feelings page 74

Example - Tuning in is helpful in situations where being aware of the feelings of others is important to you and your success. As a team lead you may be planning to introduce a new project/idea/work process at work. Understanding the mood or tone of the team in advance of adding new work to their load could be helpful in choosing the timing of this, or the way in which you pitch the additional work to them. Some ideas to tune in to a team would be to listen to the words they say, how they feel (tired, fulfilled, etc) at the end of the day, if they choose to be social with each other, if there is ongoing conflict, if they are supportive of each other and whether they speak positively about the the future in your team.

Empathize with Others page 76

Example -

Q How is *Tune in to Feelings* different from *Empathize with Others*

Tune in is about noticing and observing what is going on around you, specifically with other people and their reactions, feelings, moods. At a high level it’s about picking up on subtle cues of behaviour that show the other person’s thoughts and feelings. It’s about “reading the room”. Empathize is about being with the other person and feeling what is going on with them. At a high level empathize is genuinely feeling the other person’s feeling, paying attention to their feelings and not judging, not giving them ideas and solutions just being with them and giving them your time and space.

It is possible to do one of these without the other. Someone high in tune-in is keenly aware of what is going on with others, and if they are low in empathize, they may keep an emotional distance and not feel the other person’s feelings. Someone low in tune-in may not notice other people’s feelings but if they are high in empathize they will be able to share their feelings, if they are expressed openly

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Express

Crux

Conclude

Validate

Experience

Values Driven

Trust Your Heart

What can I do to increase my Personal Spirit scores?

AI AND THE 4D-i®: MINDSETS AND STRATEGIES

MINDSETS: Core Source Resource for The Mindsets:

- 1. Source data for all the mindsets is in the The 4D-i Root Document**
- 2. Source data is in the Smart for Life book - pages 37 to 46**

- § What does a low score in..... mean?
- § What does a low average score mean?
- § What does an average score mean?
- § What does a high average score mean?
- § What does a high score mean?
- § What's the difference between a low score and a high score in..? – show results
- § Why is this....strategy important? – see text

THE STRATEGIES FRAMEWORK – 5 levels of data – low, low average – average – high average – high

Core Source Resources for the Strategies:

- 1. Source data for all these questions is in the The 4D-i Root Document**
- 2. Source data is in the Smart for Life book - pages 47 to 112**

LOW AND LOW AVERAGE STRATEGY SCORES

- § What does a low score in..... mean?
- § What does a low average score mean?
- § What happens if I /someone avoids using it? – see Avoids..
- § What happens if I /someone doesn't like to use it? – see Avoids using it text
- § What happens if I /someone doesn't know how to use it? – see avoids using it text
- § How can I develop this strategy? – see Skill builders
- § What are some coaching tips on using it properly?- see Coaching Principle and see Skill Builders

AVERAGE SCORES

- § What does an average score in..... mean?
- § Why is this important?
- § What are some coaching tips on how I can improve?- see Coaching Principle and Tips
- § How can I use this strategy? – see How to use section

HIGH AVERAGE AND HIGH SCORES

- § What does a high score in..... mean?
- § What does a high average score mean?
- § What happens if I /someone overuses it? – see Be Careful of..

- § What are the benefits of a high score – high average score – see Play to Your Strengths
- § How can I coach or help others learn how to use strategy? – see Be a Coach/ Help Others
- § How can I use this strategy? – see How to use

WRITING TO RECORD, REPORT AND PERSUADE WORKBOOK

- What to say to connect with someone who is high in? - p 50
 - § How to write to someone who is high in – red/yellow/ green/white – p 50
 - Yellow cool – page 4
 - Yellow warm – page 4
 - Red – page 5
 - White - page 5
 - Green -page 6
 - § How can I use the smart tracks to plan my writing or presentation – p 24
 - § How can I use the colours to plan my writing or presentation? – pages 14 and 20
 - § What are some different words and phrases I can use to be effective in using each of the 21 strategies? - note -
 - provide the specific text for each of the strategies
 - Red strategies – page 7
 - Yellow strategies -page 8
 - Green strategies – page 9
 - White strategies – page 9

IGNITING PERSONAL SPIRIT WORKBOOK

- § What are the mind traps and what do they do? – page 7
- § What are the 3 Me's? – page 19
- § What is personal spirit and resilience – page 30, pages 32 and 33
- § What are some ways/tips to build my/strengthen my resilience- page 34
- § Tell me more – what is outlook in person spirit – page 39 and 40
- § What are some ways to improve my outlook?- pages 44 and 45
- § Tell me more – what is sense of control in person spirit – page 56
- § What are some ways to increase my sense of control in personal spirit?- page 67,69,77
- § Tell me more – what is initiative in person spirit – page 85 and 86
- § What are some ways to improve my initiative in personal spirit?- page 87
- § How can I use personal spirit to increase my value at work? – page 97

WORKING COLLABORATIVELY WITH OTHERS WORKBOOK

- § How can I improve my relationships – page 7 and 8
- How to powershift from one mindset into another
 - § What is powershifting and how do I do it? – page 17 /top half, page 18/bottom half, page 21
 - § How do I stop using each mindset – page 22

- § How do I shift out of a mindset? – page 25
- § How do I shift into a different colour or mindset? – page 28
- § How do I connect with green and shift to red? – page 30
- § How do I shift from yellow to red? – page 33
- § How do I shift from green to yellow? – page 36
- § How do I shift from red to green? – page 39
- § How do I shift from yellow to green? – page 42
- § Conflict - How do different types of thinking or colours show up in conflict? – page 63
- § How can use this – the smart skills – the colours – to help me in conflict? - page 63
and 67

§